

Mastery English (C2 Proficiency)

The full teaching manual for a 13-week adult-education C2 class (26 classes × 90 minutes): lesson stages and timing, board plans, drilling and concept-check questions, pair-work, error correction, differentiation, and L1 watch-outs.

8 modules • 24 lessons

26 classes • 90 min • 13 weeks

Teacher copy • not for students

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Module 1 — The Mot Juste: Precision & Nuance

Three classes that open the C2 level. Your learners already have a vast vocabulary and control of register; the C2 frontier is **discrimination**. First, the single word: denotation and connotation (*frugal vs stingy*), the myth of the synonym (*surprised · astonished · taken aback · bemused*), semantic prosody (*why rot sets in* but happiness doesn't) and the specificity dividend (*walked slowly and wearily → trudged*). Then the whole manner: **register agility** across field, tenor and mode, with **tone** as a second, independent dial. Last, the prefabricated layer: **binomials** in their fixed order (*by and large, odds and ends*), **restricted collocations** (*a foregone conclusion, bitterly disappointed*), **lexical bundles**, fixed similes, and the garbles that betray a speaker (*for all intensive purposes*).

3 lessons

Lessons 1.1–1.3

Classes C1–C3

Weeks 1–2

90 min per class

CEFR C2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** (workbook) → a demanding **workshop** → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**. C1 (the first class) replaces the warmer with a welcome routine that doubles as a **C1 diagnostic**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-1-mot-juste.html](#). Print [materials/module-1/classroom-materials.html](#) before C1. It holds the force-cline picture cards and word cards, the **welcome question cards**, the **C1 diagnostic grid** and writing-sample rubric, the new identity cards, the **Mot Juste Editing Workshop** texts, the **Five Voices** message cards and voice specifications, the **Naturalness Audit** texts, the **Odds and Ends** binomial card game and all the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons (with a UK or US voice), so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- These are workshops, not lectures.** At C2 nobody needs the concept explained twice; they need to *use* it under pressure and be held to a high standard. Every class spends roughly a quarter of its time on one extended product: a tuned text with a justification log (C1), one message written in five voices and performed (C2), an audited near-native text plus a binomial card game (C3). Protect that time. If you run late, cut the controlled practice (set it for homework), never the workshop.

- ◆ **Refinement, not re-teaching.** At C1 your learners met connotation and collocation (C1 4.2), register and nominalization (C1 3.1) and softening (C1 3.3). Do not re-teach any of it. The C2 step is **deliberate effect**: choosing a word, a register or a chunk on purpose, being able to say which dimension you adjusted, and hearing the near-imperceptible clash that separates a very good speaker from an indistinguishable one.
- ◆ **Feedback on four things.** In every workshop, take notes in four columns: **precision** (the vague or approximate word: *a lot of bad problems, very big*), **naturalness** (grammatical but not what a proficient user would say: *caused her success, a loud success, make a hard bargain, quiet and peace*), **appropriacy** (right word, wrong room: *utilize* in a friendly email, *as easy as pie* in a report, a stray *notwithstanding* in a tweet) and **effect** (does the choice do what the writer wants: flatter, damn, amuse, move?). Keep a small side note for **fossils**: the one or two persistent accuracy errors (*informations, I am agree, since three years*) that survive to C2. In the feedback stage, board 2–3 items from each column, without names.
- ◆ **Giving C2 learners genuinely useful feedback.** C2 learners are often near-native in some areas and fossilized in others, and most have heard "Your English is excellent" so often that it no longer helps them. Be specific and ambitious: quote their exact words, name the dimension ("*caused* leans negative here, so your success sounds like an accident"), and offer the proficient alternative. Praise precise choices by name, not "good job." For fossils, agree a **private target** with each learner (one error, one term) and flag it only when it appears, never in front of the class. Many C2 learners are language professionals: invite them to argue with your suggestion. "Convince me" is a legitimate C2 reply to feedback, and defending a choice is itself the skill.
- ◆ **Peer review, every class.** Each workshop ends with a structured peer-review test: the "**Justify or cut**" test (C1: every change must name its dimension, and the skeptic may challenge any change as ornament), the "**Clang hunt**" (C2: listeners raise a hand at any stray marker that belongs to another register) and the "**Seams test**" (C3: can you hear where a chunk was bolted on?). Reviewers always give **one strength** and **one suggestion**, in that order, and quote the text rather than summarize it.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** C2 classes attract confident professionals (lawyers, academics, translators, managers) who are used to being the best English speaker in the room. Give them the roles that require listening and restraint: in C1 the **skeptic** (who may only ask "Does this serve or show off?"), in C2 the **clang hunter** for another group's performance, in C3 the **auditor** who must justify every flag with the category (order / partner / garble / register / stuffing). Say it kindly: "You've got the sharpest ear in the room; I need it on the checklist this round." In whole-class feedback, use "a new voice first."
- ◆ **Stretching the strongest learners.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The direction for this module is **connotation as persuasion** and **controlled mismatch**: writing the same fact to flatter and to damn (C1), deliberate register clash for irony (C2: the mock-legalistic notice about a missing stapler) and knowingly bending a fixed expression for wit, which only works once you own the original (C3). This leads straight into Module 2 (irony, humor and implicature).
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and a good deal of British vocabulary (*colour, behaviour, judgement, recognise, utilise, endeavour, humour, nominalisation, finalised*; in 1.2 *solicitor, vendor, completion, bloke, chuffed, knackered, gutted, soz, cheers, mate, give me a shout*; in 1.3 *touch wood*). Teach *color, behavior, judgment, recognize, utilize, endeavor, lawyer / attorney, seller, closing*,

knock on wood. At C2, treat the British forms as **receptive** knowledge worth having (Module 5 covers varieties of English): accept them whenever a learner uses them, but point out that British slang in an American workplace is itself a register choice.

- Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Choose the word → choose the voice → choose the chunk. In C1 learners weigh a single word on every axis at once (denotation, connotation, force, register, specificity, prosody) and tune a vague text until every word earns its place. In C2 they zoom out to the whole manner of a message, sliding one proposition across five registers and learning that tone (warm, cool, ironic, authoritative, deferential) is a separate dial from formality. In C3 they meet the layer below the word: the ready-made chunks that proficient users retrieve whole, in their fixed order and with their fixed partners. Every class produces something another learner reads, hears or judges.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: TRIBUTES, NOTICES AND BEREAVEMENT

Register work easily drifts toward heavy occasions (eviction notices, condolences). For learners who have been displaced, lost housing or recently lost someone, these can land hard. Keep examples light, as the online lesson 1.2 does: the cline example is a **community center closing early**, and the "eulogy-style tribute" in the Five Voices workshop is always a tribute to a **retiring person** or a **place that is closing** (a bakery, a movie theater, a pool), never to someone who has died. Learners never write about their own bereavement, and anyone can take a different message card or say "Pass." If a learner chooses to mention a personal loss, thank them simply and move on; don't build a task on it.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- **Placement.** Ideally, learners finished the C1 course or took the toolkit placement test (../instructor-toolkit/placement-test.html). Either way, the C1 welcome mingle and the 8-minute writing sample double as a **C1 diagnostic** (see Lesson 1.1). It won't replace a placement test, but it will show you, within the first hour, each learner's profile across **precision, range, naturalness** and **register control**, which is exactly what this course trains.
- Print the **welcome question cards** (Set B, one set per 16 learners), **one copy of the C1 diagnostic grid** and writing-sample rubric for you on a clipboard, and name tents (folded paper is fine). The writing-sample page is in the workbook (Lesson 1.1).
- Print the **flashcards** (Set A, one set for the board): picture force-cline cards (8), connotation and prosody word cards (C1), register-room picture cards and tone cards (C2), binomial picture cards and strong-collocation cards (C3).

- ◆ For C1: one **Mot Juste Editing Workshop** text per group of 3 (4 texts; Set D) and one justification log per group (in the workbook).
- ◆ For C2: the **Five Voices** message cards (6; Set E), one **voice specification sheet** per group, and a **Clang hunt** slip per listener.
- ◆ For C3: one **Naturalness Audit** text per pair (4 texts; Set F) and one set of **Odds and Ends** cards per group of 3–4 (Set G). Cut the game cards before class and keep each set in an envelope.
- ◆ Print the **new identity cards** (Set C) and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- ◆ Optional but powerful: bring two real texts that describe the same thing with different connotation (a glowing and a lukewarm review of the same restaurant; a company's press release and a news report on the same announcement). C2 learners enjoy dissecting real language far more than invented examples.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
1.1	C1 • wk 1	Welcome + C1 diagnostic (speaking mingle + 8-minute writing sample: precision, range, naturalness, register control); denotation vs connotation (<i>frugal / stingy, resolute / obstinate</i>); near-synonym clines of force (<i>decent → good → excellent → superb → sublime</i>); the myth of the synonym (<i>surprised, astonished, startled, taken aback, flabbergasted, bemused</i>); careful senses (<i>bemused, enormity, fulsome</i>); semantic prosody (<i>set in, cause, utterly, bordering on, a breeding ground for</i>); force, register and specificity	tune a deliberately vague text by replacing at least ten adequate words with precise, well-weighted ones, name the dimension improved by each change, and cut any change that shows off rather than serves
1.2	C2 • wk 1	Field, tenor, mode and the formality cline (frozen → formal → neutral → informal → intimate); markers that move as a cluster (lexis, nominalization, voice, contractions, stance, sentence length); tone as a second dial (warm, cool, ironic, authoritative, deferential); the register clang : over-formality, misplaced slang, archaism and jargon as resources or liabilities	render one message in five voices (official notice, friendly email, press release, social post, tribute) so that every marker agrees, justify each with field, tenor and mode, and deliver each aloud with a matching tone
1.3	C3 • wk 2	Binomials and trinomials in irreversible order (<i>by and large, odds and ends, lock, stock and barrel</i>); restricted collocation (<i>a foregone conclusion, a moot point, a vested interest, drive a hard bargain</i>); lexical bundles and their register (<i>that said, for what it's worth, at the</i>	audit a near-native text for unnatural collocations, misordered binomials, garbled expressions, register clashes and overstuffing, classify and fix each, and use

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		<i>end of the day</i>); fixed similes; garbles (<i>a mute point, nip it in the butt</i>); overstuffing	binomials accurately and fluently in a timed card game

1.1 · C1

Welcome to C2 · Fine Shades of Meaning — The Mot Juste

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ distinguish a word's **denotation** (dictionary sense) from its **connotation** (the feeling and value judgment it carries), and choose positive, neutral or negative near-synonyms deliberately (*thrifty / careful with money / stingy*)
- ◆ order near-synonyms on a **cline** of force (*tepid → warm → hot → scorching*) and explain what else separates them: register, collocation, specificity (*surprised vs startled vs taken aback*)
- ◆ use the careful senses of commonly misused words (*bemused* = bewildered; *fulsome* = excessive; *enormity* = great wickedness)
- ◆ recognize **semantic prosody** (the good or bad company a word habitually keeps) and repair a prosody clash (*caused a victory → brought about / secured*)
- ◆ replace a weak word plus a modifier with one specific word (*walked slowly and wearily → trudged*), and stop before precision turns into ornament

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.1 (Welcome to C2, writing sample, New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Mot Juste Editing Workshop log, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 1–9 · name tents · **Welcome question cards** (Set B) · **C1 diagnostic grid** + writing-sample rubric (your copies) · force-cline picture cards and connotation / prosody word cards (Set A) · **Mot Juste Editing Workshop** texts (Set D) · New identity cards (Set C)
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.1-A (two references for the same colleague) and 1.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: one fact, three judgments. careful with money (0) → **frugal / thrifty** (+) → **stingy / tight-fisted** (–). determined → **resolute** (+) / **obstinate, pig-headed** (–). confident → **self-assured** (+) / **cocky, smug** (–). Denotation = the dictionary · Connotation = the verdict.

Center: no true synonyms. Force: decent → good → excellent → superb → sublime. Register: kids → children → offspring. Specificity: walk → stride · amble · trudge · saunter. Careful senses: *bemused* = puzzled (not amused) · *fulsome* = excessive · *enormity* = wickedness.

Right: the company words keep (prosody). set in: rot, despair, winter (not happiness) · cause: damage, delay, concern (success? → *bring about, lead to*) · a breeding ground for: crime, resentment · rife with: corruption · a spate of: burglaries. Test: Force? Connotation? Register? Prosody? Specific? Then: does it serve or show off?

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome & name tents	5	T-S	Greet each person at the door. Learners write the name they want to be called on a name tent (a new-identity name is fine). Learn to say every name correctly , and ask once how the person prefers it said. Introduce yourself with one deliberately precise word and one deliberately vague one, and let them catch it: "I'm ___, and I'm thrilled — well, <i>moderately delighted</i> — to be teaching this group."
Welcome mingle = C1 diagnostic (speaking)	14	S-S (mingle)	Slide 3. Each learner takes four welcome question cards , one of each color (LOOK CLOSER · SHADES OF MEANING · TAKE A POSITION · SAY IT THREE WAYS). They find a partner, ask one question and one follow-up , answer in a long turn (about a minute), then swap one card and find a new partner (4 rounds, about 3 min each). You walk with the diagnostic grid (see "Running the diagnostic" below). Last minute: 2 learners report the most precise word they heard a partner use. ICQs first.
Writing sample	8	S	Workbook 1.1, "First-day writing sample." Learners choose prompt A (describe a place, object or routine precisely, for a reader who has never seen it) or B (the same piece of news twice: an email to a senior colleague and a two-line message to a friend), 100–150 words, no phones or dictionaries . Say: "This isn't a test. It shows me where your English is already masterful and where it's merely very good." Collect or photograph the pages at the end of class.
About this course	3	T-S	Slide 2. 26 classes, 2 a week, 13 weeks; the workbook; the online course is homework (show it and tap a 📶 button). C2 = nuance, pragmatics, style and authority : not proving you can speak English, but wielding it with precision. Feedback will target four things (write them on the board edge and leave them all term): precision · naturalness · appropriacy · effect .
Lead-in: the lightning-bug	3	T-S	Slide 4. Mark Twain: "The difference between the almost right word and the right word is... the difference between the lightning-bug and the lightning." Board: <i>She's careful with money</i> . Ask: "Say it so I'll admire her. Now so I'll dislike

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			her." Elicit <i>frugal</i> / <i>stingy</i> . "Same behavior? (Yes.) Same verdict? (No.) Today: the word that is <i>exactly</i> right."
Meaning: connotation, clines, prosody	14	T-S → S-S	Slides 5–8. (1) Force clines with the picture cards (slide 5): pairs get 90 seconds to order the word cards under each picture (<i>small</i> → <i>tiny</i> → <i>minuscule</i> ; <i>cold</i> → <i>chilly</i> → <i>freezing</i> → <i>glacial</i>), then check. (2) Connotation (slide 6): the + / 0 / – table; one learner reads a neutral description, the class makes it flattering, then damning. (3) The myth of the synonym (slide 7): the <i>surprised</i> family, plus the careful senses (<i>bemused</i> , <i>fulsome</i> , <i>enormity</i>). (4) Semantic prosody (slide 8): "Rot set in" vs "Happiness set in." CCQs throughout (below).
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: "Flatter it, damn it," "Up the cline" and "One exact word." Choral for the contrastive-stress sentence, then individuals, then open pairs.
Controlled practice + listening	8	S → S-S	Read Script 1.1-A (two references for the same colleague); learners complete Ex 1 (the admirer's word and the critic's word). Then Ex 2–3 alone, check in pairs. Board-check only the disagreements (usually <i>forceful</i> and <i>old-fashioned</i> , where 0 and – are both defensible: praise the argument, not the label). Ex 4–5 go to homework unless a pair finishes early.
Freer: Mot Juste Editing Workshop	20	S-S → T-S	Slide 9. Groups of 3 get one deliberately vague text (Set D: a museum web page, a team update, a product review, a volunteer newsletter). Tune (10 min) : at least 10 changes, at least one each of force, connotation, specificity and register, no change to the facts; log four changes in the workbook. Justify or cut (6 min) : swap with the next group; the reviewers read the tuned text aloud, and the group's skeptic challenges any change: "Does this serve or show off?" The authors must name the dimension or cut the change. Share (4 min) : two groups read before and after; the class votes for the single best substitution. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns on the board, no names. Precision: "a lot of very old things" → <i>a wealth of antiques</i> . Naturalness: "caused a great atmosphere." Appropriacy: "The café is commendably economical" (grand for a museum web

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			page). Effect: praise one change that altered the verdict (<i>modest vs unpretentious</i>). Learners fix and discuss.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box. Collect the writing samples.
Total	90		5 + 14 + 8 + 3 + 3 + 14 + 5 + 8 + 20 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

The welcome mingle is the most important part of C1: the group needs it, and you need the diagnostic. Don't cut it. If time is short, the writing sample becomes homework (same prompts, "no dictionary, 10 minutes, please"), the drill shrinks to "Flatter it, damn it," and the workshop share is dropped. Keep at least 14 minutes for the Mot Juste Editing Workshop.

◆ RUNNING THE DIAGNOSTIC – WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

The mingle is a friendly first conversation, not an exam. Learners must never feel watched. Hold the grid on a clipboard, stand near a pair for 30–60 seconds, and join in sometimes ("What's the difference, for you, between *assertive* and *pushy*?"). Mark each learner ✓ (masterful: consistent and effortless) · ~ (strong, with gaps or occasional misfires) · ✗ (avoids it or can't produce it yet) in four columns:

- ◆ **PRECISION** (LOOK CLOSER cards): Does the learner reach for the exact word (*trudged, cluttered, faintly musty*) or circle with weak word + modifier (*very big, a bit bad, walked slowly*)? Do they paraphrase gracefully around a missing word?
- ◆ **RANGE** (SHADES OF MEANING and TAKE A POSITION cards): Can they explain a connotation difference and illustrate it? Do they use idiom, advanced collocation, cleft and fronted structures, nuanced hedging and concession (*granted..., that said...*) without effort?
- ◆ **NATURALNESS** (all cards): Do the chunks sound native-like (*by and large, a foregone conclusion, bitterly disappointed*) or subtly homemade (*a big success, strong rain, make a photo, in the other hand*)? Note any fossils (*informations, I am agree, since three years, discuss about*).
- ◆ **REGISTER CONTROL** (SAY IT THREE WAYS cards): Does the whole cluster of markers move between the friend, the colleague and the written notice, or only the vocabulary? Can they sound warm *and* formal? Many C1 graduates are accurate but tonally flat or over-formal: that is exactly what C2 trains.

The writing sample. Score it with the four-row rubric in the materials (Set B): **precision, range, naturalness** and **register & tone control**, 0–3 each. As a rough guide: 10–12 = already performing at C2 in writing (give Stretch tasks and ask them to lead peer review); 6–9 = the typical C2 entry profile; 5 or less **and** mostly ✗ in the speaking grid = check the placement privately (the toolkit's oral interview takes 5 minutes); the learner may be better served by the C1 course. A spiky profile (for example, superb academic precision but an

intimate register that sounds like a textbook) is normal at this level; note it and target the weaker dimension.

What to do with the results. Write one short, private, specific note to each learner by C3: one strength and one focus, quoting their own words ("*A faintly institutional smell* is exactly right. Focus: *since three years* → *for three years*, and reserve *utilize* for technical contexts."). **Never share the grid with learners.** Keep it; compare it with Progress Test 1 in C13.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WELCOME MINGLE

SAY: *How many cards do you take? (Four, one of each color.) · How long is your answer: one sentence? (No, about a minute.) · What do you ask after the answer? (A follow-up question.) · After each conversation, what do you do? (Swap one card and find a new partner.) · Do you have to talk about your real life? (No. A new identity card, something invented, or "Pass.") · On the TAKE A POSITION card, must you give your real opinion? (No, you can argue the side printed on the card.)*

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: denotation and connotation. Two words can point at the same thing and pass opposite verdicts on it. The choice of word is the message.

SAY: *"She's frugal." "She's stingy." Is she spending a lot of money in either sentence? (No.) Same behavior? (Yes.) Which speaker likes her? (The first.) So what changed: the facts or the judgment? (The judgment.) · "He's resolute." "He's pig-headed." Would you put either in a job reference? (Resolute, yes; pig-headed, never.)*

Meaning: no true synonyms. Near-synonyms almost always differ in at least one dimension: force, register, collocation, specificity or connotation.

SAY: *"I was startled." Long or short? (Short, sudden.) Physical or mental? (Often physical: a noise.) · "I was taken aback by his tone." Pleasant surprise? (No, usually disconcerting.) · "I was bemused by the instructions." Was I laughing? (No.) Was I confused? (Yes.) · "Absolutely flabbergasted." Would you write it in a report? (No: very strong, informal, faintly comic.)*

Meaning: semantic prosody. Some words carry an aura of approval or disapproval simply from the company they keep. Ignoring it produces sentences that are grammatical but subtly foreign.

SAY: *"Rot had set in." "A deep contentment set in." Which sounds natural? (Rot.) Is the second grammatically wrong? (No.) So why does it grate? (Set in usually introduces something unpleasant and gradual.) · "Years of practice caused her success." What does cause usually go with? (Damage, delay, problems.) Better verb? (brought about, led to, paved the way for.)*

Meaning: specificity and restraint. One exact word often beats a weak word plus modifiers, but precision is not ornament.

SAY: "She trudged home." Fast or slow? (Slow.) Energetic or tired? (Tired, heavy.) Why is it better than "walked slowly and wearily"? (Shorter, stronger, more exact.) · "I shall endeavor to utilize the facility." Precise or pompous? (Pompous: I'll try to use the gym.) Is the grand word ever the mot juste? (Yes, when the room calls for it.)

Form.

Connotation	neutral · positive · negative	thin → slender, svelte / skinny, scrawny · unusual → distinctive / odd, peculiar · careful with money → thrifty, frugal / stingy, miserly
Force cline	weakest → strongest	tepid → warm → hot → scorching · irritated → annoyed → furious → livid · decent → good → excellent → superb → sublime
Register	informal → neutral → formal	kids → children → offspring · get → receive → obtain · try → attempt → endeavor
Specificity	general → exact	walk → stride, amble, trudge, saunter · say → mutter, chide, exclaim · look → glance, peer, scrutinize
Prosody	the habitual company	set in (rot, despair) · cause (damage, concern) · utterly (ruined, exhausted) · bordering on (rudeness, obsession) · rife with (corruption) · a spate of (burglaries) · a breeding ground for (resentment)
Careful senses	the traditional meaning	bemused = bewildered · fulsome praise = excessive, insincere · enormity = great wickedness (not just size)

Pronunciation. Model the terms learners will use all term: con·no·TA·tion, de·no·TA·tion, **PROS**·o·dy, **SYN**·o·nym but sy·**NON**·y·mous; *mot juste* is French: /moʊ 'zu:st/, "moh ZHOOST." Target words: **FRU**·gal, a·**STON**·ished, be·**MUSED**, **FLAB**·ber·gast·ed, **SUB**·tle (silent b), **NU**·ance. Then the key delivery skill: **contrastive stress** carries the distinction in speech. "She isn't **STINGY**; she's **FRUGAL**." "I was be**MUSED**, not a**MUSED**." A flat reading loses the point.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Flatter it, damn it** (fast, individual): T: "careful with money" → S1: "frugal" → S2: "stingy." T: "determined" → "resolute / obstinate." T: "confident" → "self-assured / cocky." T: "curious" → "inquisitive / nosy." T: "unusual" → "distinctive / peculiar." T: "relaxed about rules" → "easygoing / lax."
- 2 Up the cline** (choral, then individual): T: "tepid" → S: "warm, hot, scorching." T: "irritated" → "annoyed, furious, livid." T: "decent" → "good, excellent, superb, sublime." Ask: "Which of those would you never write in a report?" (*livid*, perhaps *sublime*.)

- 3 **One exact word:** T: "walked slowly and wearily" → S: "trudged." T: "looked quickly" → "glanced." T: "said quietly and unwillingly" → "muttered." T: "ate very fast" → "wolfed down / devoured." T: "very, very big" → "vast / colossal / enormous."
- 4 **Contrastive stress** (choral, then pairs): "She isn't stingy; she's frugal." · "I was bemused, not amused." · "He didn't just walk home; he trudged." Listen for the stress falling on the contrasted word.

◆ MOT JUSTE EDITING WORKSHOP – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3** with three roles: the **editor** (holds the pen), the **advocate** (proposes substitutions and fills in the log) and the **skeptic** (may only ask questions: "Is that the same fact? Does it serve or show off? Which dimension?"). Give the skeptic role to a dominant speaker.
- ◆ **The texts** (Set D) are 80–100 words of deliberately adequate English: correct, clear and lifeless (*very good, a lot of, nice, bad, big, things*). Each card has a gray model version for you at the bottom: cut or fold it off before class.
- ◆ **Tune (10 min):** at least **10 substitutions**, including at least one gain in **force**, one in **connotation**, one in **specificity** and one in **register**; remove any prosody clash. **Facts unchanged:** learners may not invent numbers, names or events. Log four changes in the workbook: original → choice → dimension → why.
- ◆ **Justify or cut (6 min):** groups swap texts. The reviewing group reads the tuned version aloud. Its skeptic may challenge up to three changes; the authors must name the dimension and defend the choice in one sentence, or cut it. Every group must **revert at least one change** that turned out to be ornament. Reviewers then give one strength and one suggestion, quoting the text.
- ◆ **Share (4 min):** two groups read their before and after versions. The class votes for the single best substitution of the day, and you board it.
- ◆ **Keep it honest:** there is no single right version. The standard is that every change earns its place. A text with twelve grand words and no restraint has failed the task.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WORKSHOP

SAY: *How many changes at least? (Ten.) · Can you add a new fact, like a number or a name? (No.) · Which four dimensions must appear? (Force, connotation, specificity, register.) · What does the skeptic ask? (Does it serve or show off? Which dimension?) · If you can't justify a change, what happens? (We cut it.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some C2 speakers, often those who acquired English by living and working in it, are more precise orally than on the page, or read more slowly than they speak. Give them the **force-cline picture cards** as anchors and a strip with ten "tuning" words to choose from (*sturdy, spacious, dimly lit, modest, sluggish, a handful of, shortly, frequently, heartfelt, remarkable*). In the workshop they make an excellent advocate: they propose substitutions orally while the editor writes. Fewer items: Ex 2 rows 1–2, Ex 4 items 1–5. Target: five precise substitutions, justified aloud.

STRETCH

Connotation as **persuasion**. Strong learners write the same 50-word description of a colleague or a city twice, once as a glowing reference and once as a damning one, changing **only word choice**, never the facts; the partner must find every loaded word. Then ask them to find one real example of semantic prosody the online lesson doesn't list (*commit* + crime, error, offense; *rife with*; *perpetrate*) and check it against a corpus or a search engine's usual pairings. Finally: when is the plainest word the *mot juste*? (A condolence card, a safety instruction, a child's bedtime.)

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **False friends that differ in connotation, not just meaning:** Spanish/Portuguese *propaganda* (= advertising) vs English *propaganda* (manipulative); Russian *амбициозный* (can suggest arrogance) vs English *ambitious* (usually positive in US workplaces); French *prétendre* (= claim) vs *pretend*; German *konsequent* (= consistent) vs *consequent*; Spanish *sensible* (= sensitive). At C2 these survive as connotation errors: "our aggressive colleague" meant as praise, "propaganda for the new product."
- ◆ **Prosody transfer:** Spanish *causar*, French *causer*, Italian *causare* and Portuguese *causar* are more neutral than English *cause*, so "caused a big success" is common. Spanish *provocar* → "provoked an improvement." Offer *brought about, led to, resulted in, gave rise to* (the last also leans negative).
- ◆ **Thesaurus inflation:** learners who built their vocabulary from bilingual dictionaries or exam word lists (common in Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Russian and Arabic educational traditions) may reach for the rarest synonym: *utilize, commence, endeavor, purchase* in a friendly email. Praise the range; then ask, "Is it the exact word, or the impressive one?"
- ◆ **Careful senses:** *bemused* is confused with *amused* by native speakers too; *eventual* (Spanish/French/German *eventual, éventuel, eventuell* = possible) → "an eventual problem" meaning a possible one; *actual/actually* (= current/currently in Spanish, French, German, Russian, Italian and Romanian) still appears at C2.
- ◆ **Contrastive stress:** speakers of syllable-timed and tone languages (Spanish, French, Italian, Chinese, Vietnamese, Tagalog) may not shift sentence stress to the contrasted word, so "She isn't stingy, she's frugal" sounds like two unrelated claims. Drill it.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_01.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and repeat them with the contrastive stress; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Tune a Paragraph" project (use a paragraph of your own or a bland news paragraph). Workbook 1.1: Exercises 4–5, "My new words" and the journal (three pairs of near-synonyms you used to treat as interchangeable: for two of them, one sentence where only one member fits, and why).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** bemused · Q2 **A** A deep contentment set in. · Q3 (new) **B** excessive, perhaps insincere. Listening (Ex 1): 1 frugal / stingy · 2 resolute / obstinate · 3 self-assured / cocky · 4 inquisitive / nosy · 5 candid / blunt · 6 meticulous / fussy · 7 distinctive / peculiar.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ diagnose a situation's **field** (subject), **tenor** (relationship: power and distance) and **mode** (spoken or written, planned or spontaneous) before choosing a register
- ◆ slide one proposition along the **formality cline** (frozen → formal → neutral → informal → intimate), moving the whole **cluster** of markers together: lexis, nominalization, voice, contractions, stance and sentence structure
- ◆ set **tone** independently of formality: warm, cool, ironic, authoritative or deferential, at the same level of ceremony
- ◆ spot and fix a register **clang** (a stray marker from another register), including over-formality (*utilize, commence*) and slang that punctures authority
- ◆ judge when jargon, slang and archaism are resources and when they are liabilities, and re-key a message mid-conversation when the listener signals a different tenor

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Five Voices planner, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 10–14 · register-room picture cards and tone cards (Set A) · **Five Voices** message cards (6) + voice specification sheets + Clang hunt slips (Set E) · New identity cards (Set C) · a timer
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.2-A (the architect's call) and 1.2-B (five voices, one piece of news)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the mixing desk. FIELD = what about? (jargon, assumed knowledge) · TENOR = who to whom? (power, distance → politeness, directness) · MODE = spoken / written, planned / spontaneous (ellipsis, contractions, packing) · FORMALITY cuts across all three.

Center: one message, five levels. 1 Frozen: *Notice is hereby given that the premises will close at 3:00 p.m. on Friday.* · 2 Formal: *Please be advised that the center will close early on Friday.* · 3 Neutral: *Just a reminder that we're closing at 3 on Friday.* · 4 Informal: *Heads up, we're shutting early Friday.* · 5 Intimate: *Friday, 3 o'clock, doors shut. Don't be late!* Move the **whole cluster**.

Right: the second dial = tone. warm · cool · ironic · authoritative · deferential. Same formality, opposite tone: *Thanks so much for flagging this; I'll get it fixed today.* vs *Noted. This will be addressed in due course.* CLANG = one marker from the wrong register: *Please find attached the aforementioned pics.*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: tune it	7	S-S	Review C1. Board three adequate sentences ("The meeting was very long and quite boring." · "She said no in an angry way." · "The new rules caused a big improvement."). Pairs tune each in one minute and name the dimension; one of them has a prosody clash (<i>caused an improvement</i>). Two pairs read theirs. Hand back or glance at the writing samples if you've scored them (private notes only).
Lead-in: one message, many rooms	5	T-S	Slide 10 (the register rooms: book, email, phone, coffee). Read aloud, in random order, the five versions of "The community center will close early on Friday" from the board plan, with a matching voice each time. Learners order them on the cline. Ask: "What changed? Only the words?" (No: the grammar, the voice, the contractions, the length, the attitude.) "Today: moving all of it at once, on purpose."
Meaning & form: the dimensions and the cline	13	T-S → S-S	Slide 11. Field, tenor and mode with one example each (<i>myocardial infarction / heart attack</i> ; "Pass the salt / Could you pass the salt? / Would you mind passing the salt?"). Then the marker table: pairs get the register marker cards (Set A) and sort them onto a HIGH / LOW line on their desk (<i>notwithstanding, sort out, it was decided that, gonna, remuneration, you know, hereby, stuff</i>). Check on the slide. Stress that features cluster : a lone contraction in a legal notice clangs. CCQs.
Meaning: tone, the second dial	8	T-S	Slide 12. Read the warm and cool versions of the same professional reply. "Which is more formal?" (Neither, really.) "Which would you rather receive?" Then the five tones with the tone cards : hold up a card (WARM, COOL, IRONIC, AUTHORITATIVE, DEFERENTIAL), say one neutral sentence ("The report is ready.") in that tone, and let the class name the markers (pitch, pace, boosters, hedges, we). Irony = register clash on purpose: "a catastrophe of biblical proportions" for a spilled coffee.
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: "Slide it" (the <i>I disagree</i> and <i>please wait</i> ladders), then "Turn the tone dial." Choral, then individuals.
Listening: the architect's call	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 1.2-A twice (two voices, or with a confident learner). First: "Can the café open in May?" Second: learners match four formal phrases to the plain versions the architect switches to. Pairs discuss: "What made her switch?"

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			(The client's request for plain English: a tenor signal.) Slide 13 shows the model.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-4 alone (label register and tone, slide up and down the cline, fix the clang), then check in pairs. Board-check disagreements only. Ex 5 (the tone dial) is homework unless a pair finishes early.
Freer: Five Voices workshop	28	S-S → T-S	Slide 14. Groups of 5 (or 3-4, with some learners writing two voices). Each group gets one message card (Set E): the same facts must be rendered as (1) an official notice , (2) a friendly email , (3) a press release , (4) a social post (280 characters) and (5) a tribute in the style of a eulogy, celebrating the retiring person or the closing place. Plan (4 min) : agree the facts; each learner takes a voice and reads its specification. Draft (10 min) : each writes their voice on the Five Voices planner, naming field, tenor, mode and two markers. Perform + Clang hunt (12 min) : each group reads its five versions aloud to another group in a random order , with matching tone; listeners name the voice and raise a hand at any clang. Share (2 min) : one tribute and one social post to the whole class. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns, no names. Precision: "some changes will happen soon" in a press release (what, when?). Naturalness: "We inform you that the bakery closes its doors definitely" (→ <i>permanently</i>). Appropriacy: a contraction in the official notice; "Notwithstanding, see you there!" in the social post. Effect: praise one tribute line that moved the room and name its device (a tricolon, a concrete detail, direct address).
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.2 and a  button. Point out the lesson's British vocabulary and that the class uses American English (see the note above). Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		7 + 5 + 13 + 8 + 5 + 6 + 8 + 28 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: field, tenor, mode. Register is a mixing desk, not a single knob. The relationship (tenor) is the dimension learners misread most, and it is the one that makes a speaker sound either presumptuous or oddly servile.

SAY: "Pass the salt." · "Could you pass the salt?" · "Sorry to bother you, would you mind passing the salt?" Same field? (Yes: dinner.) Same mode? (Yes: spoken.) So what changes? (The relationship: a sibling, a colleague, a stranger.) Is the third one "better English"? (No, just right for a different person.) · "The patient's in AF." Who says this, to whom? (A doctor to another doctor.) To the patient's family? (No: jargon excludes them. "Her heart rhythm is irregular.")

Meaning: the cluster. When register moves, everything moves together: vocabulary, grammar, voice, contractions, length and stance.

SAY: "Notice is hereby given that the premises will close at 3 p.m. on Friday. Don't forget!" Is there a problem? (Yes: "Don't forget!" is informal.) Is it a grammar mistake? (No: a register clang.) · "Heads up, we're shutting early Friday. Kindly be advised." Where's the clang? (Kindly be advised.) What's the fix: raise everything or lower one phrase? (Lower one phrase: move the whole message to one level.)

Meaning: tone is a separate dial. Formality sets the ceremony; tone sets the attitude.

SAY: "Noted. This will be addressed in due course." Formal? (Yes, fairly.) Warm? (No: cool.) "Thanks so much for flagging this; I'll get it sorted today." Informal? (Neutral, professional.) So can formal be warm? (Yes.) Can informal be cold? (Yes: "Whatever. Fine.") · "Ah yes, another flawless plan." Does the speaker think the plan is flawless? (No: irony.)

Meaning: over-formality. The pompous clang sounds inflated, not educated.

SAY: "The committee will utilize the feedback to commence a review." Wrong? (Not wrong: inflated.) Plainer? ("use the feedback to start a review.") Is plain less intelligent? (No: usually more masterful.) When is commence right? (A formal ceremony or a legal document: "Proceedings will commence at ten.")

Form.

High / formal	Latinate lexis · nominalization · passive / impersonal · hedging · subordination · no contractions · formal connectives	ascertain, remuneration · the implementation of · It was decided that... · It may be argued... · notwithstanding, hitherto, thereby
Low / informal	phrasal verbs · contractions and ellipsis · discourse markers · vague language · idiom and slang · direct address, tags	sort out, put off · Got a minute? · you know, I mean, anyway · stuff, sort of · no worries · ... right? ...yeah?
Frozen formulas	legal and ceremonial fixed frames	Notice is hereby given that... · failing which... · without further notice · the undersigned

Tone markers	warm · cool · ironic · authoritative · deferential	we, thanks, exclamation · impersonal, clipped · over-grand on the trivial · <i>clearly</i> , imperatives · <i>perhaps, I wonder if</i>
Genre frames	press release · social post · tribute	FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE · headline + city, date + quote + About... · ≤280 characters, one hashtag · "For forty-two years, ..."

Pronunciation. Register lives in the voice as much as in the words. **Frozen / formal:** slower pace, full forms (*do not, it is*), even rhythm, falling tones, pauses at clause boundaries. **Informal / intimate:** faster, weak forms and contractions (*gonna, wanna, dunno* are receptive at C2: understand them; use them only when the tenor invites it), wider pitch range, rising tags ("...yeah?"). **Warm vs cool:** warmth = wider pitch range and a rise-fall on key words ("Thanks so much"); coolness = narrow range, clipped syllables, a flat fall ("Noted."). **Irony:** exaggerated stress or a deadpan flat delivery on an over-positive word ("another **FLAWless** plan"). The online project's key test applies in class: a perfect informal sentence read in a stiff, formal cadence still fails.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Slide it** (choral, matching the voice): T: "I disagree: frozen." → S: "I must respectfully take issue with the foregoing." T: "Formal." → "I'm afraid I can't agree with that assessment." T: "Neutral." → "I see it a bit differently, actually." T: "Informal." → "Yeah, I'm not so sure about that." T: "Intimate." → "Nah, you're way off there." Repeat with "please wait": "Kindly be advised that a brief delay is anticipated." → "Thank you for your patience; this won't be long." → "Bear with me one moment." → "Hang on a sec." → "Gimme a second."
- 2 Jump the ladder** (individual): T calls a level at random ("please wait, formal!" "I disagree, informal!"); a learner answers with the right line and the right voice.
- 3 Turn the tone dial** (individual, same words): "The report is ready." T holds up a tone card: WARM (bright, rising: "The report's ready!") · COOL (flat fall, clipped) · IRONIC ("The report is *finally* ready.") · AUTHORITATIVE ("The report is ready. We present it on Monday.") · DEFERENTIAL ("I think the report might be ready, if you'd like to take a look?"). The class names one marker each time.

◆ FIVE VOICES – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **The message cards** (Set E) each give one piece of community news with fixed facts: a bakery closing as its founder retires, a 1931 movie theater closing for restoration, a school librarian retiring after 35 years, a public pool closing for rebuilding, a local newspaper ending its print edition, a community jazz night ending after 25 years. All are deliberately warm, non-political and low-stakes. Every card carries dates, numbers, one quotation and one "what happens next," so that five voices share **identical facts**.
- ◆ **The five voices** (specifications on Set E): **(1) Official notice:** frozen / formal, impersonal, passive, no contractions, dates in full, *Notice is hereby given...* · **(2) Friendly email** to a friend who loves the place: informal, warm, contractions, a shared memory, a suggestion · **(3) Press release:** formal-neutral, third

person, headline, city and date, one quotation, "About..." paragraph · **(4) Social post:** at most 280 characters, informal-public, energetic, one hashtag at most · **(5) Tribute:** eulogy-style, ceremonial and warm, elevated but never pompous, concrete detail, rhythm (a tricolon, a closing line meant to be spoken).

- ◆ **A model, if you need one:** Script 1.2-B is one piece of news (the pool) in all five voices. If your group seems unsure what a press release or a tribute sounds like, read it before the Plan stage and take the 2 minutes from the Share stage; in that case, don't hand out Message 4 (the same pool). Otherwise, keep it for the C4 warmer ("Name the voice and one marker").
- ◆ **Plan (4 min):** the group underlines the facts that must appear in every version. Each learner takes one voice (in groups of 3–4, the strongest writers take two). **Draft (10 min):** each learner writes their voice on the Five Voices planner, with one line of justification: field, tenor, mode and two markers.
- ◆ **Perform + Clang hunt (12 min):** groups pair up. Group A reads its five versions **in a random order**, each in a matching voice (grave for the notice, brisk for the press release, quick and bright for the post, slow and warm for the tribute). Listeners write the voice number on their Clang hunt slip and raise a hand at any stray marker from another register. Then they give one strength and one suggestion, quoting the text. Swap.
- ◆ **Share (2 min):** one tribute and one social post to the whole class. Ask: "Same facts? Which words carried the tone?"
- ◆ **The tribute needs care** (see the trauma-informed note at the top of this module): it celebrates a retirement or a closing, never a death. If a learner wishes, any group may swap its card.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE FIVE VOICES WORKSHOP

SAY: *Can the facts change between the five versions? (No, only the packaging.) · Which voice has no contractions at all? (The official notice.) · How long is the social post? (280 characters at most.) · Is the tribute about someone who has died? (No: a retirement or a place that is closing.) · When you perform, what order do you read in? (A random order.) · What do listeners do at a clang? (Raise a hand.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give learners who write slowly the **social post** or the **friendly email** (short, spoken-like), with the voice specification as a frame and three starter lines on a strip ("Just heard that... · Can you believe it? · We have to go before..."). They can perform another learner's tribute aloud: delivery is half the task, and many strong speakers are superb readers of an emotive text. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–2, Ex 4 items 1–3. Target: one voice where every marker agrees, delivered with the right tone.

STRETCH

Controlled mismatch. Strong learners write a sixth version: a **mock-legalistic notice** about something trivial ("Notice is hereby given that the stapler on the third floor has been removed from the premises without authorization..."), where the frozen register on a trivial field produces irony. Then ask them to re-key their tribute for two different tenors: spoken by a grandchild of the founder, and spoken by the mayor. What changes? (Pronouns, anecdote, formality of address; the warmth stays.) This leads straight into Module 2 (irony and implicature).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Tenor through pronouns:** speakers of languages with a T–V distinction (French *tu / vous*, Spanish *tú / usted*, German *du / Sie*, Russian *ты / вы*) and with honorific systems (Japanese, Korean, Javanese, Thai) are used to marking distance in a pronoun or verb ending. English marks it with modals, indirectness, past-tense distancing and vocabulary. Show the salt ladder: the pronoun *you* never changes, everything else does.
- ◆ **Translated letter formulas:** Spanish *Sin otro particular, le saluda atentamente*, French *Veuillez agréer...*, Russian bureaucratic style and some South Asian English formulas (*Kindly do the needful, Please revert*) produce a frozen register where American English expects neutral-professional. Treat these as regional register norms, not errors, but show the American equivalent (*Thanks in advance · Please reply by...*).
- ◆ **Diglossia:** Arabic speakers (Modern Standard Arabic vs dialect) and speakers of other diglossic languages may equate "written" with "very high register." English neutral-professional writing is lower than they expect: contractions are acceptable in most workplace emails.
- ◆ **Dated or regional slang:** slang learned from textbooks, TV or a previous posting (British *chuffed, knackered, cheers, mate*; dated American *groovy, far out*) can clang in an American office. Slang is a tenor signal: it claims membership of a group.
- ◆ **Directness and tone:** German, Dutch, Hebrew and Russian speakers may produce accurate but cool-sounding neutral English; Japanese, Korean, Thai and Indonesian speakers may default to deferential. Neither is wrong. Teach tone as a **choice**, and let learners practice the dial they use least.
- ◆ **Exclamation marks and capitals:** Spanish and Portuguese writers may use *!!!* freely; in an English press release or notice they read as unprofessional, while ALL CAPS in a social post reads as shouting.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_02.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and match your tone to each; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "One Message, Four Registers" project (choose a neutral message such as the office closing early; record the four versions if you can). Workbook 1.2: Exercise 5 (the tone dial), "My new words" and the journal (a register misfire you made or witnessed, real, invented or from a new identity card: what was said, which dimension slipped, and a better version).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** Nominalization · Q2 **C** Please find attached the aforementioned pics. · Q3 (new) **B** "Thank you so much for letting us know; we'll have this resolved by Friday and will update you the moment it's done." Architect's call (Ex 1): 1 c · 2 a · 3 d · 4 b.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use common **binomials** and **trinomials** in their fixed, irreversible order (*by and large, part and parcel, odds and ends, lock, stock and barrel*) and with natural rhythm
- ◆ choose the one idiomatic partner in a **restricted collocation** (*a foregone conclusion, a moot point, a vested interest, bitterly disappointed, drive a hard bargain*)
- ◆ place **lexical bundles** (*that said, for what it's worth, when all is said and done*) and **fixed similes** (*as dry as a bone*) in the register where they belong, and ration clichés
- ◆ detect and repair **garbled** fixed expressions (eggcorns: *for all intensive purposes, nip it in the butt, peaked my interest*)
- ◆ audit near-native writing for naturalness: wrong order, wrong partner, garble, register clash and overstuffing

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, audit log, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 15–18 · binomial picture cards and strong-collocation cards (Set A) · **Naturalness Audit** texts (4; Set F) · **Odds and Ends** card game (1 envelope per group of 3–4; Set G) · New identity cards (Set C)
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.3-A (the job interview news) and 1.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: fixed order. bread and butter · salt and pepper · fish and chips · by and large · odds and ends · part and parcel · give and take · sooner or later · null and void · wear and tear · peace and quiet · pros and cons · lock, stock and barrel · hook, line and sinker. ✗ butter and bread · ✗ later or sooner. Say it as one unit: *by 'n' LARGE*.

Center: one partner only. a foregone conclusion · a moot point · a vested interest · drive a hard bargain · a resounding success · bitterly disappointed · a burning ambition · few and far between. Free collocation: *a strong / compelling / powerful argument*. Restricted: no choice.

Right: exact or nothing. ✗ a mute point → a **moot** point · ✗ for all intensive purposes → for all **intent**s and **purposes** · ✗ nip it in the butt → in the **bud** · ✗ peaked my interest → **piqued** · ✗ on tender hooks → on **tenterhooks**. Bundles: *that said* (anywhere) · *at the end of the day* (worn smooth). Audit: ORDER · PARTNER · GARBLE · REGISTER · STUFFING.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: jump the ladder	8	S-S	Review C2. Pairs take turns: A says a neutral message from the board ("I'm running late." · "The printer's broken." · "Thanks for your help."), B names a level and a tone ("frozen and cool," "informal and ironic"), A delivers it. Then each pair finds the clang in one board sentence: "Dear Professor Lindqvist, Hope you're good! Can you send me the reading list asap? Thx." Collect or glance at homework journals.
Lead-in: which order?	4	T-S	Slide 15 (pictures: bread, salt, fish, sugar). Say each pair in the wrong order ("butter and bread," "pepper and salt," "chips and fish," "sugar and milk?") and let the class wince. "Is 'pepper and salt' ungrammatical? (No.) Why does it sound foreign? (Convention: the order is fixed.) Today: the chunks proficient speakers retrieve whole, and the tiny slips that give a speaker away."
Binomials & trinomials	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 15. Meaning of eight binomials via quick example sentences (the class guesses the meaning), then the trinomials. Why the order is fixed: shorter or older word first (<i>bread and butter</i>), lighter vowel first (<i>this and that</i> , <i>tick-tock</i> , <i>flip-flop</i>), and the plain fact of convention. Pronunciation: one unit, weak <i>and</i> /ən/, main stress on the second word. CCQs.
Restricted collocation	8	T-S	Slide 16. The continuum from free (<i>a strong / compelling / powerful argument</i>) to restricted (<i>a foregone conclusion</i> : no synonym works). Go through the strong-collocation cards; for each, a learner offers the logical-but-wrong alternative (<i>a loud success</i> , <i>harshly disappointed</i>) and the class explains why it fails. CCQs.
Bundles, similes & garbles	7	T-S → S-S	Slide 16. Lexical bundles with register notes (<i>to cut a long story short</i> : spoken; <i>that said</i> : safe in writing; <i>at the end of the day</i> : cliché). Fixed similes are informal by nature. Then the garble table: pairs cover the right-hand column and correct each eggcorn from memory. Ask: "Why are these so revealing?" (They are fluent and phonetically close: a listener hears that the chunk was half-remembered.)
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: binomial ping-pong, "Reverse alarm," and strong-collocate completion. Choral first, then individuals, with the rhythm.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Listening+ controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Read Script 1.3-A (two friends: the job interview news). Learners complete the chunks in Ex 1, then do Ex 2-3 alone and check in pairs. Board-check disagreements only. Ex 4-5 go to homework unless a pair finishes early.
Freer: Naturalness Audit	20	S-S → T-S	Slide 17. Pairs get one near-native text (Set F: a conference blog post, a farewell speech draft, a restaurant review, a project email). Each hides 7 naturalness problems among many correct chunks. Audit (9 min) : underline each problem and label it ORDER, PARTNER, GARBLE, REGISTER or STUFFING; fix it on the audit log. Cross-check (6 min) : join a pair with the same text; compare flags. Any flag the two pairs disagree on must be defended: "Is it wrong, or just not my choice?" Seams test (5 min) : each group reads its repaired text aloud; listeners say whether they can still hear a seam (a chunk bolted on). ICQs first.
Game: Odds and Ends	10	S-S	Groups of 3-4, one envelope each (Set G). All half-cards face down in a grid. Players turn over two; if they make a binomial, the player must say it in the right order and use it in a natural sentence within five seconds to keep the pair. Wrong order = cards go back. Trinomial cards score double. See the rules on the materials sheet. Early finishers play the "Snap" variant.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns, no names. Precision: "a big success" → <i>a resounding success</i> . Naturalness: "quiet and peace," "make a hard bargain," "a mute point." Appropriacy: "as easy as pie" in a project email; "at the end of the day" twice in one speech. Effect: praise one sentence where a single well-placed chunk did more than three would have.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.3 and a 🗣️ button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can..." for all three lessons (module wrap-up; see "Closing the Module").
Total	90		8 + 4 + 10 + 8 + 7 + 5 + 8 + 20 + 10 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: binomials and fixedness. A binomial is a fixed pair joined by *and* or *or*, always in the same order. No grammar rule forbids the reversal; convention does, and a proficient ear notices at once.

SAY: "By and large, the plan worked." *Did it work completely? (No, generally, on the whole.) Can I say "large and by"? (No, never.)* · "Late nights are part and parcel of the job." *Can you avoid them? (No,*

they're an unavoidable part of it.) · "It was touch and go." Did it end well? (We don't know; it was uncertain for a while.) · "I cleared out the odds and ends." Important things? (No, small miscellaneous items.)

Meaning: restricted collocation. At the rigid end of the collocation continuum, a word accepts essentially one partner, and a logical synonym still sounds wrong.

SAY: *"The result was a foregone conclusion." Did anyone know before? (Yes, it was certain in advance.) Can I say "a predetermined conclusion"? (Understandable, but not the fixed phrase.) · "Whether he knew is now a moot point." Important or no longer relevant? (No longer relevant, or debatable.) Spelling? (m-o-o-t; not "mute.") · "She has a vested interest in the project." Neutral observer? (No: she gains if it succeeds.)*

Meaning: register and rationing. Every chunk carries a register stamp, and some are worn to cliché.

SAY: *"The results were as clear as day." Where would you hear it? (Conversation, a lively review.) In a lab report? (No: unambiguous, self-evident.) · "At the end of the day..." three times in one talk. Natural? (No: autopilot.) Once? (Fine.) · "That said, the costs remain high." Formal or informal? (Neutral: safe anywhere.)*

Form.

Binomials	X and / or Y, fixed order	by and large · part and parcel · give and take · ups and downs · sooner or later · touch and go · null and void · wear and tear · peace and quiet · back and forth · pros and cons · odds and ends · safe and sound · short and sweet
Trinomials	X, Y and Z	lock, stock and barrel · hook, line and sinker · signed, sealed and delivered
Restricted collocation	one partner only	a foregone conclusion · a moot point · a vested interest · drive a hard bargain · a resounding success · bitterly disappointed · a burning ambition · a vexed question · run-of-the-mill · few and far between
Lexical bundles	framing chunks + register	to cut a long story short (spoken) · if truth be told (warm) · when all is said and done · that said (writing too) · for what it's worth · needless to say · believe it or not
Fixed similes	as ADJ as NOUN · like NOUN (informal)	as good as gold · as dry as a bone · as easy as pie · as clear as day · get on like a house on fire · as fit as a fiddle

Garbles	exact wording only	dog-eat-dog · for all intents and purposes · a moot point · nip it in the bud · should have · pique my interest · scapegoat · on tenterhooks
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Pronunciation. Binomials are said as **one tone unit** with a weak *and* (/ən/ or just /n/) and linking: *odds_and_ends* /ˌɒdzən'endz/, *by 'n' LARGE, PEACE 'n' QUIet, salt 'n' PEPper, fish 'n' CHIPS*. The main stress falls on the second word. Saying *and* in full, with equal stress, is itself a sign that the chunk is being assembled, not retrieved. Trinomials use list intonation: rise, rise, fall (*lock ↗ stock ↗ and BARrel ↘*). Garbles are often pronunciation-driven: *moot* /mu:t/ vs *mute* /mju:t/; *tenterhooks* (TEN-ter-hooks, not "tender"); *piqued* /pi:kt/, which sounds like *peaked* but isn't spelled like it.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Binomial ping-pong** (fast, choral then individual, with the rhythm): T: "by and..." → S: "large." T: "part and..." → "parcel." T: "sooner or..." → "later." T: "null and..." → "void." T: "wear and..." → "tear." T: "odds and..." → "ends." T: "lock, stock and..." → "barrel." T: "hook, line and..." → "sinker."
- 2 Reverse alarm:** T says some binomials in the wrong order ("quiet and peace," "cons and pros," "forth and back," "tired and sick"); learners call "Alarm!" and say the right order. Mix in correct ones so they have to listen.
- 3 One partner only:** T: "a ___ conclusion (certain in advance)" → S: "a foregone conclusion." T: "___ disappointed (deeply)" → "bitterly." T: "a ___ success (huge, clear)" → "a resounding success." T: "___ a hard bargain" → "drive." T: "a ___ point (no longer relevant)" → "a moot point." T: "a ___ interest (personal stake)" → "a vested interest."
- 4 Fix it fast:** T: "for all intensive purposes" → S: "for all intents and purposes." T: "nip it in the butt" → "nip it in the bud." T: "on tender hooks" → "on tenterhooks." T: "it peaked my interest" → "it piqued my interest."

◆ NATURALNESS AUDIT – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **The texts** (Set F) are about 130 words each and read like the work of a very proficient non-native writer: fluent, accurate, ambitious, and subtly homemade in exactly seven places. Each hides one or two of every problem type: **ORDER** (a reversed binomial), **PARTNER** (a logical but non-idiomatic collocate), **GARBLE** (an eggcorn), **REGISTER** (a chunk in the wrong room), **STUFFING** (too many chunks crowded into one sentence). The key is on the teacher's copy of each card.
- ◆ **Pairs** with two roles: the **reader** reads each sentence aloud (many problems are heard before they are seen), the **auditor** marks and labels. Swap roles halfway. Give the auditor role to a dominant speaker: they must justify every flag with a category.
- ◆ **Audit (9 min):** find, label and fix on the audit log. Warn learners that the texts also contain many *correct* chunks; over-flagging correct language is also an error ("Is it wrong, or just not how I'd say it?").

- ◆ **Cross-check (6 min):** two pairs with the same text compare. Where they disagree, each side argues its case in one sentence; you arbitrate only if they can't agree.
- ◆ **Seams test (5 min):** one learner per group reads the repaired text aloud; the others listen for a seam, a chunk that sounds placed rather than arisen. If they hear one, the group removes or replaces it.
- ◆ **Real-life link:** many C2 learners edit colleagues' English at work. Remind them that an audit comment should be **specific and kind**: "The fixed phrase is *a moot point*" rather than "wrong word."

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE AUDIT AND THE GAME

SAY: *How many problems are hidden in your text? (Seven.) · What are the five labels? (Order, partner, garble, register, stuffing.) · Are all the chunks in the text wrong? (No, most are correct.) · In the cross-check, if you disagree, what do you do? (Argue it in one sentence.) · In the game, how do you keep a pair? (Say it in the right order and use it in a sentence.) · Wrong order? (The cards go back.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give learners who read more slowly **Audit text C** (the restaurant review: shorter sentences, most of its problems audible) and let them take the **reader** role first: hearing the text aloud is where most garbles surface. Pair picture cards with binomials (bread and butter, salt and pepper, fish and chips) for the game's first round. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–6, Ex 3 items 1–6. Target: find five of the seven problems and fix them correctly.

STRETCH

Bending the chunk on purpose. Once you own a fixed expression, you can play with it: headline writers do it constantly (*a foregone contusion* for a boxing story; *lock, stock and two smoking budgets*). Ask strong learners to write two "bent" chunks for a headline and explain why the joke only works if the reader knows the original. Then have them write a 150-word toast that uses at least six fixed expressions and passes the Seams test for the whole class. This connects to Module 2 (wordplay and humor).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Reversed binomials from L1:** Spanish *tarde o temprano* ("late or early") → "later or sooner"; Chinese 东西 (east, west, south, north) → "east, west, south and north" instead of *north, south, east and west*; Spanish *blanco y negro* happens to match *black and white*, but *negro sobre blanco* ("black on white") does not map to *in black and white*. Many pairs match, though: Portuguese *mais cedo ou mais tarde*, French *tôt ou tard*, German *Salz und Pfeffer*. Ask learners which pairs match their language and which don't: the mismatches are the ones to drill.
- ◆ **Collocation calques that survive to C2:** German, Russian and Polish *make a photo*; Spanish, French and Italian *do a mistake*; Chinese and Japanese *strong rain* (→ *heavy*); Spanish *big success* (→ *great* /

resounding); Arabic and French *open / close the light*; Portuguese and Spanish *win money* (→ *earn*, unless it's a prize). Treat each as a chunk to replace, not a rule to learn.

- ◆ **Pronunciation-driven garbles:** speakers who don't distinguish /u:/ and /ju:/ or /ʊ/ may write *mute point*; learners of all backgrounds write *peek / peak / pique* interchangeably. Show the spelling alongside the sound.
- ◆ **Full-form "and":** syllable-timed languages (Spanish, French, Italian, Tagalog, Turkish) lead learners to say *by AND large* with equal stress. Drill the weak form and the linking.
- ◆ **British vs American fixed expressions:** the online lesson uses *touch wood* (American: *knock on wood*) and lists *knife and fork*, which is the dominant order in both varieties. Some binomials differ: British *fish and chips* vs American *burger and fries* are cultural, not grammatical. Accept both varieties; point out the American one.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_03.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 📻 and say each chunk as one unit, in its locked order; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Chunk-Woven Piece" project (a toast, a review or an anecdote; record it if you can and listen for seams). Workbook 1.3: Exercises 4–5, "My new words" and the journal (begin a chunk archive: five fixed expressions you meet this week, copied exactly, each with its register).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A peace and quiet · Q2 B foregone · Q3 (new) C Her question really peaked my interest. (→ *piqued*) Listening (Ex 1): 1 tenterhooks · 2 story short · 3 delivered · 4 resounding · 5 foregone · 6 go · 7 bargain · 8 take · 9 large · 10 worth · 11 say · 12 quiet.

END OF C3: MODULE 1 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "choose the word, choose the voice, choose the chunk": **She isn't stingy; she's frugal and rot sets in; happiness doesn't** (the word) → **Notice is hereby given...** / **Heads up, we're shutting early Friday,** with tone as a separate dial (the voice) → **by and large** · **a foregone conclusion** · **a moot point, not a mute one** (the chunk). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C4 warmer (the **Odds and Ends** game works well again) and in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Your private notes. By the end of C3 every learner should have received their one-strength, one-focus diagnostic note (see Lesson 1.1). Keep the grid for C13.

Watch for in Module 2: implicature in 2.1 depends on everything in this module: connotation and prosody are how speakers hint without saying ("*He's certainly... economical with his time*"). Irony in 2.2 is controlled register mismatch (C2's mock-legalistic notice) and bent fixed expressions (C3's stretch). Figurative language in 2.3 builds on fixed similes. Make those links out loud.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: connotation (+ / 0 / –) and near-synonym choice, force clines, careful senses (*bemused*, *fulsome*), prosody clashes, the exact verb, identifying field / tenor / mode, shifting a message along the formality cline, fixing a register clang, warm vs cool tone, binomial order, restricted collocations and garbled expressions.

Module 2 — Reading Between the Lines: Pragmatics

Three classes about the gap between what is said and what is meant.

First, **implicature and inference**: how a cooperative speaker means more than the words ("*He's very punctual*" in a reference), how a sentence smuggles in a premise ("*Why is your team **still** behind?*"), and how writers imply a verdict through diction, omission and distancing words (*reportedly, insisted, so-called*). Then **irony, humor and wordplay**: the same gap used for comic effect, from dry understatement (*a bit of a problem*) and sarcasm detection to puns in headlines. Last, **figurative language**: the conceptual metaphors that quietly organize English (*ARGUMENT IS WAR, TIME IS MONEY*) and the craft of building a descriptive passage on one controlled image.

3 lessons

Lessons 2.1–2.3

Classes C4–C6

Weeks 2–3

90 min per class

CEFR C2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** (workbook) → a demanding **workshop** → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-2-pragmatics.html](#). Print [materials/module-2/classroom-materials.html](#) before C4. It holds the flashcards, the new identity cards, the **Implicature Lab** source texts and encode cards, the **Wit Workshop** headline-desk stories and mock-review prompts, the **Figurative Language Studio** family-sort cards, imagery passages and subject cards, the A/B pair cards for each lesson, the **Between the Lines** board game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences, and the intonation that carries the implied meaning, again at home.
- Run every class as a workshop.** About a quarter of each class goes on one extended product: a decoded text plus a message encoded entirely by implication (C4), a set of pun headlines and a short comic piece in writing (C5), a descriptive passage built on one controlling metaphor (C6). Protect that time. If you're running late, cut controlled practice (set the rest for homework), never the workshop.
- Refinement, not a first meeting.** At C1 learners met hedging, diplomatic softening, litotes and understatement (C1 3.3), and connotation and idiom (C1 Module 4). Don't re-teach any of it. The C2 step is **deliberate control of**

the unsaid: hearing the implied verdict at conversational speed, naming the mechanism that produced it, and producing it on purpose, at exactly the strength intended.

- ◆ **Feedback on four things.** C2 learners are often near-native in some areas and fossilized in others (a flawless reader who takes every spoken remark literally; a witty speaker who still says "I have a doubt"). In every workshop, take notes in four columns: **accuracy** (errors to fix, including the fossilized ones: "the regime claims" used neutrally, "*only she got a B*" for "*she only got a B*"), **precision** (the exact word or trigger: *insisted* vs *said*, *even* vs *also*), **appropriacy** (grammatical but wrong for the room: sarcasm to a manager, a pun in a condolence note, an implication so buried that nobody gets it) and **effect** (did it land? would a native listener infer what you meant, at the strength you meant?). The effect column is the most useful at C2. Board 2–3 items per column in the feedback stage, without names.
- ◆ **Give feedback that a C2 learner can use.** "Good!" teaches them nothing. Quote the exact words, name the effect, and offer one precise alternative: "'*He is punctual*!' implies faint praise. Did you mean that? If not, add a second quality." When a learner is right but unidiomatic, say so plainly: "Grammatical and clear, but no one would say it; we say *damn with faint praise*." Target fossilized errors one at a time, privately, with a written note: a learner who has said "explain me" for fifteen years needs a strategy (a sticky note on the laptop), not a correction in front of the class.
- ◆ **Peer review, every class.** Each workshop ends with a structured critique, and each has its own test: the "**What's the real message?**" test (C4: the reviewers write, in one line, the message they inferred; the writers reveal their card), the "**Gap and Target**" test (C5: can the reviewer point to the words where the gap lies, and who pays for the joke?) and the "**Name the frame**" test (C6: the reviewer names the controlling metaphor without help and flags any image that breaks the frame). Reviewers always give **one strength** and **one suggestion**, in that order, and quote the text instead of summarizing it ("In line 2, *ambitious* does all the work. Nice.").
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** C2 classes often include senior professionals, academics and teachers who are used to having the last word. Give them the roles that need listening: in C4 the **decoder** who may only speak after the group has written its reading; in C5 the **editor** who cuts words from other people's drafts but writes none; in C6 the **cold reader** who reads a passage aloud and names its frame without discussion. Say it warmly: "Your ear is the best in the room. I need it on the checklist this round." In whole-class feedback, use "a new voice first," and a 30-second silent writing pause before any open discussion, so faster speakers don't set the answer for everyone.
- ◆ **Stretch for the very strong.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The direction for this module is **calibration**: producing the same implied message at three strengths (C4), writing irony that survives in print without any signal of tone (C5), and reframing one argument through two different conceptual metaphors to show how the metaphor steers the thinking (C6).
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and words (*humour*, *realise*, *programme*, *behaviour*, *analyse*, *queue*, *favourite*, *colour*, *counsellor*) and several British cultural references (*Downing Street*, *Fleet Street*, *Monty Python*). Teach *humor*, *realize*, *program*, *behavior*, *analyze*, *line*, *favorite*, *color*, *counselor*, and gloss the references quickly. Accept British forms whenever a learner uses them.

British English is famous for understatement: point that out as a cultural pattern, not as a standard learners must copy.

- Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Infer it → play with it → picture it. Every lesson in this module lives in the same gap: the distance between the words and the meaning. In C4 learners decode that gap in workplace emails, references, reviews and minutes, and then encode a hard message into it so skillfully that it lands but cannot be quoted back. In C5 the gap becomes comic: irony says the opposite, understatement says less, hyperbole says more, and a pun says two things at once. In C6 the gap becomes an image: an argument becomes a battle, time becomes money, a library becomes a sleeping animal. Each class produces something another learner must decode: an implied message, a headline or mock review, a descriptive passage.

HANDLE HUMOR AND IMPLIED CRITICISM WITH CARE

No humor at anyone's expense. Every joke, headline and example in this kit is about objects, situations, weather, bureaucracy or the speaker's own small misfortunes. Never use or allow humor about nationalities, ethnic groups, religions, accents, disabilities, bodies, age or gender, and never ask a learner to explain "how people from your country joke." If a learner offers such a joke, redirect calmly and without shaming: "Let's keep our targets to situations and ourselves today," and move on. **Nobody has to perform a joke.** In C5 learners *analyze* humor and *write* short comic pieces in pairs; reading aloud is always optional (the writer, a volunteer partner or you may read, or the piece can be displayed silently), and "Pass" is always accepted. Nobody is asked to perform their own accent or to be "the example" of a culture. **Keep criticism invented.** C4's implied messages (a weak reference, a rejected proposal, a bad hotel stay) are all on cards: learners encode the card's message, not their real opinion of a real colleague. The online lesson 2.1 uses the old courtroom example "Have you stopped beating your wife?": this kit replaces it with workplace loaded questions, and you should do the same in class. Some learners come from workplaces or countries where an innocent-sounding question could be a trap with real consequences; loaded questions are practiced as a language pattern with low-stakes office examples only.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): the four genre picture cards (email, minutes, review, reference) and the maxim and trigger word cards (C4); the irony-situation picture cards and device cards (C5); the four source-domain picture cards (bank, bread, station, lamp) and figure cards (C6).
- For C4: one **Implicature Lab** source-text pack per group of 3 (4 genres; give neighboring groups different texts), one **lab worksheet** per group, and the six **encode cards** (one per group, face down). The C4 **A/B cards** ("Say it without saying it") are for early finishers and the C5 warmer.

- For C5: the eight **Headline Desk** story cards, the **mock review / wry anecdote** prompt cards, and one **Gap and Target** checklist per pair. The C5 **A/B cards** ("What really happened?") are an optional pair task after the listening.
- For C6: one set of **metaphor family** sort cards per pair (24 expressions, 6 families), the three **imagery passages** (one per group), the **subject** and **source-domain** cards for writing, and one **Name the frame** review slip per writer. The C6 **A/B cards** ("Name the frame") are for early finishers.
- The **Between the Lines** board game (1 board per group, 1 die, counters) is for early finishers in C6 and the C7 warmer.
- Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- Optional but powerful: collect two or three authentic, harmless examples before C4 and C5: a product review that damns with faint praise, a pun headline from a local paper or a shop sign, a "we've decided to go in a different direction" email with names removed. Real examples convince C2 learners that this is how English actually works.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
2.1	C4 • wk 2	Implicature and inference: sentence meaning vs speaker meaning; the cooperative principle and the four maxims (quantity, quality, relation, manner), kept practical; flouting and damning with faint praise; deniability; presupposition triggers (<i>stop, again, still, even, only, the, regret, realize, manage to</i>) and loaded questions; indirectness (hinting, understatement, strategic vagueness); slant in text (diction, omission, juxtaposition, distancing markers)	decode what a workplace email, a reference, a review and a set of meeting minutes really say, name the mechanism behind each implied meaning, refuse the premise of a loaded question, and write a short message that conveys a difficult verdict entirely by implication
2.2	C5 • wk 3	Irony, humor and wordplay: verbal irony vs sarcasm; the signals (stress, tone, context clash); understatement , litotes and deadpan; hyperbole and its inflation; situational and dramatic irony; puns (polysemy and homophones), malapropism, spoonerism; headline wordplay ; setup → incongruity → punchline; register and appropriacy (who pays for the joke?)	detect irony and sarcasm from context and intonation, explain exactly why a pun or headline works, turn a blunt statement into dry understatement, and write a short comic piece (a mock review or a wry anecdote) whose humor targets a situation or themselves and suits a named audience

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
2.3	C6 · wk 3	Figurative language: metaphor, simile, metonymy, synecdoche, personification; conceptual metaphor families (<i>ARGUMENT IS WAR</i>, <i>TIME IS MONEY</i>, <i>IDEAS ARE FOOD</i>, <i>LIFE IS A JOURNEY</i>, <i>UP IS GOOD</i>, <i>UNDERSTANDING IS SEEING</i>) and extending them; dead, clichéd and live metaphors; refreshing and re-coining; the sustained (controlling) metaphor; mixed metaphors; imagery in descriptive writing	name a figure and its effect, sort everyday expressions into their conceptual metaphor and coin a new one on the same map, analyze the imagery of a short descriptive passage (controlling metaphor, supporting images, the one that breaks the frame), and write a 120–150-word passage built on one controlled metaphor

2.1 · C4

Implicature, Inference & Reading Between the Lines

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ distinguish **sentence meaning** (what the words say) from **speaker meaning** (what this speaker, here, intends), and infer the implicature of a reply that is too thin, too long, off-topic or obviously untrue
- ◆ name the **maxim** that a speaker visibly flouts (quantity, quality, relation, manner) and explain why the implied meaning is **deniable**
- ◆ spot **presupposition triggers** (*still, again, stop, even, only, the, realize, regret, manage to*), state what a sentence takes for granted, use the negation test, and **refuse the premise** of a loaded question before answering it
- ◆ read a short text for its **slant** (diction, omission, juxtaposition, distancing markers such as *reportedly, insisted, so-called*) and state the verdict it never states
- ◆ encode a face-threatening message by **implication** (hinting, understatement, strategic vagueness), so that a listener infers it at the intended strength

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Implicature Lab frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Genre picture cards (email, minutes, review, reference) · Maxim and trigger word cards · **Implicature Lab** source packs (4 texts) · lab worksheets · **encode cards** (6) · C4 A/B cards · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.1-A (the reference call) and 2.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: said vs meant. "It's cold in here." = *Please close the window.* Sentence meaning ≠ speaker meaning. Maxims: **quantity** (enough) · **quality** (true) · **relation** (relevant) · **manner** (clear). Flout on purpose → implicature. "Is she good?" "She's very punctual." → *faint praise* · deniable: "I only said she was punctual!"

Center: taken for granted. Triggers: still · again · stop · even · only · the · realize / regret · manage to. Negation test: "Why is your team **still** behind?" / "Your team isn't **still** behind." → both assume you were behind. Refuse first: "*That assumes we're behind. In fact...*"

Right: slant in text. diction (*insisted vs said*) · omission · juxtaposition · distancing (*reportedly, allegedly, so-called*). Two questions: What does it **state**? What does it want me to **conclude**? Toolkit: hint · understate · stay vague · frame as a question.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: finish the chunk	7	S-S	Review C3 (1.3, fixed expressions and collocation). Board six half-chunks: <i>by and ___ · part and ___ of the job · high and ___ · a heartfelt ___ · a snap ___ · as fit as a ___</i> . Pairs complete them in 90 seconds, then choose two and build one natural sentence about their week, real or from a new identity card. Two pairs read theirs. Note one fossilized error (<i>large and by, a fast decision</i>) and one example of effortless range.
Lead-in: it's cold in here	5	T-S	Slide 3. Act it: stand by the window, rub your arms, say "It's cold in here." Ask: "What did I say? (The temperature.) What did I mean? (Close the window.) Did I say 'close'? (No.) How did you know?" Show the four genre cards: "Today, the same trick in an email, a reference, a review and meeting minutes. What they say, what they mean, and how."
Meaning: implicature and the maxims	12	T-S → S-S	Don't lecture Grice: say the four expectations in one line each, then read the four replies aloud before you show slide 4; pairs have 3 minutes to write the real message behind each and guess which expectation it breaks. Check, then focus on faint praise and deniability : "Could the diner say 'I only meant the plates were warm'? (Yes.) Do we still know what they meant? (Yes.)" CCQs (below).
Meaning: presupposition and loaded questions	8	T-S	Slide 5. Trigger table; learners call out what each example takes for granted. Demonstrate the negation test. Then the loaded question: "Why is your department still so disorganized?" Ask for a yes/no answer; show how any answer signs for the premise. Model the refusal formula on the board: <i>That assumes X, which isn't the case. What I can tell you is...</i>
Drill	6	T-S → S	Three rounds (see Drill script): "What does it take for granted?" (fast, individual), "Refuse the premise" (choral formula, then individual) and the intonation of implying phrases (<i>It's certainly... bold.</i>), choral then individual. Anyone may mouth rather than speak in the choral round.
Listening: the reference call	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 2.1-A twice (two voices, or with a confident learner). First: "Will Dana hire Leo as a team lead?" (Probably not.) Second: learners complete the six phrases, then pairs write what each one implies and name the maxim.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			Point out Dana's own loaded question (<i>Did he manage to meet his deadlines in the end?</i>).
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-3 alone (state the implicature; identify the presupposition and refuse two loaded questions), then compare in pairs. Board-check only disagreements. Do Ex 4 (the slanted news item) together in 2 minutes as the bridge into the lab; Ex 5 is homework.
Freer: Implicature Lab	25	S-S → T-S	Slides 6-8. Round 1, Decode (10 min): groups of 3 get one source text (a workplace email, a reference letter, a hotel review, meeting minutes). On the lab worksheet they fill three columns for every loaded phrase: Said · Meant · Mechanism (maxim flouted, trigger, lever), then write the one-line real message. Round 2, Encode (8 min): each group draws an encode card (a difficult message and a reader) and writes a 4-6 line email or exchange that conveys it entirely by implication: no bald statement anywhere. Round 3, Peer test (7 min): groups swap encoded texts and run the " What's the real message? " test (below). Two groups share. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction in four columns. Accuracy: "Only she got a B" (wrong position for the meaning intended) · "It assumes that we are behind of schedule". Precision: <i>said</i> where <i>insisted</i> was the lever. Appropriacy: an implication so buried that the peer group inferred the opposite. Effect: the best deniable line of the day, quoted. Learners fix and discuss.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.1 on screen; point at a  button and play one model sentence ("Well, she certainly has a lot of energy — I'll give her that much."). Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 12 + 8 + 6 + 7 + 10 + 25 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: implicature. We assume a speaker is cooperative. When a reply seems to fall short (too little, too much, off-topic, obviously untrue, oddly worded) we don't decide the speaker has malfunctioned: we infer an extra meaning. That inferred meaning is the implicature. It is **deniable**: the speaker can retreat to the literal words.

SAY: "Is she good at her job?" "She's very punctual." Did the speaker say anything negative? (No.) What do you understand? (She isn't good at the job.) Why? (That's the only good thing mentioned: if there were more, they'd say it.) Could the speaker deny it? (Yes: "I only said she was punctual.") Which maxim was flouted? (Quantity: too little information.)

SAY: "What did you think of my presentation?" "Shall we get coffee?" Did the speaker answer? (No.) Is that an accident? (No: it's deliberate.) What does it mean? (I'd rather not say, so probably not good.) Which maxim? (Relation: the reply is off-topic on purpose.)

Meaning: presupposition. Not implied by the speaker but assumed by the sentence, carried by a trigger word. It survives negation, which is why it is hard to challenge.

SAY: "Have you stopped cutting corners?" If I say yes, was I cutting corners before? (Yes.) If I say no? (Yes, and I still am.) So what's the problem with answering? (Any answer accepts the premise.) What should I do first? (Reject the premise: "That assumes I was cutting corners.") · "Even Tom passed." What do we learn about Tom? (He was the least likely to pass.) Is that stated? (No, even assumes it.)

Meaning: slant in text. Writers imply a verdict without a false sentence: *insisted* (against the evidence), *reportedly* (I'm not vouching for this, but I'm telling you), a fact placed next to another fact (juxtaposition), a question not asked (omission).

SAY: "The CEO insisted the launch was a success." Is *insisted* neutral? (No.) What does it suggest? (Others disagree; the evidence says otherwise.) What's the neutral word? (*said*.) · "The app reportedly crashed twice." Does the writer say it crashed? (Not directly.) Why say it at all? (To tell us, while keeping a distance.)

Form.

Flouting a maxim	quantity · quality · relation · manner	"The plates were warm." (quantity) · "Lovely day!" in a storm (quality) · "Shall we get coffee?" (relation) · "They produced sounds corresponding to the score." (manner)
Presupposition triggers	change-of-state verbs · <i>again</i> , <i>still</i> · <i>even</i> , <i>only</i> · definite <i>the</i> / possessive · factive verbs · <i>manage to</i>	stop / start / keep · Are you late again ? · Even Tom... · She only got a B. · the mistake in your figures · realize / regret / admit · Did you manage to finish?
Refusing the premise	name the assumption → reject it → reframe	That question assumes X, which isn't the case. · I don't accept the premise. What I can say is... · Before I answer, "still" isn't quite right.

Indirect moves	hint · understate · stay vague · frame as a question or observation	I couldn't help noticing... · It's certainly... bold. · That's one way of doing it. · Let's circle back on that. · Have you had a chance to...?
Distancing markers	adverbs, reporting verbs, scare quotes	reportedly · allegedly · apparently · so-called · <i>insisted / claimed / maintained</i> · the "success"

Pronunciation. Implied meaning is carried by **stress and pause** as much as by words. Faint praise has a tell-tale fall-rise and a pause before the praise: *"Well... she's very **PUNCTual**."* The implying adjective comes after a hesitation: *"It's certainly... **BOLD**."* Presupposition triggers can be stressed to make the attack obvious (*"Are you late a**GAIN**?"*) or left unstressed to slip them past the listener: point out that the unstressed version is the more dangerous one. In the refusal formula, stress the word you are rejecting: *"That assumes we're **STILL** behind."*

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 What does it take for granted?** (fast, individual): T: "Did you manage to find the file?" → S: "Finding it was difficult." T: "Are you late again?" → "You've been late before." T: "Even the intern understood." → "The intern was the least likely to understand." T: "She only got a B." → "A B was less than expected." T: "When did you realize the budget was wrong?" → "The budget was wrong."
- 2 Refuse the premise** (choral formula, then individual): T: "Why is your team still behind schedule?" → S: "That assumes we're still behind. In fact, we're on track for the new date." T: "When will you stop missing deadlines?" → "I don't accept that I miss deadlines. What I can tell you is..." T: "Why did your project fail?" → "I wouldn't say it failed. What happened was..."
- 3 Say it with the pause** (choral, then individual): "Well... she's very punctual." · "It's certainly... bold." · "That's one way of doing it." · "I'm sure you had your reasons." Then ask one learner to say "It's certainly bold" sincerely, and another with the pause: the class says which one is a compliment.

◆ IMPLICATURE LAB – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3** with three roles: **reader** (reads the text aloud with the implied tone), **scribe** (fills the worksheet) and **decoder** (in Round 1 may speak only after the group has written its reading, then challenges it: "Is that really implied, or are we over-reading?"). Give the decoder role to a dominant speaker. Rotate roles between rounds.
- ◆ **Round 1, Decode (10 min):** each group gets one source text: **C1** a director's email rejecting a proposal, **C2** a reference letter that says nothing about the work, **C3** a polite hotel review that is a demolition, **C4** meeting minutes that record a row without saying so. For every loaded phrase: Said · Meant · Mechanism. Then one line: "The real message is...". The teacher's model reading is printed small at the foot of each card: fold it under before handing out.
- ◆ **Round 2, Encode (8 min):** each group draws an encode card (for example "Tell a colleague that their slides have far too much text" or "Tell a neighbor that their music is too loud after 11 p.m."). They write a

4–6 line email or exchange that conveys the message **entirely by implication**: at least one flouted maxim, one presupposition trigger and one indirect phrase from the bank, and no sentence that states the message. They keep the card hidden.

- ◆ **Round 3, Peer test (7 min)**: swap texts with the next group. Run the **"What's the real message?" test**: the reviewers write, in one line, the message they inferred and how strong it is (mild / clear / severe). Then the writers reveal their card. **Pass** = the message matches and every line could be defended literally. **Too buried** = the reviewers inferred nothing or the opposite. **Too bald** = one line says it outright. Reviewers give one strength and one suggestion, quoting the text.
- ◆ **Share**: two groups read their encoded texts aloud (the reader role, or you read them). The class guesses the message before the card is revealed.
- ◆ Keep the ethics visible: tact communicates a true message gently; manipulation uses inference to mislead. If a group's text implies something false (for example a reference that invents a problem), point it out as the line not to cross.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE IMPLICATURE LAB

SAY: *In Round 1, how many columns? (Three: said, meant, mechanism.) When can the decoder speak? (After the group has written its reading.) · In Round 2, can you say the message directly? (No, never.) What must you include? (A flouted maxim, a trigger, an indirect phrase.) Do you show your card? (No, not until the test.) · In Round 3, what do the reviewers write? (The real message, in one line, and how strong it is.) What does "too buried" mean? (Nobody could infer it.) Whose opinion is on the card, yours or the card's? (The card's.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some C2 speakers are much stronger orally than in writing, and they are often **superb** at hearing implied meaning. Give them the **reference letter (C2)**, the shortest text, with the loaded phrases already underlined, and a strip with the four maxim names and a one-word gloss (*enough · true · relevant · clear*). Let them be the reader in Round 1 and the voice in the share. In Round 2 they may dictate the encoded message while the scribe writes. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 3 items 1–4. Target: decode three phrases orally and produce one deniable line.

STRETCH

Calibration. Ask strong learners to encode the same message at three strengths (a mild doubt, a clear objection, a severe verdict) using only implication, and let the group rank them blind. Then give them the online lesson's ironic manager dialogue and ask: which line would be hardest to deny in a formal complaint, and why? For reading: rewrite the slanted news item (Ex 4) twice, once neutral and once slanted the *opposite* way, without adding any new facts.

- ◆ **Literal reading as a sign of respect:** learners from low-context communication cultures (for example, German, Dutch, Scandinavian, Israeli and many Eastern European workplaces) may read faint praise as praise ("The reference says he is punctual, so it is positive"). Present implicature as **information that native readers will act on**, whether or not the learner likes the convention.
- ◆ **Over-reading:** learners from high-context cultures (for example, Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Thai and Indonesian workplaces) are often expert decoders but may find implied criticism in every neutral sentence. The decoder's question "Is that really implied?" is for them.
- ◆ **only and even position:** in English their position changes the presupposition (*She only got a B · Only she got a B · Even Tom passed · Tom even passed*). Speakers of Russian, Polish, Chinese, Spanish and Arabic often place *only* by L1 habit. Drill two or three contrasts.
- ◆ **Definite article as a trigger:** learners whose languages have no articles (Russian, Polish, Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese, Hindi-Urdu) may not hear that *the mistake in your figures* presupposes a mistake while *a mistake* doesn't. Make the contrast explicit; it is also a common source of accidental accusations in their emails.
- ◆ **False friends in slant words:** Spanish *pretender* (= to try to), French *prétendre* (= to claim), Italian *pretendere* (= to demand), and Portuguese *pretender* (= to intend) lead to "He pretended the scheme was a success." In English, *pretend* means to fake. Also *eventually* (≠ Spanish *eventualmente*, French *éventuellement* = possibly), which changes a sentence's implication.
- ◆ **"I have a doubt"** (Spanish *tengo una duda*, Portuguese *tenho uma dúvida*, Italian *ho un dubbio*, Hindi-Urdu English): in English "I have a doubt about your figures" implies suspicion, not a question. Offer *I have a question about...*

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_04.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and copy the pauses and stress, not just the words; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Say It Without Saying It" project (analysis part required; the performed exchange may be written as a script instead of recorded). Workbook 2.1: Exercise 5 (rewrite to imply), "My new words" and the journal (a conversation in which someone meant more, or less, than they said: real, invented, or from a new identity card).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** The concert was disappointing, implied by praising only a trivial detail · Q2 **B** "When will you admit the data was falsified?" · Q3 (new) **B** "That question assumes we're behind schedule...". Listening (Ex 1): 1 punctual · 2 enthusiasm · 3 colorful · 4 social events · 5 restructured · 6 eventually.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ tell **verbal irony** (saying the opposite, often gently) from **sarcasm** (irony with a target and an edge), and detect both from the three signals: stress, tone and **context clash**
- ◆ use **understatement** and litotes (*a bit of a problem, not bad at all, not exactly ideal*) for dry humor and tact, and **hyperbole** sparingly for comic effect
- ◆ recognize situational and dramatic irony in stories, news and film
- ◆ explain exactly how a **pun** (two meanings, or two words that sound alike), a **malapropism** and a **spoonerism** work, and decode and write **pun headlines**
- ◆ judge the register of humor (who is the target, who is listening, is this the moment?) and write a short comic piece that targets a situation or themselves

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Wit Workshop frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · Irony-situation picture cards (umbrella, flight, coffee, mobile phone) · Device cards · **Headline Desk** story cards (8) · **Mock review / wry anecdote** prompt cards · **Gap and Target** checklists · C5 A/B cards · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.2-A (sincere, ironic or understated?) and 2.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the gap. *Irony* = the opposite ("Lovely weather for it." in a storm) · *sarcasm* = irony + target + edge ("Oh, nice parking.") · signals: STRESS · tone (flat / drawled) · **context clash**. Understatement: *a bit of a problem* · *not bad at all* · *I've had better days*. Hyperbole: *a mountain of paperwork*. Keep it rare.

Center: play with the words. Pun: I used to be a banker, but I lost **interest**. (2 meanings) · a tie (homophone/polysemy) · malapropism: an ~~escape~~ goat → a scapegoat · spoonerism: *a well-boiled icicle* ← a well-oiled bicycle. Headlines: BAKERY **RISES** TO THE OCCASION.

Right: the rules of the room. Setup → incongruity → punchline (last!). Who pays? a situation · an object · a system · me. Never: nationality, religion, accent, disability, body. In writing: over-signal or don't risk it. Nobody has to perform.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: what's really meant?	7	S–S	Review C4. Board three lines: "Thanks for the proposal. It's certainly comprehensive." · "Why are the figures wrong

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			again?" · "The venue was, reportedly, full." Pairs write the real message and the mechanism for each, then refuse the premise of the second. Or use the C4 A/B cards ("Say it without saying it") if you printed them. Check two answers; collect or glance at the journals.
Lead-in and ground rules	5	T-S	Slide 9 (umbrella, flight, coffee, phone). Point at the flight card and say, deadpan: "Flight canceled. Well, this is going brilliantly." Ask: "Do I mean it? (No.) How do you know? (The situation, my voice.)" Then say the ground rules plainly (slide 13 has them too): "Today we analyze humor and write a little. Nobody has to tell a joke or perform anything. Our targets are situations, objects, systems and ourselves; never people's countries, religions, accents or bodies."
Meaning: irony and sarcasm	8	T-S	Slide 10. The three signals, the ironic set phrases (<i>Oh, fantastic.</i> · <i>Just what I needed.</i> · <i>Well, that went well.</i>) and the difference between irony and sarcasm: target and edge. Why irony misfires: in writing and across cultures. CCQs (below).
Listening: sincere, ironic or understated?	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 2.2-A : eight lines, each with its context. Learners circle S / I / U and note the signal. Pairs compare; check the two pairs of identical words (items 1-2 and 3-4) that change meaning with the context. Optional A/B follow-up: the C5 cards "What really happened?"
Meaning: understatement and hyperbole	7	T-S → S-S	Slide 10 (lower half). Build an understatement ladder on the board for a disaster (the projector caught fire): <i>a bit of a problem</i> → <i>not our finest hour</i> → <i>I've had better days</i> . Contrast with hyperbole (<i>a mountain of paperwork</i> · <i>I could sleep for a week</i>) and its inflation. Pairs make a ladder for "the client was furious."
Meaning: wordplay and headlines	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 11. Dissect one pun (<i>lost interest</i>): which word, which two meanings? Then malapropism and spoonerism, quickly. Show three pun headlines; pairs name the pivot word and both meanings in 60 seconds each. Setup → incongruity → punchline with the "broken arm in two places" joke from the online lesson (slide 12).
Drill	5	T-S → S	Intonation, not jokes (see Drill script): the same words sincere vs ironic; the understatement ladder with a straight

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			face; pivot words said with both stresses. Choral first; individuals only if they volunteer.
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (what's really meant?) and Ex 4 (name the device and fix it) alone, then check in pairs. Ex 3 (the headlines) is done in the workshop; Ex 5 (blunt → dry) is homework.
Freer: Wit Workshop	25	S-S → T-S	Slide 13. Round 1, Headline Desk (7 min): pairs get two story cards (a bakery wins a prize, a new pool opens...) and write a pun headline for each, plus a one-line explanation of the pivot word. Round 2, Comic piece (10 min): pairs choose a prompt card and write 80–120 words: a mock review of a mundane object (the office stapler, a self-checkout machine) or a wry anecdote about a small invented or real disaster, with irony, understatement or hyperbole, and one piece of wordplay. Round 3, Gap and Target review (8 min): pairs swap and run the checklist (below); then up to three pieces are shared, read by the writers, a volunteer or you, or displayed. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction in four columns. Accuracy: "It was a bit of problem" · "I nearly died of laugh". Precision: <i>ironic</i> used for <i>coincidental</i> . Appropriacy: sarcasm aimed at a named colleague in a mock review. Effect: the best pun headline of the day, and why the pivot word works.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.2 on screen; play one 🗣️ model sentence ("The weather's a touch damp, said the man wringing out his coat.") and ask where the understatement is. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 8 + 6 + 7 + 8 + 5 + 9 + 25 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: irony vs sarcasm. Both say the opposite of what is meant. Irony can be gentle, affectionate or aimed at yourself; sarcasm has a target and an edge and is meant to sting.

SAY: *It's pouring on the company picnic. "Perfect weather for a picnic." Is the weather perfect? (No.) Is the speaker lying? (No: everyone knows the truth.) Is anyone being attacked? (No.) So: irony or sarcasm? (Irony.) · A colleague parks across two spaces. "Oh, nice parking." Is there a target? (Yes, the driver.) An edge? (Yes.) So? (Sarcasm.) Would you say it to your manager? (Probably not.)*

SAY: *How do we know it's ironic? (The situation clashes with the words; heavy stress; a flat or drawled voice.) Which signal disappears in an email? (Tone and stress.) So what's the risk in writing? (The reader takes it literally.)*

Meaning: understatement and hyperbole. Understatement says far less than the situation deserves; the listener supplies the missing emotion. Hyperbole says far more. Both are signals, not lies.

SAY: *"The client had a few reservations." Were they mildly unsure? (No, they were furious.) Why say it that way? (It's dry and calm, and it's funny because of the gap.) Is it also polite? (Yes.) · "I've told you a million times." A million? (No.) So what does it mean? (Many times, and I'm annoyed.) What happens if everything is "the worst ever"? (It stops meaning anything.)*

Meaning: puns and headlines. A pun makes one word or phrase carry two meanings at once (*interest*: money / enthusiasm), or uses two words that sound alike. Headlines use puns because they are short and memorable.

SAY: *"BAKERY RISES TO THE OCCASION." What does bread do in an oven? (It rises.) What does "rise to the occasion" mean? (Perform well when it matters.) How many meanings are active? (Two.) Would this headline work in your language? (Almost certainly not: puns rarely translate.)*

Form.

Ironic set phrases	praise that means the opposite	Oh, fantastic. · Just what I needed. · Well, that went well. · Couldn't be better. · Nice one.
Understatement / litotes	<i>a bit of / slightly / not exactly / not the most... · not bad / no small...</i>	a bit of a problem · slightly overdue · not exactly ideal · not our finest hour · no small feat · not bad at all
Hyperbole	impossible numbers, sizes, times; comic images	a million times · a mountain of paperwork · waited an eternity · a coffee cup you could bathe in
Pun	one word, two meanings (polysemy) · two words, one sound (homophones)	lost interest · impossible to put down · atoms make up everything · ended in a tie
Malapropism · spoonerism	wrong word that sounds like the right one · swapped first sounds	an escape goat (scapegoat) · for all intensive purposes (intents and) · a well-boiled icicle (a well-oiled bicycle)
Joke structure	setup → incongruity → punchline	"I broke my arm in two places." → "Stop going to those places." (the punchline

Pronunciation. Irony lives in **stress, pitch range and pace**. Sincere praise uses a lively, rising-falling pitch; ironic praise is either exaggerated ("*Oh, FANTastic*" with a slow, wide fall) or completely flat. Deadpan understatement is spoken with a **narrow pitch range**, level volume and no smile: that is the joke. Stress can create the irony on its own: "*Well, **THIS** is going brilliantly.*" In puns, the pivot word is usually said neutrally: stressing it too much "explains" the joke. Learners from tone languages or syllable-timed languages often use a narrower pitch range overall, so their sincere praise may sound ironic, and their irony may not register at all. Practice the contrast in the drill.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Same words, two meanings** (choral, then volunteers): T gives the context, class says the line. "Your colleague fixed the printer." → "You're a genius." (warm, lively) · "The printer jams again." → "Oh, great. Genius strikes again." (flat or exaggerated). "Sunny, 75 degrees." → "Perfect weather for a picnic." · "Pouring rain." → "Perfect weather for a picnic."
- 2 **The understatement ladder** (choral, straight face): T: "Your car broke down on the highway." → S: "It's been a bit of a day." → "I've had better days." → "Not exactly the trip we planned." T: "The cake collapsed in the oven." → "It's... a little flatter than intended."
- 3 **Find the pivot** (individual, fast): T: "I'm reading a book about anti-gravity. It's impossible to put down." → S: "*put down*: stop reading / let it fall." T: "Don't trust atoms. They make up everything." → "*make up*: invent / form." T: "SWIMMING POOL PLAN MAKES A SPLASH." → "*splash*: water / a big impression."

◆ WIT WORKSHOP – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Pairs** (or groups of 3 with an **editor**, who cuts words from the draft but writes none: give this role to a dominant speaker). The workshop is about **writing and analyzing** humor. Nobody is required to read aloud, act or "be funny" in front of the class.
- ◆ **Round 1, Headline Desk (7 min)**: each pair gets two story cards (all invented, harmless local news: a bakery wins a national prize, a town pool reopens, a library forgives all late fees, a dentist opens a free children's clinic...). Write a pun headline for each (max. 7 words, headline style: present tense, no articles) and one line naming the pivot word and its two meanings. Model headlines are on the back of each card for when a pair is stuck.
- ◆ **Round 2, Comic piece (10 min)**: choose one prompt card: a **mock review** (a mundane object reviewed as if it were a luxury product, or damned as if it were a disaster: the office stapler, the break-room microwave, a self-checkout machine, an umbrella that turns inside out) or a **wry anecdote** (a small disaster told dry: locked out of your own apartment, a flat-pack bookshelf with one extra screw, a video call with the camera on). 80–120 words. Include irony or sarcasm aimed at the object or situation, understatement or hyperbole, and one piece of wordplay. The punchline comes last.
- ◆ **Round 3, Gap and Target review (8 min)**: swap with another pair and fill the checklist: **1. The gap**: underline the words where what is said and what is meant come apart. **2. The signals**: in writing, is the

irony clear without a tone of voice? Mark any line a reader could take literally. **3. The target:** who pays for the joke? It must be the writer, an object, a situation or a system. **4. The cut:** one word or phrase that delays the punchline. Then one strength and one suggestion, quoting.

- ◆ **Share (optional):** up to three pieces. The writers decide how: read it themselves, ask a volunteer or you to read it, or show it on the document camera. "Pass" is fine. Ask the class to point at the pivot word, not to rate how funny it is.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WIT WORKSHOP

SAY: *In Round 1, how many words in a headline, at most? (Seven.) What else do you write? (The pivot word and its two meanings.) · In Round 2, how long is the piece? (80–120 words.) Three things to include? (Irony or sarcasm, understatement or hyperbole, and wordplay.) Where does the punchline go? (At the end.) Can the joke be about a person's country or accent? (No: an object, a situation, a system or yourself.) · In Round 3, what do you underline? (The gap.) Do you have to read your piece aloud? (No. You can ask someone else or just show it.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Headlines are short, which makes Round 1 accessible. Give a stronger oral learner the **bakery** and **pool** cards and a strip of pivot words to choose from (*rises · on a roll · makes a splash · dives in · in the deep end*). In Round 2 they may choose the wry anecdote and **tell it** to their partner, who writes it down; the teller then edits. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 4 items 1–3. Target: one explained headline and three lines of a dry anecdote.

STRETCH

Irony that survives in print. Ask strong learners to write a mock review in which the irony is clear with *no* exaggeration words (*so, very, amazing, literally*) and no exclamation marks: only the gap between calm words and absurd facts. Then give them a sincere product review and ask them to change three words to make it ironic, and to explain which change did the most work. For wordplay: write a headline with a pun that works on two levels of the story (the literal event and its consequence).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Irony across cultures:** in some communication cultures heavy irony toward other people sounds cold or dishonest, and sarcasm toward a superior is unthinkable; learners from these backgrounds may *detect* irony perfectly but reasonably prefer not to produce it. That's a legitimate choice: the production target is understatement and situational irony, which travel well.
- ◆ **Pitch range:** speakers of Mandarin, Cantonese, Vietnamese and Thai use pitch for word meaning and often narrow their pitch range in English, so ironic "Oh, FANTastic" may sound sincere and sincere praise may sound flat. Speakers of syllable-timed languages (Spanish, French, Italian, Turkish) may not produce the stressed *THIS* that flags irony. Practice the contrast.

- ◆ **Homophone puns:** learners who don't separate English /ɪ/ and /i:/ (Spanish, Portuguese, Arabic, Russian, many others) or /l/ and /r/ (Japanese, Korean) may miss or mishear some homophone puns. That's not a comprehension failure: explain the sound, and choose polysemy puns (*interest, put down*) for the drill.
- ◆ **ironic for coincidental:** many speakers of all backgrounds (native speakers too) use *ironic* for any coincidence. Situational irony needs an outcome contrary to expectation (the fire station burns down), not just a surprise.
- ◆ **Literal translation of L1 humor:** "It's not my circus, not my monkeys" (Polish) travels; most L1 puns don't. Learners may enjoy sharing an L1 saying, but **never require it**, and never ask anyone to explain "how your culture jokes."
- ◆ **False friend:** French *humour* ≈ English humor, but Spanish *humor* also means mood (*estar de buen humor*): "I'm in bad humor" → *I'm in a bad mood*.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_05.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and copy the timing; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz, and the "Craft & Deliver a Comic Piece" project in writing (delivering it to a listener is optional). Workbook 2.2: Exercise 5 (blunt → dry), "My new words" and the journal (a moment when humor in English landed or missed; yours, someone else's, or invented).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** Irony: she means it's going terribly · Q2 **C** *interest* carries two meanings at once · Q3 (new) **B** a gently self-deprecating line about your own first-day sense of direction. Listening (Ex 1): 1 S · 2 I · 3 I · 4 S · 5 I (sarcasm) · 6 U · 7 I · 8 S.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ distinguish **metaphor**, **simile**, **metonymy**, **synecdoche** and **personification**, and say in a phrase what each achieves in context
- ◆ group everyday expressions under their **conceptual metaphor** (*ARGUMENT IS WAR*, *TIME IS MONEY*, *IDEAS ARE FOOD*, *LIFE IS A JOURNEY*, *UP IS GOOD*, *UNDERSTANDING IS SEEING*) and coin a new expression that obeys the same map
- ◆ tell **dead**, **clichéd** and **live** metaphors apart, and refresh or re-coin a cliché
- ◆ analyze the **imagery** of a short descriptive passage: its controlling metaphor and source domain, its supporting images, and any image that breaks the frame (a **mixed metaphor**)
- ◆ write and revise a 120–150-word descriptive passage built on one **sustained metaphor**, and critique a peer's passage precisely

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Studio frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · Source-domain picture cards (bank, bread, station, lamp) · Figure cards · **Metaphor family** sort cards (24) · **Imagery passages** (3) · **Subject** and **source-domain** cards · **Name the frame** slips · C6 A/B cards · **Between the Lines** board game · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.3-A (the library at closing time) and 2.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the figures. metaphor (X is Y: *her argument was a fortress*) · simile (**like / as**: *fear rose like cold water*) · metonymy (association: *the front desk said...*, *Hollywood*) · synecdoche (part / whole: *all hands on deck*, *wheels*) · personification (*the house groaned*).

Center: the hidden maps. ARGUMENT IS WAR: *defend, attack, shoot down, win* · TIME IS MONEY: *spend, save, waste, budget* · IDEAS ARE FOOD: *half-baked, digest, food for thought* · LIFE IS A JOURNEY: *crossroads, dead end* · UP IS GOOD: *spirits rose* · UNDERSTANDING IS SEEING: *I see, murky*. New on the map: *her rebuttal outflanked him*.

Right: keep it alive, keep it in one frame. dead (*the leg of the table*) · cliché (*think outside the box*) → refresh / re-coin · live (*the fog comes on little cat feet*). Mixed: ~~We'll burn that bridge when we come to it.~~ Test: can you **see** it? One source domain → sustained metaphor.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: headline desk review	7	S-S	Review C5. Board three headlines from last class (or: <i>DENTIST GETS TO THE ROOT OF THE PROBLEM</i> · <i>PRINTER LAUNCH FAILS TO MAKE AN IMPRESSION</i>). Pairs name the pivot word and its two meanings, then turn "The meeting was terrible" into dry understatement. Check quickly; praise one pun from last class's work (with the writer's permission).
Lead-in: the hidden maps	5	T-S	Slide 14 (bank, bread, station, lamp). Ask: "What do these have to do with <i>time, ideas, life</i> and <i>understanding</i> ?" Elicit one expression each (<i>spend time</i> · <i>food for thought</i> · <i>at a crossroads</i> · <i>I see</i>). "We don't just talk this way. We think this way. Today: the maps under English, and how to build your own images."
Meaning: the core figures	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 15. Quick definitions with one example each; spend the time on the two confusing pairs: metaphor vs simile (live inside it vs notice the likeness) and metonymy vs synecdoche (association vs part-whole). Pairs name the figure in four slide examples. CCQs (below).
Meaning: conceptual metaphor families	10	S-S → T-S	Pairs get the 24 family sort cards and 3 minutes to sort them into six families. Check against the family table on slide 15 (UNDERSTANDING IS SEEING is on slide 14). Then "extend the map": each pair coins one new expression for ARGUMENT IS WAR and one for TIME IS MONEY that a native reader would accept (<i>her rebuttal outflanked him</i> · <i>that meeting was a total write-off</i>). Two pairs share.
Meaning: live, dead, clichéd, mixed	7	T-S	Slide 16. Three piles on the board: dead · cliché · live. Learners call out where each example goes. Then the gallery of mixed metaphors: learners describe the impossible picture ("You can't burn a bridge and cross it"). The master moves: refresh (<i>the ball has been in your court so long it's gathering dust</i>) or re-coin .
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: "Name the family" ping-pong, "Keep the frame" (continue a metaphor in the same domain) and "See the picture" (fix the mix). Fast, individual after a choral start.
Listening: the library at closing time	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 2.3-A slowly, twice. First: "What is the library compared to?" (A large animal falling asleep.) Second: learners complete six images. Pairs name the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			controlling metaphor, one simile and one personification that isn't part of the main frame but fits it.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (name the figure and its effect) and Ex 4 (fix the mix / refresh the cliché) alone, then check in pairs. Ex 3 was done with the cards; Ex 5 (imagery analysis) is Round 1 of the Studio or homework.
Freer: Figurative Language Studio	23	S-S → S → S-S	Slide 17. Round 1, Analyze (6 min): groups of 3 get an imagery passage (the commute as a river, a deadline as a siege, a restaurant kitchen as an orchestra). They name the controlling metaphor and source domain, underline the supporting images, and find the one image that breaks the frame and the one cliché. Round 2, Write (10 min): individually or in pairs, learners choose a subject card and a source-domain card and write 120–150 words built on one controlling metaphor, with two or three supporting images (a simile, a personification, a metonymy) from the same domain. Round 3, Name the frame (7 min): swap; the reviewer reads the passage silently, then writes the controlling metaphor on the slip <i>before</i> talking to the writer, flags any image that breaks the frame and one cliché to refresh. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction in four columns. Accuracy: "an extended metaphor" used for an idiom · "as brave like a lion". Precision: <i>simile</i> vs <i>metaphor</i> labels. Appropriacy: a sustained metaphor pushed one image too far. Effect: read (with permission) the freshest image of the day and ask the class what they <i>saw</i> .
Homework and module wrap-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.3; play one 🗣️ model sentence ("Time is a thief, and it had already picked our pockets clean."). Set the homework (below). Slide 18 recap; learners tick the three "I can..." lists. Early finishers and the C7 warmer: Between the Lines board game.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 8 + 10 + 7 + 5 + 7 + 8 + 23 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: metaphor vs simile. A simile keeps the two things apart and invites comparison (*like, as*); a metaphor fuses them and asks the reader to live inside the image. Metaphors can be sustained; similes

usually can't.

SAY: "Her argument was a fortress." Was it a building? (No.) What do we understand? (It was very hard to attack.) "Her argument was like a fortress." Which is bolder? (The metaphor.) Which one could continue for a paragraph? (The metaphor: walls, siege, gates...)

Meaning: metonymy vs synecdoche. Metonymy names something by an associated thing (*the front desk* = the receptionists; *Hollywood* = the film industry). Synecdoche names it by a part (*hands* = workers; *wheels* = a car).

SAY: "The front desk called about your booking." Did a desk make a call? (No.) Is the desk part of the person? (No, it's associated with them.) So? (Metonymy.) · "We need more hands on the night shift." Are hands part of a worker? (Yes.) So? (Synecdoche.) Why say "hands"? (It focuses on the physical work.)

Meaning: conceptual metaphor. Whole families of ordinary words map one concept onto another. Knowing the family lets you coin new expressions that sound natural.

SAY: "She shot down my idea." "He defended his claim." "I won that argument." What is an argument in these sentences? (A battle, a war.) Is that decoration or the normal way to talk? (The normal way.) If ARGUMENT IS WAR, can I say "Her question ambushed him"? (Yes: it's on the map.) Can I say "Her question watered him"? (No: that's a different map.)

SAY: Dead, clichéd or live? "The foot of the hill." (Dead: nobody sees a foot.) "Think outside the box." (Cliché: we notice it, and we're tired of it.) "Hope is the thing with feathers." (Live: we see a bird.) Which one should you refresh? (The cliché.)

Form.

Simile frames	<i>like + noun · as + adj + as · as if / as though + clause</i>	fear rose like cold water · as busy as a bee · he looked as if he'd seen the invoice
Metaphor frames	noun is noun · metaphorical verb · metaphorical adjective · of-phrase	Time is a thief. · The economy staggered . · a half-baked plan · a sea of forms · a mountain of paperwork
Personification	human verb or adjective + non-human subject	the wind howled · the old house groaned · a restless city
Conceptual metaphor	TARGET (abstract) IS SOURCE (concrete)	ARGUMENT IS WAR · TIME IS MONEY · IDEAS ARE FOOD · LIFE IS A JOURNEY · UP IS GOOD · UNDERSTANDING IS SEEING
Sustained metaphor	one source domain, 4+ sentences, varied word classes	summer (boom) → warm rain (cheap credit) → cold front (warning) → storm (crash) → shelter

Pronunciation. Descriptive passages are read **slower** than conversation, with pauses before each new image and stress on the image-carrying word, not the grammar word: "*The library begins to | fall a**SLEEP**. | The lights | **BLINK** off | row by row, | like heavy **EYEL**ids."* In the Studio, when writers choose to read aloud, coach one thing only: pause before the image, stress the image, let the last word of a sentence fall.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Name the family** (ping-pong, fast): T: "I spent hours on it." → S: "Time is money." T: "That's hard to swallow." → "Ideas are food." T: "She demolished his case." → "Argument is war." T: "We've come a long way." → "Life is a journey." T: "My spirits sank." → "Up is good." T: "That explanation is a bit murky." → "Understanding is seeing."
- 2 **Keep the frame** (individual): T starts a sustained metaphor, S adds one sentence in the same domain. T: "The negotiation was a chess game." → S: "Each side waited for the other to move first." / "She sacrificed a small point to win the big one." T: "The inbox was a flood." → "By noon I was treading water." T: "Our project is a garden." → "This month we're pulling up weeds."
- 3 **See the picture** (fix the mix): T: "We'll burn that bridge when we come to it." → S: "We'll cross that bridge when we come to it." T: "Let's grab the bull by the horns before we drown." → "Let's grab the bull by the horns." / "Let's start swimming before we drown." T: "This is a virgin field pregnant with possibilities." → "This is a new field, full of possibilities."

◆ FIGURATIVE LANGUAGE STUDIO – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Round 1, Analyze (6 min):** groups of 3, one imagery passage each (from the materials: **F1** the morning commute as a river, **F2** a deadline as a siege, **F3** a restaurant kitchen as an orchestra). Each has one planted image from the wrong domain and one cliché. Tasks: name the controlling metaphor (*THE COMMUTE IS A RIVER*), underline every supporting image, circle the intruder and the cliché, and propose a replacement for each. Groups that finish early do Workbook Ex 5.
- ◆ **Round 2, Write (10 min):** each learner (or pair) takes a **subject card** (a place, a mood, an experience or an argument: *a hospital waiting room at night · a job interview · learning to drive · the first day in a new city*) and a **source-domain card** (weather, the sea, a theater, a garden, a machine, a chess game, a kitchen, a river), or chooses their own pairing. Name the controlling metaphor in one line, then write 120–150 words: at least four sentences in the same domain and two or three supporting images. New identity cards include a "place I know well" for anyone who prefers not to describe their own life.
- ◆ **Round 3, Name the frame (7 min):** swap. The reviewer is a **cold reader**: they read silently and write on the slip (1) the controlling metaphor and source domain, (2) the strongest image, quoted, (3) any image that breaks the frame, (4) one cliché to refresh. Only then do they talk to the writer. If the reviewer can't name the frame, the metaphor isn't controlling enough: that's useful information, not failure. Writers revise one sentence on the spot.

- ◆ **Share:** two or three volunteers read (or you read them). The class names the frame before the writer says it.
- ◆ Personal content stays optional: a passage about "a mood" can be invented, and a hospital or a new city can be anyone's. Nobody is asked to explain what a passage says about their life.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE STUDIO

SAY: *In Round 1, what are you looking for? (The controlling metaphor, the supporting images, one image from the wrong domain and one cliché.) · In Round 2, how many source domains? (One.) How many words? (120–150.) Can you mix in a second picture? (No, only images that fit the first.) Must you write about your own life? (No: any subject card, or invented.) · In Round 3, when do you talk to the writer? (After writing on the slip.) What if you can't name the frame? (Tell the writer; it means the metaphor needs to be stronger.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give the **kitchen-as-orchestra** passage (F3), the shortest, with the domain words pre-listed in the margin (*conductor, tuning, section, crescendo, encore*). For Round 2, offer a **frame**: "___ is a ___. In the morning, ___. By noon, ___. When evening comes, ___." and a word bank for the chosen domain. The learner may dictate while a partner writes. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 4 items 1–2. Target: a five-sentence passage in one domain and one named figure.

STRETCH

Metaphors steer thinking. Give strong learners a short paragraph about a workplace disagreement written entirely in ARGUMENT IS WAR (*attacked, defended, retreated, won*) and ask them to rewrite it as ARGUMENT IS A DANCE or ARGUMENT IS BUILDING (*laid the foundations, added a floor, reinforced*). Then discuss: what changed besides the words? Who "wins" a dance? For writing: sustain a metaphor across two paragraphs, and deliberately end it with a single literal sentence for effect.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Different maps:** conceptual metaphors are partly universal (UP IS GOOD is very widespread) and partly language-specific. Speakers of Chinese may reach for TIME IS A RIVER, and some languages place the future behind the speaker. Invite comparison *if learners want to share* ("Is time money in your language?"), but don't make it a required cultural display.
- ◆ **Idiom blending:** C2 learners often cross an L1 idiom with an English one ("to kill two flies with one stone," Spanish/German/Russian; "to put the cart before the oxen," Spanish/Portuguese; "the drop that made the glass overflow," from many European languages). These are **mixed idioms, not mixed metaphors**: correct them gently and note that the L1 image is perfectly vivid; it just isn't the English fixed form.

- ◆ **like vs as:** "as brave like a lion," "like I said you" and "as a ghost" (for *like a ghost*) from Spanish *como*, French *comme*, Portuguese *como*, Italian *come*. Board: *as + adj + as · like + noun · as + role (she worked as a nurse)*.
- ◆ **Metonymy with institutions:** learners used to capital-for-government metonyms in their own press will understand *Washington* or *Brussels*, but may not know workplace metonyms (*the front desk, the top floor, HR says*). These are the more useful ones to teach.
- ◆ **Over-decoration:** academic and literary traditions in some languages (for example Arabic, Persian, Spanish, Russian) prize rich figurative prose; in English workplace and academic writing, one precise figure beats five. Frame it as a genre difference, not a flaw.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_06.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and read them aloud with pauses before each image; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "A Passage Built on One Metaphor" project (revise today's Studio passage rather than starting again, and keep the before/after of the freshness pass). Workbook 2.3: Exercise 5 (if not done in class), "My new words" and the journal (five conceptual metaphors caught in the wild this week).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A Synecdoche · Q2 B "We'll burn that bridge when we come to it." · Q3 (new) A "We need to nip this problem in the bud before it spreads through the whole garden." Listening (Ex 1): 1 blink · 2 eyelids · 3 exhales · 4 belly · 5 fed · 6 curled; controlling metaphor: THE LIBRARY IS A (SLEEPING) ANIMAL.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C6: MODULE 2 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "infer it, play with it, picture it": **He's very punctual** · **Why is your team *still* behind?** · **reportedly** (infer it: what's meant, what's assumed, what's implied) → **a bit of a problem** · **Oh, fantastic** · **BAKERY RISES TO THE OCCASION** (play with it) → **she shot down my idea** · **time is a thief** · **the library begins to fall asleep** (picture it). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C7 warmer (the **Between the Lines** game is ready for that) and in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Watch for in Module 3: discourse markers of stance in 3.1 (*admittedly, arguably, allegedly, frankly*) are the explicit cousins of this module's distancing markers: make the link out loud ("*reportedly* in C4 was a stance marker in disguise"). Cohesion across long texts in 3.2 builds on the sustained metaphor: a controlling image is one of the strongest cohesive devices there is. Summarizing and paraphrasing in 3.3 must keep implied meaning: a summary of a faint-praise reference that says "the referee praises the candidate" has failed.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: stating an implicature and naming the flouted maxim, identifying a presupposition trigger and refusing a loaded premise, spotting slant words in a short text, telling sincere from ironic and understated statements in context, explaining a pun, correcting a malapropism, naming figures (metaphor, simile, metonymy, synecdoche, personification), sorting expressions into conceptual metaphors, and fixing a mixed metaphor.

Module 3 — Discourse Mastery: Structure & Cohesion

Three classes that lift learners from the well-made sentence to the well-made text. First, the small words that steer and color discourse: **organizing markers** (*that said, turning to, in short*), **stance adverbials** (*admittedly, arguably, tellingly, ostensibly*) and **interactional markers** (*the thing is, mind you, let's face it*), used to signal attitude on purpose and to read the attitude other writers smuggle in. Then the architecture of long texts: **cohesion versus coherence**, **theme and rheme** (given before new), **lexical chains** without "elegant variation," **topic sentences** and the one-sentence-per-paragraph skeleton. Last, the three condensing arts at the heart of C2 reading-into-writing: the faithful **summary**, the genuine **paraphrase** (not patchwriting) and the multi-source **synthesis**, organized by idea and attributed with reporting verbs that are fair to every source.

3 lessons

Lessons 3.1–3.3

Classes C7–C9

Weeks 4–5

90 min per class

CEFR C2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** (workbook) → a demanding **workshop** → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from `slides/module-3-discourse.html`. Print `materials/module-3/classroom-materials.html` before C7. It holds the flashcards, the new identity cards, the **Stance Workshop** neutral reports and **Stance Detective** A/B cards (C7), the cut-up **Wrenfield** article and the **Riverside Radio** broken draft for the **Cohesion & Coherence Lab** (C8), the three **library sources** and the **paraphrase integrity strips** for the **Synthesis Workshop** (C9), the **Thread It!** board game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home and shadow the intonation.
- This module is a writing-and-reading lab.** Each class spends roughly a quarter to a third of its time on one extended product that another learner reads, hears or checks: a neutral report rewritten in three stances (C7), a reconstructed and repaired long text (C8), a 200-word attributed synthesis of three sources (C9). Protect that time. If you're running late, shorten the controlled practice (set the rest for homework), never the workshop.

- ◆ **Refinement, not a first meeting.** At C1 learners met linking and signposting (C1 6.2), reference, substitution and ellipsis (C1 3.2), hedging (C1 3.3), cleft sentences and end-weight (C1 2.3), critical reading for bias (C1 6.1) and note-taking and summarizing a lecture (C1 7.1). Don't re-teach any of it. The C2 step is **deliberate effect at the scale of the whole text**: choosing the marker that plants exactly the attitude you intend, engineering flow so the reader never stumbles, and restating other people's thought so faithfully and so freshly that nothing is distorted and nothing is borrowed.
- ◆ **Feedback on four things.** C2 learners rarely make the errors a C1 checklist catches; what they need is feedback on **effect**. In every workshop, take notes in four columns: **precision** (the word that is nearly right: *ostensibly* where *apparently* was meant, *claims* where *notes* is fair, *Consequently* where no consequence exists), **appropriacy** (the register seam: *anyway* in a report, *furthermore* in a chat, *the thing is* in a synthesis), **naturalness** (grammatical but no native writer would do it: three stance adverbials in one sentence, "Firstly... Secondly... Thirdly..." in a two-point email, five synonyms for one noun) and **effect** (did the reader get the attitude, the order, the attribution you intended?). In the feedback stage, board one or two items from each column, without names, and ask the class to explain the effect before anyone fixes it.
- ◆ **Fossilized and near-native at once.** Many C2 learners write more elegantly than their teachers in one register and repeat the same fossilized habit in another: "On the other hand" with no first hand, "In my opinion, I think," "Actually" meaning "currently," a comma-less "Frankly I...," a synthesis that marches "Source A says... Source B says...". Name the habit privately and specifically ("You use *moreover* in speech about once a minute: try *and on top of that* today") and give it a one-class target. Praise the near-native range out loud; correct the fossil in writing, on a sticky note.
- ◆ **Peer review, every class.** Each workshop ends with a structured peer-review step that has its own test: the **"Name the attitude" + "Strip" tests** (C7: can a reviewer name the stance of each version, and when every marker is stripped out, are the facts identical?), the **"Skeleton" test** (C8: one sentence per paragraph, read as a list: does it make an argument?) and the **"Highlighter" + "Whose voice?" tests** (C9: any run of three or more words borrowed from a source is highlighted; every claim is tagged with its source or "writer"). Reviewers always give **one strength and one suggestion**, in that order, and **quote** the text instead of summarizing it ("In line 4, *claims* makes you sound doubtful of Hsu").
- ◆ **Critique protocol at C2.** Strong writers can be bruised by peer comments and can bruise others. Run every review as **describe → ask → suggest**: first describe what the text does ("Your second version reads as warmly approving because of *remarkably* and *mercifully*"), then ask a real question ("Did you intend *mercifully* to sound relieved?"), and only then suggest. No verdicts ("It's bad," "It's perfect") and no rewriting the writer's text for them.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** C2 classes often include senior professionals, academics and translators who are used to being the best writer in the room. Give them the roles that require listening and restraint: in C7 the **stance detective** (who may only name the attitude and quote the evidence), in C8 the **skeleton writer** (who reduces each paragraph to one sentence and reads the list aloud without comment), in C9 the **source checker** (with the highlighter). Say it kindly: "Your ear is the best in the group. I need it on the evidence this round." In whole-class feedback, use "a new voice first."

- ◆ **Stretching the strongest.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The direction for this module is **controlled effect**: moving stance adverbials into medial and final position for rhythm and irony (C7), mixing constant-theme and linear progression deliberately and delaying a point for a "reveal" (C8), and writing a synthesis whose own verdict is visible only in its ordering and emphasis, never in a loaded verb (C9). Ask strong learners to explain the effect of every choice, not just make it.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and words (*organise, summarise, colour, scepticism, honour, travellers, lorries, pounds, pitch*). Teach *organize, summarize, color, skepticism, honor, travelers, trucks, dollars, field*. Accept British forms whenever a learner uses them, and point out that *précis* keeps its accent in both varieties.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Steer it → build it → distill it. In C7 learners steer a stretch of discourse: organizing markers tell the reader where they are, stance adverbials tell the reader how to take it, and interactional markers keep a conversation reciprocal. They also learn to read the same devices working on them. In C8 they build a whole text that holds together: cohesion on the surface, coherence underneath, information flowing from given to new, one lexical chain, one through-line. In C9 they take other people's texts and distill them, into a gist, a paraphrase and a synthesis, without distorting a source or borrowing its words. Each class depends on the one before: stance language returns as reporting verbs in C9; flow and ordering return as "organize by idea."

TOPIC CARE: INVENTED TEXTS, ASSIGNED STANCES, LOW PERSONAL STAKES

Stance and synthesis are practiced on **invented, neutral texts**: a museum's free evenings, open textbooks at a college, a parking app, an orchestra's pay-what-you-can concerts, pocket forests, a community radio station, fine-free libraries. Keep every example and discussion on language, not politics. Every stance in the workshop is **assigned** on a card: a learner writing the "skeptical" version is practicing a register, not declaring a belief. The C9 journal asks learners to look honestly at their own past paraphrasing. Treat patchwriting as a **convention to learn**, never as a moral failing: in several educational traditions, reproducing an authority's exact words is a mark of respect and diligence. Any "write about you" task allows a new identity card or an invented answer, and anyone can say "Pass."

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): the four picture "register rooms" (book, notebook, email, coffee), organizing markers by function, stance adverbials color-coded by family, cohesion and coherence terms (C8) and reporting verbs by stance (C9). Cut them before C7.
- ◆ For C7: one **neutral report** per group of 3 (4 reports, so neighboring groups differ), one three-column **stance worksheet** per group (in the workbook) and one set of **Stance Detective A/B** cards per pair.

- ◆ For C8: one cut-up set of the **Wrenfield article** (7 paragraphs, labeled with scrambled letters) per group of 3, split into the A/B/C info-gap packets; one **Riverside Radio** broken draft per group; a **fault log** per group. Put each article set in an envelope.
- ◆ For C9: the three **library sources** as A/B/C expert cards (one set per group of 3), one **idea grid** per group, the **paraphrase integrity strips** (one set per pair) and a highlighter per group.
- ◆ Print the **new identity cards** (six professional profiles) and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- ◆ The **Thread It!** board game (1 board per group, 1 die, counters) is for early finishers in C9 and the C10 warmer.
- ◆ Optional but powerful: bring two real published pieces on the same light topic, for example two reviews of the same restaurant, film or exhibition, one enthusiastic and one skeptical. Learners strip the stance markers from both in C7 and find that the facts are nearly identical.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
3.1	C7 • wk 4	Discourse markers & stance: organizing markers by function and register (opening, adding, conceding, shifting, closing); stance adverbials in four families (epistemic <i>admittedly, arguably, presumably, ostensibly</i> ; attitude <i>frankly, remarkably, ironically, tellingly</i> ; viewpoint <i>technically, broadly speaking, reportedly</i> ; focus <i>notably, if anything, at least</i>); comma and position; interactional markers; reading slant (<i>supposedly, so-called, needless to say</i>)	rewrite a neutral report in three assigned stances (skeptical, approving, judiciously balanced) without changing a single fact, name the stance of another group's versions from the markers alone, and deliver a 90-second spoken commentary whose attitude a listener can identify
3.2	C8 • wk 4	Cohesion vs coherence; theme / rheme and given-before-new (linear and constant-theme progression); lexical chains (repetition, synonym, superordinate, general word) and the elegant-variation trap; signposting and meta-discourse ; topic sentences, ordering principles and the one-sentence-per-paragraph test	reconstruct a jumbled 700-word article from its cohesive clues and name its ordering principle, diagnose each break in a disjointed draft as a cohesion or a coherence fault, and repair it so its skeleton reads as one argument
3.3	C9 • wk 5	The three condensing arts: summary (main idea vs detail vs example; delete, generalize, supply a topic sentence, keep the logical relations; fidelity of proportion); paraphrase vs patchwriting ; reporting verbs and the stance they carry;	give a faithful one-sentence gist of a dense source, tell genuine paraphrase from patchwriting and repair it, and synthesize three short sources into one 200-word,

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		synthesis organized by idea (agree, diverge, qualify, extend)	idea-organized paragraph with fair attribution and nothing borrowed

3.1 · C7

Discourse Markers & Stance

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ choose organizing markers that fit the function (open, add, concede, shift, close) **and** the mode, and switch a text's register by swapping its hinges (*That said* → *Nevertheless*; *Anyway* → *Turning to...*)
- ◆ use stance adverbials from four families to plant a precise attitude with one word, distinguishing near-neighbors: *admittedly* (concede against yourself) vs *arguably* (defensible but contestable) vs *undoubtedly* (full commitment); *apparently* vs *ostensibly* vs *reportedly*
- ◆ punctuate and position a stance adverbial so it comments on the whole clause (*Frankly, I disagree* vs *She spoke frankly*) and use medial and final positions for rhythm (*The result, remarkably, held.* · *He said nothing, tellingly.*)
- ◆ use interactional markers (*the thing is, I mean, mind you, let's face it*) to manage rapport in speech, and keep them out of formal writing
- ◆ read the stance that others encode (*supposedly, so-called, needless to say, as everyone knows*) and strip it away to test whether an argument lives in the facts or only in the framing

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Stance Workshop frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 3–7 · "Register rooms" picture cards · organizing-marker and stance-adverbial flashcards · **Stance Workshop** neutral reports (4) · **Stance Detective** A/B cards · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 3.1-A (the museum commentary) and 3.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the joints (organizing). spoken → written: *Right, so...* → *To begin with* · *On top of that* → *Furthermore* · *That said* / *Mind you* → *Nevertheless* / *Admittedly* · *Anyway* → *Turning to...* · *Long story short* → *In short*. The marker announces the register.

Center: the color (stance). "The safety feature caused the accident." + *Ironically,* / *Predictably,* / *Mercifully,* (*no one was hurt*). Four families: **epistemic** *admittedly* · *arguably* · *presumably* · *ostensibly* · **attitude** *frankly* · *remarkably* · *tellingly* · **viewpoint** *technically* · *broadly speaking* · *reportedly* · **focus** *notably* · *if anything* · *at least*. Comma! *Frankly, I disagree.* / medial / final.

Right: the slant (reading). *supposedly* · *so-called* · *needless to say* · *as everyone knows* · *of course*. The Strip test: delete every marker. Are the facts the same? Where did the argument go?

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: rescue the metaphor	7	S-S	Review C6 (2.3, metaphor and imagery). Board three flat or mixed sentences: "The new policy is a double-edged sword that will open the floodgates." · "Her argument was very strong." · "The project has problems." Pairs repair the mixed metaphor and give the flat ones one fresh, consistent image. Two pairs read theirs; the class judges "apt or overdone?" Note one precision item and one range item.
Lead-in: one word changes everything	5	T-S	Board: "The safety feature caused the accident." Add one word at a time in front: <i>Ironically</i> , · <i>Predictably</i> , · <i>Apparently</i> , · <i>Tellingly</i> , Ask after each: "Did any fact change? (No.) What changed? (The speaker's attitude; how we should read it.)" Elicit <i>stance</i> . "Today: the small words that steer a text and the small words that color it, and how to catch other writers using them on you."
Organizing markers & register	9	T-S → S-S	Slides 3-4. Pairs get 12 organizing-marker flashcards and 90 seconds to place each under a picture "room" (coffee chat / work email / report / essay) and a function (open, add, concede, shift, close). Check on slide 4. Then the lesson's pair: "Right, so the plan didn't work. That said, we learned a lot. Anyway, what next?" → written version. Ask which words did all the mode-switching (only the joints). CCQs below.
Stance adverbials: meaning	11	T-S	Slide 5. Present the four families with one example each; spend the time on near-neighbors (see CCQs): <i>admittedly</i> / <i>arguably</i> / <i>undoubtedly</i> , <i>apparently</i> / <i>ostensibly</i> / <i>reportedly</i> , <i>curiously</i> / <i>ironically</i> / <i>tellingly</i> . Then form: the comma, front vs medial vs final position, and the <i>hopefully</i> debate (fully standard; avoid only in the stiffest formal prose). Slide 6: the exhibition dialogue: learners find stance vs interactional markers.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Three rounds (see Drill script): "Which attitude?" (T gives a neutral sentence + an attitude, S fronts the right adverbial with the right intonation), register switch, and move-the-adverbial for rhythm. Choral for intonation, then individual.
Listening: the museum commentary	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 3.1-A twice. First listening: "Would the speaker recommend the museum? How warmly?" (Yes, with reservations; amused, fair.) Second listening: learners write the eight markers and label each O (organizing), S (stance) or I (interactional). Pairs compare, then say which three words did most to reveal the attitude.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-4 alone (choose the stance, label function and register, signpost and color a bare paragraph), then check in pairs. Board-check only disagreements. Ex 5 (read the slant and strip it) is homework unless a pair finishes early.
Workshop: Stance Workshop + Stance Detective	25	S-S → T-S	Slide 7. Round 1, Three stances (12 min) : groups of 3 get one neutral report (about 80 words: a museum's free Thursday evenings, open textbooks at a college, a parking app, pay-what-you-can concerts). Each learner writes one version on the stance worksheet, skeptical , approving or judiciously balanced , then the group polishes all three together. Rules: every fact unchanged, nothing added, 3-5 markers per version, register consistent (a written report). Round 2, Peer review (6 min) : swap with the next group. Reviewers run the " Name the attitude " test (label each version without looking at the headings and quote the two words that told them) and the " Strip " test on one version (cross out every marker: are the facts identical to the neutral report?). One strength and one suggestion. Round 3, Stance Detective (7 min) : pairs, A/B cards: A speaks for 90 seconds on a topic card in a secret assigned attitude; B, the detective, names the attitude and quotes the evidence. Swap once. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns on the board. Precision: "Ostensibly, attendance rose" (the writer meant <i>apparently</i> ; <i>ostensibly</i> implies the stated reason hides the real one). Appropriacy: "Anyway, the board will vote in March" in a written report. Naturalness: "Frankly, honestly, to be fair, the app arguably worked." Effect: a "balanced" version that reviewers read as skeptical. Learners explain the effect first, then fix.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 9 + 11 + 6 + 7 + 10 + 25 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: organizing markers. They change nothing in the propositional content; they tell the reader where we are in the discourse. Their register is their most visible feature.

SAY: "That said, we learned a lot." Does that said add a fact? (No.) What does it do? (Concedes / qualifies what came before.) Would you write it in a formal report? (Yes, it's neutral; nevertheless is more formal.) · "Anyway, moving on." Chat or essay? (Chat or a relaxed talk.) What would the essay say? (Turning to... / As for...)

Meaning: stance adverbials. A fronted word, fenced by a comma, comments on the whole clause and reveals the speaker's attitude to it. It is outside the grammar of the clause.

SAY: "Admittedly, my figures were incomplete." Is the speaker attacking someone? (No.) Whose position does the admission weaken? (Their own.) Why do it? (To look fair and win trust.) · "Arguably the finest novel of the decade." Is the speaker certain? (Fairly confident, but they accept someone could disagree.) Is arguably weaker than undoubtedly? (Yes, and safer.)

SAY: "Ostensibly, it was a courtesy call." Was it a courtesy call? (That was the stated reason.) Does the speaker believe it? (Probably not: there was another, hidden reason.) · "Apparently the deal collapsed." Does the speaker know for sure? (No: they heard it, or it seems so.) · "Reportedly, talks have stalled." Who says so? (A source; the speaker doesn't vouch for it.)

SAY: "Tellingly, he said nothing." Is silence important here? (Yes: it reveals something bigger.) Positive or negative? (It depends on context, but usually critical.) · "Curiously, sales rose." Surprised or angry? (Surprised, puzzled.) "Ironically, the diet made her hungrier." What's ironic? (The result is the opposite of the intention.)

Meaning: reading slant. *supposedly* and *so-called* plant doubt; *needless to say* and *as everyone knows* assume agreement; *to be fair* stages a concession. Strip them out and the "argument" often disappears.

SAY: "The so-called upgrade slowed every laptop in the office." Does the writer think it was an upgrade? (No: the label is ironic.) · "Needless to say, the old system worked better." If it's needless to say, why say it? (To present an opinion as obvious and pull the reader along.)

Form.

Front (default)	adverbial + comma + clause	<i>Frankly, the scheme was doomed.</i>
Medial	between subject and verb, fenced by commas	<i>The result, remarkably, held.</i>
Final	after the clause, with a comma	<i>He said nothing, tellingly.</i>
Manner vs stance	no comma, after the verb = manner	<i>She spoke frankly.</i> (in a frank way) vs <i>Frankly, she lied.</i> (I'm being blunt)

Phrase forms	to + adj · adj + enough · -ly + speaking	<i>to be fair · interestingly enough · broadly speaking · strictly speaking</i>
Reading frames	so-called + noun · supposedly · needless to say	<i>the so-called reforms · it was supposedly designed to...</i>

Pronunciation. A fronted stance adverbial is its own **intonation unit**: a short pause after it and, usually, a **fall-rise** on the stressed syllable that says "there's more to this": *adMITtedly* ↘ ↗ | *the evidence is thin*. Know the stress: *ARguably*, *adMITtedly*, *preSUMably*, *osTENSibly*, *conCEivably*, *unDOUBTedly*, *TELLingly*, *reMARKably*, *FRANKly*. Medial and final adverbials are said on a **lower, quieter pitch**, like an aside: "The result, *remarkably*, held." Interactional markers are unstressed and quick (*I mean, you know*); stressing them sounds impatient ("LOOK, ...").

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Which attitude?** (choral then individual; exaggerate the fall-rise): T: "The trial was small. (concede against yourself)" → S: "Admittedly, the trial was small." T: "No one was hurt. (relief)" → "Mercifully, no one was hurt." T: "The minutes don't mention the budget. (this reveals something)" → "Tellingly, the minutes don't mention the budget." T: "It's a fruit. (strict definition)" → "Technically, it's a fruit." T: "The venue will change. (a reasonable guess)" → "Presumably, the venue will change."
- 2 Switch the room:** T reads a spoken hinge, S gives a written equivalent: "On top of that" → "Furthermore / What is more." "That said" → "Nevertheless / Be that as it may." "Anyway, moving on" → "Turning to... / As for..." "Long story short" → "In short / In sum." Then the reverse, written → spoken.
- 3 Move it:** T: "Remarkably, the result held." → S (medial): "The result, remarkably, held." T: "Tellingly, he said nothing." → S (final): "He said nothing, tellingly." Ask: "Which feels more like an aside? Which feels like a verdict?"
- 4 Strip it** (reading): T reads, S says the bare fact: "Needless to say, the so-called improvement supposedly saved time." → "The change was meant to save time." "Surprisingly enough, the cheaper option, arguably, performed better." → "The cheaper option performed better."

◆ STANCE WORKSHOP + STANCE DETECTIVE – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3** with one neutral report. Each learner takes one stance to draft first: **skeptical** (doubt, distance, a raised eyebrow: *ostensibly, supposedly, predictably, needless to say, tellingly*), **approving** (warmth, admiration: *remarkably, encouragingly, mercifully, notably, if anything*) and **judiciously balanced** (a scholar weighing evidence: *admittedly, arguably, broadly speaking, that said, on balance*). Draft alone for 5 minutes, then polish all three together for 7.
- ◆ **The rules** are what make it C2: ☐ every number and fact identical to the neutral report ☐ nothing added (no invented quotes, no new facts) ☐ 3–5 markers per version, no stacking (never three in one sentence) ☐ at least one medial or final adverbial ☐ written-report register (no *anyway, you know, let's face it*). A learner who "cheats" by changing a fact (*a mere 71%* is fine; *only 60%* is not) must put it back.

- ◆ **Peer review (6 min):** swap the three versions, headings folded under. Reviewers write the stance they read for each and quote the two words that told them; then they choose one version and run the **Strip test**, crossing out every marker and checking the bare text against the neutral report. Mismatches are the most useful feedback of the class: "We read your balanced version as skeptical because of *ostensibly*."
- ◆ **Stance Detective (7 min):** pairs. A takes a topic card and a secret **attitude card** (grudging admiration, polite skepticism, wry amusement, enthusiastic but fair, weary disappointment, cautious optimism) and speaks for 90 seconds, spoken register, interactional markers welcome. B listens only for stance, then names the attitude and quotes two markers. Swap once. The detective role goes to your most dominant speaker first.
- ◆ **Share:** one group reads its three versions aloud in random order; the class names each stance. Ask: "Which version would you trust most as a reader, and why?" (Usually the balanced one, because *admittedly* makes the criticism look fair.)

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE STANCE WORKSHOP

SAY: *Can you change a number? (No.) Can you add a new fact or a quote? (No.) How many markers in each version? (Three to five.) Three in one sentence? (No.) Is this a chat or a written report? (A written report.) So is anyway OK? (No.) In the review, what do you write for each version? (The stance, and two words that show it.) What's the Strip test? (Cross out every marker and check the facts are the same.) · In Stance Detective, does B know A's attitude? (No, B guesses.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some C2 speakers are far stronger orally than in writing (often learners with interrupted schooling who have lived and worked in English for years). Give them a **marker strip** sorted by stance (skeptical / approving / balanced, four words each) and let them write one version only, the one they choose, while the group writes the others. In Stance Detective they are often the best detectives: their ear for attitude is excellent. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–6, Ex 3 items 1–6. Target: one clean version with three well-placed markers, read aloud with the pause after each fronted adverbial.

STRETCH

Stance by **position and scarcity**. Ask strong learners to write a fourth, **wry** version of their report in which the irony lives in a single final-position adverbial (*The board, which had predicted disaster, voted to continue the trial, unanimously*) and to explain why one well-placed word is more damning than three. Then the reverse skill: give them a real published review and ask them to rewrite it as a neutral report, cataloguing every stance device they removed. Finally, *hopefully*: write the same sentence for a text message, a university report and a conservative style editor.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **False-friend markers:** *actually* for "currently" (Spanish *actualmente*, French *actuellement*, Portuguese *atualmente*, Italian *attualmente*, German *aktuell*); *eventually* for "possibly" (German *eventuell*, Spanish *eventualmente*, Dutch *eventueel*); *also* for "so / therefore" (German *also*); *in fine* for "finally" (French *enfin*). These fossilize even in near-native speakers; board them once and keep a tally.
- ◆ **"On the other hand" as "also":** very common across L1s. In English it needs a genuine contrast, ideally with a first hand. For addition, use *moreover*, *what is more*, *on top of that*.
- ◆ **Formal markers in speech:** learners from exam-focused systems (Chinese, Korean, Japanese, Russian, and many South Asian and Arabic-medium schools) often say *Firstly... Secondly... Moreover... In conclusion* in conversation. Praise the control, then point out the register: "Perfect in your report. At the coffee machine: *and another thing... anyway, that's about it.*"
- ◆ **"Of course" and "naturally":** Russian *конечно*, Spanish *claro*, Portuguese *claro*, Arabic *ṭab'an* are neutral "yes, sure"; English *of course* can sound as if the listener's question was obvious. Offer *sure*, *certainly*, *absolutely*.
- ◆ **"In my opinion, I think..." and "Honestly speaking / Frankly speaking"** as fixed openers (common in Chinese-, Hindi-, Urdu- and Arabic-influenced English, and in many exam-trained learners). Neither is wrong, but at C2 one stance marker per clause is enough.
- ◆ **Comma omission:** languages without a strong comma convention for sentence adverbs (Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Thai, Vietnamese) produce "Frankly I disagree," "Hopefully it works." Tie the comma to the pause they already hear.
- ◆ **Stance adverbials that don't translate one-to-one:** Spanish *de hecho* and French *en fait* map to "in fact," which English uses more sparingly and often for correction; German *eigentlich*, Dutch *eigenlijk* are wider than "actually." Encourage learners to find the *function* first, then the English word.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_07.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and shadow them, pausing after each fronted marker; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Signpost a Commentary — Twice" project (any topic that is not political; a new identity card's "opinion I hold" works well). Workbook 3.1: Exercise 5 (read the slant and strip it), "My new words" and the journal (two sentences: the stance adverbial you most want to activate and one real sentence using it).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** It signals the stated reason, hinting the true reason is otherwise · Q2 **B** anyway · Q3 (new) **B** "The trial was, admittedly, small; nevertheless, the results were encouraging." Listening (Ex 1): 1 Right, so (O) · 2 To be honest (I / S) · 3 Admittedly (S) · 4 That said (O) · 5 Arguably (S) · 6 Mind you (I) · 7 frankly (S) · 8 Tellingly (S). Closing: "Anyway, long story short" (O). Attitude: amused, mildly skeptical, fair; recommends the museum with reservations.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ distinguish **cohesion** (surface links you can point to) from **coherence** (a line of thought the reader infers), and diagnose a text that has one without the other
- ◆ control **information flow**: open each sentence on given information (theme) and end on the new (rheme), using linear ("staircase") and constant-theme progression on purpose
- ◆ build a **lexical chain** (repetition, synonym, superordinate, general word, collocation) that binds and develops a topic, and avoid the **elegant-variation** trap by repeating the anchor term
- ◆ use **meta-discourse** sparingly (preview, topic sentence, internal summary, transition, cross-reference) and signpost the turns, not every step
- ◆ reconstruct and repair a long text: choose an **ordering principle**, write topic sentences and test the whole with the **one-sentence-per-paragraph skeleton**

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Lab frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 8–12 · Cohesion and coherence flashcards · **Wrenfield article** cut-up sets (7 paragraphs, A/B/C packets, in envelopes) · **Riverside Radio** broken drafts · fault logs · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 3.2-A (the lecture opening) and 3.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: two virtues. **Cohesion** = on the page, you can point to it (reference, connectives, lexical links). **Coherence** = in the reader's mind, you infer it (order, relevance, a through-line). ✗ "The committee approved the budget. However, the budget is a document. Moreover, paper comes from trees." (cohesive, incoherent) · "The scheme failed. Nobody had been consulted." (coherent, under-cohesive). Ask: **is the wiring missing, or the thought?**

Center: flow. THEME (given) → RHEME (new). "The lecture introduced a new theory. This theory challenges the standard model. The standard model had gone unquestioned..." Linear A→B, B→C · Constant A→B, A→C. Chain: *the drought* → *the dry spell* → *the water shortage* · spaniel → dog → animal. ✗ novel / book / work / volume / tome.

Right: architecture. Topic sentence → development → link. Orders: chronological · general → specific · specific → general · problem → solution · claim → evidence · compare/contrast. **Skeleton test:** one sentence per paragraph, read as a list. Signpost the turns, not the steps.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: strip and restore	8	S-S	Review C7. Read four sentences with stance (flashcards or slide): "Tellingly, the report never mentions the cost." · "The results, admittedly, were mixed." Pairs strip each to the bare fact, then restore it with a <i>different</i> stance and read it with the pause and fall-rise. Glance at homework journals; note one fossilized marker to target today.
Lead-in: glued, not reasoned	5	T-S	Slide 8. Read the "budget... document... paper... trees" text with total conviction. "Any grammar mistakes? (No.) Any missing links? (No: <i>however, moreover, therefore.</i>) So what's wrong? (It doesn't make sense.)" Then "The scheme failed. Nobody had been consulted..." "What's wrong here? (Nothing logically; it's just bare.)" Elicit the two virtues. "Today: how to build a long text that has both."
Cohesion, coherence & theme / rheme	12	T-S → S-S	Slides 8–9. The diagnostic question (wiring or thought?). Then theme / rheme with the staircase on the board: underline each rheme and draw the arrow to the next theme. Pairs fix the lesson's "sharp fall in productivity" paragraph (new information in the theme slot) in 3 minutes; compare with the model. Name the two progression patterns. CCQs.
Lexical chains, signposting & macro-structure	10	T-S	Slides 10–11. Chains: repetition, synonym, superordinate, general word; the "novel / book / work / volume / tome" muddle and its fix. Meta-discourse moves with the phrase bank; the over-signposting warning. Then the six ordering principles and the skeleton test , modeled on the lesson's cycling paragraph (disjointed → re-engineered).
Drill	5	T-S → S	"Hand it on" and pitch reset (see Drill script). Choral, then individual, then chain round the class.
Listening: the lecture opening	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 3.2-A twice. First: "What is the lecture's through-line?" (City parks as a history of public health.) Second: learners complete the seven signposts and label each move (preview, sequence, internal summary, transition, cross-reference). Pairs compare: "Which signpost could you delete without loss?"
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–4 alone (reorder, improve the flow, diagnose cohesion or coherence), then check in pairs. Board-check disagreements only. Ex 5 (build the chain) is homework.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Workshop: Cohesion & Coherence Lab	25	S-S → T-S	Slide 12. Round 1, Reconstruct (10 min) : groups of 3; each learner gets a sealed packet (A, B or C) with two or three paragraphs of the Wrenfield article (about 700 words, 7 paragraphs, scrambled letters). No showing: learners read their paragraphs to themselves, then describe or read aloud openings and closings to negotiate the order. When agreed, lay them out and name the ordering principle and three clues (a reference, a summary noun, a theme picking up a rheme). Round 2, Diagnose & repair (9 min) : the Riverside Radio draft has six planted faults. Groups log each one as cohesion or coherence and repair the draft in about 120 words. Round 3, Skeleton test (6 min) : swap repairs with the next group. The skeleton writer reduces each of the other group's paragraphs (or, for the one-paragraph draft, each move) to one sentence and reads the list aloud; the group says whether it reads as one argument. One strength and one suggestion. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns. Precision: a summary noun that doesn't fit (<i>This increase...</i> for a fall). Appropriacy: "In this next part I will now..." in a board report. Naturalness: "the scheme... the initiative... the project... the green venture... the program" in five lines. Effect: an order that was coherent but buried the main point. Show the model order (K R D W M T H) and the clue that settled it.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.2 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can..."
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 10 + 5 + 6 + 9 + 25 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: cohesion vs coherence. Cohesion is the visible wiring; coherence is the thought the wiring should carry. Editing the wrong layer is the commonest waste of an editor's time.

SAY: "The gallery reopened in March. Consequently, the café serves excellent coffee." Is there a connective? (Yes.) Is it true? (No: the coffee isn't a consequence.) Cohesion or coherence problem? (Coherence: a false link.) Will a better connective fix it? (No: we need a real relation, or no link at all.) "The scheme failed. Nobody had been consulted." Can you follow it? (Yes.) What's missing? (A little wiring: because.)

Meaning: theme / rheme. The theme is the point of departure, usually given; the rheme is the news, usually at the end, where attention rests (end-focus, which learners met as end-weight at C1).

SAY: "The director unveiled a radical proposal. This proposal alarmed her own board." Where does sentence 2 start? (On this proposal, the news of sentence 1.) Given or new? (Given.) Where's the new information? (At the end: alarmed her own board.) · "...Alarm among her own board was the immediate reaction." What's wrong? (Brand-new information in the theme slot: the reader has to hold it in suspense.)

Meaning: lexical chains and elegant variation. A chain binds and develops; variation for its own sake confuses.

SAY: "The spaniel... the dog... the animal." Same creature? (Yes.) Is the lens getting wider or narrower? (Wider: specific to general.) · "The novel... the book... the work... the volume... the tome." How many books? (One, but the reader has to keep checking.) Fix? (Repeat novel once and let it do the rest.) Is repeating a key word bad style? (No: repeating the anchor is a virtue.)

Meaning: meta-discourse and the skeleton. The writer steps outside the content to orient the reader. Too much, and the text reads like its own table of contents.

SAY: "So far, then, the evidence suggests..." Is this new content? (No, a summary of what came before.) Why use it? (To consolidate before a turn.) · "Firstly, I will now begin by introducing the first point." How many signposts? (Too many for one step.) · If the one-sentence skeleton stutters, should you polish sentences? (No: fix the order or relevance first.)

Form.

Given → new	theme picks up the previous rheme	...a sharp fall in productivity. This decline stemmed from...
Summary noun as theme	this / that / such + general noun	This neglect · Such objections · That chaos, in turn,...
Moving new info to the end	it-cleft · there is · passive · fronting given info	It is this single thread, trust, that... · There followed a wave of resignations.
Lexical chain	repetition · synonym · superordinate · general word · collocation	the drought · the dry spell · the crisis · the whole business · reservoir, ration, parched
Meta-discourse	preview · topic sentence · internal summary · transition · cross-reference	This essay will argue that... · A second objection is more serious. · So far, then,... · Against this backdrop,... · as we shall see

Pronunciation. Flow is audible. **Given information is de-accented** and the **nuclear stress falls on the new**: "The lecture introduced a new **THE**ory. This theory challenges the **STAN**dard model" (*theory* in sentence 2 is low and unstressed because it's given). When reading a long text aloud, use a **pitch reset**: start each new

paragraph or topic on a noticeably higher pitch, and let the last sentence of a paragraph fall low. Signposts such as *So far*, *then*, and *Against this backdrop*, are their own intonation units with a pause after them.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Hand it on** (the staircase): T says a sentence; S starts the next with a summary-noun theme that picks up the rheme. T: "Sales fell sharply in March." → S: "This decline..." T: "The council closed the pool for repairs." → "The closure..." T: "Staff proposed a four-day week." → "The proposal..." T: "The river flooded twice in one winter." → "These floods..." Stress the new information at the end of each S sentence.
- 2 **De-accent the given**: choral, then individuals, with the given word low: "The lecture introduced a new THEory. This theory challenges the STANDard model. The standard model had gone unQUESTioned."
- 3 **Name the relation** (coherence check): T reads two sentences; S says the relation or "none": "The bridge closed. Traffic doubled on Elm Street." → "Cause and effect: so / as a result." "The gallery reopened. The café serves good coffee." → "None: don't fake it."
- 4 **Pitch reset**: two learners read the first two paragraphs of the Wrenfield article (the model order), the second starting noticeably higher. Class judges: "Could you hear the new paragraph?"

◆ COHESION & COHERENCE LAB – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3**, packets A, B and C (the paragraph split is on the materials sheet). In pairs, use the two-packet version. The rule is **no showing** in the first five minutes: learners may read a paragraph's first and last sentences aloud, or describe it, but not pass it over. This forces them to listen for cohesive clues (*These gains, however,...* · *It is this unplanned expense...* · *Supporters of the scheme reply...*).
- ◆ **Reconstruct (10 min)**: after five minutes, lay all seven paragraphs on the table and finalize the order. On the Lab frame they write: the order (letters), the ordering principle, and three clues that decided it. Any defensible order with a coherent skeleton earns credit, but the article was written with one clear order in mind (answer key).
- ◆ **Diagnose & repair (9 min)**: the **Riverside Radio** draft (a one-paragraph board report, about 160 words) has six planted faults: empty over-signposting, an irrelevant detail, a false connective, a buried main point with no topic sentence, elegant variation, and new information in the theme slot with an ambiguous *This*. Groups log each on the fault log as **cohesion** or **coherence** before rewriting, then repair it in about 120 words.
- ◆ **Skeleton test (6 min)**: swap repairs. The **skeleton writer** (give this role to a dominant speaker) writes one sentence per move and reads the list aloud without commentary. The rest of the group answers: Does it make one argument? Is anything redundant or missing? Then one strength and one suggestion, quoting the text.
- ◆ **Share**: one group reads its repaired draft aloud with pitch reset; the class runs the skeleton test live on the board.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE LAB

SAY: *In Round 1, can you show your paragraphs at first? (No, read or describe them.) What do you write at the end? (The order, the principle and three clues.) Is there only one possible order? (The article has one best order, but explain yours.) · In Round 2, what do you label first? (Each fault: cohesion or coherence.) Rewrite before labeling? (No.) · In Round 3, what does the skeleton writer do? (One sentence per move, read aloud, no comments.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give the article paragraphs with the **first sentence of each highlighted** and the cohesive clue words boxed (*These gains · this unplanned expense · then*). The learner's job is to match "what each paragraph points back to" rather than read every word. In Round 2, give the draft with the six faulty sentences numbered and a menu of six fault names to match. Fewer items: Ex 2 set A only, Ex 4 items A–C. Target: the correct first and last paragraphs and three faults labeled correctly, explained aloud.

STRETCH

Structure as **strategy**. Ask strong learners to re-order the Wrenfield article for a different effect: specific → general (open on the drought, the "reveal" later), or compare/contrast (critics and supporters point by point), and to write the new topic sentences so the joins still feel inevitable. Then ask them to mix constant-theme and linear progression in one paragraph on purpose and to explain where each serves. For exam candidates: the CPE Writing Part 1 essay rewards exactly this, a single through-line across two texts.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Delayed main point:** several rhetorical traditions build toward the point rather than opening with it: the Chinese and Japanese four-part *qǐ-chéng-zhuǎn-hé / ki-shō-ten-ketsu* structure, some Arabic and Persian persuasive prose, and much Romance-language academic writing. Learners may write a beautiful paragraph whose topic sentence arrives last. Frame the English preference for **topic sentence first** as a genre convention, not a better way of thinking; the "specific → general reveal" is a legitimate choice when it's deliberate.
- ◆ **Synonym fever:** French, Spanish, Portuguese, Italian and Russian school writing often penalizes repetition, so learners produce the elegant-variation muddle with pride. Reassure them that repeating the anchor term is good English style.
- ◆ **Additive chains:** Arabic *wa*, Persian *va* and oral narrative styles in many languages link long runs of clauses with *and*. In English, a run of *ands* hides the logical relations that coherence depends on.
- ◆ **Theme and word order:** speakers of free word-order languages (Russian, Polish, Czech, Ukrainian, Finnish, Hungarian) put new information last through word order and may try the same in English ("In

the corner stood a man" is fine; "The report wrote the manager" is not). Offer English's tools instead: passive, *there is*, clefts, a summary noun.

- ◆ **Topic-comment openers:** Chinese, Japanese and Korean topic-prominence produces "As for the budget, it...", "Regarding the report, it..." at the start of every paragraph. One is fine; five read as a list.
- ◆ **Paragraph length and comma splices:** German and Spanish academic writing tolerates very long paragraphs and sentences joined by commas. English readers expect one idea per paragraph and a period between independent clauses.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_08.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and shadow them, de-accenting the given words; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Re-Engineer a Text" project (a new identity card's "text I wrote recently" is fine if learners prefer not to use their own writing). Workbook 3.2: Exercise 5 (build the chain), "My new words" and the journal (the skeleton of something they wrote, and one sentence on whether its weakness is order, relevance or a missing through-line).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A Coherence · Q2 B "The director unveiled a radical proposal. This proposal alarmed her own board." · Q3 (new) B A coherence problem: one step is repeated, the drought is missing, and the critics get no reply; reorder and cut. Lecture opening (Ex 1): 1 will argue that · 2 I'll begin with · 3 then turn to · 4 finally ask · 5 So far, then, · 6 This raises a further question · 7 A very different picture emerges when. Through-line: the history of the city park is, at heart, a history of public health.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ sort a dense source into main idea, supporting detail, example and aside, and reduce it to a faithful **one-sentence gist** that keeps its logical relations (*although, but, because*) and its proportions
- ◆ paraphrase by **rebuilding the sentence** (change word class, voice, clause order, subject), and recognize **patchwriting** (same skeleton, swapped synonyms) as a form of plagiarism, even when cited
- ◆ choose **reporting verbs** that carry the right stance (*notes · argues · concedes · counters · claims*) and distance a source only when the doubt is earned
- ◆ write a **synthesis organized by idea**, not by source: a governing sentence, agreement, divergence, qualification, and a close that holds the sources in tension
- ◆ check a text for integrity: every claim attributed, no run of borrowed words, no distortion of a source's certainty or scope

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Synthesis Workshop frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 13–17 · Reporting-verb flashcards (by stance) · **Library sources** A/B/C expert cards · idea grids · **paraphrase integrity strips** · highlighters · **Thread It!** board game · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 3.3-A (the radio panel wrap-up) and 3.3-B (gist it)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the ladder. Summarize = same meaning, far fewer words · **Paraphrase** = same meaning, same length, new structure · **Synthesize** = several meanings, one account organized by idea. Summary moves: delete · generalize · supply a topic sentence · keep the logic (*although... but...*). ✗ "Some critics worry the reform may raise costs" → "The reform is a costly failure."

Center: rebuild, don't re-skin. Original: *The company's reluctance to inspect its suppliers has allowed dangerous practices to flourish unchecked.* ✗ patchwrite: *The firm's unwillingness to examine its vendors has let hazardous practices thrive unrestrained.* ✓ *Because managers have declined to check on the firms they buy from, unsafe methods have been free to spread.* Moves: word class · voice · clause order · subject · then synonyms.

Right: whose voice? neutral: *notes, observes* · committed: *argues, contends, maintains* · endorsing: *shows, demonstrates, points out* · reluctant: *concedes, acknowledges* · opposing: *counters, disputes* · doubting: *claims, alleges*. Synthesis: *Both X and Y agree...* · *Whereas X..., Y counters...* · *Y qualifies X's claim...* · *Taken together,...*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: fix the flow	6	S-S	Review C8. Board a three-sentence paragraph with new information in the theme slot and one elegant variation ("A burst pipe was the cause. Flooding of the basement archive followed the pipe's failure. The collection's rescue by volunteers took a week; the holdings were then dried."). Pairs repair it given-before-new with one anchor term. One pair reads it with pitch reset. Collect or glance at C8 journals.
Lead-in: what went wrong?	4	T-S	Slide 13. Board the source "Some critics worry the reform may raise costs" and the summary "The reform is a costly failure." Ask: "Is it shorter? (Yes.) Is it faithful? (No.) What exactly changed? (<i>some</i> → all; <i>may</i> → is; worry → verdict.)" "Today: three ways to give back someone else's meaning without betraying it."
Summarizing: the précis	9	T-S → S-S	Slide 13. Main idea / supporting detail / example / aside, and the four moves. Show the high-speed-line gist and ask what was kept (the concession, the charge, the counter-argument) and cut. Pairs write a one-sentence gist of the museum-admission paragraph (Workbook Ex 2, item 1) in 3 minutes; compare with the model. CCQs.
Paraphrase vs patchwriting	9	T-S → S-S	Slide 14. The social-media original, the patchwrite and the genuine paraphrase. Learners name the moves in the good version (new subject, contrast frame, noun → adjective). Then "close the source" technique: pairs read a sentence, turn the card over, and rebuild it from memory of the meaning. CCQs, including "If I cite it, is patchwriting OK?" (No.)
Reporting verbs & synthesis moves	8	T-S	Slides 15–16. The stance ladder of reporting verbs (<i>notes</i> → <i>argues</i> → <i>points out</i> → <i>concedes</i> → <i>counters</i> → <i>claims</i>) and the Halpern pair (<i>shows</i> / <i>claims</i>). Then weak (source-by-source) vs strong (idea-by-idea) synthesis, with the remote-work model and its moves: governing idea, agreement, divergence, tension.
Drill	5	T-S → S	Reporting-verb stance drill and the gist-in-ten-words round (see Drill script).
Listening: the radio panel	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 3.3-A twice. First: "Do the three guests agree on anything?" (Yes: the street is busy on weekends and change is needed.) Second: learners complete the table:

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			who, which reporting verb, what view. Pairs discuss whether the host was fair to Dr. Lee (<i>questions</i> vs a loaded alternative).
Controlled practice	6	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 3-4 alone (judge and repair the paraphrase; choose the reporting verb), then check in pairs. Ex 5 (synthesize two opposing statements) is homework unless a pair finishes early.
Workshop: Synthesis Workshop	27	S-S → T-S	Slide 17. Topic: Should public libraries abolish overdue fines? Round 1, Experts (6 min): groups of 3; each learner gets one source card (A: a library director; B: a city budget analyst; C: a literacy researcher). Read for 2 minutes, turn the card over, then give the group a 30-second oral gist from memory (a spoken paraphrase: no reading aloud). Round 2, Idea grid (5 min): with all three cards now face up, the group fills the grid: where the sources agree, diverge, and where one qualifies another; they agree a governing sentence. Round 3, Write (11 min): in pairs or alone, a 200-word synthesis (180-220) organized by idea, every claim attributed, fair reporting verbs, nothing copied. Round 4, Integrity review (5 min): swap. The source checker runs the Highlighter test (any run of three or more words from a source, other than names and set terms like <i>overdue fines</i> , is highlighted) and the "Whose voice?" test (label each sentence A, B, C, "all" or "writer"). Then the paraphrase integrity strips as a race for early finishers. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns. Precision: "Hsu claims the data are unreliable" (he says they're short-term and self-reported; <i>notes</i> or <i>points out</i> is fair). Appropriacy: "Source A says... Source B says... Source C says..." as the whole structure. Naturalness: "According to Ortega, she argues that..." (double attribution). Effect: a synthesis where the reader couldn't tell Nwosu's view from the writer's. Learners explain the effect first, then fix.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.3 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can..." for all three lessons (module wrap-up below).
Total	90		6 + 4 + 9 + 9 + 8 + 5 + 6 + 6 + 27 + 5 + 5

Meaning: summary. A miniature of the argument, not a bag of surviving facts. Fidelity of proportion matters as much as fidelity of fact.

SAY: "Though the high-speed line has cut journey times, its huge overspend has led economists to argue the money would have helped more people elsewhere." What survived? (The concession, the charge, the counter-argument.) What vanished? (The doubled estimate, the commuters, the rural districts: detail and example.) If I write "The line cut journey times and cost a lot," what's lost? (The logic: though, and the economists' argument.) · Can I add "which was a mistake"? (No: that's my opinion, not the source's.)

Meaning: paraphrase vs patchwriting. A genuine paraphrase rebuilds the architecture; a patchwrite keeps it and swaps the furniture.

SAY: "The quick growth of social media has basically changed the way young individuals develop their political views." Same subject, verb, object and order as the original? (Yes.) What changed? (Only synonyms.) Is it a paraphrase? (No: patchwriting.) If I add "(Smith, 2024)", is it OK? (No: it's still the author's expression. Quote it or rebuild it.) · Which should you change first, the structure or the words? (The structure.)

Meaning: reporting verbs. The verb is where the writer's stance toward the source lives.

SAY: "As Halpern shows, the policy failed." Does the writer agree with Halpern? (Yes: shows endorses.) "As Halpern claims, the policy failed." (The writer doubts it.) "Ortega concedes that fines brought in some money." Is Ortega happy to say so? (No: it's a point against her own position.) · Is it fair to write "Hsu alleges..."? (Only if you can justify the doubt; otherwise it's bias.)

Meaning: synthesis. Organized by idea, not source. If the paragraph could be reordered source by source without loss, it isn't a synthesis.

SAY: "Source A says... Source B says... Source C says..." Is that a synthesis? (No: a list of summaries.) What's the first question to ask? (Where do they agree, disagree, or qualify each other?) Must I be neutral? (Fair, not necessarily neutral: your view shows through order and emphasis, openly marked.)

Form.

Gist frames	In essence,... · Boiled down,... · The author's central claim is that...	In essence, the author argues that convenience has cost us our privacy.
Paraphrase moves	word class · voice · clause order · subject · synonyms (last)	reluctance to inspect → have declined to impose rules
Attribution	According to X, ... · As X points out, ... · In X's view, ... · X argues	not both at once: ✗ According to X, she argues that...

	that ...	
Reporting-verb patterns	verb + that · verb + noun · verb + noun + as	Hsu notes that... · Nwosu questions the assumption · Ortega describes fines as...
Synthesis connectors	agree · diverge · qualify · extend · conclude	Both X and Y concur that... · Whereas X..., Y counters that... · Y qualifies X's claim, noting... · Taken together,...
Tense	present for what a text says (American academic default)	Ortega argues (not <i>argued</i>) that... · past for what someone did: Nwosu interviewed 60 parents

Pronunciation. In a spoken synthesis the listener needs to **hear** whose voice is speaking. Put the attribution first, as its own intonation unit, and **stress the name** when the source changes: "**OR**tega | argues that...; **HSU**, | by contrast, | notes that...". When quoting aloud, drop your pitch slightly and slow down, or say "and I quote... end of quote." Know the stress on the verbs: *conTENDS*, *conCEDES*, *mainTAINS*, *reFUTES*, *aLLEGES*, *aCKNOW*ledges, *QUEST*ions; and verb vs noun: *to disPUTE* / *a DIS*pute (both stresses are heard for the noun), *to COUN*ter.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Pick the stance:** T gives a view + the writer's attitude; S reports it. T: "Ortega: fines kept families away. (neutral)" → S: "Ortega notes that fines kept families away." T: "(you agree)" → "As Ortega points out, fines kept families away." T: "(you doubt it)" → "Ortega claims that fines kept families away." T: "Hsu: fine-free libraries report stable returns. (against his own position)" → "Hsu acknowledges that fine-free libraries report stable returns."
- 2 Rebuild it** (choral first, then individuals): T: "Critics attacked the plan." → S: "The plan was attacked by critics." T: "Because costs rose, the project stalled." → "The project stalled, since costs had risen." T: "The collapse of the talks surprised everyone." → "Everyone was surprised when the talks collapsed."
- 3 Gist in ten words:** T reads a two-sentence claim (from the materials sheet); S gives the gist in ten words or fewer, keeping the logical relation. Class checks: faithful? proportion kept? *but* / *although* kept?

◆ SYNTHESIS WORKSHOP – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3**, one source each (A Ortega, library director · B Hsu, budget analyst · C Nwosu, literacy researcher). The sources are short (about 90 words each) and invented, and none is simply "right": Ortega has good local results but a stake in them; Hsu is careful about evidence but frames the issue as cost; Nwosu widens the lens to other barriers.
- ◆ **Experts (6 min):** read your source for 2 minutes, underline its main claim and its hedges, then **turn the card over**. Each learner gives a 30-second oral gist from memory. Speaking without the text makes patchwriting almost impossible, which is the point. Listeners may ask one clarifying question each.
- ◆ **Idea grid (5 min):** cards face up. Fill three rows: **agree** (for example: fines raise little money; returns stay stable or rise), **diverge** (whether the lost revenue matters; whether current evidence is good enough),

qualify / extend (Nwosu: fines are one barrier among several). Agree a **governing sentence** that is not a list: "The case for fine-free libraries turns less on money than on who the library is for."

- ◆ **Write (11 min):** 180–220 words. Checklist: ☐ governing sentence first ☐ agreement before divergence ☐ each source named at least once, with a fair reporting verb ☐ at least one *whereas / by contrast* and one *qualifies / extends* move ☐ a close that holds the views in tension (the writer's own view, if any, clearly marked) ☐ no run of three or more borrowed words ☐ nothing sharper or softer than the source said. Those who finish early count words and cut to exactly 200.
- ◆ **Integrity review (5 min):** swap. The **source checker** highlights borrowed runs and writes A / B / C / all / writer beside each sentence. The writer must fix any highlight and any sentence whose voice the checker couldn't label. One strength and one suggestion, quoting the text.
- ◆ **Share:** one synthesis read aloud with the name-stress technique; the class says whose voice is speaking at each point. Early finishers: paraphrase integrity strips, then **Thread It!**

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SYNTHESIS WORKSHOP

SAY: *In Round 1, do you read your source aloud? (No, you give the gist from memory.) How long? (30 seconds.) · How many words in the synthesis? (About 200: 180 to 220.) Organized by source or by idea? (By idea.) What comes first? (A governing sentence.) Can you use "claims" for a source you disagree with? (Only if you can justify the doubt.) What does the source checker highlight? (Three or more words copied from a source.) What does "writer" mean in the margin? (That sentence is my own view.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give these learners the **shortest source** (C) with its main claim already underlined, and a **frame** for the synthesis: "The debate over ... turns on ... · All three writers agree that ... · Whereas Ortega ..., Hsu ... · Nwosu adds that ... · Taken together, ...". Their oral gist in Round 1 is often the clearest in the group; build on it. Fewer items: Ex 3 attempts A–C, Ex 4 items 1–5. Target: a 100–120 word synthesis with every sentence's voice labeled correctly by the checker.

STRETCH

Exam precision and authorial voice. Ask exam candidates to write the synthesis in **exactly 200 words** and then a CPE-style evaluation paragraph that weighs the sources' evidence openly ("Of the three accounts, Nwosu's is the most cautious and, arguably, the most useful..."). Then the subtler task: rewrite the synthesis so the writer's view emerges **only through ordering and emphasis**, with every reporting verb neutral or fair, and have a partner guess the writer's view. Discuss when a distancing verb (*claims, would have us believe*) is earned.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Different conventions of borrowing:** in many educational traditions (for example, parts of East and South Asia, the Middle East and Eastern Europe), reproducing an authority's words shows respect and mastery, and quotation marks are used less. Explain the Anglo-American convention clearly and without judgment: in English academic and professional writing, you either quote exactly (with marks) or rebuild completely.
- ◆ **Preposition after reporting verbs:** "discuss about," "mention about," "emphasize on," "stress on," "criticize about," "explain me" are common in South Asian, Arabic, Chinese and Spanish-influenced English, and often fossilized at C2. Drill *discuss / mention / emphasize + noun, explain (to me) that*.
- ◆ **Automatic backshift:** learners trained on reported speech write "Ortega argued that fines were..." for a text that still argues it. In English academic writing the present tense is normal for what a text says.
- ◆ **"says" for everything,** or the opposite: one learned verb (*claims*, often) used for every source, unaware of its distancing effect. Build a personal bank of six verbs with their stance.
- ◆ **Double attribution:** "According to Hsu, he thinks that..." (common across L1s). One frame is enough.
- ◆ **Precision of certainty:** modal systems don't map one-to-one (German *sollen*, Spanish conditional of rumor *habría*, French conditional *aurait* all mark "reportedly"). Learners may harden or soften a source's certainty in translation; check every *may / suggests / shows* against the original.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_09.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and shadow them, stressing the names; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Gist, Synthesise, Deliver" project (choose two texts on a non-political issue: two reviews of the same book or film, or two articles on remote work, sleep or city parks work well). Workbook 3.3: Exercise 5 (synthesize two statements), finish the 200-word synthesis if needed, "My new words" and the journal (rebuild one sentence of a past paraphrase from memory and note what changed; a new identity card's "source I relied on" may be used instead).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A It over-generalizes and distorts the source's cautious claim · Q2 C "Because the scheme was introduced so quickly, many people were left unsure how it worked" · Q3 (new) B "Okafor notes that...". Radio panel (Ex 1): Priya Raman · argues · weekend closure would bring shoppers and cut pollution · Tom Becker · concedes / insists · the street is congested / businesses need delivery access and a trial first · Dr. Lee · questions · the city's footfall figures (collected on one sunny weekend) · agreement: the street is overcrowded on weekends and something must change.

END OF C9: MODULE 3 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "steer it, build it, distill it": **Admittedly, ... that said, ... tellingly, ...** (steer and color) → **This decline... the pocket forests... so far, then,...** (build a text that coheres) → **In essence,...** · **Whereas Ortega argues..., Hsu notes...** · **Taken together,...** (distill and attribute). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C10 warmer (the **Thread It!** board game is ready for that) and again in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Watch for in Module 4: rhetoric and persuasion in 4.1 is stance turned up to full volume: the same adverbials (*undeniably, tellingly*) and reporting verbs (*would have us believe*) become persuasive weapons, so ask learners to spot where fair framing ends and manipulation begins. The C8 skeleton test is the best tool for planning a persuasive case in 4.1, and the C9 synthesis grid is the natural planning frame for the 4.3 review project, where learners must fairly represent the view they argue against.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: choosing stance adverbials for a stated attitude (including near-neighbors such as *ostensibly / apparently / reportedly*), labeling markers by function and register, reading slant, reordering a short text and naming its principle, repairing information flow and elegant variation, diagnosing cohesion vs coherence, a one-sentence gist that keeps the logic, telling paraphrase from patchwriting, choosing a fair reporting verb, and a short synthesis of two statements.

Module 4 — The Complete Communicator: Style & Rhetoric

Three classes that turn command into effect. First, a rhetoric and persuasion lab: the three classical appeals (*ethos, pathos, logos*), the named figures that make a line memorable (*tricolon, anaphora, antithesis, the rhetorical question*), the architecture of a case that survives attack (*claim → grounds → warrant → concession → refutation*) and the counterfeit moves a master refuses and names (*straw man, false dilemma, ad hominem*). Then a style and voice workshop: rhythm and sentence shape, economy (*omit needless words*), strong verbs, and voice, practiced by writing one small event in three distinct voices and critiquing each other's drafts. Last, **Mastery in Action**, the halfway review: a short speech, a live Q&A and a re-pitched written piece that orchestrate everything from Modules 1–4, scored on a checklist that feeds Progress Test 1 in C13.

3 lessons

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C10–C12

Weeks 5–6

90 min per class

CEFR C2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer → lead-in → Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill → controlled practice** (workbook) → a demanding **workshop** (a speech, a set of stylistic rewrites, a performance) → **feedback** with delayed correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-4-rhetoric.html](#). Print [materials/module-4/classroom-materials.html](#) before C10. It holds the flashcards (appeals, figures, fallacies, sentence shapes, deadwood, editing passes and six picture event cards), the new identity cards, the **Persuasion Lab** topic and side cards with the speech spine sheet and device-hunt grid, the **Style & Voice Workshop** event cards, voice cards and Critique Circle card, the **Mastery in Action** topic, audience and challenge cards, the **C12 teacher checklist** (feeds C13), the **Layer It!** review game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home and shadow their rhythm, which matters more in this module than in any other.
- Run these as workshops, and protect the workshop.** Roughly a quarter to a third of every class is one extended product: a two-minute persuasive speech (C10), one event in three voices plus a critique circle (C11), a speech,

Q&A and written re-pitch (C12). If you're running late, cut the controlled practice (set the rest for homework), never the workshop.

- ◆ **Refinement, not a first meeting.** At C1 (Lesson 4.3) learners met the rule of three, contrast, the rhetorical question and signposting for a three-minute talk, and in C1 Module 3 they learned plain English and the "Who does what?" test. Don't re-teach any of it. The C2 step is **deliberate effect with restraint**: naming a figure and choosing it for a reason, balancing the three appeals, conceding on purpose, spotting manipulation, and cutting the line you love when it serves only itself.
- ◆ **Feedback on four things, not one.** C2 learners rarely make errors that block meaning, so "accuracy" alone gives them almost nothing. Take notes in four columns: **precision** (the nearly-right word or figure: *a tricolon of four items, anaphora* used for what is really epistrophe, *very unique*), **appropriacy** (right device, wrong room: soaring anaphora in a status update, a joke at a moment that needed gravity), **naturalness** (grammatical but no English speaker would say it: *I will explain you why, as a conclusion*) and **effect** (did it land? where did the room lean in, and where did it drift?). The effect column is the most useful at this level, and the one learners almost never receive. In the feedback stage, board one item from each column, without names.
- ◆ **Near-native in some areas, fossilized in others.** Your strongest learners may argue brilliantly and still say *discuss about, informations* or *since three years*, errors they have made for twenty years without anyone telling them. Keep a private **fossil list** per learner (one line each). Once a week, give each learner **one** fossil, privately, with the correct form and one sentence of their own rewritten: "You said *We need to discuss about the budget*. At C2 it's *discuss the budget*. That one's worth fixing for good." One fossil at a time is fixable; a list of twelve is discouraging.
- ◆ **Peer critique with a protocol, every class.** Unstructured peer feedback at C2 collapses into politeness ("Very good!") or into a showcase for the most confident critic. Each workshop has its own protocol: the **Device Hunt + flat-reading test** (C10: listeners quote the devices they heard, then the speaker reads their best line flatly: if it only works with the performance, question it), the **Critique Circle** (C11: the author stays silent; critics say what stayed with them, the author asks one question, critics ask neutral questions, and only then offer one darling to kill and one fix, with permission) and the **re-pitch check** (C12: could the new reader act on this?). Critics always **quote** the text instead of summarizing it.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** C2 classes attract accomplished people used to holding a room: lawyers, academics, managers. Give them the jobs that need listening, not talking: the **fallacy watcher** and **timekeeper** in C10, the **last critic** in C11 (they may speak only after everyone else, and may not repeat a point), the **challenger who must paraphrase before asking** in C12. Say it kindly: "Your ear for this is excellent. I want you on the fallacy card this round." In whole-class feedback, use "a new voice first."
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and a few British words (*recognise, generalisation, defence, honour, practised, per cent, summarising, humour, colour, sceptical, theatres, pound*). Teach *recognize, generalization, defense, honor, practiced, percent, summarizing, humor, color, skeptical, theaters, dollar*. Accept British forms whenever a learner uses them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Persuade → sound like yourself → orchestrate. In C10 learners aim their language at an audience: an appeal chosen on purpose, a figure placed at a hinge, a concession that buys trust, and the critical armor to feel someone else's rhetoric working on them and still refuse it. In C11 they turn the same attention inward, to the sound of their own prose: rhythm, economy, strong verbs, and a voice consistent enough to be recognized. In C12 they do everything at once, for a real audience, and then re-pitch it for a different one. Every class ends with something another learner hears or reads: a two-minute speech, three short pieces in three voices, a speech with Q&A and a written re-pitch.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: NEUTRAL TOPICS, ASSIGNED SIDES, INVENTED PATHOS

Rhetoric invites strong feelings. Every persuasion topic in this module stays in **workplace, education, science, arts and culture, technology, language and community** territory (a tool library, a meeting-free afternoon, handwriting, quiet carriages, museum opening hours). There are **no** topics about party politics, religion, immigration policy, war or national identity, and no learner is asked to argue about their own country or community. **Sides are assigned** on the card: learners argue the card, not their convictions, and may say so ("I've been assigned the case against"). Pathos is the risky appeal: model **invented, low-stakes anecdotes** (a neighbor waiting three months for a fence repair) and say explicitly that nobody should use a personal loss or hardship as their story. The C11 events are small everyday mishaps (a collapsed cake, a bus that left early), never accidents, illness or grief. The online 4.3 journal asks learners to write to "the person you were at the start"; for some newcomers that period was painful, so always offer "or a letter to a learner who is just starting out." Anyone can say "Pass," take a new identity card, or present only to you.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **flashcards** (Set A, one set for the board): appeals (3) and figures (7) for C10, fallacies (8) for C10, sentence shapes (5), deadwood culprits (7) and editing passes (6) for C11, and the six **picture event cards** (suitcase, umbrella, cake, bus stop, market, kitchen) for the C11 workshop.
- For C10: one set of **Persuasion Lab** topic cards with side cards (Set C), one **speech spine sheet** per learner, one **device-hunt grid** per learner, and a phone timer per group of 3.
- For C11: the **event cards** and **voice cards** (Set D, one event per pair; every learner gets the three core voices, plus a genre voice card for stretch), and one **Critique Circle** protocol card per group.
- For C12: the **Mastery in Action** topic, side and audience cards and challenge starters (Set E), the **teacher checklist** with class grid and score slips (Set F), and the **Layer It!** board game (Set G: one board per group of 3–4, a die, counters) for the warmer.
- Print the **new identity cards** (Set B) and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- Optional but powerful: bring (or project) one short, genuinely admired speech excerpt from a non-political context, for example a commencement address, a scientist accepting a prize, or a museum director opening a

new gallery. Avoid election speeches and anything tied to a current controversy. Two minutes of real rhetoric heard aloud does more than a page of definitions.

- ◆ Tell learners at the end of C9 (or by message) to bring an idea they'd like to argue for in C12, within the topic territory above. They'll get a topic card if they don't have one.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
4.1	C10 · wk 5	Rhetoric & persuasion lab: the three appeals (<i>ethos, pathos, logos</i>) and their balance; figures (<i>tricolon, anaphora, antithesis, rhetorical question</i> ; stretch: <i>epistrophe, chiasmus, hypophora</i>); the architecture of a case (<i>claim → grounds → warrant → concession → refutation → restated claim</i>); the strategic concession; fallacies (<i>straw man, ad hominem, false dilemma, slippery slope, bandwagon, hasty generalization, appeal to authority, loaded language</i>); the ethics of rhetoric	analyze a short invented speech for its appeals, figures, spine and one counterfeit move, then write and deliver a two-minute persuasive speech on an assigned neutral topic whose listeners can name at least three of its devices
4.2	C11 · wk 6	Style & voice workshop: style as the sum of consistent choices; sentence rhythm and shape (<i>simple, compound, complex, periodic, loose</i> ; the short sentence after a long one; the fragment); economy and deadwood; strong verbs vs weak verb + noun; concrete and specific; voice as consistency; pastiche and divergence; editing in single-purpose passes; <i>kill your darlings</i>	write the same small event in three distinct, sustained voices (a reporter, a lyric essayist, a deadpan wit), cut and sharpen a draft in separate passes, and give and receive precise critique on style and voice
4.3	C12 · wk 6	Mastery in Action (review project): orchestration of Modules 1–4 (the <i>mot juste</i> , register, fixed expressions, implicature, irony, metaphor, stance, cohesion, synthesis, rhetoric, style); adapting the same substance to a different audience and mode; handling unscripted questions; self-assessment against a mastery rubric	deliver a three-minute persuasive or analytical speech with a clear arc and at least six deliberate layers, handle two minutes of unscripted questions, re-pitch the argument in writing for a different reader, and assess their own performance with specific evidence

4.1 · C10

Rhetoric & Persuasion — The Art of Argument

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ identify the dominant appeal in a persuasive extract (**ethos**: credibility; **pathos**: emotion; **logos**: reason and evidence) and explain why a strong case **braids** all three
- ◆ recognize and produce the core figures, **tricolon**, **anaphora**, **antithesis** and the **rhetorical question**, with parallel grammar and the right rhythm, and place them at the hinges of an argument (opening, pivot, close)
- ◆ build a case along the classical spine (*claim* → *grounds* → *warrant* → *concession* → *refutation* → *restated claim*) and **concede narrowly, refute decisively**
- ◆ name common fallacies (*straw man*, *ad hominem*, *false dilemma*, *slippery slope*, *bandwagon*, *hasty generalization*) and counter them calmly by redirecting to the actual claim
- ◆ judge when high rhetoric fits the occasion (a speech, an op-ed) and when it grates (a report, a status update)

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Persuasion Lab planner, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Appeal, figure and fallacy flashcards (Set A) · **Persuasion Lab** topic and side cards, speech spine sheets, device-hunt grids (Set C) · phone timers · New identity cards (Set B)
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.1-A ("Lend It, Don't Buy It": the tool-library speech) and 4.1-B ("Spot the counterfeit")

BOARD PLAN

Left: where persuasion comes from. ETHOS: trust me (*As someone who has...* · conceding a fair point) · PATHOS: feel this (*Picture, for a moment...* · one telling detail) · LOGOS: see why (*The figures are stark: It follows that...*). Braid all three: open on ethos, reason with logos, close on pathos.

Center: the shapes. TRICOLON *sharpens the mind, softens the heart, and widens the world* · ANAPHORA *This city deserves... This city deserves...* · ANTITHESIS *not to spend more, but to own less* · RHETORICAL Q *Can we really afford to wait?* · (EPISTROPHE · CHIASMUS · HYPOPHORA). Rule: few, and at the hinges.

Right: the spine. claim → grounds → warrant (*This matters because...*) → concession (*I grant that...*) → refutation (*But this overlooks...*) → restated claim. Concede narrowly, refute decisively. Counterfeits: straw man · ad hominem · false dilemma · slippery slope · bandwagon · hasty generalization. Test: **Say it flat.** Does it still hold?

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: synthesis in a sentence	8	S-S	Review C9 (3.3, summarizing and synthesis). Board two short opposing views: "Video calls save hours of travel and let quieter colleagues speak up." · "Video calls drain energy, and the best ideas still come from corridor conversations." Pairs write (1) a one-sentence synthesis (<i>While the first writer stresses..., the second counters that...</i>) and (2) a twelve-word précis of the whole debate (<i>Boiled down, the debate turns on...</i>). Two pairs read theirs. Note one precise reporting verb and one clumsy one for later.
Lead-in: same claim, different force	5	T-S	Slide 3. Read the flat claim ("We need to act now, because it will get worse and cost more if we wait...") in a neutral voice, then the figured version ("We can act now, or we can pay later..."). Ask: "Same content? (Yes.) Which one would you remember tomorrow? Why? What did the second speaker <i>do</i> ?" Elicit: balance, repetition, a triple, an image of the future. "Today: the named techniques behind that feeling, and the ethics of using them."
Meaning: the three appeals	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 4. Hold up the three appeal flashcards. Give pairs 3 minutes to sort six short extracts (Workbook Ex 2) by dominant appeal; check on the slide. Establish the balance point: pure logos convinces the intellect but rarely moves anyone to act; pure pathos collapses under scrutiny; pure ethos is assertion. Link to C1 (Lesson 1.1): loaded words are pathos in disguise (<i>casualties vs slaughter</i>). CCQs (below).
Form: the figures	10	T-S	Slide 5. Present the four core figures with one invented example each, then show how great lines stack figures (Kennedy's <i>Ask not...</i> is both antithesis and chiasmus). Keep epistrophe, chiasmus and hypophora brief: they're for recognition and stretch. Stress the grammar: a figure only works if the parallel parts are grammatically parallel (<i>to spend more... to own less</i> , not <i>spending more... to own less</i>). CCQs.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Drill: the rhythm of figures	5	T-S → S	Choral then individual (see Drill script): the tricolon's rise-rise-fall, antithesis with contrastive stress, the falling rhetorical question, anaphora with a steady beat. At C2 the drill is about delivery , not form: learners who can write a perfect tricolon often say it in a flat monotone that kills it.
Listening: "Lend It, Don't Buy It"	12	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.1-A (a retired carpenter proposes a tool library at a neighborhood meeting) with conviction. First listening: "What is she proposing? Why should we trust her? What objection does she expect?" Second listening: learners complete the seven quoted lines and name the figure in each. Then slide 6 (the spine): pairs label the moves in order and find the one counterfeit line (the bandwagon: "everyone I've spoken to already agrees with me, so the matter is settled"). Ask: "Did it work on you the first time? Why is it dangerous in an otherwise honest speech?"
Controlled practice: fallacies and concessions	8	T-S → S	Slide 7. Read Script 4.1-B ("Spot the counterfeit," six lines) once, pausing after each: learners call out the fallacy, and a volunteer counters it in one calm sentence. Then Workbook Ex 3 (rewrite with a named figure) items 1–2 alone. Ex 3 items 3–4, Ex 4 and Ex 5 are homework unless a learner finishes early.
Freer: Persuasion Lab	23	S → S-S → T-S	Slide 8. Draft (9 min): each learner draws a topic card and a side card (Set C) and fills the speech spine sheet : the claim in one sentence, grounds, warrant, the concession (draft it first), the refutation, the close. They script only three lines in full (the opening, the pivot, the close) and mark at least three named figures and all three appeals. Deliver (9 min): groups of 3, two minutes each (timekeeper stops them kindly); the two listeners tick and quote on the device-hunt grid . Critique (5 min): the Device Hunt report (listeners quote what they heard, and where) and the flat-reading test (the speaker reads their proudest line in a flat voice; the group says whether it still holds). One speaker per group whose devices were all spotted performs for the class if time allows. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns on the board, no names. Precision: "a tricolon of four items," "anaphora" used for end-repetition.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			Appropriacy: pathos that outran the evidence; three rhetorical questions in a row. Naturalness: "I will explain you why," "Let's discuss about." Effect: the line the room reacted to, and why. Learners fix and discuss.
Homework set-up	4	T-S	Show online lesson 4.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		8 + 5 + 10 + 10 + 5 + 12 + 8 + 23 + 5 + 4

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the appeals. Every persuasive utterance draws on credibility, emotion or reason, usually more than one. The question is never "which appeal?" but "which one dominates, and is the balance right for this audience?"

SAY: "As a former hospital administrator, I know what a stretched budget feels like." Which appeal? (Ethos: experience, shared understanding.) Is it evidence? (No: it's a reason to trust the speaker.) · "Behind every statistic is a family waiting for a fence to be fixed." Which appeal? (Pathos.) Is that dishonest? (Not if the statistic is real; it becomes dishonest if the feeling replaces the evidence.) · A speech that is only numbers: will people act on it? (Rarely: logos alone leaves the will unmoved.)

Meaning: the figures. A figure is a patterned arrangement of words that pleases the ear and stresses the sense. It should clarify the argument, not decorate it.

SAY: "We buy it, we use it once, and we store it for a decade." How many parts? (Three.) Same grammar in each? (Yes: we + verb + object.) What's the effect? (Complete, memorable, a little ironic.) · "I'm not asking you to spend more; I'm asking you to own less." What's opposed? (Spend more / own less.) Name? (Antithesis.) · "Isn't that what a neighborhood is for?" Does she want an answer? (No: the listener supplies "Yes.") · Five figures in one paragraph: more persuasive? (No: nothing stands out when everything is figured.)

Meaning: the strategic concession. Granting the opponent's strongest fair point makes you look reasonable, disarms the objection before it's raised against you, and makes your refutation land.

SAY: "I grant that some tools may come back damaged. But a small repair fund costs far less than forty-two households each buying a drill." Does she agree with the objection? (Partly: the fact is true.) Does she give up her claim? (No.) Which part is narrow? (The concession: some tools.) Which part is decisive? (The refutation: the cost comparison.) · A speaker who never concedes anything: how do we see them? (As partisan: we discount them.)

Meaning: fallacies. A fallacy looks like an argument but proves nothing. The master refuses them and names them in others, calmly.

SAY: "You can't trust his report on the parking lot. He can't even park straight." Is that about the report? (No: it attacks the person.) Name? (Ad hominem.) How do you answer? ("His parking isn't the question; the report is. What's wrong with its figures?") · "Either we cancel the party or we go over budget." Only two options? (No: a cheaper party, a potluck, a later date.) Name? (False dilemma.)

Form.

Tricolon	three parallel elements, often rising in length or weight	Reading sharpens the mind, softens the heart, and widens the world.
Anaphora	the same words open successive clauses	<u>This city deserves</u> schools that... <u>This city deserves</u> transport that...
Epistrophe	the same words end successive clauses	...of the people, by the people, for the people.
Antithesis	contrary ideas in balanced, parallel grammar: <i>not X but Y · X, not Y · It is not that...; rather...</i>	This is not a setback; it is an invitation to begin again.
Chiasmus	mirror order, A-B-B-A	We do not work to live well; we live well to work well.
Rhetorical question · hypophora	a question for effect · a question the speaker answers at once	Can we really afford to wait? · Why does that matter? I'll tell you why.
Concede → refute	<i>I grant that... / There is force in the objection that... / To be fair to the other side,... → But this overlooks... / That may be so, yet it does not follow that...</i>	Admittedly, culture is harder to measure. Yet is it the office that builds it, or the people?

Pronunciation. Figures live in the voice. **Tricolon:** rise, rise, fall, with a small pause before the last item: "It's cheaper ↗ | it's cleaner ↗ | and it's already here ↘." **Antithesis:** contrastive stress on the opposed words, and a pause at the hinge: "not to spend **MORE** | but to own **LESS**." **Anaphora:** keep the repeated opening at the same pitch and let the variable part carry the stress, so the ear hears the pattern. **Rhetorical questions** normally **fall** at the end ("Isn't that what a neighborhood is ↘ for?"); a rising tone sounds like a real question and invites an answer. **Hypophora:** a real pause after the question, then a lower, slower answer.

- 1 **Three beats** (choral, then individual; clap the three beats if the class enjoys it): T: "We cannot wait, we must not wait, and we will not wait." → S repeats with rise-rise-fall. T: "Share the drill, share the ladder, share the know-how." → S. Then learners complete a tricolon from a stem: T: "Good design is..." → S: "...simple, honest, and built to last."
- 2 **Hinge it** (antithesis, individual): T gives a flat pair; S makes it balanced and stresses the opposed words. T: "Prevention is better than reaction." → S: "We should not wait for the fire to fight it; we should build so it never starts." T: "Owning less, sharing more." → S: "I'm not asking you to spend **more**; I'm asking you to own **less**."
- 3 **Fall, don't rise**: T reads a rhetorical question with a rising tone; S corrects it with a fall. "Can we really afford to wait?" · "Isn't that what a neighborhood is for?" · "If we do nothing today, what do we tell our children tomorrow?"
- 4 **Concede → refute** (open pairs, fast): T reads an objection ("Won't the tools get stolen?"); S1 concedes narrowly ("I grant that a few may go missing"), S2 refutes decisively ("but the evidence from other libraries is that borrowers bring things back, because their neighbors are waiting").

◆ PERSUASION LAB – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Topics and sides.** Ten neutral topics on Set C, each with a **for** and **against** side card: a meeting-free afternoon every week, handwriting in adult education, free museum evenings, a tool library, recipes in weights rather than cups, quiet carriages on commuter trains, a four-day school timetable for adult classes, repair cafés, rotating who chairs meetings, and learning a musical instrument as an adult. Learners draw a topic and a side; they argue the card, not their convictions. A learner may swap once, no reason needed.
- ◆ **Two minutes, not four.** The online project asks for 3–4 minutes; in class, two minutes per speaker lets three speakers perform and be critiqued inside 23 minutes, and forces economy: roughly 250–280 words. The full version is homework.
- ◆ **Notes, not a script.** The spine sheet has one line per move. Only three lines are scripted in full: the opening, the pivot (concession → refutation) and the close, because that is where figures belong. Speakers mark their figures in the margin (T for tricolon, A for anaphora, X for antithesis, RQ for rhetorical question).
- ◆ **Device Hunt.** Each listener has a **device-hunt grid** (Set C): three appeals and seven figures, plus "concession" and "counterfeit move." They tick what they hear and **quote a few words** so the speaker knows where. After each speech, one minute: listeners report ("I heard antithesis in the close: *not louder, but clearer*"). The speaker then reveals their marked script: devices that were present but not heard are interesting data, not failures.
- ◆ **The flat-reading test.** Each speaker reads their proudest line in a completely flat voice. If the line still makes a claim that holds, it's rhetoric serving an argument. If it only worked with the performance, question it. This is the online lesson's "If a line survives being read flatly, keep it" made into a routine.

- ◆ **Roles.** In each group of 3: speaker, **timekeeper** (also listens), **fallacy watcher** (also listens; flags any counterfeit move, kindly). Rotate after each speech. Give the fallacy watcher and timekeeper roles to dominant speakers first.
- ◆ If a learner freezes, the timekeeper says "Thirty seconds: your close." A strong close after a shaky middle still earns applause.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE PERSUASION LAB

SAY: *Whose opinion are you arguing? (The card's.) · How long do you speak? (Two minutes.) · How many lines do you write in full? (Three: the opening, the pivot, the close.) · What must your concession do? (Grant a fair point, narrowly.) · What do listeners do while you speak? (Tick and quote devices on the grid.) · What's the flat-reading test? (Read your best line flat: does it still hold?) · Can you say "Pass"? (Yes.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some C2 speakers argue far better aloud than on paper (often learners who have lived and worked in English for years with little formal schooling in it). Give them a **spine strip** with the six moves pre-printed and one frame for each ("I want to argue that... · Consider this: ... · This matters because... · I grant that... · But... · So I come back to...") and accept one figure placed well (an antithesis in the close is enough). They can deliver from the strip without scripting anything. In the Device Hunt, let them tick without quoting. Fewer items: Workbook Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 4 items 1–3. Their ear is often the sharpest in the room for a line that "sounds fake": invite that judgment in the flat-reading test.

STRETCH

Ask strong learners to **stack** figures in one line (antithesis + chiasmus: *We do not share tools to save money; we save money because we share*), to build a close with **epistrophe**, and to use **hypophora** at the pivot. Then the harder skill: **restraint**. Their two-minute speech may contain no more than four figures; they must say afterward which figure they cut and why. For the fallacy work, ask them to write a **persuasive but fallacious** paragraph (one hidden fallacy, dressed in an honest-looking tricolon) and challenge the group to find it. Discuss: the craft is neutral; the ethics are not.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Where the claim goes:** persuasive writing in Chinese, Japanese, Korean and Thai traditions often builds context first and states the position late, or leaves it implicit. English persuasion expects the claim **early** and restated at the end. Present it as a genre difference ("in this room, the claim comes first"), not as a flaw in their thinking.

- ◆ **Repetition and ornament:** Arabic, Persian and Urdu rhetoric values parallelism, repetition and elaborate praise, and learners may produce beautiful anaphora three times in a row. Praise the control, then teach spacing: one anaphora per speech lands harder than three.
- ◆ **Syllable-timed rhythm:** speakers of Spanish, French, Italian, Portuguese, Tagalog, Turkish and Cantonese may give every syllable similar weight, which flattens a tricolon and hides contrastive stress. Drill the stressed words and the pause before the last item.
- ◆ **Rhetorical questions with a rise:** many learners (and some world Englishes) rise at the end of every question, so the audience starts to answer. Teach the fall.
- ◆ **False friends in argument:** Spanish *argumento* and Italian *argomento* (plot or topic) → "the argument of the film"; French *discuter de* and Spanish *discutir sobre* → "discuss about"; *actualmente* / *actuellement* / *aktuell* → "actually" meaning "currently"; *eventualmente* / *éventuellement* / *eventuell* → "eventually" meaning "possibly"; "as a conclusion" (*como conclusión, en conclusion*) → *In conclusion* / *In short*.
- ◆ **"I will explain you why"** (Spanish *te explico por qué*, Italian *ti spiego*, Russian *объясню вам*): *explain* takes *to* + person, or none: *Let me explain why*. A classic fossil at this level.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_10.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and shadow the rhythm (rise, rise, fall; stress the opposed words); do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Expand the Persuasion Lab speech into the online project's 3–4 minute version on the same assigned topic (the online example motions are optional; stay with your card) and record it on a phone if possible. Workbook 4.1: finish Exercises 3–5, "My new words" and the journal (one persuasive line you heard this week in an advertisement, a speech or a meeting: name its appeal and its figure, and say whether it survives the flat-reading test).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 C Antithesis and chiasmus · Q2 B Ad hominem · Q3 (new) B "I grant that some tools may come back damaged; but a small repair fund costs far less than every household buying its own." Listening (Ex 1b, Script 4.1-A): 1 saw (ethos) · 2 use / store (tricolon) · 3 asset / cost (antithesis, with a metaphor) · 4 I'll tell you why (hypophora) · 5 more / less (antithesis) · 6 share the know-how (anaphora + tricolon) · 7 neighborhood (rhetorical question). Counterfeit line: "everyone I've spoken to on this street already agrees with me, so the matter is really settled" (bandwagon, and a hasty generalization from her own conversations).

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain style as **the sum of consistent choices** (word, register, figure, rhythm, stance) and voice as the personality those choices project
- ◆ vary sentence **length and shape** on purpose (simple, compound, complex, **periodic**, **loose**), place a short sentence or a fragment for impact, and use the read-aloud test
- ◆ cut deadwood (redundant pairs, empty intensifiers, throat-clearing, deadweight phrases, hedging overload, clichés) without sliding into terse "telegram prose"
- ◆ free smothered verbs (*make a decision* → *decide*) and prefer the concrete, active and specific by default, breaking the default knowingly
- ◆ write the same event in **three distinct, sustained voices**, and give and receive precise, quoted critique on style and voice

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Three Voices frame, Critique Circle notes, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · Sentence-shape, deadwood and editing-pass flashcards + six picture event cards (Set A) · **Style & Voice Workshop** event cards, voice cards (3 core + 6 genre), Critique Circle cards (Set D) · New identity cards (Set B)
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.2-A (the fire drill in three voices) and 4.2-B (rhythm dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the music. SIMPLE *The room fell silent.* · COMPOUND *She spoke, and...* · COMPLEX *When she spoke,...* · PERIODIC *When she rose, when she drew breath, when at last she spoke, the room fell silent.* (meaning held back) · LOOSE *The room fell silent, all argument spent, every eye on her.* (point first) · Long, long, long... then short. Hard. Fragment: *For emphasis.*

Center: economy. ~~each and every every~~ · ~~very unique unique~~ · ~~It is important to note that~~ (just say it) · ~~due to the fact that because~~ · ~~make a decision decide~~ · ~~give consideration to consider~~ · ~~it seems that perhaps it might possibly~~ (one hedge). Economy ≠ terseness: cut the dead, keep the living.

Right: voice. Voice = consistency: same formality, same appetite for image, same rhythm of thought, same relationship to the reader. Three voices today: THE REPORTER (spare, exact, impersonal) · THE LYRIC ESSAYIST (periodic, image-rich, reflective) · THE DEADPAN WIT (understatement, irony, the twist at the end). Edit in passes: cut → sharpen verbs → vary rhythm → check flow → read aloud → kill your darlings.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: figure it, name it	8	S-S	Review C10. Hold up a figure flashcard and read a flat claim ("Libraries matter for many reasons."); pairs have 60 seconds to recast it with that figure. Three rounds (tricolon, antithesis, anaphora). Then one fallacy line from the fallacy cards: pairs name it and counter it. Ask two or three learners how their homework speech went: "Which device did your listener spot first?"
Lead-in: one event, three voices	8	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.2-A : a fire drill interrupts a budget meeting, told by the Reporter, the Lyric Essayist and the Deadpan Wit. First listening: "Same facts? What changed?" Second listening: learners tick the feature grid for each voice. Pairs compare. "Nothing about the event changed. Everything about the writer did. That's style."
Rhythm and sentence shape	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 9. Present the five shapes with one event ("the room fell silent"), then the long-then-short effect. Read the monotone and the rhythmically varied city passages from the online lesson aloud; ask what changed. Pairs do Workbook Ex 2 (name the shape) in 3 minutes. CCQs.
Economy and strong verbs	8	T-S	Slide 10. The deadwood culprits (flashcards on the board) and the committee sentence cut from 42 words to 14. Learners call out each cut. Then the weak verb + noun pairs (<i>conduct an investigation into</i> → <i>investigate</i>) and the C1 link: this is nominalization run in reverse. Make the counterweight explicit: economy is not terseness. CCQs.
Drill: read it aloud	5	T-S → S	Script 4.2-B and the Drill script: learners mark stresses and pauses, then read the rhythm models aloud, choral then individual. The read-aloud test is the lesson's most practical tool: make it physical.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Voice and pastiche	6	T-S	Slide 11. Voice as a fingerprint : sentence length, word stock (plain or Latinate), figures (few or many), stance (distant or intimate), and the relationship to the reader. Show the three core voice cards. Pastiche: "Imitating a manner is an old and honorable exercise. You keep what fits and let the rest fall away." Introduce the genre voice cards for stretch (a noir detective, a nature-documentary narrator, a sports commentator...).
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 3 (cut to the lean) and Ex 4 (rewrite the monotone passage) alone, then compare in pairs. No single answer: pairs read both versions aloud and keep the one that moves. Ex 5 (voice fingerprints) is homework unless a learner finishes early.
Freer: Style & Voice Workshop	28	S → S-S → T-S	Slides 12–13. Write (14 min) : each pair draws a picture event card (Set D). Each learner writes the event in three voices (the Reporter, the Lyric Essayist, the Deadpan Wit), about 50–70 words each, on the workbook frame. Same facts in all three; nothing invented that changes what happened. Critique Circle (12 min) : two pairs join (groups of 4). Each writer's pieces are read aloud by someone else , in random order and unlabeled; the group identifies each voice and names two features that gave it away. Then the four-step protocol on the Critique Circle card (see below), about 3 minutes per writer. Share (2 min) : one Deadpan Wit and one Lyric Essayist version read to the class. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns, no names. Precision: "very unique," "each and every," a periodic sentence that loses its main clause. Appropriacy: the Reporter who slipped in an adjective of opinion; the Wit who explained the joke. Naturalness: "It was raining strongly" (<i>heavily</i>), "The bus made a delay" (<i>was late</i>). Effect: the short sentence that landed; the darling the writer was brave enough to cut.
Homework set-up	4	T-S	Show online lesson 4.2 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Remind learners to bring an idea to argue for C12 (topic cards available). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		8 + 8 + 10 + 8 + 5 + 6 + 8 + 28 + 5 + 4

Meaning: style and voice. Style is the pattern that many small, consistent choices make; voice is the personality a reader hears in that pattern. Neither is more "correct"; both are judged by fitness and consistency.

SAY: *Two writers report the same fire drill; one uses exact times and no adjectives, the other uses images and long sentences. Is one of them wrong? (No: different choices.) What makes each one a voice? (Consistency: every sentence leans the same way.) If the Reporter suddenly writes "like people released from a sentence," what happens? (The voice breaks: we stop trusting the persona.)*

Meaning: periodic and loose sentences. A periodic sentence withholds the main clause until the end and builds suspense; a loose sentence delivers the point first and elaborates, which feels relaxed.

SAY: *"When she rose, when she drew breath, when at last she spoke, the room fell silent." When do we get the main point? (At the end.) Effect? (Suspense, weight.) • "The room fell silent, all argument spent, every eye turned toward her." Main point where? (First.) Which one feels more conversational? (The loose one.) • Five periodic sentences in a row? (Exhausting: vary.)*

Meaning: economy. Every word earns its place. The goal is not the fewest words but no dead ones.

SAY: *"Every applicant must submit a complete application." What did we cut from "each and every one of the applicants is required to submit a full and complete application"? (Redundant pairs, padding.) Did we lose meaning? (No.) • "Her long experience let her help the newer team members." Could we cut to "Experienced; helped newcomers"? (Shorter, but telegram prose: it lost grace and rhythm.) • "The samples were contaminated." Passive: wrong? (No: the doer is unknown or irrelevant. Break the default knowingly.)*

Meaning: kill your darlings. The line you're proudest of is the one to interrogate hardest.

SAY: *A writer loves the line "the moon, that pale accountant of the night." Does it serve the piece about a delayed bus? (Probably not: it's ornament.) What do you do with it? (Cut it; save it for another piece.) Is that a loss? (A small one, and the piece gets stronger.)*

Form.

Sentence shapes	simple • compound • complex • periodic (main clause last) • loose (main clause first, then elaboration) • fragment (deliberate)	At the end of the lane stood the old house. (fronted, periodic) • The children saw to that. (short) • They told stories. (short)
Deadwood → cure	redundant pairs • empty intensifiers • throat-clearing • deadweight phrases • hedging overload • clichés	first and foremost → first • really important → important • due to the

		fact that → because · at this point in time → now
Weak verb + noun → strong verb	make a decision · reach a conclusion · give consideration to · conduct an investigation into · provide assistance to · put forward a suggestion	decide · conclude · consider · investigate · help · suggest / propose
Specific over general	exact nouns and verbs do the work of adjectives and adverbs	walked slowly and tiredly → trudged · a dog → a whippet
Editing passes	1 cut · 2 sharpen verbs · 3 vary rhythm · 4 check flow (old before new) · 5 read aloud · 6 kill your darlings	one kind of flaw per pass

Pronunciation. The read-aloud test is the pronunciation focus. Read long sentences in **chunks**, with a slight fall at each comma and breath at the dashes; let the voice drop and slow on the short sentence that follows ("Then everything ↘ changed."). A fragment needs a full stop in the voice: a clear pause before and after. English prose rhythm rewards sentences that end on a **strong, stressed, concrete word** ("...and we did not **sleep**"), not a weak preposition or abstraction. Read the Deadpan Wit version flatly: deadpan is a delivery as much as a style, and a smile in the voice gives the joke away.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Long, then short** (choral, then individual): T reads a long accumulating sentence and pauses; learners say the short one in chorus. T: "The negotiations dragged on for months, through draft after weary draft, concession traded for concession until no one could recall who had wanted what." → Ss: "Then everything changed." T: "The rain fell." → Ss: "It fell hard." → T: "It fell all night," → Ss: "and we did not sleep."
- 2 Cut it** (individual, fast): T: "each and every" → S: "every." "first and foremost" → "first." "due to the fact that" → "because." "in the event that" → "if." "make an improvement to" → "improve." "at this point in time" → "now." "very unique" → "unique."
- 3 Free the verb:** T: "The committee will conduct an investigation into the matter and then reach a decision." → S: "The committee will investigate and decide." T: "We need to provide assistance to new members." → S: "We need to help new members."
- 4 Three voices, one line** (open pairs): T gives a fact ("The bus left two minutes early."); S1 says it as the Reporter, S2 as the Lyric Essayist, S3 as the Deadpan Wit. E.g.: "The 7:42 bus departed at 7:40." · "It slid away from us, lit and indifferent, two minutes before its promise." · "The bus, keen as ever, left without us."

◆ STYLE & VOICE WORKSHOP – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **The events** (Set D, picture cards): a suitcase that went to the wrong city; an umbrella that turned inside out at the worst moment; a birthday cake that collapsed at an office party; a bus that came early and left without us; the last loaf at a Saturday market; a smoke alarm during a dinner for friends. Each card lists four fixed facts (time, place, what happened, how it ended). All three versions must keep the facts; voices change the telling, not the event.
- ◆ **The three core voices** (voice cards): **the Reporter** (short declaratives, exact numbers and times, no opinion adjectives, third person or impersonal, past simple), **the Lyric Essayist** (first person, at least one periodic sentence and one image, reflective stance, a quiet closing line), **the Deadpan Wit** (understatement and irony from Module 2, flat delivery, the twist in the last few words, never explains the joke). 50–70 words each. The workbook frame has three boxes with a checklist under each.
- ◆ **Pastiche (stretch)**: six genre voice cards (the noir detective, the nature-documentary narrator, the sports commentator, the formal nineteenth-century letter-writer, the breathless friend on the phone, the minimalist). Early finishers write a fourth version in one of them. Pastiche imitates a *manner*, not anyone's actual sentences.
- ◆ **The Critique Circle** (groups of 4, about 3 minutes per writer; the protocol card is in Set D): **0. Blind reading.** Someone else reads the writer's three pieces aloud, in random order and unlabeled; the group names each voice and two features that gave it away. **1. What stayed with me.** Each critic quotes one phrase that stayed with them and says why (no suggestions yet). **2. The writer's question.** The writer, silent until now, asks one question about their own draft ("Did the Wit version land, or did I explain it?"). **3. Neutral questions.** Critics may ask questions without opinions hidden inside ("Why did you choose *slid*?", not "Don't you think *slid* is too much?"). **4. One darling, one fix, with permission.** "Would you like a suggestion?" If yes: one line that may be a darling (quote it) and one specific fix. The writer says "Thank you," not a defense.
- ◆ **Roles against dominance.** The **last critic** speaks only after the others and may not repeat a point already made. The reader in step 0 is never the writer. Put the most dominant critic in the last-critic role.
- ◆ **What you're listening for** as you circulate: voices that are really registers only (the Essayist that is merely formal), a Wit who uses sarcasm aimed at people rather than situations (redirect: irony at the situation, never at a person or a group), and precise, quoted critique. Note two examples of excellent critique language to praise in feedback.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WORKSHOP

SAY: *How many versions do you write? (Three.) · Can you change what happened? (No: same facts, different telling.) · About how long is each version? (50–70 words.) · Who reads your pieces aloud in the circle? (Someone else.) · Before step 4, can critics make suggestions? (No: first what stayed with them, then questions.) · What do you say when you receive a suggestion? ("Thank you." No defending.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **two-voice** version of the task: the Reporter and the Deadpan Wit only, 30–40 words each, with sentence starters on a strip (Reporter: "At 3:15 on Friday, ... · ... minutes later, ..." · Wit: "It was, I'm told, ... · I am pleased to report that ..."). The picture event card is the prompt; the facts can be said aloud and written with a partner as scribe. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–3, Ex 3 items 1–2. The read-aloud test suits these learners perfectly: often their ear for rhythm is better than their eye.

STRETCH

Ask strong learners to (1) write a fourth version in a genre voice (pastiche) and then a fifth that **diverges** from it: keep one habit of the imitated manner and replace the rest with their own; (2) write one paragraph that shifts voice **on purpose** once, and justify the shift; (3) run the six editing passes on one of their pieces and keep all drafts, noting which pass changed the most. Discuss with them why a voice is "easier for a reader to hear than for a writer to sense."

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Long sentences joined by commas:** Spanish, Portuguese, Italian, Arabic, Greek and Russian prose tolerates long chains of clauses joined by commas. In English this becomes the comma splice ("The bus left early, we missed it, it was raining"). The fix is a stylistic choice: a full stop, a semicolon, or a subordinator, and each one changes the rhythm.
- ◆ **Fragments as "mistakes":** learners trained in exam writing (and some teachers) treat every fragment as an error. Frame the deliberate fragment as a **tool for effect** in narrative, essay and speech, and still out of place in a report or an exam answer that asks for formal prose.
- ◆ **Intensifiers and redundant pairs:** *very unique, more perfect, return back, repeat again, free gift* are common across many L1s (Spanish *volver atrás*, French *répéter encore*). Treat them as deadwood, not grammar.
- ◆ **Hedging overload:** learners from high-context cultures (Japanese, Korean, Thai, Indonesian) may stack hedges for politeness ("it seems that perhaps it might possibly be..."). Keep one hedge, and keep the politeness in the relationship, not the claim.
- ◆ **Nominal style as "good style":** German, Russian and Romance academic traditions reward long noun chains. Remind them of the C1 "Who does what?" test: free the verb.
- ◆ **Deadpan and irony across cultures:** understatement reads as humor to some listeners and as sincerity to others. If a learner doesn't find the Wit funny, that's not a failure of English; ask what signals would make the irony visible in their language.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_11.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and read them aloud for cadence; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. The online project (a 200-word draft edited in two passes, all three drafts kept) can use one of today's events or a new one.

Workbook 4.2: Exercise 5 (voice fingerprints), a clean final version of your favorite voice from the workshop after the critique, "My new words" and the journal (what the critique circle told you about your own voice, and one habit of your writing you'd like to keep). Bring an idea to argue for in C12.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** Having decided, we announced it publicly. · Q2 **C** Break the monotony with variety: fuse a couple into one longer sentence and drop in a short one for impact. · Q3 (new) **B** Every volunteer should arrive early if possible. Listening (Ex 1, Script 4.2-A): A (Reporter) = exact times and numbers, impersonal, short sentences, no figures · B (Lyric Essayist) = periodic opening sentence, metaphor and simile, a fragment ("Then the stairs."), first person, closing twist ("Nothing had been decided. Something, I think, had been.") · C (Deadpan Wit) = understatement and irony, exact times, first person, a comparison that is really a joke ("faster than we have reached any decision this year"), closing twist ("nowhere").

A TASK-BASED REVIEW, NOT A NEW-LANGUAGE CLASS

There is no new language today. The class is built around one combined task in three parts: a **three-minute persuasive or analytical speech** to a small group, **two minutes of unscripted questions**, and a **150–180-word written re-pitch** of the same argument for a *different* reader (an audience card), which must fairly report the strongest challenge raised in the Q&A. The focus is **orchestration** (several layers from Modules 1–4 working together without showing off) and **adaptation** (the same substance, re-pitched for a new room). You listen and read with the **teacher checklist** (Set F). Language work comes *from* the tasks: a short focus-on-form clinic between them. The checklist results feed C13 (Progress Test 1): they are your spoken and written evidence for Modules 1–4 and tell you who goes to which catch-up station.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ structure and deliver a **three-minute speech** with a clear arc (**hook, turn, landing**) and the spine from C10 (claim, grounds, concession, refutation)
- ◆ orchestrate at least **six deliberate layers**: a *mot juste*, a register or tone shift, a fixed expression or strong collocation, a moment of implicature or understatement, a figure (metaphor or rhetorical figure), a stance marker, and an appeal, and keep them invisible in delivery
- ◆ handle **unscripted questions** gracefully: paraphrase the question, answer "the question beneath the question," concede before countering, and adapt register to the questioner
- ◆ **re-pitch** the argument in writing for a different audience and mode (register, density, idiom, rhetoric), reporting the strongest challenge fairly with a precise reporting verb
- ◆ **self-assess** against the eight-dimension mastery rubric with specific evidence: two strengths and one refinement

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.3 (Exercises 1–5, dialogue, the **speech planner**, the **written re-pitch** page, the **mastery rubric** self-assessment, the Module 4 "I can" checklist)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · **Layer It!** review game (Set G) + dice + counters · **Mastery in Action** topic, side and audience cards and challenge starters (Set E) · **Teacher checklist**: descriptors, class grid and score slips (Set F) · a phone timer per group
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.3-A (the model speech and Q&A: a decision log for every team) and 4.3-B ("Two rooms," for the clinic or a C13 station) · optional: phones for recording

Left: the arc. HOOK a question, an image, an understatement → CLAIM *My proposal is modest:* → GROUNDS + WARRANT → TURN *Admittedly,...* *That said,...* → LANDING the restated claim, a figure, a quiet last line. Q&A: *If I read your question rightly,...* · *That's a fair challenge. What I'd say is...* · *Let me answer the question beneath the question.*

Center: six layers, one voice. M1 the mot juste · a register shift · a fixed expression (*by and large, part and parcel*) · M2 implicature / understatement (*was, shall we say, memorable*) · a metaphor (*Memory is a generous storyteller and a poor accountant.*) · M3 a stance marker (*Frankly, To my mind, Admittedly*) · cohesion (*This is where..., For all that...*) · M4 an appeal + a figure. Restraint: keep one layer in reserve.

Right: the re-pitch. Same substance, new room. EXPERT / WRITTEN: Latinate, hedged, dense, logos-forward, one controlled image. LAY / SPOKEN: plain, warm, short sentences, a story, "you." Report the challenge fairly: *One colleague questioned whether...* · *It was objected that...* Then respond.

Misreading the room is the C2 error.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Layer It!	10	S-S (groups of 3-4)	Review C1–C11 with the Layer It! board game (Set G). Roll, move, do the square aloud; the group judges with the cheat sheet. Squares cover all four modules (MOT JUSTE, REGISTER, FIXED, IMPLY, IRONY, IMAGE, STANCE, THREAD, DISTIL, FIGURE, FALLACY, CUT, VOICE, CONCEDE, RE-PITCH). Stop after 10 minutes; nearest the finish wins. Walk around and note which squares (which modules) cause trouble: early evidence for C13.
Orchestration and adaptation	10	T-S → S-S	Slides 14–15. (a) Orchestration (5 min): the annotated extract ("freedom, like fire, warms only those who tend it"): pairs find five layers in one sentence before you reveal them. Point: the layers were there to be felt, not spotted. (b) Adaptation (5 min): one idea, two rooms (register, density, idiom, rhetoric, stance). Workbook Ex 4 item 1 in pairs. CCQs.
Model: listen	7	T-S	Read Script 4.3-A (a hospital pharmacist proposes a one-line decision log for every team, then takes two questions; ask two confident learners to read the questioners).

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			First listening: "What's the proposal? What's the strongest objection, and how does he answer it?" Second listening: Workbook Ex 1: note the hook, the turn and the landing, and tick the layers you hear. Slide 16 shows the Q&A moves.
Plan the speech	10	S	Slide 17. Learners fill the speech planner (Workbook 4.3): notes, not a script, except the hook and the last line. Topic from Set E or their own idea within the module's topic territory; side assigned or chosen. The planner has a layer strip: each learner plans at least six layers across Modules 1–4, and marks one they will keep in reserve. Then two likely questions and a first answer to each. Walk around: check every plan has a turn (a genuine concession).
Speech circles + Q&A + checklist	22	S–S (groups of 4) • T–S	Groups of 4. Each speaker speaks for up to 3 minutes (planner turned over; a glance is fine), then takes 2 minutes of questions: each listener asks one, using a challenge starter (Set E), and the challenger must paraphrase what they heard before asking. A timekeeper in each group. Listeners write on the back of their challenge card: <i>the speaker's claim in one sentence</i> and <i>the strongest challenge I heard</i>, and hand it to the speaker (it feeds the written re-pitch). You sit with one group at a time and score speaking S1–S5 and module ticks.
Focus-on-form clinic	5	T–S	Board four sentences you heard (no names): two to fix, two to upgrade. E.g., "We must discuss about this" → <i>discuss this</i> • "I will explain you why" → <i>Let me explain why</i> • "It's a no-brainer" → fine in the speech, re-pitch it for the board: <i>The case would appear compelling</i> • "It is very, very important" → one precise word: <i>crucial</i> /

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			<i>pivotal</i> . Learners fix in pairs. Keep it short and positive.
Written re-pitch + peer check	14	S → S-S	Each learner draws an audience card (Set E) that is different from the room they spoke to: a specialist panel, a hospital or museum board, a newspaper's general readers, a volunteers' newsletter, a skeptical manager, a class of teenagers. They write 150–180 words on the workbook page: the same argument, re-pitched for that reader, including the strongest challenge from the Q&A, reported fairly (<i>One colleague questioned whether...</i>) and answered. 10 minutes writing; 4 minutes of peer check with the re-pitch check on the page (Could this reader act on it? Is the register consistent for them? Is the challenge reported fairly? One line that fits this reader perfectly; one that belongs to the old room). Collect the pieces: you score W1–W4 after class.
Self-assessment + wrap	7	S → T-S	Learners score themselves on the mastery rubric (Workbook 4.3, eight dimensions, 1–5) and write two strengths and one refinement, each with a specific example ("reached for <i>placate</i> where <i>appease</i> would have carried the overtone I wanted"). Then content first: "Which argument moved you most? Did anyone change your mind, even a little?" Two sentences from your notes, no names: one range example, one effect example. Celebrate: halfway through C2.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 4.3; record the full 5–6 minute version of the speech with three unprepared questions from a friend or family member (or recorded questions you draw from the challenge starters), then self-critique against the rubric. Tell learners plainly about C13: "Next class is Progress

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			Test 1 on Modules 1–4, plus catch-up time. Today's checklist helps me plan that time for you." Hand out score slips in C13, not today.
Total	90		10 + 10 + 7 + 10 + 22 + 5 + 14 + 7 + 5

HEARING EVERYONE

In 22 minutes of circles you can score about eight speakers well (two groups). Choose one of these for the rest, and tell the class which one before the circles: **(a)** learners record their speech and Q&A on a phone during the circles and play it for you during the C13 catch-up time; **(b)** the rest present to you at a station in C13; **(c)** in a large class, split the class: half speak in C12 while the other half act as challengers, and the second half speak in C13. The written re-pitches give you evidence for everyone. Anyone who prefers to speak only to you, not a group, may do so. That is a normal choice, not a problem.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION (REVIEW FOCUS)

Meaning: orchestration.

SAY: "Freedom, like fire, warms only those who tend it." How many layers? (A simile, a mot juste in tend, an argument carried by an image, a balanced rhythm.) Did you notice them the first time? (Probably not: you felt them.) · A sentence with a metaphor, an idiom, a tricolon and a register drop all at once: stronger? (No: the layers fight. Restraint is mastery too.)

Meaning: adaptation.

SAY: "There is reason to suspect a degree of cognitive atrophy." Which room? (Expert, formal, written.) Same idea for a community meeting? ("Lean on it too hard and your own thinking goes soft.") What changed besides the words? (Density, rhetoric, the relationship to the listener.) · A perfect extended metaphor for a panel that wants data: error? (Not a grammar error: a misreading of the room, which at C2 is the real failure.)

Meaning: the question beneath the question.

SAY: "Isn't this just more bureaucracy?" What's the real worry? (That the log becomes the work, or that it will be used to blame people.) How does the speaker show he heard it? ("If I read your question rightly, the worry is...") Does he concede anything? (Yes: "That's a fair challenge.") Then? (He counters: one line, ninety seconds.)

Meaning: speech vs written re-pitch.

SAY: In the speech you said, "Honestly? It's a no-brainer." Your audience card says "hospital board." Keep it? (No: re-pitch it: "The case would appear compelling.") · Your card says "teenagers." Now? (Perhaps keep the energy, lose the cliché: "Honestly, this one's easy.") · How do you report the challenge? (Fairly, with a reporting verb: "One colleague questioned whether...") · Can you leave the challenge out if it was strong? (No: answering it is what makes the piece credible.)

Form: the review table.

Module 1 · The mot juste	connotation, force, specificity, semantic prosody (1.1) · register agility and tone (1.2) · binomials, strong collocation, fixed expressions (1.3)	not "very tired" but <i>spent</i> · <i>I regret to inform you...</i> ↔ <i>Look, I'll level with you...</i> · <i>by and large, part and parcel</i>
Module 2 · Between the lines	implicature and presupposition (2.1) · irony, understatement, deadpan (2.2) · metaphor, sustained image, no mixed metaphors (2.3)	<i>She's... punctual.</i> · <i>Well, that could have gone better.</i> · <i>Her argument was a fortress.</i>
Module 3 · Discourse	stance adverbials and discourse markers (3.1) · cohesion across long texts, theme/rheme, signposting (3.2) · summary, paraphrase, synthesis, reporting verbs (3.3)	<i>Admittedly,... that said,...</i> · <i>Such objections, however, miss the point.</i> · <i>While X stresses..., Y counters that...</i>
Module 4 · Style & rhetoric	appeals, figures, concession and refutation, fallacies (4.1) · rhythm, economy, strong verbs, voice (4.2)	<i>not to spend more, but to own less</i> · <i>long, long... then short</i>
Q&A moves	If I read your question rightly,... · That's a fair challenge; what I'd say is... · Let me answer the question beneath the question. · I take your point, and I'd go further... · Granted, and yet... · Let me leave you with this.	If I read your question rightly, the worry is blame.
Reporting the challenge	questioned whether · objected that · raised the concern that · countered that · conceded that	One participant questioned whether the log would be kept up.

Pronunciation. Everything from C10 and C11 now at speaking pace: pause after the hook; slow down for the claim; contrastive stress in antithesis; a falling tone on rhetorical questions; a lower, slower voice for the landing. Understatement is delivered flat and slightly slower ("It was, shall we say, **memorable**"). In the Q&A, the paraphrase takes a **level, unhurried** tone (you're checking, not accusing); the concession takes a warm fall ("That's a fair **challenge** ˩"), then a fresh, higher start on the counter ("**What** I'd say is...").

- 1 **Layer it** (individual): T gives a flat line and names a layer; S adds it. T: "The meeting was bad. Understatement." → S: "The meeting was not, shall we say, our finest hour." T: "Memory isn't reliable. Metaphor." → S: "Memory is a generous storyteller and a poor accountant." T: "I think we should try it. Stance marker." → S: "To my mind, it's worth a trial." T: "It happens every month. Fixed expression." → S: "It's part and parcel of every month-end."
- 2 **Two rooms** (open pairs): T gives an idea; S1 says it for experts, S2 for a community meeting. T: "Screens may affect children's sleep." → S1: "There is growing evidence that evening screen use may delay sleep onset in children." → S2: "Put the tablet away an hour before bed and they'll sleep better, by and large."
- 3 **Paraphrase, then answer**: T asks a challenge ("Won't people just ignore the log?"); S paraphrases before answering: "If I read your question rightly, the concern is that it won't be kept up. That's fair. What I'd say is..."
- 4 **Report it fairly**: T gives a challenge in direct speech ("This will just create more paperwork!"); S reports it for a written piece: "One colleague objected that the log would add to the paperwork." / "It was questioned whether the benefits would outweigh the administrative burden."

◆ MASTERY IN ACTION – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Three minutes, not six.** The online capstone asks for 5–6 minutes; in class, three minutes plus two minutes of questions per speaker keeps four speakers inside 22 minutes and still shows arc, layers and adaptation. The full version is homework (a phone recording).
- ◆ **Topics** (Set E): every team should keep a decision log; handwriting still deserves a place in adult education; cities should protect "third places" (libraries, cafés, parks) as essential infrastructure; translation apps will never replace learning a language; museums should let visitors handle more of the collection (replicas); every professional should explain their work to a twelve-year-old once a year; silence (quiet carriages, quiet floors) is a public good worth protecting; online reviews do small businesses more harm than good; science should be taught through its failures as well as its successes; mentoring should count as real work in performance reviews. A learner's own topic is welcome if it stays in this territory. **Side**: for, against, or "yes, but" (a nuanced position), on the card or chosen.
- ◆ **The six layers.** The planner's layer strip lists: a *mot juste* moment, a register or tone shift, a fixed expression or strong collocation, implicature or understatement, a figure (metaphor or rhetorical figure), a stance marker, an appeal. Six of the seven, planned; one in reserve. Learners mark them in the plan and aim to make them invisible in delivery.
- ◆ **Q&A.** Each listener asks one question or challenge with a starter (Set E: "Isn't there a risk that...?" · "How would that work for...?" · "You said..., but surely...?" · "What would you say to someone who...?" · "Where does the evidence for... come from?"). The challenger **paraphrases before asking** ("So your claim is that... Isn't there a risk that...?"). The speaker concedes before countering at least once. The timekeeper stops the Q&A after two minutes, kindly. "That's beyond the scope of this proposal, but..." is allowed once.

- ◆ **Challenge notes feed the re-pitch.** After each speech, listeners write the speaker's claim in one sentence and the strongest challenge they heard on the back of their card and hand it over. The speaker now has an outsider's version of the argument and the objection to report.
- ◆ **The written re-pitch** is an *adaptation*, not a summary: the same argument for a different reader (the audience card), 150–180 words, with register, density, idiom and rhetoric chosen for that reader. It must report the strongest challenge fairly and answer it. For formal readers: no contractions, no idioms, hedged claims. For lay or young readers: plain, warm, concrete, still accurate.
- ◆ If a Q&A gets heated, the timekeeper (or you) says: "Great challenge. One sentence to answer, then we move on." Challenge the idea, never the person.

◆ THE TEACHER CHECKLIST – HOW TO SCORE IT (FEEDS C13)

Speaking: five criteria, 0–3 points each, /15. **Writing:** four criteria, 0–3 points each, /12. 0 = no response · 1 = not yet C2 (a strong C1 performance) · 2 = C2 · 3 = strong C2 (an educated, articulate speaker at their best). Score the **whole spoken performance** across the speech and the Q&A, and the written re-pitch separately. Tick the **module boxes** (M1–M4) when you hear or read a move from that module used **well** (precise, appropriate, natural). The full descriptors, the class grid and the score slips are in the classroom materials (Set F).

Criterion	What 3 points looks like
S1 · Architecture	A hook, a claim early, grounds with a warrant, a genuine concession and refutation, a landing that restates the claim with force; within time.
S2 · Range & precision (Modules 1–4)	Six or more layers from at least three modules, used naturally; the mot juste; strong collocations; figures placed at the hinges, none showing off.
S3 · Accuracy & naturalness	Grammar and word choice so secure they never draw attention; no fossilized errors, or they are self-repaired.
S4 · Adaptation & interaction	Register fits the room and shifts on purpose; in the Q&A, paraphrases, answers the question beneath the question, concedes before countering, stays gracious.
S5 · Delivery & effect	Rhythm and stress serve the meaning (pauses, contrastive stress, falling rhetorical questions); the audience is moved or convinced, not merely informed.
W1 · Content & re-pitch	The argument fully re-pitched for the new reader; the strongest challenge reported fairly and answered; 150–180 words.
W2 · Architecture & cohesion	A clear arc; reference, signposting and theme/rheme make it one text; the joins don't show.

W3 · Register, style & economy	Register, density, idiom and rhetoric consistent for this reader; no deadwood; strong verbs; a recognizable voice.
W4 · Accuracy & usage	Complex sentences controlled; punctuation serves rhythm and structure; errors are rare and never affect meaning.

Feeding C13. Record each learner's scores and module ticks on the class grid. In C13, after Progress Test 1, send learners to a **catch-up station** for any module with no tick and for their lowest criterion: **no M1 tick** → precision station (connotation clines, register rewrites, binomials and collocations from your Module 1 materials); **no M2 tick** → pragmatics station (implicature, irony and metaphor tasks from your Module 2 materials); **no M3 tick** → discourse station (stance markers, a cohesion repair, a précis from your Module 3 materials); **no M4 tick** → rhetoric and style station (Workbook 4.1 Ex 3–5 and 4.2 Ex 3–4, the device-hunt grid); **S4 or W1 ≤ 1** → re-pitch station (Workbook 4.3 Ex 4 + Script 4.3-B, "Two rooms"); **S5 ≤ 1** → shadowing station (the 🗣️ model sentences in online lessons 4.1–4.3); **S3 or W4 ≤ 1** → editing station (the learner's own re-pitch, rewritten with your codes, plus their fossil from your fossil list). If Progress Test 1 has its own speaking and writing tasks, keep this grid anyway: it is your evidence of extended performance for Modules 1–4, and it lets you give each learner one kind, specific next step.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SPEECHES AND THE RE-PITCH

SAY: *Speeches: How long do you speak? (Up to three minutes.) · Can you read your notes? (Only a glance.) · How many layers do you plan? (Six, one in reserve.) · What must a challenger do before asking? (Paraphrase the claim.) · What do listeners write on the card? (The claim in one sentence and the strongest challenge.) · Do you have to speak to the group? (No: you can speak only to the teacher.)*

SAY: *Re-pitch: Who is your reader? (The one on my audience card.) · Same reader as the speech? (No: a different room.) · How many words? (150–180.) · Is it a summary of the speech? (No: the same argument, adapted for the new reader.) · What must you include? (The strongest challenge, reported fairly, and my answer.) · What do you do in the last four minutes? (Peer check with the re-pitch check.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **speech strip** ("Have you ever...? · My proposal is simple: ... · Consider this: ... · Admittedly, ... That said, ... · So let me leave you with this: ...") and a **reply strip** ("If I understand you, your worry is... · That's fair. What I'd say is..."). A two-minute speech with a hook, a concession and a landing, and three layers placed well, is a complete task. For the re-pitch, give a **frame** for the audience card ("I'm writing to propose... · The main reason is... · Some colleagues have asked whether... · My answer is... · I'd suggest we...") and accept 100–120 words. Score on the same checklist: a clear, well-judged short performance can earn full marks on S1, S4 and S5.

STRETCH

Ask strong learners to place a layer from **each** module at a hinge (hook, turn, landing) and to keep **two** layers in reserve, then explain afterward which ones they withheld and why. In the Q&A, they answer at least one question in a deliberately different register from the speech, matched to the questioner. In the re-pitch, choose the audience card **furthest** from the original room (a speech for a board → a piece for teenagers), use one sustained metaphor that survives the change of reader, and add one concessive structure (*For all that...*, ...). Homework: the 5–6 minute version with no notes.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Over-formal by default:** speakers of Romance languages, Greek and Russian may deliver the whole speech in the formal register and read the room as "always formal." Praise the control, then ask for one deliberate drop into warmth. At C2, a register shift on purpose scores; an unbroken formal wall does not.
- ◆ **Idioms in the written re-pitch:** learners who have worked hard on fixed expressions may carry them into a formal piece. "Spoken: yes. Board report: re-pitch it."
- ◆ **"According to me..."** (French *selon moi*, Spanish *según yo*, some Indian English): *according to* is for other sources. Offer *To my mind...*, *In my view...*, *I'd argue that...*
- ◆ **Irony that doesn't travel:** understatement can be heard as sincerity by listeners from more literal traditions. In mixed groups, the speaker needs a tiny signal (a pause, a flat tone, "shall we say"). Discuss it as a C2 skill: making irony legible to a mixed audience.
- ◆ **Directness in the Q&A differs.** Some learners counter without conceding ("No, this is not correct."); others concede so fully that their position disappears. Teach the middle path, **concede, then counter**, as a technique, not a personality change.
- ◆ **Fossils under pressure:** in extended speech, the old errors return (*discuss about*, *since three years*, *informations*, *I will explain you*). Note them for the fossil list, not for the public clinic, unless they're common to the whole class.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_12.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and deliver them as a master would; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. The capstone project: record the full 5–6 minute version of today's speech, handle three questions you didn't prepare (a friend's, or three drawn from the challenge starters), and self-critique against the mastery rubric, with two strengths and one refinement, each with an example. (The online project suggests "a topic you actually care about": stay in the module's topic territory, or keep today's.) Workbook 4.3: Exercises 2, 3 and 5, a clean copy of your re-pitch if you want more feedback, and the journal (the online letter to the person you were at the start of your English journey, or a letter to a learner who is just starting out). Review the Module 1–4 "I can..." lists before C13.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** Keep the substance, but re-pitch register, density, idiom and rhetoric for each room. · Q2 **A** Irony and understatement (with a stance hedge). · Q3 (new) **B** "The benefits would appear to outweigh the modest costs involved." Model speech (Ex 1, Script 4.3-A): hook = "Raise your hand if you have ever left a meeting certain that something had been decided..." · turn = "Admittedly, nobody went into healthcare to fill in forms. That said..." · landing = "A decision log won't make us wiser, but it will make us honest: about what we chose, why we chose it, and when we'll look again." Layers heard: *mot juste* (*not a transcript but a ledger*), register shift ("In plain English: we stop arguing about what we argued about."), fixed expression (*by and large, part and parcel*), understatement (*was, shall we say, memorable*), metaphor + antithesis (*Memory is a generous storyteller and a poor accountant.*), stance markers (*Frankly, Admittedly, To my mind*), ethos (*eleven years in hospital pharmacies*), logos (the ward trial, hedged: *roughly half*), tricolon (the landing). Q&A moves: paraphrase ("If I read your question rightly..."), concede ("That's a fair challenge"), counter (one line, ninety seconds), the question beneath the question (blame).

END OF C12: MODULE 4 WRAP-UP AND THE HALFWAY POINT

Recap on slide 18, "persuade, sound like yourself, orchestrate": **ethos, pathos, logos; not to spend more, but to own less; I grant that... but this overlooks...** (persuade) → **long, long... then short; cut the dead, keep the living; kill your darlings** (sound like yourself) → **six layers, one voice; the same substance for a new room; the question beneath the question** (orchestrate). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you; it becomes a C13 catch-up station.

Watch for in Module 5: the rhetoric and style work returns in new forms. Lesson 5.2 (reading literature) needs the C11 vocabulary of style (periodic sentences, voice, the fragment) to talk about why a passage works; Lesson 6.1 (op-eds, reviews, articles) is persuasion in print, where the appeals, the concession and the fallacy check from C10 apply directly; and Lesson 8.2 (public speaking) builds the C10 delivery drill into full performance. Keep the device-hunt grid and the Critique Circle card: both work again in C17 and C24.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: naming the dominant appeal, identifying tricolon, anaphora, antithesis, chiasmus and the rhetorical question, rewriting a flat claim with a named figure, naming a fallacy and countering it, completing a concession and refutation, identifying periodic and loose sentences, cutting deadwood and freeing smothered verbs, rewriting a monotone passage for rhythm, and judging the adaptation of one message to two audiences.

Module 5 — Interpreting the Real World

Three workshop classes that take learners out of the textbook and into English as it is actually spoken, written and broadcast. First, **varieties of English**: the audible features that distinguish accents (rhoticity, the *bath* vowel, t-flapping, the glottal stop, rhythm), British/American vocabulary, spelling and grammar tells, and World Englishes (Indian, Nigerian, Singaporean, Philippine and more), with an honest, respectful conversation about accent attitudes. Second, **literature and complex texts**: a close-reading seminar on short public-domain passages (Austen, Dickens, Thoreau, Dickinson, Frost, Jerome) that moves from technique to effect to theme. Third, **authentic media**: slang and its currency, headlines, memes described in words, cultural allusions, fast connected speech and sarcasm. The module starts right after Progress Test 1, so C14 opens by handing the tests back in a warm, low-stress way.

3 lessons

Lessons 5.1–5.3

Classes C14–C16

Weeks 7–8

90 min per class

CEFR C2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** (in C14, the test return) → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** (workbook) → a demanding **workshop** → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-5-real-world.html](#). Print [materials/module-5/classroom-materials.html](#) before C14. It holds the flashcards (British/American picture pairs, feature cards, literary-technique cards, slang-currency cards), the new identity cards, the **Varieties Lab** transcripts, info-gap email and attitude-discussion cards, the **Close-Reading Seminar** text cards and role cards, the **Media Decoding Lab** station cards, the **Decode It!** board game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons and an audio control for voice and speed, so learners can hear the dialogues and model sentences again at home.
- These are workshops, not lectures.** Each class protects one extended performance: the **Varieties Lab** (C14: feature detection on transcripts, a British/American info gap and a structured discussion of accent attitudes), the **Close-Reading Seminar** (C15: annotation, a role-based seminar and a written interpretation) and the **Media Decoding Lab** (C16: four stations on headlines, memes, allusions and slang). If you are running late, cut controlled practice (set it for homework), never the workshop.

- ◆ **Refinement, not a first meeting.** C2 learners met irony and humor in C2 2.2, figurative language in 2.3, register agility in 1.2 and rhetoric in 4.1. Don't re-teach any of it. This module **applies** those tools to material nobody simplified for them: an unfamiliar variety, a nineteenth-century sentence, a headline pun, a sarcastic line at speed. The C2 step is **interpretive confidence**: saying what something means, why, and on what evidence, while tolerating what remains uncertain.
- ◆ **Feedback on four things.** In every workshop, take notes in four columns: **precision** (the exact word or term: *rhotic*, not "strong r"; *theme*, not "topic"; *ironic*, not "funny"), **appropriacy** (fit for the room: current slang in a report, "broken English" in a respectful discussion, a literary term dropped without an effect), **naturalness** (grammatical but not what an expert would say: "the poem wants to say," "the author makes the imagery of cold," "this slang is very actual") and **effect** (did the interpretation persuade? did the gloss help a newcomer?). Board two or three items per column, without names. At C2 the effect column is where learners grow most.
- ◆ **Near-native and fossilized at once.** Many C2 learners are superb readers who have never heard Nigerian English, or fluent speakers who still say "the author wants to say" or "on the TV." Their fossilized errors are often invisible to them because nobody corrects fluent people. Correct them **privately and specifically** (a sticky note with the exact phrase and a better one), and praise precisely too: "*juxtaposes* was exactly right there" is useful; "great English!" is not.
- ◆ **Peer review, every class.** Each workshop ends with a structured test: the "**Evidence or assumption?**" test (C14: every claim about a variety must point to a word, a structure or a described sound, never to a stereotype or "it just sounds like..."), the "**Show me the words**" test (C15: every interpretive claim must quote the text) and the "**Gloss it for a newcomer**" test (C16: could someone who doesn't share the culture understand the gloss, and is it accurate and respectful?). Reviewers always give **one strength** and **one suggestion**, in that order, and quote rather than summarize.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** Seminars attract confident talkers, and literature classes attract learners who have read everything. Use the built-in roles: in C14 the **fair-language monitor** (listens for the loaded words: "heavy accent," "broken English," "proper English"); in C15 the **evidence keeper** (may only ask "Where does it say that?") or the **discussion leader who speaks last**; in C16 the **newcomer** (plays someone who doesn't share the reference and must honestly say whether a gloss worked). Say it kindly: "You read closely. I need that skill on the evidence card this round." In whole-class feedback, use "a new voice first."
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spelling (*recognise, colour, humour, labelled, practise*) and, in 5.3, British informal words (*quid, flat, gutted, knackered*). Teach American forms, accept British forms, and in C14 make the point explicitly: consistency within one document matters more than which variety you choose. The quoted literary texts keep their original spelling (*neighbourhood, traveled*): don't "correct" a public-domain quotation.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Hear it → read it → decode it. In C14 learners train their ears on variety: they decompose an unfamiliar English into features, recognize that every variety is complete and valid, and practice talking about accents without locating the fault in the speaker. In C15 they slow down and read a demanding text for what it does, not only what it says, and defend a reading with the words on the page. In C16 they speed back up: slang, headlines, memes, allusions and sarcasm at native speed, with strategies for the part that sails past. The skill underneath all three is the same: **notice the signal, name the feature, infer the meaning, and stay comfortable with what you can't yet catch.**

ACCENT, IDENTITY AND RESPECT: THE RULES FOR THIS MODULE

Accent is personal. Some of your learners have been corrected, mocked, passed over at work or asked "Where are you *really* from?" because of how they sound; some speak an outer-circle variety (Indian, Nigerian, Philippine, Singaporean English) as a **first or home language** and have been told it isn't "real" English. So: (1) **Learners are never asked to perform, demonstrate, imitate or be assessed on their own accent**, or anyone else's, and no one is asked to "say it in your accent" or to be the class example of a variety. (2) **You don't perform accents either.** Read every transcript in your own natural voice; the features are in the words and grammar, and the sound features are described in brackets, not acted. Mock accents slide into caricature fast. For real sound, use authentic recordings of speakers talking about their own lives (for example, the International Dialects of English Archive, dialectsarchive.com), chosen and previewed by you. (3) **Discuss attitudes, not people in the room.** The attitude cards are general statements; personal stories are welcome but always optional, and anyone can say "Pass." (4) **Pronunciation drills in this module are about intonation, stress and connected speech in the learner's own voice** (reading a model sentence, a sarcastic line, a fast-speech reduction), never about acquiring a different accent.

CONTENT CHOICES: LITERATURE, MEDIA AND SLANG

The C15 seminar uses six short, public-domain passages (all published before 1929 and in the US public domain) chosen to be **rich but gentle**: comedy, irony, fog, hope, a walk in the woods. Avoid swapping in texts about violence, war, bereavement or abuse without warning; the online lesson's own passage is about grief, so offer it as optional homework, not as the seminar text. In C16 every slang item, headline and meme is invented or generic and **no slang is offensive**; don't take requests to "explain the rude ones" in class (offer a quiet word or a good dictionary instead). Where a slang term comes from a specific community, most often African American English or LGBTQ+ ballroom culture, name the origin respectfully; understanding a community's words is fine, mocking or performing them is not. No headline or meme topic touches party politics, religion or immigration policy.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ **Mark Progress Test 1** before C14. Write a short, positive comment on every paper: one strength + one thing to refine, phrased as an upgrade, not a deficit ("Your stance markers are precise; next, vary your cohesive devices

across paragraphs"). Collect **4–5 common errors** from different papers for the C14 board (no names). Note which learners scored below about 60% so you can offer a quiet 1:1 chat at the break.

- Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): British/American picture pairs and the feature cards (C14); literary-technique cards (C15); slang-currency, allusion and fast-speech cards (C16). Cut them before C14.
- For C14: one set of **Varieties Lab transcripts** (8 cards, 2 per group of 3–4), one **Feature Detective** grid per group, the **info-gap email** (A/B) for each pair and one set of **attitude cards** per group.
- For C15: one **text card** per group of 3 (six texts in three pairs), a set of **seminar role cards** per merged group of 6, and highlighters or two colors of pen.
- For C16: four **Media Decoding stations** (headlines, memes in words, allusion hunt, slang currency) set up on four tables, plus a phone timer. The **Decode It!** board game (1 board per group, 1 die, counters) is for early finishers in C16 and the C17 warmer.
- Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking. This module's personal prompts ("which English shaped yours?", "a show you watch") can touch identity and history; a card is always an equal option.
- Optional but powerful: preview and queue two or three **short authentic recordings** of speakers from different varieties talking about ordinary topics (an archive clip, a university lecture, a cooking segment), each under a minute. Use them in C14 after the transcripts, for listening, never for imitation.
- **Check the slang.** The "current" slang column in C16 was current when this kit was written. Before C16, spend five minutes checking which terms have already dated; that drift is itself the lesson, and learners love hearing "this one is already a bit cringe."

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
5.1	C14 • wk 7	Progress Test 1 return • varieties of English: inner, outer and expanding circles; sound features (rhotic / non-rhotic, the <i>bath</i> vowel, t-flapping, glottal stop, stress- vs syllable-timed rhythm); British/American vocabulary and false friends; spelling patterns and consistency; grammar tells (<i>gotten</i> , <i>have got</i> , collective nouns, present perfect vs simple past); World Englishes vocabulary (<i>prepone</i> , <i>go-slow</i> , <i>comfort room</i> , <i>arvo</i>); the intelligibility principle , accommodation, and accent bias	identify and gloss the lexical, grammatical and described phonological features of eight varieties from transcripts, justify every placement with evidence rather than stereotype, resolve British/American false friends in an info gap, and discuss accent attitudes with precise, respectful language
5.2	C15 • wk 8	Reading literature and complex texts: subject vs theme vs purpose vs tone; narrative voice	annotate a short public-domain passage, state its theme as an

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		and point of view; the unreliable narrator; strip → spine → restore → paraphrase for difficult syntax (periodic sentences, inversion, verbless sentences, archaism); allusion, imagery, symbolism, irony, juxtaposition, foreshadowing, motif; the technique → effect → theme chain; the language of literary discussion	arguable claim, trace at least one technique → effect → theme chain, defend and revise a reading in a role-based seminar, and write a short interpretation in which every claim quotes the text
5.3	C16 · wk 8	Authentic media: slang register and currency (dated / established / current); cultural references and allusion (myth, history, film, idiomatic shorthand); headlinese (dropped articles, present for past, <i>to</i> + infinitive for future, short punchy verbs, puns); memes described in words; fast connected speech (elision, assimilation, linking, weak forms, <i>gonna</i> / <i>whatcha</i> / <i>didja</i>); sarcasm and tone over text; coping strategies	decode invented headlines, text-described memes and allusions and gloss them accurately for a newcomer, sort slang by register and currency and choose the right register for a context, transcribe fast-speech reductions, and read sarcasm from tone and situation

5.1 · C14

Varieties of English — Accents, Dialects & Global Englishes

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ reflect on their Progress Test 1 results and set one personal goal
- ◆ describe the three circles of English and explain why outer-circle varieties (Indian, Nigerian, Singaporean, Philippine English) are established standards, not learner errors
- ◆ name and recognize the main sound features that distinguish varieties (**rhotic / non-rhotic**, the broad or flat **bath vowel**, **t-flapping**, the **glottal stop**, **stress-timed / syllable-timed** rhythm) and use them to decompose an unfamiliar voice
- ◆ recognize British/American vocabulary pairs and **false friends** (*first floor, pants, table a motion, quite good, momentarily, homely*), spelling patterns (*-our/-or, -re/-er, -ise/-ize, -ce/-se, -ll/-l-*) and grammar tells (*gotten, have got*, collective-noun agreement, present perfect vs simple past), and keep one variety consistently in a document
- ◆ talk about accents and accent attitudes precisely and respectfully, reframing loaded language ("*heavy accent*," "*broken English*") and applying the intelligibility principle and accommodation

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Marked Progress Test 1 papers (in folders or face-down) · sticky notes · Workbook "My goal after Progress Test 1" box
- ◆ Workbook 5.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Varieties Lab frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 3–9 · British/American picture flashcards and feature cards · **Varieties Lab** transcripts (8) + Feature Detective grids · **info-gap email A/B** · **attitude cards** · New identity cards · (optional) 2–3 previewed authentic recordings
- ◆ Listening scripts 5.1-A (the delayed train) and 5.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the sound map. r: rhotic (car, hard: US, Canada, Scotland, Ireland) vs non-rhotic ("cah": southern England, Australia) · bath: broad "ah" (S. England, Australia) vs flat *a* (US, N. England) · t: flap ("wader": US) vs glottal stop ("wa'er": London) vs crisp · rhythm: stress-timed (bouncy) vs syllable-timed (even: India, Nigeria, Singapore). Listen for 2–3 features, not "the accent."

Center: words, spelling, grammar. lift/elevator · flat/apartment · queue/line · first floor ≠ first floor · pants ≠ pants · table it (UK: discuss now / US: postpone) · colour/color · centre/center · organise/organize · travelled/traveled · *Have you got...? / Do you have...? · the team are / the team is · Have you eaten yet? / Did you eat yet? · gotten* (US). One document = one variety.

Right: World Englishes and respect. prepone · do the needful · out of station (India) · go-slow · no wahala (Nigeria) · comfort room · open the light (Philippines) · can or not? · lah (Singapore) · arvo · heaps (Australia). ✗ "heavy accent," "broken English" → ✓ "an accent I'm less familiar with," "a variety I need more exposure to." **Intelligibility, not imitation.**

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome & Progress Test 1 return	12	T-S · S-S · S	Slide 3. See "Returning Progress Test 1" below: strengths on the board, papers back privately, pairs fix 4 anonymous errors, each learner writes one goal in the workbook box.
Lead-in: one scene, five Englishes	5	T-S	Slide 4. Board three lines from Script 5.1-A without names: "The train is delayed only, no?" · "I ken the wee café does a braw coffee." · "Elevator's right over there." Ask: "Is any of these a mistake? (No.) How do you know? What would you need to know to understand all three?" Elicit: different varieties, each with its own words and grammar. "Today we become the listener who is never thrown by an English they haven't met."
Meaning: the sound features	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 5. The three circles in one minute, then the features. Describe and model each on single words in your own voice only where it is natural for you (e.g., a flap in <i>water</i> if you are American); otherwise describe it and play a short authentic clip. Pairs sort the feature cards into "listen for the r / the t / the vowel / the rhythm." CCQs (below). Stress: these are descriptions, not targets.
Form: words, spelling & grammar tells	8	T-S	Slides 6–7. Picture flashcards (trousers, mobile phone, bill, football, garden, shop assistant, post office, muffin): learners call out the British and American word and flag the false friends . Then the spelling patterns and the three grammar tells on slide 7. CCQs.
Drill	5	T-S → S	Two quick rounds (see Drill script): Swap it (British ↔ American, choral then individual) and Name the feature . Then learners say the five model sentences from the online lesson in their own voice, focusing on stress and rhythm, not accent.
Listening: the delayed	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 5.1-A in your normal voice, naming each speaker and variety. First listening: "What's the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
train			problem, and what do they decide?" Second listening: learners write the variety word for each meaning. Pairs compare and say which items would confuse a listener new to that variety.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-4 alone (vocabulary and false friends, name the feature, make the document consistent), then check in pairs. Board-check disagreements only. Ex 5 (reframing loaded language) is the bridge into Round 3: do item 1 together, leave the rest for homework.
Freer: Varieties Lab	25	S-S → T-S	Slides 8-9. Round 1, Feature Detective (10 min): groups of 3-4 get two unlabeled transcripts . You read each aloud once in your own voice; groups underline every variety feature, gloss it, write the bracketed sound notes into their grid, and choose the variety from the label list, citing evidence. Peer check with the "Evidence or assumption?" test . Round 2, Transatlantic info gap (5 min): pairs, A has a British visitor's email, B an American host's questions; they find six traps without showing the page. Round 3, Attitudes (10 min): groups take three attitude cards and discuss agree / disagree / nuance, with a fair-language monitor. Two groups report one insight. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns. Precision: "strong r" → rhotic; "American t" → a flap. Appropriacy: "heavy accent" → "an accent I'm less used to." Naturalness: "In America they say elevator" is fine; "American language" is not (it's American English). Effect: praise the most evidence-based placement. Learners fix and discuss.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 5.1 on screen; point at a  button and the audio control. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		12 + 5 + 10 + 8 + 5 + 7 + 8 + 25 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

The test return must stay at 12 minutes. Cut Workbook Ex 4 and the dictation (Script 5.1-B) and set them for homework. If the Lab is squeezed, drop Round 2 (the info gap works well as a C17 warmer), but **never cut Round 3**: the attitudes discussion is the heart of this lesson, and it needs its full ten minutes to go beyond first reactions.

RETURNING PROGRESS TEST 1 (12 MIN) — KEEP IT WARM

1. Celebrate first (3 min). Before any paper comes out, write "**We can...**" on the board and list three things the whole class did well (for example: *choose the mot juste between near-synonyms · shift register on demand · read implicature and irony · signal stance with discourse markers · summarize and synthesize · build an argument with rhetorical control*). Say it out loud.

SAY: *Four modules of C2. You can choose the exact word, move between registers, read what's implied and not said, hold a long text together, and argue with style. That is mastery-level English. Give yourselves a hand.*

2. Return privately (2 min). Hand papers back face-down or in folders. **Never read scores aloud** and never compare learners. Everyone gets a written comment: one strength + one upgrade to work on.

3. "Let's refine it!" (5 min). Show 4 anonymous sentences from the tests. At C2 they are rarely plain errors; mix accuracy with appropriacy and naturalness. Use your own learners' sentences if you can; typical ones at this point: *The results were very unique. · In my humble opinion, the data clearly proves the hypothesis. (report) · The committee discussed about the proposal at length. · Having read the report, the conclusion seemed obvious.* (Also common: *This is a very actual problem. · She made a big effort for convincing them. · It's raining cats and dogs, so to speak, in the market.*) Pairs refine them and say what kind of problem each one was (accuracy, register, naturalness, logic). Praise the refining, not the error-free papers.

4. One goal (2 min). Each learner writes one goal in the workbook box ("My goal after Progress Test 1"): *"I want to refine _____. Every week I will _____."* Give two examples: "I want to refine my collocations. Every week I'll note ten from a long-form article and use three at work." / "I want my irony to land. I'll listen to one comedy podcast a week and note where the tone does the work."

SAY: *A test is a map. It tells us where we are. It doesn't tell us who we are.*

Some adults carry hard memories of tests, and highly qualified professionals whose credentials were not recognized here can feel a test as a judgment on their whole career. At C2 there's an extra twist: learners who are used to being "the best English speaker" in their workplace may be shaken by any mark below perfect. Keep your voice light and move on quickly. Offer a **1:1 chat at the break** to anyone who struggled (below about 60%), and plan catch-up with the Module 1–4 online lessons. The best encouragement is a successful lesson straight after it, and today's topic rewards what these learners already have: years of listening to many kinds of English.

Meaning: varieties, not errors. A variety is a complete, rule-governed form of English with its own sounds, words and grammar. Inner-circle (UK, US, Australia, Ireland), outer-circle (India, Nigeria, Singapore, the Philippines: English as an official or institutional language, often through colonial history) and expanding-circle (English as an international lingua franca) Englishes are all real English.

SAY: *"The train is delayed only, no?" Is only a mistake? (No: it's an emphasis marker in Indian English.) Who is it a mistake for? (Nobody: it's standard in that variety.) · A Nigerian colleague says "There's a go-slow on the expressway." Is there a strike? (No: in Nigerian English a go-slow is a traffic jam. In British English it can also mean a work slowdown protest, so context matters.) · Is Received Pronunciation "English done properly"? (No: it's one accent among many.)*

Meaning: features. A trained listener doesn't hear "an accent"; they hear two or three features.

SAY: *"Car" with the r sounded: rhotic or non-rhotic? (Rhotic.) Typical of? (Most of the US, Canada, Scotland, Ireland.) · "Water" as "wader": what's that called? (T-flapping.) Where? (US, Canada.) · "Butter" with a catch in the throat? (A glottal stop: London and much of England.) · Every syllable roughly the same length: stress-timed or syllable-timed? (Syllable-timed.) Is that "flat" or "wrong"? (Neither: it's the rhythm of that variety.)*

Meaning: intelligibility and accommodation. When Englishes meet, what matters is being understood by each other. Research on English as a lingua franca finds that the features causing real breakdown are few.

Accommodation = both speakers adjust (slow down, rephrase, avoid local idioms). The listener's job is half the work.

SAY: *"I couldn't understand his accent." Whose skill does that sentence describe? (Mine, the listener's: my exposure.) Better phrasing? ("I'm less familiar with that accent." / "It took me a few minutes to tune in.") · In an international meeting, who should adjust: the native speakers or the non-native speakers? (Both: that's accommodation.)*

Form.

Vocabulary	lift / elevator · flat / apartment · queue / line · petrol / gas · pavement / sidewalk · trousers / pants · mobile / cell phone · bill / check · football / soccer · garden / yard · shop assistant / salesclerk · post / mail
False friends	first floor (UK: one up / US: street level) · pants (UK: underwear / US: trousers) · table a motion (UK: discuss now / US: postpone) · quite good (UK often: fairly / US: very) · momentarily (US: in a moment / UK: for a moment) · homely (UK: cozy / US: plain-looking) · chips · biscuit · muffin
Spelling	-our/-or (colour/color) · -re/-er (centre/center) · -ise/-ize (both OK in UK) · -ce/-se (defence/defense) · -ll/-l- (travelled/traveled) · -ogue/-og (catalogue/catalog)

Grammar tells	<i>Have you got a minute? / Do you have a minute? · The team are / The team is · Have you eaten yet? / Did you eat yet? · got / gotten · at the weekend / on the weekend · in hospital / in the hospital</i>
World Englishes	India: prepone, do the needful, out of station, emphatic <i>only / itself</i> · Nigeria: go-slow, no wahala, I'll reach by ten, flash (a missed call) · Singapore: lah, can or not? · Philippines: comfort room, open the light, for a while (= hold on) · Australia: arvo, servo, heaps, reckon · Scotland: wee, ken, aye, dreich · Ireland: grand, I'm after missing it · US South: y'all, fixing to, might could

Pronunciation. Keep this about **recognition**. The learner's own production goal is intelligibility, in their own accent. Two production points are worth drilling because they help everyone: (1) the stress of the metalanguage (*RH*otic, *va*Riety, *inTE*lli*gi*BILity, *acCOM*mo*DA*tion, *GL*oTtal); (2) saying the model sentences with clear chunking and stress ("In Britain you take the lift to your flat | in America you take the elevator to your apartment"). If a learner asks "Should I change my accent?", answer honestly: only if *they* want to, for their own reasons; the course goal is to be understood and to understand.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Swap it** (choral, then individual): T: "lift" → S: "elevator." T: "queue" → "line." T: "petrol" → "gas." T: "flat" → "apartment." T: "the bill, please" → "the check, please." T: "Have you got a pen?" → "Do you have a pen?" T: "colour, with a u" → "color, no u." Reverse direction for the second round.
- 2 False friend or not?** T: "I'll meet you on the first floor." → S: "False friend! Which first floor?" T: "Let's table it." → "False friend: now or later?" T: "The sidewalk." → "Not a false friend: just American."
- 3 Name the feature:** T (describing): "The r in 'hard' is sounded." → S: "Rhotic." T: "'Better' sounds like 'bedder.'" → "T-flapping." T: "'Bottle' with a catch in the throat." → "Glottal stop." T: "Every syllable about the same length." → "Syllable-timed."
- 4 Reframe it** (individual, then choral for the best version): T: "He has a heavy accent." → S: "He has an accent I'm not used to yet." T: "She speaks broken English." → "She speaks English as an additional language, and she gets her point across." / "...and I understood her fine."

◆ VARIETIES LAB – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3–4** with roles: **reader-aloud** (optional; otherwise you read), **scribe** (fills the Feature Detective grid), **evidence checker** (asks "Which word shows that?") and **fair-language monitor** (listens for loaded words and suggests a reframe). Give the monitor role to a dominant speaker.
- ◆ **Round 1, Feature Detective (10 min):** each group gets two unlabeled transcripts from the eight (Scottish, Irish, Australian, Indian, Nigerian, Singaporean, Philippine, US Southern). Read each aloud once in your normal voice, including the bracketed sound note. Groups (1) underline each variety word or structure, (2) gloss it in standard American English, (3) copy the sound features from the bracketed note, (4) choose the variety from the label list on the grid and (5) write the evidence. Then swap grids

with the next group for the "**Evidence or assumption?**" test: every placement must cite a word, a structure or a described sound. "It sounds Indian" is an assumption; "*prepone* and *out of station* are Indian English" is evidence.

- ◆ (Optional, 2 min from Round 3) Play one authentic recording of a speaker of a variety the group worked on. "Which features from the grid can you hear?" Listening only.
- ◆ **Round 2, Transatlantic info gap (5 min):** pairs. A holds a British colleague's welcome email for a visit (first floor, the lift, a jumper, "quite good," "we'll table your proposal on Monday," the chemist's). B holds an American visitor's list of questions. B asks; A explains without showing the email. Together they list the six places an American reader could misunderstand. No one reads the email in an accent: this is vocabulary.
- ◆ **Round 3, Attitudes (10 min):** each group draws three of the eight **attitude cards** (general statements such as "A listener who says 'I can't understand your accent' is describing themselves, not the speaker"). For each: agree, disagree or "it depends," with a reason and, if possible, an example from work, media or research, **not from anyone in the room**. The fair-language monitor flags loaded words. Each group reports one insight in one sentence.
- ◆ **Share (in the feedback stage):** the most evidence-based placement from Round 1 and the most useful reframe from Round 3 go on the board.

FACILITATING THE ATTITUDES DISCUSSION

Set the frame before Round 3: "We are discussing **ideas about accents**, not anyone's accent. No one describes, rates or imitates anyone's accent, including their own. You can share an experience if you want to, and you can always pass." If a learner starts to share a painful experience (being mocked, losing a job), listen, thank them, and don't ask follow-up questions in front of the class; check in privately later. If a learner says something dismissive of a variety ("Indian English is just wrong English"), treat it as an idea to examine, not a person to shame: "Interesting. What would a linguist say? Is *prepone* less logical than *postpone*?" One piece of research is worth mentioning: in a well-known 1992 study by Donald Rubin, US undergraduates heard the **same** recorded lecture by a speaker of General American; those shown a photo of an Asian instructor rated the lecturer as more accented and understood less. The lesson: expectation shapes listening. Keep the numbers out of it and the point simple.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE VARIETIES LAB

SAY: *In Round 1, is the variety written on the card? (No: you work it out.) What must every choice have? (Evidence: a word, a structure or a described sound.) Is "It sounds Nigerian" evidence? (No: it's an assumption.) Will anyone imitate an accent? (No.) · In Round 2, can A show the email? (No.) What are you looking for? (Places an American could misunderstand: six.) · In Round 3, are we discussing people in this room? (No: ideas.) Do you have to share a personal story? (No. You can pass.) What does the monitor listen for? (Loaded words like "heavy" or "broken.")*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some C2 speakers are far stronger orally than in writing, and some read English fluently but have little experience of reading non-standard words. Give them the **glossary strip** (the World Englishes list from the Form table) to match against the transcript, and let them work on one transcript instead of two. In Round 2, they make an excellent B: asking questions is the real skill. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–6, Ex 3 items 1–4. Target: two features correctly glossed with evidence, and one reframed sentence said aloud.

STRETCH (C2+)

Sociolinguistics. Introduce **indexicality** (a feature "points to" an identity: a Scot may roll more r's among Scots than in London) and **style-shifting**. Ask strong learners to explain why a variety feature (Indian *prepone*, Irish *after-perfect*: *I'm after missing the bus* = I've just missed it) is *systematic*, with a rule. Or: rewrite the Round 2 email twice, once in consistent American and once in consistent British spelling and vocabulary, and list every change. Or: plan a 60-second briefing for an international team using accommodation strategies (no local idioms, clear chunking, check-backs).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"My English is the correct one."** Learners schooled only in RP or only in General American may treat the other (and all outer-circle varieties) as errors. Learners who grew up with **Indian, Nigerian, Philippine, Singaporean or Caribbean English** may have been told their own English is wrong. Frame everything as variety; never mark an established outer-circle feature as an error in this module.
- ◆ **Mixed spelling:** learners educated in British-influenced systems (much of Africa, South Asia, Europe, the Middle East) often mix *colour* and *color*, *organise* and *organize* in one text, especially with a US spell-checker. The C2 standard is consistency.
- ◆ **Hearing the r:** speakers of Japanese and Korean (no r/l contrast), and of Mandarin, may find rhoticity hard to perceive; speakers of Spanish, Arabic, Russian or Italian (trilled or tapped r) may hear every English r as "weak." Use minimal listening pairs (*car / cah*) from recordings; perception, not production.
- ◆ **Hearing the flap:** learners whose L1 has a tap (Spanish *pero*, Japanese r) may hear American *water* as "waro" or "wader" and think it's an r; tell them they're hearing a real sound: it's the same tap.
- ◆ **Rhythm:** speakers of syllable-timed languages (Spanish, French, Italian, Turkish, Cantonese, Yoruba, Tagalog) may find their own English described as "syllable-timed." Reassure: it's a description, and syllable-timed English is highly intelligible internationally.
- ◆ **"American language"** (Spanish *el americano*, Russian *американский*): say *American English*. Likewise *British English*, not "English English."

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_13.html. Listen to the five-speaker dialogue with 🎧 (use the audio control to pick a voice and slow it down) and the five model sentences; do Exercises 1–2, the Quick Quiz and the "Two-Voice Comparison" project (any two authentic speakers of different varieties; a 100–150-word comparison and an honest reflection on how easily you understood each). Workbook 5.1: finish Exercise 5, "My new words" and the journal (which variety of English is hardest for you to follow, and which features make it hard; and which variety has shaped your own English: real, or from a new identity card).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** American English · Q2 **C** These are standard British English features: variety, not error · Q3 (new) **B** The traffic was jammed, so she'll arrive late (Nigerian English). Listening (Ex 1): 1 only · 2 kindly · 3 wee · 4 ken · 5 arvo · 6 cuppa · 7 go-slow · 8 no wahala · 9 elevator.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ distinguish **subject**, **theme**, **purpose** and **tone**, and state a theme as a specific, arguable claim rather than a moral (*the poem treats hope as self-sustaining*, not *it's about hope*)
- ◆ identify point of view and **narrative voice**, detect an **unreliable narrator** or an ironic narrative voice, and keep narrator and author apart
- ◆ unpick a difficult sentence with **strip** → **spine** → **restore** → **paraphrase**: periodic sentences, inversion (*sore must be the storm*), verbless sentences (*Fog everywhere.*), archaism, long-range pronouns
- ◆ recognize allusion, imagery, symbolism, irony, juxtaposition, foreshadowing and motif, and turn each into a **technique** → **effect** → **theme** chain
- ◆ take part in a seminar with the language of literary discussion (*the passage evokes... the effect is to... I'd read it slightly differently...*) and write a short interpretation in which every claim quotes the text

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 5.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Close-Reading Seminar frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 10–14 · Literary-technique flashcards · **Close-Reading Seminar** text cards (6) · seminar role cards · annotation key · highlighters or two pen colors · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 5.2-A (a seminar contribution on Dickinson) and 5.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: four questions. Subject: what happens? (a fishing trip) · Theme: what is it really about? (the silence between father and son) · Purpose: what does it want to do to me? (move, unsettle, satirize, mourn) · Tone: what's the attitude? (word choice, irony, register). A theme is arguable and has evidence. ✗ "It's about love." ✓ "It treats love as a kind of negotiation."

Center: difficult syntax. STRIP the extras → find the SPINE (who does what?) → RESTORE one piece at a time → PARAPHRASE in one plain sentence. *And sore must be the storm / That could abash the little Bird* → spine: *the storm must be sore* → the storm would have to be terrible to silence the bird. *Fog everywhere.* = no verb, on purpose.

Right: the engine. The text does X (technique) → which creates Y (effect) → which serves Z (theme). *The repeated "Fog" creates a sense of something inescapable, which suggests...* · evokes · juxtaposes · foreshadows · it is heavy with irony · the tone shifts from... to... · I'd read it slightly differently · Where does it say that?

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: evidence or assumption?	7	S-S	Review C14. Board six items: <i>prepone · the team are · y'all · arvo · gotten · comfort room</i> . Pairs say the variety, gloss it and add one sound feature they remember. Then show one "Round 2" trap from the info gap (<i>We'll table your proposal on Monday</i>) and ask: "Good news or bad for an American?" Glance at homework journals.
Lead-in: the fishing trip	5	T-S	Slide 10. "A short story is about a fishing trip. A father and son sit in a boat all day and say almost nothing. At the end, the son rows home." Ask: "What's it about?" Collect answers; most will give the subject. Push: "What's it <i>really</i> about?" Elicit a theme (the silence between them; love that can't be spoken). "Today: from what a text says to what it means, and how to prove it."
Meaning: theme, purpose, voice	10	T-S → S-S	Slides 10–11. The four questions. Then voice: read the two narrators from the online lesson ("I was frightened, and I said so." / "I was perfectly calm — anyone would have done as I did...") and the Austen opening. CCQs. Pairs write one arguable theme for the fishing story and test it: "Can I point to lines? Could a thoughtful reader disagree?"
Form: strip → spine → restore	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 12. Model the method on the Dickinson inversion and on Thoreau's long sentence (bracket the interruptions on the board with learners calling "strip it!"). Pairs do the Austen sentence. CCQs. Point out the Dickens verbless sentence as a deliberate choice, not an error.
Drill: the language of discussion	5	T-S → S	Slide 13. Technique cards up, learners produce the chain (see Drill script). Choral for the frames, then individual. Stress and chunking: <i>the Effect is to make the Familiar feel STRANGE</i> .
Listening: a seminar contribution	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 5.2-A (a learner's contribution on Dickinson's "Hope is the thing with feathers") twice. First: "What theme does the speaker propose?" Second: learners complete the seven phrases of literary discussion. Pairs compare: "Which claim has the best evidence?"
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–4 alone (technique → effect, unpick the syntax, weak vs arguable themes), then pairs. Board-check disagreements only. Ex 5 (the Frost annotation) is homework unless a pair finishes early.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Freer: Close-Reading Seminar	29	S-S → T-S	Slide 14. Round 1, Annotate (10 min) : groups of 3 get one text card (six texts in three pairs: Austen + Jerome on voice and irony; Dickens + Thoreau on syntax and imagery; Dickinson + Frost on metaphor and theme). Using the annotation key, they annotate, then write one arguable theme sentence and one technique → effect → theme chain . Round 2, Seminar (14 min) : the two groups with paired texts merge (6 people). Each group presents its text (a volunteer or you read it aloud; 1 min), then a 6-minute seminar with role cards: discussion leader (speaks last), evidence keeper, alternative reader, connector (links the two texts). Round 3, Peer review (5 min) : groups swap their written theme + chain and run the "Show me the words" test . ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns. Precision: "the theme is fog" (subject) → "the fog stands for a legal system that obscures everything." Appropriacy: jargon with no effect ("there is alliteration"). Naturalness: "the poem wants to say" → "the poem suggests"; "the author makes a metaphor" → "the author uses / builds a metaphor." Effect: praise the most persuasive chain. Learners fix and discuss.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 5.2 and a 🔊 button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		7 + 5 + 10 + 10 + 5 + 6 + 8 + 29 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: theme vs subject. The subject is what happens; the theme is the concern the text keeps returning to. A good theme statement is specific, arguable and supported.

SAY: "The subject is a fishing trip; the theme is the silence between father and son." Which one could you photograph? (The subject.) Which one could a reader argue about? (The theme.) · "The poem is about the sea." Theme or subject? (Subject.) · "The poem is about love." Arguable? (Not really: it's too broad. Everyone agrees, and nobody learns anything.) · "The poem treats memory as something that both preserves and distorts." Theme? (Yes: specific, and someone could disagree.)

Meaning: narrator vs author; unreliability; ironic voice. The voice telling the story is constructed. An unreliable narrator reveals more than they intend; an ironic narrative voice says one thing and means another.

SAY: "I was perfectly calm — anyone would have done as I did, and only a coward would say otherwise." Was he calm? (Probably not.) What gives it away? (He protests too much; he attacks imaginary critics.) Is the author a coward-hater? (We don't know: the author built the voice so we'd see

through it.) · Austen: "It is a truth universally acknowledged, that a single man in possession of a good fortune must be in want of a wife." Is it really universal? (No.) Who actually wants the marriage? (The families with daughters.) So is the sentence sincere? (No: it's ironic.)

Meaning: technique → effect → theme. Naming a device is not interpretation. The interpretation is what it does, and why that matters.

SAY: "There is imagery of cold." Interpretation? (Not yet: it's only a label.) What's missing? (The effect, and the theme it serves.) · "The cold imagery makes the reunion feel like a funeral, which foreshadows the estrangement." How many steps? (Three: technique, effect, theme.)

Form.

Strip → spine → restore	Bracket the extras: [relative clauses] [participle phrases] [asides between dashes or commas] → find subject + verb → put the pieces back one by one → paraphrase in one plain sentence	I went to the woods [because I wished to live deliberately, ...] → <i>I went to the woods</i> + why
Inversion	adjective / adverbial first, then verb, then subject (poetry and formal prose)	<i>Sore must be the storm</i> = The storm must be sore (severe).
Verbless sentences	noun phrases as sentences for effect: stillness, a list, a camera panning	<i>Fog everywhere. Fog up the river...</i>
Archaism	old words, old meanings; infer from context and modern relatives	<i>wanted wear</i> = lacked wear · <i>hence</i> = from now · <i>fancy</i> = think
Discussion frames	the passage evokes... · the image juxtaposes X and Y · this detail foreshadows... · the tone shifts from... to... · the effect is to... · which suggests / reinforces... · I'd read it slightly differently: ...	The repeated "Fog" creates a sense of suffocation, which suggests a city lost in its own confusion.

Pronunciation. Reading literature aloud is a skill in itself; this is about **pausing and stress**, never accent. For verse, pause at punctuation and dashes, not at every line end (Dickinson's commas in "Yet, never, in extremity" are breaths). For long prose sentences, chunk at the clause boundaries you found when you stripped the sentence, and let the voice rise through the suspended part and fall on the landing. Word stress in the metalanguage: **ALLusion** → *alLUSion* (second syllable), **Irony**, **SYMBOLism**, *juxTApoSition*, *foreSHAdowing*, *inTERpreTAtion*, **MOTif** → *moTIF* (both are heard; American usually stresses the second).

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Name it** (fast): T: "an early hint of what's to come" → S: "foreshadowing." T: "a glancing reference to a myth" → "allusion." T: "a gap between what's said and what's meant" → "irony." T: "two things side by side for contrast" → "juxtaposition." T: "a recurring image" → "a motif."

- 2 **Build the chain** (card up, individual): T holds up IMAGERY + "dust, a slowing clock" → S: "The imagery of dust and a slowing clock evokes stillness, which suggests a life that has stopped with her." T: IRONY + Austen → "The opening is heavy with irony: the 'universal truth' is really the families' wish, which exposes marriage as a matter of money." T: JUXTAPOSITION + "guest / his own life" → "The simile juxtaposes 'guest' and 'his own life,' and the effect is to make the familiar feel strange."
- 3 **Push back politely** (pairs): A makes a claim from the text cards; B responds with one of three frames: "I'd read it slightly differently: ..." · "That's persuasive, but what about the line...?" · "Where exactly does it say that?"

◆ CLOSE-READING SEMINAR – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **The texts** (all public domain; see materials Set D): **A1** Austen, *Pride and Prejudice* (1813), opening · **A2** Jerome K. Jerome, *Three Men in a Boat* (1889), the British Museum · **B1** Dickens, *Bleak House* (1853), the fog · **B2** Thoreau, *Walden* (1854), "I went to the woods..." · **C1** Dickinson, "Hope is the thing with feathers" (published 1891) · **C2** Frost, "The Road Not Taken" (1916), stanzas 2–4. Six groups of 3. With fewer learners, use pair A or C only.
- ◆ **Round 1, Annotate (10 min)**: read the text three times (surface; slowly for word choice; aloud, quietly, for rhythm). Annotation key: underline images · **circle** key words and repeated words · [bracket] interruptions in long sentences · → arrows from pronouns to referents · ? in the margin for anything uncertain. Then answer the four prompts on the card and write, on the worksheet, **one arguable theme sentence** and **one technique → effect → theme chain** with a quotation.
- ◆ **Round 2, Seminar (14 min)**: merge paired groups (A1 + A2, etc.). Hand out role cards: **discussion leader** (opens with a question, keeps turns fair, *speaks last* with a summary), **evidence keeper** (may only ask "Where does it say that?" and "Which word?"), **alternative reader** (must offer one different, defensible reading), **connector** (links the two texts: "Both narrators..."). Remaining learners are **contributors**. Group 1's text: 1 min read aloud + 6 min discussion; then Group 2's.
- ◆ **Round 3, "Show me the words" peer review (5 min)**: each group gives its theme sentence and chain to the other group in the merge. Reviewers check: Is the theme arguable (could someone disagree)? Does every claim quote specific words? Is there an effect, not just a label? One strength, one suggestion, quoting the text.
- ◆ **Model answers** for every text are in the materials (for you, folded back) and in the answer key. Accept any reading the words support. "Two well-supported readings can coexist" is a core message of this class.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SEMINAR

SAY: *In Round 1, how many times do you read? (Three.) What do you write at the end? (One arguable theme and one chain.) What must the chain include? (A quotation, an effect and the theme.) · In Round 2, can the evidence keeper give opinions? (No: only "Where does it say that?") Who speaks last? (The discussion leader.) What does the alternative reader do? (Offers a different reading, with evidence.) · Is there one right answer? (No, but every answer needs the words.)*

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give learners who read more slowly the **Dickinson** text (short lines, everyday words) or the **Frost** text, with the three glossed words (*abash*, *extremity*, *wanted wear*) in the margin. Offer a **sentence-frame strip**: "The ____ evokes ____, which suggests ____." In the seminar, the evidence-keeper role suits them well: asking "Where does it say that?" is powerful and needs no long turn. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 3 items 1–2. Target: one chain, spoken aloud with a quotation.

STRETCH (C2+)

Free indirect discourse: in Austen, whose voice is the "truth universally acknowledged"? The narrator's, society's or Mrs. Bennet's? Ask strong learners to find the exact word where irony enters (*property*). With Frost, ask them to argue *both* readings (the celebratory popular one and the ironic one) and decide which the text supports better, citing "really about the same" and "with a sigh." Or: write a 100-word pastiche of the Dickens fog paragraph about their own city's weather, using verbless sentences and anaphora, then explain one effect.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"The correct interpretation"**: learners schooled in traditions where the teacher or the textbook provides the meaning (common in many exam systems) may wait for your answer. Hold back: "What do the words let you say?" Praise defended disagreement.
- ◆ **Narrator = author**: common everywhere, but reinforced where literature is taught mainly through the author's biography. Keep asking, "Does the text endorse this voice, or invite us to judge it?"
- ◆ **"Irony" as coincidence or bad luck**: from everyday English and many L1 calques. Keep the definition tight: a gap between what is said and what is meant (or expected).
- ◆ **"The author wants to say"** (Spanish *quiere decir*, Russian *хочет сказать*, German *will sagen*): upgrade to *suggests*, *implies*, *invites us to see*. Also "the poem speaks about" (Spanish *habla de*, Portuguese *fala de*): *the poem explores / is concerned with*.
- ◆ **Periodic sentences**: speakers of verb-final languages (Japanese, Korean, Turkish, German subordinate clauses) are often comfortable waiting for the verb; learners from SVO languages may panic. Strip → spine helps both.
- ◆ **False friends in literary terms**: Spanish *argumento* / French *argument* / Italian *argomento* (= plot or topic, not argument); French *caractère* (≠ character in a story, which is *personnage*); Spanish/Portuguese *novela* (can mean a TV soap, but also a novel). Check the word, not the look.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_14.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back with clear chunking; do Exercises 1–2, the Quick Quiz and the "Close

Reading" project (150–250 words; any seminar text, or a short public-domain poem or passage you choose; the online passage about a house after a loss is also available if you prefer it). Workbook 5.2: Exercise 5 (Frost), "My new words" and the journal (a passage that resisted an easy reading, and what opened up when you slowed down).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** The failure of communication within a family · Q2 **A** An unreliable narrator · Q3 (new) **B** It's ironic: the "universal truth" is really the neighborhood families' wish to marry their daughters to a rich man. Seminar contribution (Ex 1): 1 extended metaphor · 2 evokes · 3 juxtaposes · 4 the effect is to · 5 inversion · 6 the tone shifts · 7 I'd argue.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ classify slang and informal expressions by **register** (where you can use it) and **currency** (dated, established, current), explain why slang dates fast, and choose plain English when in doubt
- ◆ notice that a **cultural reference** is present (the "why did that land?" reflex) and decode common allusions from myth, history, literature and film (*Achilles' heel*, *a Trojan horse*, *meet your Waterloo*, *Catch-22*, *Groundhog Day*)
- ◆ decode **headlinese** (no articles, present simple for past, *to* + infinitive for future, short verbs like *axe*, *probe*, *back*, *slam*, puns and double meanings) and memes described in words
- ◆ recognize the processes of **fast connected speech** (elision, assimilation, linking, weak forms, reductions: *gonna*, *wanna*, *whatcha*, *didja*, *lemme*, *dunno*, *shoulda*) and catch the load-bearing words
- ◆ read **sarcasm** from delivery and situation (tone over text), and use coping strategies: ride the gist, use context, subtitles as a bridge, rewind, look up selectively, tolerate ambiguity

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 5.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Media Decoding Lab frame, self-check, "Look back at my goal" box)
- ◆ Slides 15–18 · Slang-currency, allusion and fast-speech flashcards · **Media Decoding** station cards (4 stations) · phone timer · **Decode It!** board game · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 5.3-A (the coffee-shop run-in) and 5.3-B (fast-speech dictation + sincere or sarcastic?)

BOARD PLAN

Left: slang has a date and a room. DATED: groovy (1960s–70s) · rad (1980s) · da bomb (1990s) · on fleek (2010s) → ESTABLISHED: ghost someone · the vibe · binge-watch · FOMO · a hot take · (UK) gutted, knackered → CURRENT (check!): no cap · it slaps · lowkey / highkey · the ick · main-character energy. Understand widely. Use sparingly. Never in a report.

Center: references. Achilles' heel · a Trojan horse · Pandora's box · the Midas touch · meet your Waterloo · cross the Rubicon · Catch-22 · Big Brother · Kafkaesque · Groundhog Day · "Houston, we have a problem." Headlinese: *CITY BACKS BIKE PLAN* = The city has backed... · *MAYOR TO UNVEIL*... = will unveil · *CHEF GRILLS MAYOR* = pun.

Right: speed and tone. What are you going to do? → *Whatcha gonna do?* · Did you see it? → *Didja see it?* · Let me know → *Lemme know* · I don't know → *I dunno* · should have → *shoulda* · next day → "nex day" · ten bikes → "tem bikes." Sarcasm: "Oh, great. Another meeting." Words vs situation disagree → trust the situation and the tone.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: one-line readings	7	S-S	Review C15. Board three lines: "Fog everywhere." · "Sore must be the storm." · "I shall be telling this with a sigh." Pairs name one technique in each and give its effect in one sentence ("The verbless sentence creates stillness, which..."). Two pairs share. Collect or glance at the close-reading homework.
Lead-in: why did that land?	5	T-S	Slide 15. Board an invented headline: CHEF GRILLS MAYOR OVER FOOD-TRUCK RULES . "Did the chef cook the mayor? (No!) What happened? Why is it funny? What else is missing from this sentence?" Elicit: pun (<i>grill</i> = cook / question hard), no articles, present tense for a past event. "Today: the English nobody simplified for you."
Slang: register & currency	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 15. The three bands (dated / established / current) with the slang cards. Pairs place six cards on a timeline and say where each could be used (text to a friend, team chat, email to a manager, report). Name community origins respectfully where relevant (<i>no cap</i> and <i>lowkey</i> spread from African American English). CCQs. Key message: understand widely, use sparingly.
References & headlines	8	T-S	Slide 16. Allusion cards: learners give the meaning and, if they know it, the story behind it. Then the four rules of headlines on three invented headlines. Then one meme described in words ("a cartoon dog sits calmly with a cup of coffee in a burning room and says 'This is fine'"): "When would someone share this? What's the attitude?" CCQs.
Fast speech + drill	8	T-S → S	Slide 17. The five processes, each with one example read naturally, then slowly. Drill (see Drill script): full form → fast form and back, choral then individual. Then sarcasm: you read "Oh, great. Another meeting." sincerely and sarcastically; learners say which is which and what signaled it (pitch, stress, lengthening). Learners try the sarcastic reading in pairs: intonation practice in their own voice.
Listening: the coffee- shop run-in	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 5.3-A at natural speed with reductions (two voices, or with a confident learner). First: "Who did Jordan run into, and how did Jordan really feel?" Second: learners answer the six decoding questions. Pairs compare.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-4 alone (headlines, slang register, allusions), then pairs. Board-check disagreements only. Ex 5 (fast-speech full forms) is homework unless a pair finishes early.
Freer: Media Decoding Lab	22	S-S → T-S	Slide 18. Four stations on four tables; groups of 3-4 rotate every 4 minutes (16 min): 1 Headlines (rewrite as full sentences, find the pun), 2 Memes in words (what's the joke, what's the attitude, when would you share it?), 3 Allusion hunt (a short invented article with five allusions to find and gloss), 4 Slang & register (sort by currency; rewrite a friend's text as an email to a manager). At each station, the group writes one gloss for a newcomer on the station sheet. Last 6 min: the " Gloss it for a newcomer " test: each group reads the glosses left at its final station and checks: accurate? understandable without the culture? respectful? One strength, one suggestion. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns. Precision: "it's a joke" → "it's a pun on <i>grill</i> ." Appropriacy: current slang in the manager email. Naturalness: "This slang is very actual" → "current / up-to-date"; "on the TV" → "on TV." Effect: praise the clearest newcomer gloss.
Module wrap-up & goal check	5	T-S • S	Slide 19: "hear it, read it, decode it." Learners tick the three "I can..." lists and read their Progress Test goal again in the "Look back at my goal" box (see Closing the Module). Private; no one reports.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 5.3 and a 📶 button. Set the homework (below).
Total	90		7 + 5 + 10 + 8 + 8 + 7 + 8 + 22 + 5 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: slang has a register and a date. Slang marks belonging, mood and generation more than information. It is the fastest-changing layer of English: that's why textbooks avoid it and media is full of it.

SAY: "No cap, that album slaps." Formal or informal? (Very informal.) Would you write it in an email to a client? (No.) Is it wrong? (No: it's right for a friend, wrong for a report.) • "That's groovy." Current? (No: 1960s-70s; now it's retro or ironic.) • Is ghost still slang? (Barely: it's near-standard now, even in newspapers.) • A 45-year-old accountant says "It's giving main-character energy" in a meeting. What's the risk? (It may sound forced or stale; plain English is safer.)

Meaning: references do invisible work. The words are clear; the meaning depends on shared knowledge. The skill is **noticing** a reference is there, then deciding whether to look it up.

SAY: *"The new policy turned out to be a Trojan horse." Is there a horse? (No.) What's the meaning? (Something that looks like a gift but hides a threat.) Where does it come from? (Greek myth: the siege of Troy.) · "Every day at this job is Groundhog Day." Meaning? (Every day is exactly the same.) Source? (A 1993 film.) · Everyone laughs and you don't know why. What probably happened? (A reference or an in-joke passed.) Should you stop the conversation? (Usually not: note it, ride the gist, look it up later.)*

Meaning: sarcasm lives in the delivery.

SAY: *The car breaks down. "Well, this is going great." Going great? (No: the opposite.) How do you know? (The situation, and the flat or exaggerated tone.) Can you look sarcasm up in a dictionary? (No.) · "Oh, brilliant, a 7 a.m. meeting — said no one ever." What does "said no one ever" do? (It marks the first part as sarcastic.)*

Form.

Headlines	no articles or <i>be</i> · present simple for the past · <i>to</i> + infinitive for the future · past participle = passive · short verbs: axe (cut), back (support), probe (investigate), slam (criticize), vow (promise), bid (attempt), quit (resign), eye (consider) · puns	LIBRARY FINES AXED = Library fines have been abolished. · MAYOR TO UNVEIL PARK PLAN = The mayor will unveil...
Fast speech	elision (sounds dropped) · assimilation (sounds change) · linking · weak forms · reductions	nex(t) day · <u>tem</u> bikes · a-napple · fish 'n' chips · gonna, wanna, gotta, whatcha, didja, wouldja, lemme, dunno, shoulda, kinda
Asking about a reference	polite, low-stakes ways to ask	Sorry, is that a reference to something? · I think I missed the joke; what's the story there? · Is that from a show?
Coping strategies	ride the gist · use context and reactions · subtitles as a bridge · rewind · look up selectively · tolerate ambiguity	"I didn't catch every word, but the gist was..."

Pronunciation. Recognition first. Learners don't need to say "whatcha," but they must hear it. If they want to use reductions, *gonna* / *wanna* / *kinda* in casual speech are safe; *whatcha*, *didja* are fine but optional; never write them in formal text. **Sarcastic intonation** (in the learner's own voice): a flat, low pitch ("Great.") or an exaggerated rise-fall with lengthening ("Oh, grea-a-at"), stress on the "wrong" word ("That's **just** what I needed"). Practice both sincere and sarcastic readings of the same line so learners feel the contrast; this is intonation, not accent.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Hear it fast** (you say the fast form, learners give the full form, choral then individual): "Whatcha gonna do?" → "What are you going to do?" · "Didja see it?" → "Did you see it?" · "Lemme know." → "Let me know." · "I dunno." → "I don't know." · "You shoulda told me." → "You should have told me." · "Wouldja mind?" → "Would you mind?"
- 2 **Headline it:** T: "The city council has approved the new bike lanes." → S: "COUNCIL BACKS BIKE LANES." T: "The museum will open a new wing." → "MUSEUM TO OPEN NEW WING." T: "Scientists are investigating a strange signal." → "SCIENTISTS PROBE MYSTERY SIGNAL."
- 3 **Name the allusion:** T: "Math was always her ____ heel." → S: "Achilles." T: "Opening that file was like opening ____ box." → "Pandora's." T: "He can't get the job without experience, and can't get experience without the job: it's a ____." → "Catch-22."
- 4 **Sincere or sarcastic?** T reads "Oh, perfect." / "Thanks a lot." / "I just love waiting." with either intonation → S: "Sincere!" / "Sarcastic!" and name the cue.

◆ MEDIA DECODING LAB – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Set up four stations** before class (materials Set E). Each station has a card with its task and a **station sheet** where every group writes one "gloss for a newcomer": a one- or two-sentence explanation that someone new to the culture could understand.
- ◆ **Groups of 3–4** with roles that rotate at every station: **reader**, **scribe**, **time-keeper** and **newcomer** (plays a person who has never met the reference and says honestly whether the gloss makes sense). The newcomer role is ideal for a dominant speaker: they may only ask questions.
- ◆ **Station 1, Headlines:** six invented headlines. Rewrite three as full sentences; identify the pun or double meaning in two.
- ◆ **Station 2, Memes in words:** four memes described in text. For each: what's the joke, what's the attitude (irony? self-mockery? frustration?), and when would someone share it?
- ◆ **Station 3, Allusion hunt:** a short invented newsletter article with five allusions. Find, gloss and give the source of each.
- ◆ **Station 4, Slang & register:** sort twelve cards into dated / established / current, then rewrite a slang-heavy text to a friend as a two-sentence email to a manager.
- ◆ **Rotation:** 4 minutes per station. Ring a bell at 3:30. Groups may not finish every item; that's fine (ride the gist!).
- ◆ **"Gloss it for a newcomer" test (6 min):** at its final station, each group reads the glosses the other groups left. Check: accurate? understandable without the culture? respectful (no mockery of the community a word comes from)? One strength, one suggestion.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE MEDIA DECODING LAB

SAY: *How long at each station? (Four minutes.) Must you finish everything? (No.) What do you leave at every station? (One gloss for a newcomer.) What does the newcomer do? (Asks questions, says honestly if the gloss works.) At Station 4, who is the email for? (A manager: no slang.) At the end, what three things do you check in a gloss? (Accurate, understandable, respectful.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Headlines and memes are short, which helps. Give learners who read slowly the **headline-rules strip** (no articles · present = past · *to* = future · short verbs) and let them focus on Stations 1 and 4. The allusion article is the densest text: pre-teach two allusions from it (*Achilles' heel*, *Trojan horse*) during the reference stage. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 5 items 1–5. Target: two headlines rewritten as sentences and one clear newcomer gloss.

STRETCH (C2+)

Why slang dates: ask strong learners to explain the life cycle (in-group → spread → mainstream → adopted by brands and parents → "cringe" → retro) with one example. Or: write three headlines of their own for real, light news from the week (workplace, science, sport, arts) with at least one pun, and explain each pun. Or: find a reference in a show they watch and write a 60-word gloss for a classmate from a different country, then test it on them. Link to C2 2.2: which comic mode (deadpan, understatement, satire, wordplay) does each meme use?

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Dated textbook idioms as "cool English":** many learners were taught "It's raining cats and dogs," "the bee's knees," "groovy" as living idioms. Place them honestly on the timeline; praise the curiosity, not the usage.
- ◆ **Sarcasm read literally:** learners from communication cultures where sarcasm is rare in public or signaled differently (for example, some East and Southeast Asian contexts), and speakers of tonal languages (Mandarin, Cantonese, Vietnamese, Thai), where pitch carries word meaning, may not attach attitude to pitch in English. Contrast the two readings explicitly.
- ◆ **British understatement** ("not bad at all," "a bit of a problem") heard as literal: link to C2 2.2 and 3.3 in C1. In media, a flat "Brilliant." is often the harshest line in the scene.
- ◆ **Reductions in writing:** learners who pick up *gonna*, *wanna*, *kinda* from media sometimes write them in emails. Clear rule: recognize everywhere, write only in texts to friends, never in formal writing.
- ◆ **"Actual" = current** (Spanish *actual*, French *actuel*, German *aktuell*, Russian *актуальный*): "This slang is very actual" → *current*, *up to date*, *topical*. Also "on the TV" → *on TV*, and "in the internet" → *on the internet*.
- ◆ **Allusion sources:** allusions to Greek myth and Shakespeare may be familiar to learners from European schooling and unfamiliar to others; allusions to American film and TV depend on exposure, not

education. Make it clear that **not knowing a reference is never a sign of low English**.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_15.html. Listen to the fast exchange and the five model sentences with , first at normal speed and then slowed down; do Exercises 1–2, the Quick Quiz and the "Decode a Real Clip" project (3–5 minutes of media you enjoy: once without subtitles, once with; five items looked up and classified as slang, reference, idiom or fast speech). Workbook 5.3: Exercise 5 (fast speech), "My new words," the journal, and the "Look back at my goal" box. Note that the online dialogue uses British informal words (*quid*, *flat*); the kit's version uses American ones (*bucks*, *apartment*): a nice variety check from C14.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** The opposite: things are going badly (sarcasm) · Q2 **B** Note that a reference likely passed, keep following the gist, and look it up later · Q3 (new) **B** "The new schedule is working really well for the team." The coffee-shop run-in (Ex 1): 1 Marcus, at a coffee shop · 2 cut off all contact without explanation · 3 no: it was awkward; "cool cool cool" is ironic · 4 I bet · 5 no lie / honestly · 6 something awkward happened at a birthday party; the details are never given (a shared reference).

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C16: MODULE 5 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 19, "hear it, read it, decode it": **rhotic · a flap · a glottal stop · prepone · go-slow · first floor ≠ first floor · intelligibility, not imitation** (hear it) → **theme is arguable · narrator ≠ author · strip → spine → restore · technique → effect → theme** · **Where does it say that?** (read it) → **slang has a date and a room · a Trojan horse · MAYOR TO UNVEIL... · whatcha gonna do? · trust the tone** (decode it). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C17 warmer (the **Decode It!** board game is ready for that).

Check the C14 goals. At the end of C16, invite learners to read their Progress Test goal again (the "Look back at my goal" box in Workbook 5.3): "Did you practice it? What will you do next?" This is private: no one reports to the class.

Watch for in Module 6: 6.1 (op-eds, reviews and articles) is where learners *produce* the media they decoded in C16: headlines and a hook for a review, an allusion used deliberately, a register that suits the publication. Make the link aloud: "Last week you decoded headlines; this week you write one." The close-reading habits from C15 (every claim quotes the text) become the evidence discipline of the long-form writing in 6.2, and the spelling-consistency point from C14 returns in 6.3 (usage and punctuation). In Module 7, C14's respect for variety underpins cross-cultural pragmatics (7.1), and C16's sarcasm and humor return with more care about taboo.

Final assessment (C26) covers all eight modules. From this module, expect: naming and glossing variety features from a transcript (without judging them), British/American false friends and spelling consistency, a short close reading (theme, one technique → effect → theme chain, with quotation), decoding a headline and an allusion, placing slang by register, writing the full form of fast-speech reductions, and reading sarcasm in context.

Module 6 — Writing with Authority

Three writing workshops for learners who already write correctly and now need to write well. First, the **op-ed, review and feature lab**: writing for a reader who owes you nothing and can leave at any line (the hook, the line, the concession, the grounded verdict, the close that lands, and a voice matched to the publication). Then the **long-form and research-writing lab**: architecture over 1,500+ words (the through-line, the argued outline, signposting across sections, and literature-review moves that synthesize sources instead of listing them), with a plan and one section drafted in class. Last, a **clinic on the fine points**: semicolons, colons and dashes, restrictive vs non-restrictive clauses, parallelism, dangling modifiers, rule vs myth, and US vs UK conventions, ending in an **Editing Race**.

3 lessons

Lessons 6.1–6.3

Classes C17–C19

Weeks 9–10

90 min per class

CEFR C2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** (workbook) → a demanding **workshop** → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**. In a writing module the "drill" is short and oral: learners say the working moves of the genre aloud until they sound like reflexes, because prose that cannot be read aloud comfortably is rarely good prose.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-6-writing-authority.html](#). Print [materials/module-6/classroom-materials.html](#) before C17. It holds the flashcards, the writer identity cards, the **Commission cards** and **Pitch cards** (A/B), the annotated model texts and the **Write–Critique–Revise rubric** (C17); the four **Source Packs**, the **Supervision cards** (A/B) and the outline planner (C18); the **Style-Sheet cards** (A/B), the **Rule, Convention or Myth?** sort and the **Editing Race** passages and scoreboard (C19); and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home, and each ends in a writing project that extends the in-class workshop.
- Protect the workshop**. Every class gives about a third of its time to one extended product: a drafted, critiqued and revised piece for a named publication (C17); an argued plan for a 1,500–2,500-word piece plus one drafted section that synthesizes sources (C18); a timed editing race in which every correction must be justified by name

(C19). If you're running late, cut the controlled practice (set the rest for homework), never the workshop.

Writing classes die when writing is always "for homework."

- ◆ **Refinement, not a first meeting.** These learners met essay structure, hedging, cohesion and summary at C1 (C1 Modules 3 and 6), and in this course they have already worked on discourse markers, long-text cohesion and synthesis (C2 3.1–3.3) and rhetoric and voice (C2 4.1–4.2). Don't re-teach topic sentences or linking words. The C2 step is **authority**: the reader's trust earned by a clear line, grounded judgment, a plan that carries them, and a surface so clean that nothing snags.
- ◆ **Feedback on four things.** At C2, accuracy is rarely the most useful column. In every workshop take notes under **precision** (the exact word or mark: *concedes* vs *claims*, a semicolon where a colon was needed), **appropriacy** (right for this publication and reader: a broadsheet op-ed that opens "Hey guys," a research section that says "I reckon"), **naturalness** (grammatical but not how an expert writer would put it: "It is important to note that," "In today's fast-paced world," "the author says" six times) and **effect** (does it work on a reader: a hook that grabs, a verdict that persuades, a signpost that orients). Board 2–3 items per column, without names, and ask the class to improve each one.
- ◆ **Useful feedback for near-native writers.** C2 learners are often near-native in one area and fossilized in another (flawless argument, but *informations*; elegant syntax, but a comma splice in every paragraph). Generic praise ("Very good, very fluent") wastes their time. Always (1) **quote** the exact words, (2) name the **effect** on a reader ("I stopped trusting the verdict here because it isn't anchored to a detail"), and (3) offer **one** alternative, not a rewrite. For fossilized errors, agree on a personal "watch list" of two or three items per learner and check only those in the homework; C2 writers improve fastest when they proofread for their own patterns.
- ◆ **Peer critique, every class.** Each workshop has a structured critique protocol with its own test: the **"Where did you stop?" test** (C17: the reader marks the exact line where their attention dipped, then scores the rubric), the **"Read the claims in order" test** (C18: a partner reads only your section claims aloud; if they can be reordered without loss, you have a list, not an argument), and the **"Name it" rule** (C19: no correction scores unless the team can name the point at issue). Critics always give **one strength and one suggestion**, in that order, quoting the text. Writers may only say "thank you" or ask a question until all feedback is in: no defending the draft.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** C2 classes often include academics, editors and senior professionals who are used to being the expert in the room. Give them roles that need restraint: in C17 the **editor** in the pitch (who may ask only three questions) or the **timekeeper-reader** who marks where attention dipped; in C18 the **supervisor** with the checklist (who must not rewrite the outline, only question it); in C19 the **judge** for another team's claims. Say it kindly: "Your eye is excellent. I want it on someone else's draft this round." In whole-class feedback use "a new voice first."
- ◆ **Topics stay safe.** Op-eds and research questions in this module stay in arts, food, technology, city life, work culture, education and science: no party politics, religion or immigration-policy debates. Every Commission card with an argument has an **assigned side**, so nobody has to reveal a personal opinion. Learners who prefer not to write personally can take a **writer identity card** (a food critic, a tech columnist, a city-life blogger...) and write in that persona's voice.

- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and words (*organisation, criticise, sceptical, rigour, marshalled, honour, centre, flat, full stop, humour*). Teach *organization, criticize, skeptical, rigor, marshaled, honor, center, apartment, period, humor*, and accept British forms whenever a learner uses them consistently. Lesson 6.3 turns the difference into content: learners compare US and UK conventions (quotation marks, the Oxford comma, dash spacing, collective nouns, *that / which*) and learn that the professional rule is **pick one house style and hold it**.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Earn the reader → carry the reader → never let the reader snag. In C17 learners write for someone free to leave: every sentence must earn the next, and the voice must fit the room (a broadsheet, a food blog, a trade magazine). In C18 the problem is distance: over 1,500+ words the reader can no longer see the whole, so the writer must build an architecture (a through-line, argued sections, signposts) and bring sources in without surrendering the argument to them. In C19 the scale shrinks to the single mark: a comma that rewrites a family, a dangler that makes the rain walk to work, a semicolon that balances two thoughts. Authority is all three at once: a reason to read, a structure to follow, and a surface the careful reader trusts.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: PERSONA, ASSIGNED SIDES, PRIVATE DRAFTS

Audience writing loves the personal anecdote, and anecdotes drift toward difficult moments. In class, **never require a true personal story**. Offer three routes for every anecdote: a real one, an invented one, or one from a **writer identity card**. Keep model texts light (lunch at your desk, a noisy food hall, night buses, a museum's free evenings). Drafts are read by **one** partner or a small group, never displayed to the whole class without the writer's consent; ask "May I share this line?" before boarding anything. Some learners come from places where publishing an opinion carried real risk: make it explicit that op-ed practice is a **craft exercise on an assigned side**, not a statement of belief. In C19, never board a learner's own error with their name, and never make a learner's accent or L1 "the example" of a punctuation habit.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): the six "publication rooms" picture cards (book, restaurant, tv, coffee, park, notebook), genre-move cards (C17), attribution-verb cards color-coded by stance and signposting cards (C18), and punctuation-mark and usage-test cards (C19). Cut them before C17.
- ◆ For C17: one set of **Commission cards** (8), cut so each learner draws one and the three members of a group hold different cards; **Pitch cards** (a writer card per learner and the four editor cards); one **Write-Critique-Revise rubric** per learner; the annotated model op-ed, review and feature for your own reference (set C). Colored pens help: the critic writes in a different color.

- ◆ For C18: one **Source Pack** per group of 3 (4 different packs, each with four short fictional sources); an **outline planner** and a **section-draft frame** per learner; **Supervision cards** A/B per pair.
- ◆ For C19: **Style-Sheet cards** A/B per pair; a set of **Rule, Convention or Myth?** cards per group; the four **Editing Race** station passages (one copy of each per team, placed at four "stations" around the room), the answer strips for you, and a scoreboard on the whiteboard.
- ◆ Print the **writer identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- ◆ Optional but powerful: bring in one real review and one real op-ed (from a local paper, a food blog, a trade magazine) on light topics. Learners enjoy finding the hook, the line and the concession in a real published piece, and seeing that professionals do exactly what the lesson teaches. Choose pieces free of party politics.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
6.1	C17 • wk 9	Writing for an audience: reader vs marker; the op-ed (hook → line → concession → rebuttal with evidence and anecdote → close that lands); the review (minimal description → grounded evaluation → calibrated verdict; no spoilers, no mush); the popular article / feature (headline, front-loading, subheadings, one reader); voice and matching the publication	pitch, draft, critique and revise a 250–350-word op-ed, review or feature for a named publication so that a peer reader does not stop, the line or verdict is clear and grounded, and the voice fits the outlet
6.2	C18 • wk 9	The long form: why length changes writing in kind; the through-line and the argued outline ("read the claims in order"); informative headings; signposting (backward, forward, locational); integrating sources (paraphrase vs quotation vs patchwriting; attribution verbs that encode stance); literature-review moves (consensus, divergence, building on, the gap); terminological consistency; the abstract	plan a 1,500–2,500-word research-style piece whose section claims form a necessary sequence, and draft one 250–300-word section that synthesizes at least two sources with precise attribution verbs and opens with a backward and a forward signpost
6.3	C19 • wk 10	Fine points: rule vs convention vs myth; semicolon, colon, em dash , the three volumes of aside, the comma splice; restrictive vs non-restrictive (<i>that / which</i> , the commas that carry meaning); the Oxford comma; parallelism ; dangling and misplaced modifiers (<i>only, almost</i>); agreement with tricky subjects, <i>who /</i>	find, correct and justify by name the usage and punctuation faults in an unfamiliar text under time pressure, leave the myths alone, apply one house style consistently, and use punctuation deliberately for rhythm and effect

LESSON

CLASS

FOCUS

LEARNERS CAN...

whom, fewer / less, the subjunctive; **US vs UK**
conventions

6.1 · C17

Writing for an Audience — Op-eds, Reviews & Articles

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain how writing for a free reader differs from writing for a marker (opening, voice, evidence, sentence rhythm, close) and diagnose "essay register in disguise"
- ◆ open with a **hook** that makes the second sentence unavoidable (a vivid particular, a provocation, a counter-intuitive claim, an anecdote) and cut throat-clearing (*In today's fast-paced world... · This article will discuss...*)
- ◆ state an op-ed's **line** in one breath, concede the strongest objection fairly (*The obvious reply is that... · None of this is to deny that...*) and rebut it with one statistic and one story
- ◆ write a review that moves from minimal description to **grounded evaluation** to a **calibrated verdict** (*What makes it remarkable is... · Where it falls short is... · For all its flaws...*), without spoilers and without mush
- ◆ match headline, structure and voice to a named publication and its reader, and close on a line that lands rather than summarizes

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 6.1 (New words, Genre toolkit, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Write–Critique–Revise frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 3–7 · Publication-room picture cards · Genre-move flashcards · **Commission cards** (8) · **Pitch cards** A/B · **Write–Critique–Revise rubric** (1 per learner) · annotated models (set C, teacher copy) · Writer identity cards · colored pens
- ◆ Listening scripts 6.1-A (the editor's call) and 6.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the contract. Marker = captive, paid to read every word. Reader = free, can leave at any line. →

Earn the next sentence. Delete: *In today's fast-paced world · This article will discuss · It is important to note that.*

Center: three genres. OP-ED: hook → line (one breath) → concede the best objection → rebut (1 statistic + 1 story) → close that lands (echo the hook). REVIEW: describe (minimal, no spoilers) → evaluate (every judgment anchored to a detail) → verdict (calibrated: a flaw in the rave, a strength in the pan). FEATURE: specific headline → payoff early → short paragraphs → subheadings → one reader.

Right: the room. Broadsheet · lifestyle blog · trade magazine · popular science · cultural column. Name the outlet → picture the reader → choose the voice. Rubric: Hook · Line/verdict · Grounding · Voice fit · Close · Precision (1–4 each). Test: **Where did you stop?**

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: headline decoding	7	S–S	Review C16 (5.3, authentic media, slang and cultural reference). Board three invented headlines that play on idiom or reference ("Food Hall Serves Up a Storm," "City Pulls the Plug on Night Buses — Then Plugs It Back In," "Is Your Inbox Eating Your Lunch?"). Pairs explain the wordplay and predict what each article argues. Ask: "Which one would you click? Why?" The headlines become today's lead-in. Note one precision and one naturalness example.
Lead-in: the reader who can leave	5	T–S	Slide 3 (the six publication rooms). Read two openings aloud (slide 4): "This article will discuss the topic of urban green spaces and their various benefits..." and "There is a park bench near my apartment that has, over three years, quietly done more for my mental health than any app I've downloaded." Ask: "You're on a train, half-distracted. Which one do you keep reading? What did the second writer do that the first didn't?" Elicit: a concrete image, a promise, no announcement. "Today: writing for someone who owes you nothing."
Meaning: three genres, one discipline	11	T–S → S–S	Slides 4–5. The op-ed arc (hook → line → concede → rebut → land); the review's three movements and the two opposite dangers (the timid describer, the reckless judge); the feature's front-loading and headline. Keep it brisk: these learners know the ideas; the point is the moves . Pairs sort the genre-move flashcards by genre in 90 seconds. CCQs (below).
Listening: the editor's call	6	T–S → S–S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 6.1-A (an editor calls a writer about a restaurant review draft). First listening: "Will the review be published? What's the main problem?" (Yes, after revision; it's a recap with no verdict.) Second listening: learners note the five changes the editor asks for. Pairs compare.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Close reading: the annotated model	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2. Learners read the model op-ed "Give Us Back the Lunch Hour" alone and label seven moves in the margin (hook, line, concession, rebuttal, evidence, anecdote, close), then write its line in one sentence. Pairs compare; board-check only disagreements. Ask: "Where is the voice strongest? Where does it disappear into the argument, and why is that good?"
Drill: the moves, aloud	5	T-S → S	See Drill script. Choral then individual: concede-then-turn with contrastive stress, the praise move, the measured criticism, the calibrated verdict, then a quick "hook it" round.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 3 (hook clinic) items 1–2 and Ex 4 (calibrate the verdict) alone; check in pairs. Ex 5 (match the publication) is quick and oral. Leave Ex 3 items 3–4 for homework.
Freer: Write–Critique–Revise Lab	30	S-S → S → S-S	Slide 7. Groups of 3. Pitch (4 min) : each learner draws a Commission card (outlet, reader, genre, topic, assigned side, word count). In pairs with Pitch cards, the writer pitches the piece in three sentences (hook, line or verdict, why this reader will care); the editor may ask only three questions. Draft (12 min) : alone, each learner writes the opening and body of a 200–250-word piece for the commission (they finish to 250–350 words at home). Critique (8 min) : swap within the group. The reader runs the " Where did you stop? " test (a small mark at the exact line where attention dipped), then scores the rubric and writes one strength and one suggestion, quoting the text. Revise (6 min) : writers rewrite the hook, the close and the paragraph where the reader stopped. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns on the board. Precision: "falls short to its ambition" → <i>falls short of</i> . Appropriacy: "one might argue" in a lifestyle blog. Naturalness: "In this article I will talk about..." Effect: a hook that promised a story and never delivered it (clickbait). With permission, read one excellent revised hook aloud.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 6.1 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." list.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Total	90		7 + 5 + 11 + 6 + 8 + 5 + 8 + 30 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the contract. An academic marker is paid to read every word; a reader of an op-ed, review or feature is not. Everything else (the hook, the voice, the varied rhythm, the landing) follows from that one fact.

SAY: "Your reader owes you nothing." Can they stop reading in the middle? (Yes, at any line.) Who is the marker? (Someone paid to read the whole thing.) So what is the job of every sentence? (To earn the next one.) · "In today's fast-paced modern world, technology is changing fast." Is it wrong? (No, it's grammatical.) Does it make the second sentence unavoidable? (No: it's throat-clearing.)

Meaning: the line and the concession. An op-ed argues *one* thing, sayable in a breath. Conceding the strongest objection early is not weakness; it earns a skeptical reader's trust.

SAY: "The obvious reply is that busy people are simply busy. That's true, and it's exactly the problem." Is the writer agreeing with the objection? (Partly: they grant it, then turn it.) Why grant it? (So a skeptic feels understood.) Could you persuade someone you seem not to have understood? (No.) · Is an op-ed a balanced essay? (No: it's a case made with conviction, fairly.)

Meaning: the calibrated verdict. Unrelieved praise reads as a press release; unrelieved scorn reads as a grudge. Authority comes from a grounded strength in a pan and an honest reservation in a rave.

SAY: "For all its flaws, it is a far better film than most that are flawless." Did the reviewer like the film? (Yes, mostly.) Does the film have problems? (Yes.) Which is more credible: this or "It's perfect, go now"? (This: the praise is believable because the criticism is there.) · "The food was amazing and the vibe was great." What's missing? (Grounding: which dish, what detail?)

Form: the genre toolkit.

Hook types	vivid particular · provocation · counter-intuitive claim · anecdote · the meta-turn	The last video store in town closed on a wet Thursday, and no one came to say goodbye. · We need to talk about how we talk about failure.
Concede → turn	It's tempting to think..., but · The obvious reply is that... · None of this is to deny that... · Granted, ...	None of this is to deny that the food hall is loud; it is to insist that loud is not the same as bad.
Reframe	The real question is not X but Y. · Here is what we too often forget: ... · If that sounds alarmist, consider...	The real question is not whether we can afford free museum evenings but whether we can afford empty museums.

Evaluate (review)	What makes X remarkable is... · Where it falls short is... · It never quite earns its... · The result is more X than Y.	What makes the album remarkable is its restraint. · The result is more museum than meal.
Verdict	For all its flaws, ... · worth the price of admission for ... alone · a must-read / must-see · where lesser work would..., this...	Worth the trip for the flatbread alone.
Feature	specific headline + standfirst (the one-line summary under it) · payoff early · one idea per paragraph · subheadings	"Why your 6 a.m. alarm may be sabotaging you" (not "Some thoughts on sleep")

Pronunciation: prose lives in the ear. Teach the read-aloud test as a revision tool. Concede-then-turn sentences depend on **contrastive stress** and a fall-rise on the concession: "It's **TEMPT**ing to think the problem is **NEW** ↘ ↗ | but the **EVI**dence points the **OT**her way ↘." The praise move puts the nucleus on the evaluative word: "What makes the book re**MARK**able | is not its **ANS**wers | but the **SHARP**ness of its **QUE**stions." Short "punch" sentences after long ones need a real pause before them. Watch *op-ed* (**OP**-ed, two syllables, not "oped") and *verdict* (**VER**dict).

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Concede, then turn** (choral, then individual; exaggerate the fall-rise): T: "remote work / lonely" → S: "It's tempting to think remote work is simply freedom, but for many people it's lonely." T: "food hall / loud" → "None of this is to deny that the food hall is loud; it's to insist that loud isn't bad." T: "phones at concerts" → "The obvious reply is that people paid for the ticket, and they can film what they like. And yet..."
- 2 Praise move:** T: "the novel / restraint" → S: "What makes the novel remarkable is its restraint." T: "the café / its bread" → "What makes the café remarkable is its bread." T: "the app / what it leaves out" → "What makes the app remarkable is what it leaves out."
- 3 Measured criticism:** T: "final act / ambition" → S: "The final act falls short of its ambition." T: "the second half / its promise" → "The second half never quite earns its promise."
- 4 Calibrated verdict:** T: "flawed but good film" → S: "For all its flaws, it's a far better film than most that are flawless." T: "overpriced but one brilliant dish" → "Worth the price of admission for the flatbread alone."
- 5 Hook it** (individual, fast): T reads a flat opening ("Libraries are important for communities.") → S offers a hook of a named type ("vivid particular, please"). Accept anything concrete; praise the ones that make you want the second sentence.

◆ WRITE-CRITIQUE-REVISE LAB – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3;** each member holds a different Commission card (outlet, reader, genre, topic, assigned side where relevant, 250–350 words). Topics: a new downtown food hall (review, lifestyle magazine), phone-free concerts (op-ed, arts section), night buses (feature, city magazine), a smart kitchen gadget (product review, tech blog), free Thursday evenings at the art museum (op-ed, local paper), the four-day week at a design studio (feature, HR trade magazine), a neighborhood bakery's sourdough (review, food blog), reply-all culture (op-ed, workplace column). Anyone may write as a **writer identity card** persona.
- ◆ **Pitch (4 min):** in pairs with Pitch cards A/B. A (writer) pitches in three sentences: the hook, the line or verdict, and why this outlet's reader will care. B (editor) has the outlet's reader profile on the card and may ask only three questions (give this role to a dominant speaker). Then swap. The third member of the group joins a pair as a second editor.
- ◆ **Draft (12 min):** silent writing, 200–250 words: the hook, the line or verdict, the body (op-ed: concession + rebuttal with one statistic and one story; review: minimal description → grounded evaluation → verdict; feature: payoff early, one subheading). No dictionaries for the first 8 minutes: write first, polish later. The close can be a placeholder.
- ◆ **Critique (8 min):** pass the draft to the left. The reader (1) reads once at normal speed and puts a small mark at **the exact line where attention dipped**, the "Where did you stop?" test; (2) scores the six rubric criteria 1–4; (3) writes one strength and one suggestion, quoting the text, in a different color. Writers listen and may only say thank you or ask a question.
- ◆ **Revise (6 min):** writers rewrite three things only: the hook, the close, and the paragraph where the reader stopped. Two volunteers read "before" and "after" hooks aloud (with permission).
- ◆ **Keep it honest:** a score of 2 is useful information, not a failure. At C2, the most valuable critique is usually about **effect** ("I stopped here because the example is general") rather than grammar.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE LAB

SAY: *In the pitch, how many sentences? (Three.) How many questions can the editor ask? (Three.) · Can you write your own opinion on an op-ed card? (Write the assigned side; it's a craft exercise.) Must the anecdote be true? (No: real, invented or from an identity card.) · In the critique, where do you put the mark? (Where my attention dipped.) Can the writer argue with the critic? (No: only thank you or a question.) · What do you revise? (The hook, the close, and the paragraph where the reader stopped.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some C2 speakers are far stronger orally than on the page (often learners who acquired English through work and immersion rather than schooling). Let them **draft aloud first**: they tell the piece to a partner for two minutes, the partner notes the best sentence, and that sentence becomes the hook. Give them a **move frame strip** (Hook: ... · The line: ... · The obvious reply is that... · And yet... · For all its flaws... · Close: echo the hook) and reduce the target to 150 words. In the critique they make excellent "Where did you stop?" readers: honest attention is the whole test. Fewer items: Ex 3 items 1–2, Ex 4 items 1–3.

STRETCH

Voice under constraint. Ask strong writers to produce the same opening for two outlets on the same Commission card (the broadsheet and the lifestyle blog) and to annotate every choice that changed (person, sentence length, metaphor, humor, hedging). Then set the harder genre problem: a **mixed review** whose verdict is genuinely balanced but still actionable ("Go for the bread; skip the mains"), or an op-ed whose close echoes the hook with a twist. For editors and academics: write the standfirst (one-line summary under the headline) and cut the draft by 20% without losing a single move.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **The exam-essay opening:** learners trained for IELTS, TOEFL or national exams often open with a memorized frame ("Nowadays, with the development of technology...", "It is a well-known fact that..."). It is a **genre transfer**, not an error: praise the discipline, then show that a free reader leaves at that sentence.
- ◆ **Delayed thesis:** many Chinese, Japanese and Korean writing traditions build toward the main point (and *ki-shō-ten-ketsu* structures use an unexpected turn before the conclusion). English op-eds and features front-load. Frame it as a **reader-responsibility** difference: in English audience writing, the writer does the work of making the point findable.
- ◆ **Ornate openings and long periodic sentences:** formal Spanish, Portuguese, Arabic and Persian prose often values elaborate, rhythmic introductions. At C2 this can be a real asset for voice; the fix is proportion and one short sentence after a long one.
- ◆ **Reluctance to use "I":** learners schooled in French, German, Russian or many Asian academic traditions may feel the first person is unprofessional. In audience writing it is expected, used with judgment. Conversely, learners from some US-influenced blogging cultures may overuse it.
- ◆ **Evaluation adjectives:** *interesting, nice, amazing, great, very good* carry no grounding. Push for the anchored detail and precise evaluative language (*restrained, overworked, generous, uneven, assured*).
- ◆ **False friends in reviews:** Spanish *actual* / French *actuel* ("the actual menu" = current), *sensible* ("a sensible performance" = sensitive), German *sympathisch* ("a sympathetic chef" = likable), *eventual* (= possible). Circle and ask "Is that what you mean in English?"

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_16.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back with the fall-rise on each concession; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the project: finish the in-class piece to 250–350 words for the named outlet, revised against the rubric and read aloud once. Workbook 6.1: Exercise 3 items 3–4, "My new words" and the journal (a hook and a close you admire from real writing, copied exactly, and one sentence on why each works).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** To make the second sentence unavoidable · Q2 **A** Anchoring each verdict to a specific detail, and noting a flaw even in a rave · Q3 (new) **C** "Go for the flatbread, forgive the service, skip the desserts: for all its flaws, Ember is the most interesting new kitchen downtown." Listening (Ex 1): 1 cut the plot-style recap of the evening to two sentences · 2 anchor "amazing" to a dish · 3 give a clear verdict · 4 add one reservation (the noise / the wait) · 5 replace the opening "In this review I will..." with a hook.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain why length changes writing in kind (the reader can't see the whole; the writer can't hold it) and plan before drafting
- ◆ write a **through-line** that makes a contestable claim, and build an **argued outline** of 5–7 sections whose one-line claims, read in order, form a necessary sequence, with informative headings
- ◆ orient a reader across sections with **backward, forward and locational signposts** (*Having established that...* · *The following section turns to...* · *The remainder of this report is organized as follows*)
- ◆ integrate sources by paraphrasing by default and quoting by exception, avoid **patchwriting**, and choose **attribution verbs** that encode stance (*demonstrates* · *claims* · *concedes* · *suggests* · *draws on*)
- ◆ use **literature-review moves** to synthesize rather than list sources (consensus, divergence, building on, identifying a gap, positioning your own contribution), and hold one term per concept across the piece

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 6.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Architecture Lab frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 8–13 · Attribution-verb flashcards (color-coded by stance) · Signposting cards · **Source Packs A–D** (1 per group of 3) · outline planners · section-draft frames · **Supervision cards A/B** · Writer identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 6.2-A (the supervision meeting) and 6.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: architecture. Through-line (a claim someone could disagree with) → 5–7 section **claims**, not topics → headings a skimmer can read the argument from. Test: **read the claims in order**. Could you reorder them without loss? → a list ("and also"), not an argument. Repair: the reverse outline (one sentence per paragraph: what does it actually do?).

Center: signposts at every seam. Backward: *Having established that...* · *As noted in Section 2...*

Forward: *This section argues that...* · *The following section turns to...* Locational: *The remainder of this report is organized as follows...* · *At this point it is worth stepping back...* One term per concept (no drift).

Right: sources serve the argument. Paraphrase (default) · quote (the wording is the point) ·

patchwriting (swapped synonyms = plagiarism). Stance verbs: *demonstrates* (accept) · *argues* (a position) · *claims* (distance) · *concedes* (against interest) · *suggests* (tentative) · *draws on* (extends).

Lit-review moves: *There is broad agreement that...* · *Whereas A..., B...* · *Building on...* · *Little attention has been paid to...* · *This study therefore...* Shopping list ✗ → synthesis ✓.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: hook swap	7	S-S	Review C17. Learners read their revised hook (from the homework) to a new partner, who must say the piece's line or verdict after hearing only the hook and the next sentence. Swap. Two volunteers share. Ask: "What did the hook promise? Did the second sentence keep the promise?" Collect or glance at the finished pieces; give individual written feedback on them before C19 (quote, name the effect, one alternative).
Lead-in: page nine	5	T-S	Slide 8 (book, notebook, desk, read). "A 1,000-word essay: the reader can hold the whole in view. A 10,000-word report?" Read the supervisor exchange on slide 10 briefly, or tell it: "I got lost around page nine." Ask: "Whose fault is that, the reader's or the writer's? What changes when a piece gets long?" Elicit: structure replaces good sentences as the main problem.
Meaning: architecture	11	T-S → S-S	Slides 9–10. The through-line; the argued outline vs the topic list (the "car-free centers" example from the online lesson); the "read the claims in order" test; informative vs generic headings; three directions of signposting. Pairs turn two generic headings into informative ones ("Background" → "Why the old model broke down"). CCQs (below).
Meaning: sources and the literature review	11	T-S → S-S	Slides 11–12. Paraphrase vs quotation vs patchwriting (show one original and a patchwritten version side by side); attribution verbs by stance; then the key move of the lesson: the shopping-list review ("Smith (2021) found... Lee (2022) found... Okafor (2023) found...") vs the synthesized review ("Although there is broad agreement that..., studies diverge on...; little attention has been paid to..."). Pairs label the moves in the synthesized model. CCQs.
Drill: stance and signposts	5	T-S → S	See Drill script. Stance ping-pong with attribution verbs (T gives the stance, S gives the verb and a sentence), then signpost completion, then stress on <i>conTEND</i> , <i>ABSTRACT</i> / <i>abSTRACT</i> .
Listening: the supervision meeting	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 6.2-A (a supervisor and a student discuss a draft chapter). First: "Is the supervisor happy with the writing? With the structure?" (The

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			sentences, yes; the structure, no.) Second: learners note the three problems and the three fixes. Pairs compare.
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (attribution verbs), Ex 3 (order the claims, write the headings) and Ex 4 (paraphrase, quote or patchwriting?) alone, then check in pairs. Board-check disagreements only. Ex 5 (shopping list → synthesis) begins in class if time allows, otherwise homework: it rehearses the Lab.
Freer: Architecture Lab	26	S-S → S → S-S	Slide 13. Groups of 3, one Source Pack each (A: background music and concentration at work · B: public libraries as community hubs · C: food-delivery apps and neighborhood restaurants · D: open-plan offices and collaboration). Plan (9 min) : each learner writes a through-line and 5–7 section claims with informative headings for a 1,500–2,500-word piece on the pack's question, using the outline planner. Supervision (4 min) : in pairs with Supervision cards: the supervisor reads the writer's section claims aloud in order and asks the card's questions; could they be reordered? Is the through-line contestable? Draft (10 min) : each learner drafts one section (250–300 words, usually the literature-review section) that synthesizes at least two sources with precise attribution verbs and opens with a backward and a forward signpost. Reverse-outline check (3 min) : swap; the partner writes one sentence per paragraph saying what it actually does and ticks the frame's checklist. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns. Precision: "Lee claims that the data demonstrate..." when the writer accepts the finding (→ <i>Lee demonstrates...</i>). Appropriacy: "I reckon the sources kind of disagree." Naturalness: "According to Smith, Smith says..." or "the author says" five times. Effect: a section with no signpost where a reader got lost; a shopping-list paragraph. Learners fix and name the move.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 6.2 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can..."
Total	90		7 + 5 + 11 + 11 + 5 + 6 + 9 + 26 + 5 + 5

Meaning: the argued outline. An outline is not a list of topics; it is the argument in miniature. Each section states what it *claims*. If the claims, read in order, tell a coherent story that could not be reordered, the piece will hold.

SAY: "1. History of cars in cities. 2. Traffic. 3. Pollution. 4. Businesses." Is that an argument? (No, a list of topics.) Could you swap sections 2 and 3? (Yes, nothing breaks.) What does that tell you? (There's no through-line.) · "The business objection, granted: retailers fear lost customers." Is that a topic or a claim? (A claim: it says something someone could check or dispute.)

Meaning: signposting. The writer can hold the whole piece in mind; the reader can't. Signposts tell the reader where they have been, where they are going, and where they are in the whole.

SAY: "Having established that remote work raises individual output, we now turn to the hidden cost." Which way does "Having established" look? (Backward.) And "we now turn to"? (Forward.) Why both at the start of a section? (To connect what's settled to what's next.) · Does a 600-word op-ed need "The remainder of this report is organized as follows"? (No: too heavy for the length.)

Meaning: attribution verbs and synthesis. The verb that introduces a source is never neutral: it tells the reader how far *you* accept the claim. A literature review is not a list of summaries; it shows how the sources relate and where the gap is.

SAY: "Okafor claims the app doubled sales." Does the writer fully accept that? (No: claims keeps a skeptical distance.) "Okafor demonstrates..."? (The writer accepts it as shown.) "Even Okafor concedes the sample was small." Is that against Okafor's interest? (Yes: an admission.) · "Smith found X. Lee found Y. Park found Z." Do we know how the three studies relate? (No: it's a shopping list.) "Whereas Smith and Lee report gains, Park's larger study finds none." Now? (Yes: they diverge, and we know why it matters.)

SAY: Paraphrase or patchwriting? Original: "Background music with lyrics significantly impaired performance on reading tasks." Version: "Background songs with words considerably damaged performance in reading activities." (Patchwriting: same structure, swapped synonyms; it counts as plagiarism even with a citation.) What's a real paraphrase? (Lyrics seem to get in the way of reading, Rossi (2021) found, though instrumental music did not.)

Form.

Stance verbs	accept · position · distance · admission · tentative · extension · neutral	demonstrates / shows / establishes · argues / contends / maintains · claims / asserts / alleges · concedes / acknowledges / grants · suggests / proposes / speculates · draws on / builds on · notes / observes / points out
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Lit-review: consensus	There is broad agreement that... · Most studies concur that... · A growing body of work suggests...	A growing body of work suggests that libraries are becoming community hubs (Garcia 2020; Nwosu 2022).
Lit-review: divergence	Whereas A..., B... · However, studies diverge on... · In contrast to..., ...	Whereas Garcia (2020) reports rising visits, Chen (2023) finds that book loans continue to fall.
Lit-review: building on / gap	Building on..., ... · Little attention has been paid to... · What remains unclear is...	What remains unclear is whether new visitors ever borrow books.
Positioning	This report therefore... · The present study addresses...	This report therefore asks what happens to the loan desk when the library becomes a hub.
Tense in reporting	present for a source's current argument; past for a specific study's finding; present perfect for a body of research	Rossi argues... · Rossi's 2021 study found... · Several studies have shown...

Pronunciation. Attribution verbs are often read but rarely heard, so learners guess the stress. Drill: **conTEND**, **mainTAIN**, **deMONstrate**, **esTABlish**, **asSSERT**, **aLLEGE**, **acKNOWledge**, **SPECulate**, **proPOSE**. Noun–verb stress pairs: an **ABSTRACT** / to **abSTRACT**, a **REcord** / to **reCORD**, a **SUBject** / to **subJECT**. *Synthesis* = **SYNthesis**; *synthesize* = **SYNthesize**. *Research* is accepted with either stress in US English (**REsearch** / **reSEARCH**); don't correct it. When presenting an outline aloud, pause at each seam and use a rising "list" tone on section claims until the last, which falls.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Stance ping-pong** (choral, then individual): T: "You accept it as proven: Rossi, the effect." → S: "Rossi demonstrates the effect." T: "You're skeptical: the brochure, a total cure." → "The brochure claims a total cure." T: "An admission: even the author, a small sample." → "Even the author concedes the sample was small." T: "Tentative: the paper, a possible link." → "The paper suggests a possible link." T: "Extension: the model, earlier work." → "The model draws on earlier work."
- 2 Finish the signpost:** T: "Having established that visits are rising, ..." → S: "...we now turn to the question of what visitors actually do." T: "The remainder of this report..." → "...is organized as follows." T: "This point..." → "...is developed further in Section 4."
- 3 List → synthesis** (individual): T: "Garcia: visits up. Chen: loans down." → S: "Whereas Garcia reports rising visits, Chen finds that loans continue to fall." T: "Most studies: noise hurts reading. Nobody tested older workers." → "Most studies concur that noise hurts reading, but little attention has been paid to older workers."

- 4 **Stress check:** T: "an abstract" → S: "an **AB**stract." T: "to abstract" → "to ab**STR**ACT." T: "contend / acknowledge / speculate" (choral).

◆ ARCHITECTURE LAB – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3**, one Source Pack per group; each pack holds four short **fictional** sources (author, year, type, key finding, one quotable line, a limitation). Say clearly that they are invented for practice and must not be cited in real work. Learners may also plan a piece from their own field instead (academics and professionals often prefer this); they still use the pack for the drafted section, or bring two real sources they know well.
- ◆ **Plan (9 min):** on the outline planner: the through-line in one sentence (a claim someone could disagree with), then 5–7 sections, each with an **informative heading** and a **one-line claim**, and a word budget per section adding up to 1,500–2,500 words. Mark where each source enters and the attribution verb it will get.
- ◆ **Supervision (4 min):** pairs with Supervision cards. The supervisor reads the writer's section claims aloud **in order, without the headings**, then asks the card's four questions (Is the through-line contestable? Could any two sections swap? Where is the strongest objection? Which term will you hold constant?). The supervisor may not rewrite; only question. Swap roles. Give the supervisor role to a dominant speaker first.
- ◆ **Draft (10 min):** each learner drafts one section of 250–300 words (the literature-review section is recommended). Frame checklist: ☐ opens with a backward and a forward signpost ☐ synthesizes at least two sources (consensus, divergence, or gap) ☐ at least three different attribution verbs, each chosen for stance ☐ at least one paraphrase and at most one short quotation ☐ one key term held constant ☐ ends by pointing forward.
- ◆ **Reverse-outline check (3 min):** swap drafts. The partner writes one sentence per paragraph describing what it *does* ("summarizes Garcia; contrasts Chen; names the gap") and ticks the checklist. A paragraph whose sentence is "summarizes a source" and nothing more = a shopping-list flag.
- ◆ The rest of the piece is not the homework; the online project is the outline and an abstract. Learners who want to write the full piece can bring it to C25 (the review project) or the 8.3 masterwork.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE LAB

SAY: *Is your through-line a topic or a claim? (A claim.) How many sections? (Five to seven.) What goes next to each heading? (A one-line claim.) · In the supervision, what does the supervisor read aloud? (The claims, in order.) Can the supervisor rewrite your outline? (No, only ask questions.) · How many sections do you draft today? (One.) How many sources must it bring together? (At least two.) Are the sources real? (No, invented for practice.) · In the check, what do you write for each paragraph? (What it does.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Long-form planning is a **visual** task: let these learners plan on sticky notes, one claim per note, and physically reorder them on the desk; the "read the claims in order" test becomes a real move they can see. Give them a **move strip** of five literature-review frames to copy and complete (There is broad agreement that... · Whereas..., ... · Building on... · Little attention has been paid to... · This report therefore...). Reduce the plan to 4 sections and the draft to one 120-word synthesis paragraph using two sources. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 4 items 1–2.

STRETCH

The whole piece in miniature. Ask strong writers to write the **abstract** (150–200 words: context → problem → method → findings → meaning) for their planned piece *before* leaving class, then check it against the outline: any finding in the abstract that no section delivers is a structural hole. Researchers can add a **positioning paragraph** that states the gap and the contribution in two sentences, and test **terminological drift** in their own real draft (circle every name for the key concept). Offer the harder synthesis: three sources that agree on the finding but disagree on the cause.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Source use and "respectful copying":** in some educational traditions (for example, parts of China, the Gulf, South and Southeast Asia, and Eastern Europe), reproducing an authority's exact words is a sign of respect and learning. Treat patchwriting as a **convention to learn**, not a moral failing, but be completely clear that in English-medium academic and professional writing it counts as plagiarism.
- ◆ **Reader-responsible prose:** Japanese, Korean and Chinese academic writing often expects the reader to infer connections; learners from these traditions may drop signposts because stating them feels condescending. The supervisor dialogue ("I knew where I was, so I assumed the reader did") is for them.
- ◆ **Digressive architecture:** German, Russian and some Spanish-language academic traditions tolerate (and sometimes admire) digressions and long theoretical preambles. The "read the claims in order" test shows where a digression breaks the sequence.
- ◆ **"Says" and "according to" as the only reporting tools**, and the double attribution "According to Smith, he says..." (common from Spanish *según*, Arabic *wafqan li*, Chinese 根据...). Push for stance verbs.
- ◆ **Tense of reporting:** learners from languages without the present perfect (Chinese, Russian, Arabic) or with different reporting norms may write "Many studies showed" for a body of research. Teach the three-way choice on the board plan.
- ◆ **Elegant variation:** French and Spanish school writing often penalizes repetition, so learners rename the key concept every paragraph (*knowledge-sharing* → *informal learning* → *tacit exchange*). In long-form English, a load-bearing term stays constant.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_17.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and repeat the signposts until they feel like reflexes; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the project (the full outline plus a 150–200-word abstract, built on today's plan). Workbook 6.2: Exercise 5 (shopping list → synthesis), revise the drafted section using the partner's reverse outline, "My new words" and the journal (a reverse outline of a long piece you have read, and whether it has a real through-line).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** You could not reorder the sections without breaking the argument · Q2 **C** Last, and it should summarize the whole, delivering the actual findings · Q3 (new) **B** "Whereas Garcia (2020) reports a sharp rise in library visits, Chen (2023) finds that loans continue to fall; what remains unclear is whether new visitors ever borrow books." Listening (Ex 1): problems: the reader gets lost (no signposts) · Section 3 has drifted off the through-line · the literature review is a list of summaries; fixes: open each section with a backward + forward signpost · cut or reframe Section 3 so it serves the through-line · regroup the sources by where they agree and disagree, and end on the gap.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ tell a meaning-bearing **rule** (danglers, restrictive commas, the comma splice) from a register **convention** (*whom*, the subjunctive *were*) and a **myth** (split infinitives, final prepositions, starting with *And*), and choose accordingly
- ◆ use the **semicolon** (two balanced independent clauses; lists whose items contain commas), the **colon** (delivering what the clause promised) and the **em dash** (an emphatic aside or turn), and choose among commas, dashes and parentheses as three volumes of aside
- ◆ distinguish **restrictive** and **non-restrictive** clauses (*that / which*, commas or none) and explain the change of meaning; use the Oxford comma where ambiguity threatens
- ◆ repair **faulty parallelism**, **dangling** and **misplaced modifiers** (*only*, *almost*, *even*), agreement with tricky subjects, *who / whom*, *fewer / less*, *between you and me* and the mandative subjunctive
- ◆ apply one **house style** consistently (US or UK quotation marks, dash spacing, the Oxford comma, collective nouns, *-ize / -ise*), and use punctuation deliberately for rhythm

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 6.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Editing Race score sheet, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 14–19 · Punctuation-mark and usage-test flashcards · **Style-Sheet cards** A/B · **Rule, Convention or Myth?** sort cards · **Editing Race** station passages 1–4 (one copy each per team) + answer strips (teacher) · scoreboard on the whiteboard · a timer
- ◆ Listening scripts 6.3-A (hear the punctuation) and 6.3-B (restrictive or not?)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the marks. ; two independent clauses, balanced (The rain stopped; the match resumed.) · list items containing commas. : delivers the promise (She had one goal: to win.) — a complete clause before it. — emphatic aside / turn, sparingly. Three volumes: , neutral · — loud · () quiet. ✗ comma splice: *It rained, we left.* → ; · . · and.

Center: meaning-bearing. My brother who lives in Berlin is a doctor. (several brothers) vs My brother, who lives in Berlin, is a doctor. (one brother) · that = identifies (US edited prose) · , which , = adds · Oxford comma: my parents, the chef, and the porter. · Danglers: ~~Walking to work, the rain soaked me.~~ → Walking to work, I... · *only / almost* right before what they limit · Parallel: *install, configure, and maintain.*

Right: rule · convention · myth. Tests: he/him → who/whom · drop the other person → you and me · count it? → fewer · whose action? → dangler · read it aloud → splice. Conventions: whom, subjunctive *were*, *that/which* strictness. Myths: split infinitive, final preposition, And/But at the start. US / UK:

"double" + ,. inside / 'single' + logical · word—word / word – word · Oxford comma usual / optional · the team is / is or are · Mr. / Mr · -ize / -ise or -ize. **Pick one; hold it.**

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: signpost relay	7	S–S	Review C18. Groups of 3: each learner states their through-line from C18, then the group builds a spoken relay for one learner's piece: A gives a backward signpost, B a forward one, C a locational one. Then one learner turns two "shopping-list" sentences on the slide into one synthesized sentence. Return the C17 pieces with your written feedback.
Lead-in: two commas and a family	4	T–S	Slide 14. "My brother who lives in Berlin is a doctor." / "My brother, who lives in Berlin, is a doctor." Ask: "How many brothers in each?" Let the class argue; then read both aloud (Script 6.3-B item 1) so they hear the pauses. "Two commas just rewrote a family. Today: the small marks that carry meaning, and the 'rules' that don't."
Clinic 1: punctuation	12	T–S → S–S	Slide 15. Semicolon (two uses), colon (what comes before must be a complete clause), em dash; the three volumes of aside (commas / dashes / parentheses) using the same sentence; the comma splice and its three cures; the Oxford comma that prevents a misreading. Restrictive vs non-restrictive: <i>that</i> without commas, <i>which</i> with them (strict in US edited prose, looser in British). Pairs punctuate four board sentences two ways and explain the difference. CCQs (below).
Clinic 2: usage	11	T–S → S–S	Slide 16. Dangers and misplaced <i>only</i> / <i>almost</i> (let learners laugh at the picture each faulty sentence paints: the coffee rushing to the train); parallelism in series and paired connectives; agreement (<i>each has, neither... nor</i> + nearer subject, <i>the box of chocolates is</i>); the quick tests (he/him, drop the other person, can you count it?); the mandative subjunctive (<i>that he be present</i>). Then slide 17: rule, convention or myth? Groups sort the 12 cards in 3 minutes and check.
Drill: hear the marks	4	T–S → S	See Drill script. Read-aloud pairs with and without commas (pitch drop and pause on the non-restrictive clause), the colon's suspense, the dash's sharp turn, and the "short sentence after a long one."

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Listening: hear the punctuation	6	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 6.3-A : six sentences read with clear pauses and intonation, no punctuation shown. Learners write the punctuation they hear (comma pairs, semicolon, colon, dash). Then Script 6.3-B: learners say "one" or "several" for each restrictive / non-restrictive pair.
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (restrictive or not?), Ex 3 (choose the mark) and Ex 4 (danglers and parallelism) alone; check in pairs. Ex 5 (US or UK?) is quick and oral, and feeds the style-sheet negotiation.
Style-sheet negotiation	5	S-S	Slide 17. Pairs with Style-Sheet cards : A is a copy editor at a US publisher, B is a British author whose manuscript is being published in the US (information gap: each card lists different preferences and one non-negotiable). In four minutes they agree a five-line house style for the book (quotation marks, dashes, Oxford comma, spelling, collective nouns) and write it down. Early finishers compare with another pair. This is also practice for 7.2's negotiation.
Freer: the Editing Race	22	S-S → T-S	Slide 18. Teams of 3 rotate through four stations (4 min each + 1 min to move), each with a short passage in a different genre (a café review, a research paragraph, a feature on night buses, an office memo). Each passage has a stated number of faults. Teams mark every fault, write the correction and name the point on the race sheet. Scoring : +1 correct fix · +1 correct name · -1 "false alarm" (changing a myth or a correct sentence, e.g. un-splitting an infinitive, "fixing" a sentence that ends with a preposition) · +2 bonus per station for one deliberate style improvement (a semicolon, colon or dash used for effect) that the team can justify. Final 2 minutes: you read the answer strips, teams self-score, and the class votes on the best style improvement. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns. Precision: "a colon after an incomplete clause" (<i>The ingredients are: flour...</i> → acceptable in some US styles, but better <i>The ingredients are flour...</i> or <i>You need three things: ...</i>). Appropriacy: <i>whom</i> in a friendly text. Naturalness: an infinitive contorted to avoid splitting it. Effect: five dashes in one paragraph. Learners fix and say "rule, convention or myth?"
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 6.3 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists for the module (see

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			Closing the Module).
Total	90		7 + 4 + 12 + 11 + 4 + 6 + 9 + 5 + 22 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: restrictive vs non-restrictive. A restrictive clause identifies *which one*; a non-restrictive clause adds information about something already identified. The commas, not just the word, carry the difference.

SAY: "The report that I sent yesterday is final." How many reports are there? (More than one.) Which one is final? (The one I sent yesterday.) • "The report, which I sent yesterday, is final." How many reports? (One.) Is "I sent it yesterday" needed to know which report? (No: it's extra.) • "The employees, who worked overtime, got a bonus." Did everyone get a bonus? (Yes, all of them; and all of them worked overtime.) Without commas? (Only the ones who worked overtime.)

Meaning: the marks.

SAY: "The rain stopped; the match resumed." Two sentences or one? (Two independent clauses, held together.) Could we use a comma? (No: that's a comma splice.) A period? (Yes, but the link is weaker.) • "She had one goal: to win." Does the colon promise something? (Yes: the goal.) "Her goals are: to win." (No: the clause before the colon isn't complete.) • "The proposal (after much debate) was approved." / "The proposal — after much, much debate — was approved." Which aside is louder? (The dashes.) Which almost whispers? (The parentheses.)

SAY: "Walking to the office, the rain soaked me." Who was walking? (Me, but the sentence says the rain!) Fix? (Walking to the office, I was soaked by the rain.) • "We almost drove 500 miles." Did we drive? (As written, no: we almost did.) What did the writer mean? (We drove almost 500 miles.) • "To boldly go." Rule, convention or myth? (Myth: splitting an infinitive is fine.)

Form.

Semicolon	independent clause ; independent clause • list items that contain commas	The café was full; the bakery next door was empty. • Lisbon, Portugal; Accra, Ghana; and Hanoi, Vietnam
Colon	complete clause : what it promised (list, explanation, example, punchline)	The menu has one weakness: dessert.
Em dash	aside or sudden turn; closed in most US book style (word—word), often spaced in newspapers and online (word — word); UK usually a spaced en dash (word – word)	They had planned for everything—and then the power failed.

Restrictive	that / who, no commas (identifies)	The app that crashed was mine.
Non-restrictive	, which / , who , (adds)	The app, which crashed twice, is free.
Parallelism	same form in a series and after paired connectives (not only... but also · either... or · both... and)	diligent, creative, and able to lead · not only skilled but also disciplined
Modifiers	an introductory participle attaches to the subject; <i>only / almost / even</i> go right before what they limit	Having finished the report, I found that the printer had jammed. · We sell only organic eggs.
Agreement	each / every / either / neither → singular · neither A nor B → nearer subject · head noun, not the intervening phrase	Each of the plans has merit. · Neither the manager nor the staff were told. · The box of chocolates is here.
Subjunctive	contrary-to-fact <i>were</i> · mandative base form after <i>insist, recommend, demand that</i>	If I were you... · The board recommends that she step down.

Pronunciation: punctuation is prosody. A non-restrictive clause is read on a **lower pitch** with a pause either side ("My brother | *who lives in Berlin* | is a doctor"); a restrictive clause runs straight through with no pause. A colon gets a slight rise and a held pause (suspense); a dash a sharper, shorter break; a semicolon a pause longer than a comma but with the voice not fully falling. Reading aloud is the best splice detector: at a comma splice the voice falls to a full stop and the ear hears the error. Model, don't lecture: learners copy you.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 One or several?** (T reads, class answers): "My sister | who lives in Madrid | is a lawyer." → "One sister." "My sister who lives in Madrid is a lawyer." → "Several sisters." Then learners read each version aloud, choral, then individual.
- 2 Colon suspense:** T: "She had exactly one demand ↗ | ... that the meeting be held in public ↘." Choral, then individuals with their own endings ("The menu has one weakness: ...").
- 3 Dash turn:** T: "They had planned for everything — and then the power failed." Stress the pause before *and then*. Choral.
- 4 Fix it fast** (individual): T: "between you and I" → S: "between you and me." T: "less mistakes" → "fewer mistakes." T: "Each of the proposals have merit." → "Each of the proposals has merit." T: "I insist that he is present." → "I insist that he be present." T: "To who should I write?" → "To whom should I write?"

◆ EDITING RACE – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Set up before class:** four stations around the room (tables or wall spots), each with one passage (set G): **Station 1** a café review (8 faults), **Station 2** a research paragraph (8 faults), **Station 3** a feature on night buses (8 faults), **Station 4** an office memo (8 faults). Each passage also contains two **traps**: a correct "myth" sentence (a split infinitive, a final preposition, a sentence starting with *And*) that must *not* be changed.
- ◆ **Teams of 3**, one race sheet per team, one pen. Roles rotate at each station: **editor** (marks the passage), **namer** (writes the name of each point: "comma splice," "dangling modifier," "non-restrictive commas"), **judge** (decides whether a change is a real fault or a myth). Give the judge role to a dominant speaker: they must listen to both teammates before ruling.
- ◆ **Timing:** 4 minutes per station, 1 minute to move (use a visible timer). Teams start at different stations. After four rounds, 2 minutes for scoring: read the answer strips aloud; teams self-score on the race sheet and you board the totals.
- ◆ **Scoring:** +1 each fault correctly fixed · +1 each correct name · -1 each false alarm (a myth "corrected," or a correct sentence changed) · +2 per station for one style improvement the team can justify (e.g. joining two related short sentences with a semicolon; a colon before a payoff). Ties are broken by the fewest false alarms.
- ◆ **Why the "name it" rule:** at C2 the goal is not to fix by instinct but to be able to explain a change to a colleague, a client or a student. A fix without a name scores half.
- ◆ **If time is short:** run three stations (3 × 5 min) and do Station 4 as homework. **Early finishers:** rewrite the station passage's weakest paragraph for rhythm (a long sentence, then a short one that lands).

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE EDITING RACE

SAY: *How many minutes at each station? (Four.) How many faults in each passage? (Eight.) · Do you just correct the fault? (No: correct it and name it.) What do you lose a point for? (Changing something that isn't wrong: a myth.) · Is "to really understand" a fault? (No: a split infinitive is fine.) · How do you get the bonus? (One style improvement we can justify.) Who decides if it's a fault or a myth? (The judge, after listening to both teammates.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give these learners the **quick-test card** (he/him · drop the other person · can you count it? · identify or add? · whose action? · read it aloud) and let them work **by ear**: in the race, the namer role suits a strong reader, while the learner who hears well reads the passage aloud and says "stop" at every snag. Pre-mark the number of faults per paragraph on their copy. Reduce the controlled practice to Ex 2 items 1–3 and Ex 4 items 1–3; target: hear and fix the comma splice and the dangler.

STRETCH

Punctuation as music. Give strong writers a flat paragraph of eight even sentences (the "reads flat" paragraph from the online lesson's editor dialogue) and ask them to rewrite it for rhythm using exactly one semicolon, one colon, one dash and one short sentence, then justify each mark in a margin note. For editors and translators: compare the house styles of two real publications (a US magazine and a UK newspaper) and write a six-line style sheet. For the hardest usage cases, discuss *none is / none are*, singular *they* (accepted in US and UK style guides), and *data is / data are* by register.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Comma splices by transfer:** Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian, Russian, Vietnamese and Chinese all allow (or tolerate) joining independent clauses with a comma. This is the most frequent fossilized error at C2. Put it on each learner's personal watch list.
- ◆ **German and Russian commas:** German requires a comma before *dass* and every relative clause, Russian before *что* and *который*, so learners write "I think, that..." and "The report, that I sent yesterday, is final" (a restrictive clause with non-restrictive commas). Contrast with English, where commas around a relative clause change the meaning.
- ◆ **French spacing:** French puts a space before **: ; ? !** ("Attention : ..."). Learners who write French professionally carry it over. Also French and Russian guillemets « » and German „...“ quotation marks.
- ◆ **Dashes for dialogue:** Spanish, Russian and French fiction use a dash to open dialogue. In English quoted speech uses quotation marks.
- ◆ **Hypercorrection is native too:** "between you and I" and "whom shall I say is calling?" are errors of *educated* native speakers. Tell learners so; it is a relief for them to know that some "native" usage they have copied is itself the error.
- ◆ **Arabic punctuation:** Arabic uses the comma (،) and *wa* ("and") far more freely between clauses, so long comma-linked chains are a natural transfer. Also watch the inverted comma form and question mark (؟) in typed work.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_18.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and read them aloud, letting the punctuation shape the pauses; do Exercises 1–3, the

Quick Quiz and the project (correct the flawed passage, justify three changes by name, and flag one convention-vs-rule judgment). Workbook 6.3: finish any Editing Race station you missed, "My new words" and the journal (proofread a page of your own writing for your personal watch list; name the fine point you most often miss).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 B The writer has one sister; that she lives in Madrid is extra information · Q2 A "Never end a sentence with a preposition" · Q3 (new) C "Having checked the figures twice, the analyst approved the report; the board, which met on Friday, agreed." Listening (Ex 1, Script 6.3-A): 1 The proposal, after much debate, was approved. · 2 The café was full; the bakery next door was empty. · 3 She had one goal: to win. · 4 They had planned for everything — and then the power failed. · 5 My colleague, who speaks four languages, translated the menu. · 6 We visited Lisbon, Portugal; Accra, Ghana; and Hanoi, Vietnam.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C19: MODULE 6 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 19, "earn, carry, polish": **a hook that makes the second sentence unavoidable, a line in one breath, a grounded verdict** (earn the reader) → **a through-line, claims in a necessary order, signposts at every seam, sources synthesized with stance verbs** (carry the reader) → **the comma that carries meaning, the dangler repaired, the myth left alone, one house style held** (never let the reader snag). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook and write their **personal watch list** (two or three fine points they will proofread for in every piece from now on) on the inside cover. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you; revisit it in the C20 warmer and in C25.

Watch for in Module 7: 7.1 (cross-cultural pragmatics) returns to **audience** from a new angle: the same op-ed hook or joke lands differently across cultures, so the "picture the reader" habit from C17 transfers directly. The C19 style-sheet negotiation is a low-stakes rehearsal for 7.2's negotiation; point it out. 7.3 (translation awareness) will reward the C19 learners who noticed their L1 punctuation habits.

Assessment: this module feeds the C26 final assessment. Before C26, check the final test and its key for the exact items; the skills to revise are an audience-aware piece for a named outlet (hook, line or verdict, grounding, close), a synthesized paragraph with stance verbs, and the fine points from 6.3 (comma splices, restrictive commas, danglers, parallelism, agreement, rule vs myth). The 8.3 masterwork is the natural home for the long piece learners planned in C18: encourage them to write it.

Module 7 — Communicating Across Cultures

Three classes about what happens when fluent English meets different unwritten rules. First, **cross-cultural pragmatics**: politeness strategies, directness and indirectness, small talk, compliments and silence, taboo *as a linguistic phenomenon* (euphemism, minced oaths, the euphemism treadmill) and humor that does or doesn't travel, with a repair toolkit for when the wires cross. Then **diplomacy and negotiation**: acknowledge-then-counter, positions versus interests, the BATNA, the conditional trade (*If you were able to..., then we could...*), face-saving and the cushioned difficult message, practiced in a full negotiation simulation between invented organizations. Last, **working between languages**: why word-for-word fails, false friends, the untranslatable, register loss, translation versus interpreting and the ethics of interpreting, with a lab in which learners may (voluntarily) bring their own languages into the room.

3 lessons

Lessons 7.1–7.3

Classes C20–C22

Weeks 10–11

90 min per class

CEFR C2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** (workbook) → a demanding **freer task** (a workshop, not a quick chat) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-7-across-cultures.html](#). Print [materials/module-7/classroom-materials.html](#) before C20. It holds the flashcards, the new identity cards, the **Critical-Incident Clinic** case cards and analysis frame, the **euphemism ladders**, the two **Negotiation Simulation** scenarios (confidential A/B briefs, prep sheet, observer checklist), the **Translation & Interpreting Lab** cards (ethics dilemmas, register rescue, plain-English sight texts, the untranslatables gallery), the **Bridge It!** board game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has Listen buttons, so learners can hear the dialogues and model sentences again at home, and shadow the tone, which matters more than usual in this module.
- These are workshop classes**. Each class spends roughly a quarter to a third of its time on one extended performance: diagnosing and bridging invented cross-cultural incidents (C20), a full multi-issue negotiation

(C21), a mediation lab with sight translation and interpreting-ethics dilemmas (C22). Protect that time. If you run late, shorten the controlled practice (set the rest for homework), never the workshop.

- ◆ **Refinement, not a first meeting.** These learners met implicature and irony in C2 Module 2 (C4–C6), register agility in 1.2 (C2), and diplomatic softening and hedging at C1 (C1 3.3). Don't re-teach "I was wondering if...". The C2 step is **calibration and metapragmatic control**: choosing the degree of directness for *this* person and moment, decoding what others' softeners are doing, repairing a misfire lightly, and being able to *explain* a pragmatic choice to someone else, which is exactly what a mediator does.
- ◆ **Feedback on four things.** At C2 accuracy is rarely the story. Take notes in four columns: **accuracy** (fossilized slips worth fixing: *I don't hope so, agree to disagree* used as a threat, *a false friend* like *actually* for "currently"), **range** (well-chosen moves to praise and spread: *I don't suppose there's any chance...*, *Where might there be room to move?*, *The nearest we get in English is...*), **appropriacy** (grammatical but miscalibrated: a hedge so heavy the refusal vanished, *with respect* used as a sneer, a joke at a colleague's expense) and **effect** (what the move *did* to the other person: Did they relax? Dig in? Save face?). In the feedback stage, board 2–3 items from each column, without names.
- ◆ **Peer review, every class.** Each workshop ends with a structured peer check, each with its own test: the **good-faith test** (C20: could both people in the incident read your analysis and feel fairly described?), the **"Can they sell it upstairs?" test** (C21: each negotiator states in one sentence how they will present the deal to their own side; if either can't, face wasn't saved) and the **"Explain it back" test** (C22: the listener explains the concept or text back in their own words; if the *meaning and the feeling* both arrive, the mediation worked). Reviewers always give **one strength** and **one suggestion**, in that order, and **quote the words** rather than summarizing.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** C2 classes often include confident professionals: managers, lawyers, teachers, interpreters. Give them the roles that need listening: in C20 the **good-faith auditor** (who may only ask questions until the group has written two readings), in C21 the **observer** or the **"board chair"** who hears the deal only at the end and must be convinced by it, in C22 the **listener who explains it back**. Say it kindly: "Your ear is excellent. I want you on the checklist this round." In whole-class feedback, use "a new voice first" before opening the floor.
- ◆ **Useful feedback for near-native learners.** Many of these learners are fluent beyond their teacher in some domains and fossilized in others. Don't praise fluency in general; praise a *specific* move and its effect ("Your 'Correct me if I'm wrong, but...' made him laugh and concede in the same breath"). Target fossilized items with a private written note, not a public correction. And ask for **metapragmatic reasoning**: "Why that softener, for that person, at that moment?" At C2, the explanation is part of the skill.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and some British idioms (*humour, recognise, cosy, cancelled, per cent, brilliant, have I got the wrong end of the stick?*). Teach *humor, recognize, cozy, canceled, percent*, and give the American equivalent of British-flavored idioms alongside the original (*Did I get the wrong idea? / Did I misunderstand you?*). Accept British forms whenever a learner uses them. This module is a good place to say it out loud: **varieties of English have pragmatic differences too** (understatement, for example), and none is the neutral default.

- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Read the rules → negotiate across them → carry meaning between them. In C20 learners notice that the same words can follow different rules, and practice decoding a hedge, handling a delicate topic and repairing a misfire, without ever turning a person into a stereotype. In C21 they take that calibration into the pressure-cooker: a negotiation where tone decides whether the other side digs in or works with you, and where the best deal comes from interests, not positions. In C22 they cross the widest gap: between languages, where the unit of meaning is the idea, not the word, and where the mediator's ethics matter as much as their vocabulary. Every class produces something another learner hears and judges: a bridge script, a signed deal, a mediated text.

CULTURE-SAFE CLASSROOM: SITUATIONS, NOT NATIONALITIES

This module is where a well-meant class can slide into stereotyping. Set the rules on day one (slide 2) and keep them all module. **(1) Talk about situations and settings, never nationalities.** Don't ask "In your country, how do people refuse?" Ask "In a setting you know well (a workplace, a family, a school, a community), what would be usual? And is everyone there the same?" **(2) Nobody speaks for a culture.** No learner is ever the "representative" or "example" of a country, a religion or a language community. Any learner can use an invented setting or a new identity card, with no reason given. **(3) Individuals, not types.** When a generalization slips out ("They're always so direct"), reframe it without shaming: "Some people, in some settings. What about the specific person in the story?" **(4) Humor has limits.** No jokes at the expense of nationalities, religions, accents or disabilities, and nobody performs an accent, their own or anyone else's. **(5) Taboo is studied as language.** We look at euphemism and mild substitutes (*passed away, let go, the facilities, darn, gosh*). Nobody is asked to say a swear word, name a taboo from their own language or describe what is taboo "where they come from." **(6) Own languages are voluntary.** In C22, learners *may* draw on their other languages; every task has an English-only route of equal value.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: INVENTED STAKES, AND THE CHILD INTERPRETER IN THE ROOM

Keep every negotiation and difficult message **invented and low-stakes**: room bookings, a coffee cart, a price rise, a launch date, a volunteer rota. **Never** role-play a firing or layoff, a salary cut, a disciplinary hearing, a medical diagnosis, a landlord eviction, a police, court or immigration interview, or a family conflict. Positions are **assigned** on cards; learners play the role and anyone can say "Pass." C22 needs particular care: many adult immigrants and refugees interpreted for their parents as children, or have depended on an interpreter (or a child) at a hospital, a benefits office or an immigration appointment. Those settings appear in this lesson **only as ethics discussed in the abstract** ("Why do professional interpreters exist?"), never as a role-play. If a learner shares such an experience, thank them, don't probe, and offer to talk after class. Journals always offer "a real one, an invented one, or one from a new identity card."

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): the four picture "moments" (coffee, cake, umbrella, email) for C20; politeness-strategy, repair and euphemism cards (C20); negotiation-move cards (C21); false-friend and mediating-frame cards and the four picture "everyday mediation" cards (menu, phone, book, passport) for C22. Cut them before C20.
- For C20: one set of **Critical-Incident Clinic** case cards (8 invented incidents: one per group of 3, two spare) and one **analysis frame** (Describe · Interpret · Evaluate · Bridge) per group; one set of **euphemism ladder** strips per pair.
- For C21: the **Negotiation Simulation**. Two scenarios (**The Hall** and **The Coffee Cart**), each with a confidential A brief and B brief, a **prep sheet** per learner and an **observer checklist** per group. Decide groupings in advance: two negotiators per side works best (A-pair vs B-pair, plus one observer), so groups of 5; with smaller classes, 1 v 1 + observer. Keep the A and B briefs in separate envelopes: the simulation only works if the other side's points stay secret.
- For C22: the **Translation & Interpreting Lab**: 8 ethics dilemma cards and 2 register rescue cards per group; the **untranslatables gallery** (a set of word cards on a side table); 3 **plain-English sight texts** (the English-only route). A week before, ask learners (optionally) to bring a **short, simple, public text** in any language they read: a recipe, a museum sign, a product label, a children's news story, a tourist leaflet. Say clearly: nothing personal, no letters, no medical or legal documents, and bringing nothing is completely fine.
- Print the **new identity cards** (six workplace profiles, each with an invented cross-cultural moment, a negotiation and a word to convey) and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- The **Bridge It!** board game (1 board per group, 1 die, counters) is for early finishers in C22 and the C23 warmer.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
7.1	C20 · wk 10	Cross-cultural pragmatics : directness vs indirectness in requests, refusals, criticism and disagreement; politeness strategies (bald on record, positive, negative, off record); small talk, compliment responses, silence; taboo as a linguistic phenomenon (euphemism, dysphemism, minced oaths, the euphemism treadmill) and signal-soften-defer for sensitive topics; humor (irony, self-deprecation, banter, understatement) and why it fails; the repair toolkit (notice · clarify · realign)	diagnose an invented cross-cultural critical incident from both sides in good faith, decode the softeners in it, and script and perform a bridge that repairs it (a softener, a clarifying check and a realigning line), without generalizing about any group

7.2 C21 · wk 11

Diplomacy and negotiation: acknowledge-then-counter, downgraded verdicts, regretful hedges, *with respect* used sincerely; **positions vs interests**, **BATNA** and the walk-away point; opening, exploring, the **conditional trade** (*If you were able to..., then we could... · provided that · as long as*), trading toward a package; **face-saving** (blame the situation, the golden bridge, credit the reasoning, "us vs the problem"); the **cushioned difficult message**; staying calm and assertive

prepare and conduct a multi-issue negotiation between invented organizations, exploring interests rather than trading positions, making conditional offers, protecting the other side's face, and closing on a written package both sides can "sell upstairs"

7.3 C22 · wk 11

Working between languages: why word-for-word fails (idiom, collocation, grammar); **false friends**; the untranslatable and culture-bound, conveyed by the **paraphrase pattern** (signal → literal image → plain meaning → feeling); **register loss**; translation vs interpreting (consecutive, simultaneous, sight translation); the **ethics of interpreting** (accuracy and completeness, impartiality, confidentiality, transparency, role boundaries, the first-person convention)

sight-translate a short, simple text of their choice into natural English (or render a dense English notice into plain spoken English), convey an untranslatable word so that a listener can explain it back with its feeling, and reason through an interpreting-ethics dilemma using the core principles

7.1 · C20

Cross-Cultural Pragmatics — Politeness, Taboo & Humor

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ place a request, refusal, criticism or disagreement on a **directness dial** and move it up or down on purpose, using the grammar of indirectness (*I don't suppose you could...? · Would there be any chance of...? · I was wondering whether...*)
- ◆ name the four **politeness strategies** (bald on record, positive, negative, off record) and explain which one a speaker chose and why
- ◆ **decode a softener as content** (*That would be quite challenging · I'll see what I can do*) and check its meaning without accusing: *When you said..., did you mean...?*
- ◆ discuss taboo as a **linguistic phenomenon**: place words on a dysphemism–neutral–euphemism ladder, explain minced oaths and the euphemism treadmill, and raise a sensitive topic with signal → soften → defer
- ◆ recognize why irony, self-deprecation, banter and understatement misfire across a gap, and **repair** a misfire lightly: notice, clarify, realign

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 7.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Critical-Incident Clinic frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Picture "moments" cards (coffee, cake, umbrella, email) · politeness-strategy, repair and euphemism flashcards · **Critical-Incident Clinic** case cards (8) + analysis frames · euphemism ladder strips · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 7.1-A (Maya and Jun: a misunderstanding, repaired) and 7.1-B (what do they really mean?)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the directness dial. Send me the file today. → Could you send it today? → I was wondering whether you could... → I don't suppose there's any chance of...? · Refusal: No, that won't work. ↔ That would be quite challenging. **An indirect refusal is still a refusal.** Strategies: bald on record · positive (we, compliments, in-group) · negative (hedge, apologize, give options) · off record (hint).

Center: delicate ground. Ladder: kicked the bucket · died · passed away (dysphemism → neutral → euphemism). Minced oaths: darn · gosh · heck. Treadmill: toilet → bathroom → restroom. Signal (May I ask something a little personal?) → soften (Some people find...) → defer (Say as much or as little as you like.)

Right: humor and repair. irony · self-deprecation · banter · understatement. Repair: notice (Did I get the wrong idea? / Have I got the wrong end of the stick?) → clarify (When you said..., did you mean...?) → realign (That's on me. Let's start again from there.) Default: **assume good faith**.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: fine points relay	7	S-S	Review C19 (6.3, fine points of usage and punctuation). Board five "almost right" sentences ("Less people came than we hoped." · "Between you and I, the plan is weak." · "Each of the proposals have merit." · "I wish it was otherwise." · "Walking into the room, the lights went out."). Pairs fix and justify each in 3 minutes (<i>fewer · you and me · has · were · As I walked in...</i>). Then twist: "Which of these could you say to a senior colleague without sounding pedantic if you corrected <i>them</i> ?" This opens today's theme: correct is not the same as well received.
Lead-in: same words, different rules	5	T-S	Slide 3 (four pictures: coffee, cake, umbrella, email). For each, one line: "So, how much do you pay in rent?" (coffee) · "You made this? It's amazing!" / "Oh, it's nothing." (cake) · "Lovely weather!" in a downpour (umbrella) · "Send me the figures by 3." (email). Ask: "Is any of these ungrammatical? (No.) Could any of them go wrong? How?" Elicit that the risk is in the <i>rules for use</i> , not the words. Set the culture-safe rules from slide 2: settings, not nationalities.
Meaning: directness and politeness strategies	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 4: the directness dial for four speech acts (request, refusal, criticism, disagreement). Key point: neither end is "more polite" in the abstract ; each is polite by its own rules. Slide 5: the four politeness strategies with one example each. Pairs get 3 minutes to sort six strategy flashcard examples. CCQs (below). Plant the C2 insight: "I'll see what I can do" can be a complete, courteous no.
Small talk, compliments, silence · taboo as language	9	T-S → S-S	Slide 6. Quickly: safe and risky small-talk topics, compliment acceptance vs deflection, silence as vacuum vs resource, and the default: match, then observe . Then taboo as a linguistic phenomenon : pairs order three euphemism ladder strips (<i>kicked the bucket · died · passed away; got the boot · was fired · was let go; the john · the bathroom · the facilities</i>) and say where each belongs.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			Introduce minced oaths (<i>darn, gosh, heck, shoot</i>) and the euphemism treadmill. Finish with signal → soften → defer for raising a sensitive topic.
Humor and repair	7	T-S	Slide 7. Four kinds of humor and why each can fail (a literal listener hears irony as a false statement; self-deprecation read as real low status; banter without a shared frame lands as a real jab; understatement underestimated). "What travels best?" (Warm, situational, gentle, self-directed.) Then the repair toolkit in three phases: notice, clarify, realign. CCQs.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Three rounds (see Drill script): dial it down, decode and check, repair it. Choral for the formulaic frames (with the tentative intonation), then individual.
Listening: a misunderstanding, repaired	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 7.1-A (Maya and Jun) twice, two voices if possible. First listening: "What deadline do they agree in the end?" (Monday.) Second: learners answer the "what did Jun mean" questions and complete the five repair phrases. Pairs compare. Ask: "Who adapts? (Both. The repair is mutual.)"
Controlled practice	7	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (label the strategy) and Ex 3 (decode the hedge and write a check) alone, then compare in pairs. Board-check only disagreements: most will be about Ex 2 items 3 and 8, which is good discussion. Ex 4 (euphemism ladders) and Ex 5 (humor repairs) are homework unless a pair finishes early.
Freer: Critical-Incident Clinic	22	S-S → T-S	Slide 8. Groups of 3 get one invented critical-incident card (a "yes" that wasn't, a silent video call, a deflected compliment, a welcome-lunch question, banter in week one, a blunt email, irony about the rain, "I'll think about it"). Round 1, Diagnose (8 min) : on the analysis frame, Describe only what was said and done (no adjectives about people), Interpret with at least two good-faith readings for each person, Evaluate which pragmatic dimension was in play (directness, silence, compliment, taboo/small talk, humor). Round 2, Bridge (7 min) : script the repair or the pre-emptive move: at least one softener, one clarifying check and one realigning line; rehearse it as

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			a two-person scene. Round 3, Perform and review (7 min): groups pair up, perform their bridge for each other, and run the good-faith test on each other's analysis (see below), then one strength and one suggestion, quoting the words. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction in four columns. Accuracy, for example: "I don't suppose you can send..." (needs <i>could</i>) · "Please feel free to not answer" (fine, but <i>not to answer</i> is the fixed frame) · "Have I got the wrong side of the stick?" Range: "Would there be any chance of...", "I'll leave it to you to say as much or as little as you like." Appropriacy: a clarifying check that sounded like an accusation ("So you lied when you said yes?"). Effect: which bridge made the other person visibly relax?
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 7.1 on screen; point at a Listen button beside the dialogue. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 10 + 9 + 7 + 6 + 7 + 7 + 22 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: pragmatics and the directness dial. Pragmatics is the meaning that isn't in the words but in how, when and to whom they are said. The same act (a request, a refusal) can be done at many points on a dial from bald to oblique; different settings expect different points, and the listener decodes accordingly.

SAY: "I don't suppose there's any chance of the file today?" Is it a question about my beliefs? (No: it's a request.) Strong or gentle? (Very gentle.) Why the negative? (It assumes the answer might be no, so the listener isn't cornered.) · "That would be quite challenging." Is it a yes with a warning, or a no? (In many settings, a courteous no.) What happens if you hear it as "doable"? (You commit to something that won't happen, like Maya.) · Is the direct end rude? (Not necessarily: in some settings it's honest and efficient.)

Meaning: politeness strategies. A useful research framework (Brown and Levinson) treats requests, refusals and criticism as **face-threatening acts**, with four ways to perform them: **bald on record** (direct, no softening: urgent or close relationships), **positive politeness** (closeness: *we*, *let's*, compliments, shared ground), **negative politeness** (distance and deference: hedges, apologies, options, *I don't suppose...*) and **off record** (a hint the listener must infer: *It's chilly in here*). The frame isn't in the online lesson; it gives C2 learners the metalanguage to explain their choices.

SAY: "Watch out, the step!" Softened? (No.) Rude? (No: it's urgent.) Strategy? (Bald on record.) · "You're a genius with spreadsheets. Can we look at this together?" What's the compliment doing? (Building

closeness before the ask: positive politeness.) · "Gosh, it's chilly in here." Is it about the temperature? (Maybe: it could be a hint to close the window.) Can the speaker deny it was a request? (Yes: that's why it's off record.)

Meaning: taboo as language. Every language fences off some topics (death, money, the body, illness, bodily functions). Languages respond with **euphemisms** (softer words: *passed away*), **dysphemisms** (deliberately harsher or jokier words: *kicked the bucket*) and **minced oaths** (disguised swear words: *darn, gosh, heck, shoot*). Euphemisms wear out: as a polite word takes on the associations of the thing it names, a new one replaces it (**the euphemism treadmill**: *toilet* → *bathroom* → *restroom*). We study this *as language*, with mild examples only.

SAY: *"She passed away last spring." Softer or harder than "died"? (Softer.) Where would you use it? (A condolence card, a conversation with the family.) "He kicked the bucket." When might someone say that? (Joking, about someone not close, or to lighten a heavy moment; risky in front of family.) · "Oh, shoot!" Did the speaker swear? (No: it's a mild substitute, a minced oath.) · Why do English speakers say "restroom" in a restaurant, when nobody rests there? (It's a euphemism; the older word felt too direct.)*

Meaning: humor and repair. Humor depends on a shared frame; across a gap it's the first thing to fail, and a failed joke can look like an insult. The skill is less the joke than the **light repair**.

SAY: *A new colleague arrives late on day one. "Working part-time already?" Is it a joke? (For the speaker, yes: teasing.) What might she hear? (A real criticism.) Why? (No shared history yet: banter needs a relationship.) · "Sorry, that was meant as a joke, and not a very good one." Long or short? (Short.) Do you explain why it was funny? (No: drop it and move on.) · "Have I got the wrong end of the stick?" British or American flavor? (British. American: "Did I get the wrong idea?" / "Did I misunderstand?")*

Form.

Negative + modal question	I don't suppose + could / would	I don't suppose you could take another look? · I don't suppose there's any chance of...?
Distancing	past / progressive / <i>would</i>	I was wondering whether... · Would there be any chance of...? · Might it be possible to...?
Conditional cushion	If + it's not too much trouble / you have a moment	If it's not too much trouble, could you...?
Hedged disagreement	concede + counter + open door	I see where you're coming from, but... · I see it slightly differently, though I may be missing something.
Clarifying check	When you said X, did you mean Y? · Just so I don't assume, are you	When you said "we'll see," did you mean it's unlikely?

	saying...?	
Offering an exit	feel free not to + verb · leave it to you	Please feel free not to answer. · Tell me if I'm straying into something you'd rather not discuss.
Repair	notice · clarify · realign	I think I may have misread that. · Let me play that back to you... · That's on me. No harm done.

Pronunciation. Tentative frames only work with a tentative **tune**. Model a slow start and a **fall-rise** at the end of softened requests and hedges: "I don't sup**POSE** you could...?" ↘ ↗, "That would be quite **CHAL**enging..." ↘ ↗ (the fall-rise signals "there's more I'm not saying"). A flat or fast delivery turns the same words into sarcasm. In repair phrases, keep the pitch low and the pace unhurried: "That's on **ME**." A light **laugh-voice** on "and not a very good one" signals the joke is dropped. Linking: *I don't suppose* /aɪ 'dəʊn(t) sə'pəʊz/ (American /daʊn(t) sə'pəʊz/), with the *t* nearly silent.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Dial it down** (choral first, fall-rise tune): T: "Send me the file." → S: "I don't suppose you could send me the file?" T: "Move your bag." → "If it's not too much trouble, could you move your bag?" T: "Check the figures again." → "I was wondering whether you might check the figures again." T: "I disagree." → "I see it slightly differently, though I may be missing something."
- 2 Decode and check:** T says a hedge; S gives the likely meaning, then a check. T: "I'll see what I can do." → S: "Probably no. When you say you'll see, do you mean it's unlikely?" T: "It's an interesting idea." → "Maybe not keen. Can I check what you mean by interesting?" T: "We'll have to see." → "Uncertain or no. Just so I don't assume, are you saying it probably won't happen?"
- 3 Repair it:** T describes a misfire; S repairs. T: "Your joke fell flat." → S: "Sorry, that was meant as a joke, and not a very good one." T: "You talked over your colleague." → "That's on me for talking over you; let's back up." T: "Your question was too personal." → "Please tell me if I'm straying into something you'd rather not discuss."
- 4 Up the ladder** (euphemism): T: "died" → S: "passed away." T: "fired" → "let go." T: "old people" → "older adults / seniors." T: "the toilet" → "the restroom / the facilities." Then reverse one for humor: T: "passed away" → S (jokey, informal only): "kicked the bucket." Ask: "Where would that be risky?"

◆ CRITICAL-INCIDENT CLINIC – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **What a critical incident is.** A short, invented, true-to-life moment where two people behaved reasonably by their own rules and still misread each other. The cards give **names and settings only, never nationalities**. If a group asks "Where is he from?", answer: "It doesn't matter, and it wouldn't tell you what *he* meant. Work from what he said."

- ◆ **Groups of 3**, with three roles: **scribe** (writes on the frame), **voice of person 1** and **voice of person 2** (each argues for the good-faith reading of their person). Give one dominant speaker the extra job of **good-faith auditor**: they may only ask questions until two readings are written.
- ◆ **Round 1, Diagnose (8 min)**: Describe (only observable words and actions: "Ravi said 'Yes, yes, I understand'", not "Ravi was evasive") · Interpret (at least two good-faith readings for *each* person) · Evaluate (which dimension: directness, silence, compliment, small talk/taboo, humor; what each person was probably trying to do).
- ◆ **Round 2, Bridge (7 min)**: write the exact words that would repair the moment afterward, *or* pre-empt it. Checklist: ☐ a softener ☐ a clarifying check (*When you said..., did you mean...?*) ☐ a realigning line (*That's on me / We'll get the hang of each other*) ☐ responsibility taken, not assigned. Rehearse it as a two-person scene; mind the tune.
- ◆ **Round 3, Perform and review (7 min)**: two groups pair up. Each performs its bridge (60–90 seconds) and reads its Interpret box. The other group runs the **good-faith test**: "Could both people in the incident read this analysis and feel fairly described?" Flag any sentence that judges a person or a group ("typical," "they always"). Then one strength and one suggestion, quoting the words.
- ◆ **Share**: one bridge is performed for the whole class. Ask: "What did the repair cost the person who made it? (Very little.) What did it save?"

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE CLINIC

SAY: *Where are the people in the story from? (It doesn't say, and it doesn't matter.) In "Describe," can you write "he was rude"? (No: only what was said and done.) How many readings for each person? (At least two, both in good faith.) What three things must your bridge include? (A softener, a clarifying check, a realigning line.) In the review, what's the question? (Could both people feel fairly described?) Can you say "Pass" or use a new identity card? (Yes.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some very fluent speakers write far less easily than they speak (often learners with interrupted schooling or literacy in a non-Latin script). Give them the case card **read aloud** by a partner and a **bridge strip** of six ready frames to choose from (*I think I may have misread that · When you said..., did you mean...? · Just so I don't assume... · That's on me · No harm done · Let's start again from there*). They take a voice role in Round 1 (arguing a reading aloud) rather than the scribe role, and perform the bridge. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–5, Ex 3 items 1–3. Target: one good-faith reading said aloud, and one complete notice → clarify → realign repair performed with the right tune.

STRETCH (TOWARD PROFESSIONAL MASTERY)

Metapragmatic commentary. Ask strong learners to take a real, public, non-personal text (a company's apology email, a customer-service reply, an out-of-office message) and annotate every politeness strategy in it, then rewrite it twice: one notch more direct, one notch more indirect, and say which reader each version would suit. In the Clinic, their bridge must also include an **off-record** move that the other person could safely ignore. Ask them to explain in two sentences why a strategy that works with one colleague could backfire with another, *without* naming any group.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS (LANGUAGE TRANSFER, NOT NATIONAL CHARACTER)

- ◆ **Answering negative questions:** speakers of Japanese, Korean, Chinese and some other languages often answer the *proposition*: "You don't mind? — Yes" (meaning "Yes, that's right, I don't mind"). In English this reads as the opposite. A pure transfer of grammar that looks like a pragmatic clash. Teach: *No, not at all / No, I don't mind*.
- ◆ **Imperative + please as neutral:** in Russian, Polish, Czech, Arabic and others, a polite imperative is ordinary courtesy, so "Please send me the report today" feels soft to the speaker and firm to many English listeners. Offer the question and distancing forms.
- ◆ **Present-tense requests:** Spanish, Portuguese and Italian *¿Me pasas...? / Me passa...?* → "You pass me the salt?" and "You send me the file?" Tie it to *Could you...? / Would you mind...?*
- ◆ **"I want" and "must":** Spanish *quiero*, Arabic *ureed*, German *müssen*, French *il faut* can surface as "I want that you..." or "You must...", far stronger in English than intended. At C2 these are fossilized; flag them privately.
- ◆ **"Please feel free to not answer":** split infinitives are fine in English, but the fixed courtesy frame is *feel free not to*. Also watch the invented "Please feel free for not answering."
- ◆ **False-friend politeness words:** Spanish *constipado* (= has a cold) used for "constipated" can land a speaker in exactly the embarrassing territory euphemism avoids; French *sensible* (= sensitive); German *eventuell* (= possibly) → "I'll eventually come" meaning "I might come." Keep a board corner for them; they return in C22.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_19.html. Listen to the Maya and Jun dialogue with the Listen buttons and shadow it, exaggerating the softening tones; say the five model sentences back; do Exercises 1–2, the Quick Quiz and the "Bridge a Real Difference" project (a real difference, an invented one, or the one on a new identity card: all three are equally good, and nobody has to describe their own culture). Workbook 7.1: Exercises 4 and 5, "My new words" and the journal (one moment when a pragmatic difference surfaced, described as a situation, not a stereotype, and the one line you'd use now).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** It may well be a polite "no": treat the hedge as the answer · Q2 **C** Lightly acknowledge it ("Sorry, that was meant as a joke") and move on · Q3 (new) **B** "Oh, enough to keep me in coffee! How are you finding the new office so far?" Listening (Ex 1): 1 Thursday isn't realistic (an indirect refusal) · 2 "I'll certainly do my best" · 3 Jun went quiet (the silence) · 4 end · talked · on · back · hang · 5 Monday.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ disagree, refuse and hold a line without hostility, using **acknowledge-then-counter**, downgraded verdicts and regretful hedges (*I take your point; my only concern is... · I have one or two reservations · I'm afraid I can't quite see how...*)
- ◆ separate **positions** (what someone says they want) from **interests** (why they want it), know their own **BATNA** (best alternative to a negotiated agreement) and walk-away point, and explore the other side's interests with open questions
- ◆ make **conditional trades** with remote conditionals and conditional connectors (*If you were able to..., then we could... · provided that · as long as · on condition that · What if we were to...?*) and build a **package** rather than haggle one issue at a time
- ◆ protect the other side's **face**: blame the situation, credit their reasoning, offer a **golden bridge**, move from "you vs me" to "us vs the problem"
- ◆ deliver a **difficult message** that is clear and early, then cushioned (signpost → state → explain → look forward), and stay calm and assertive under pressure with a holding phrase

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 7.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Negotiation prep sheet, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · Negotiation-move flashcards · picture cards (bill, notebook) · **Negotiation Simulation**: scenario 1 **The Hall** and scenario 2 **The Coffee Cart** (confidential A and B briefs in separate envelopes), prep sheets, observer checklists · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 7.2-A (Rosa and Daniel: a delicate negotiation) and 7.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: firm on substance, warm on person. You're wrong. → I appreciate where you're coming from, but I see it differently. · That's a bad idea. → I have one or two reservations. · No. → I'm not sure we'll be able to do that, I'm afraid. · We'll never agree. → We may have to agree to differ. · You didn't deliver. → Things didn't quite go to plan.

Center: the machinery. POSITION = what they say (Thursday mornings or nothing) · INTEREST = why (clients need a big screen) · BATNA = best alternative if no deal (hotel room at \$150) · walk-away point. Moves: open → explore (What matters most to you here?) → propose conditionally: **If you were able to X, then we could Y** · provided that · as long as · What if we were to...? → package → close (Shall we say...?)

Right: face and hard news. Blame the situation (The timing has been against us) · Credit the reasoning (Your logic was sound given what we knew) · Golden bridge (With the new figures in, it'd be completely

reasonable to revisit this) · Us vs the problem. Cushion: signpost → STATE → explain → forward.
Holding phrase: Let me make sure I understand your concern.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: decode and repair	7	S-S	Review C20. Hold up five hedge flashcards one at a time (<i>That would be quite challenging · I'll see what I can do · It's an interesting idea · We'll have to see · Mm, maybe next time</i>). Pairs say the likely meaning and a clarifying check. Then two euphemism ladders from memory. Quick round: one learner reads their homework bridge line (invented incidents welcome); the class names the three phases. Collect journals, or glance at them.
Lead-in: the price is what it is	5	T-S	Slide 9. Board: "Our costs have gone up. We need a higher price." Ask: "Can you change the content? (No.) What can you change? (The tone, the framing, the offer around it.)" Read the brutal and the diplomatic versions of one line aloud. "Today: firm on substance, warm on person, and a negotiation where the best deal isn't a split down the middle."
Meaning/Form: diplomatic language and face	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 9 table (blunt → diplomatic → what the softening does). Highlight three shapes: acknowledge-then-counter, the downgraded verdict, the regretful hedge. Warn about weaponized courtesy (<i>with respect</i> as a sneer). Then face-saving (slide 11, lower half): blame the situation, credit the reasoning, the golden bridge, "us vs the problem". Pairs turn three blunt workplace lines into diplomatic ones in 2 minutes. CCQs.
Negotiation: positions, interests, BATNA, the conditional trade	10	T-S	Slide 10: position vs interest with the meeting-room example (two teams, one room); elicit two interests behind each position; then BATNA (the best thing you can do if there's no deal) and why it sets your walk-away point: "Never accept a deal worse than your BATNA; never reveal it as a threat." Slide 11: the moves (open, explore, propose conditionally, trade, package, close) and the grammar of the conditional trade: remote <i>If you were able to...</i> vs open <i>If you can...; provided that, as long as, on condition that, supposing, What if we were to...?</i> CCQs.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Drill	6	T-S → S	Three rounds (see Drill script): diplomatic swap, make it a trade, hold the line. Choral for the frames, with a calm, even pace, then individual.
Listening: a delicate negotiation	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 7.2-A (Rosa and Daniel), slide 12 as support after the first listening. First listening: "What's the final deal?" (3% for twelve months, rate frozen, in writing today.) Second: Ex 1 questions (the trade, the numbers, Daniel's real interest). Pairs compare. Ask: "Who won? (Both: the deal was built on interests.)"
Controlled practice	7	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (blunt → diplomatic) and Ex 4 (demands → conditional trades) alone, then check in pairs; board-check disagreements only. Ex 3 (positions, interests, BATNA) is done in the simulation prep. Ex 5 (the cushioned message) is homework.
Freer: Negotiation Simulation	28	S-S → T-S	Slide 13. Two invented scenarios, run side by side (neighboring groups get different ones): The Hall (Harbor Lane Community Center vs Blue Heron Youth Robotics Club: shared use of a hall) and The Coffee Cart (Maplewood Public Library vs Fernside Coffee Co-op: a cart at the library entrance). Each side has a confidential brief with its interests, a points table and its BATNA. Prep (8 min) : same-side pairs fill in the prep sheet: interests ranked, BATNA, walk-away point, three conditional offers, one face-saving line, one holding phrase. Negotiate (12 min) : A-side vs B-side; the observer uses the checklist; a written deal on the deal sheet, or an honest "agree to differ." Debrief (8 min) : each side runs the "Can they sell it upstairs?" test (one sentence each: how will you present this to your board?), then sides reveal their points and compare with their BATNA; observers give one strength and one suggestion, quoting a line. Whole class: which groups found the package where both sides scored high? ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns. Accuracy: "If you would be able to..." · "provided you will sign" (<i>provided you sign</i>) · "agree to disagree" used as a door slam. Range: "Where might there be room to move?", "What if we were to...?", "Your logic was sound given what we knew." Appropriacy: a BATNA revealed as a threat; "with respect" said through the teeth. Effect: the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			moment the other side's shoulders dropped, and what caused it.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 7.2 and a Listen button beside the Rosa and Daniel dialogue. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		7 + 5 + 10 + 10 + 6 + 7 + 7 + 28 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: diplomatic language. The content may be fixed (the answer is no, the price is higher); the tone is yours. Diplomatic language lowers the temperature so the other person can move without feeling cornered. It is honest: it changes the framing, never the truth.

SAY: "I have one or two reservations about that approach." Does she like the approach? (Not really.) Is it a verdict or a concern? (A concern: downgraded.) Why downgrade? (It leaves the other person room to improve it.) · "With respect, we may have to agree to differ." Has anyone lost? (No.) Is the discussion over? (On this point, yes.) · "With RESpect..." said slowly through the teeth: diplomatic? (No: it's contempt in a velvet glove. The words only work if the respect is real.)

Meaning: positions, interests and BATNA. A **position** is the demand on the table; an **interest** is the need underneath it. Two positions can be incompatible while the interests fit together. The **BATNA** (Fisher and Ury, *Getting to Yes*) is what you'll do if no agreement is reached; it tells you when to walk away. The online lesson gestures at this ("naming your alternative without threat"); the kit makes it explicit.

SAY: "We need the big room every Thursday morning." Position or interest? (Position.) Ask "why?": "Our clients have to see the demo on a large screen." (Interest.) Could another room with a big screen work? (Maybe: interests open options.) · "If this doesn't work out, we'll book the hotel room at \$150 a morning." What is that? (Their BATNA.) Should they accept a deal that costs them \$200 a morning? (No: it's worse than the BATNA.) Should they say "Give us the room or we go to the hotel"? (No: it's a threat, and it closes the door.)

Meaning: the conditional trade and face. Every concession is tied to a return, so nothing is given away for nothing and the talk moves toward a package. Face = a person's dignity and public self-image; a person who can move without losing face will move.

SAY: "If you were able to commit to twelve months, then we could hold the rate." Is Rosa promising to hold the rate? (Only if Daniel commits.) Why "were able to" and not "can"? (More tentative: it offers without pushing.) · "With the new figures in, it'd be completely reasonable to revisit this." Was the other person wrong before? (No: the situation changed.) What does it give them? (A dignified way to change

position: a golden bridge.) · "You keep missing the deadline" vs "How do we get the timeline back on track?" Which invites a defense? (The first.) Which invites a solution? (The second.)

Form.

Acknowledge → counter	I appreciate / take / see + your point / where you're coming from, but...	I take your point; my only concern is the timeline.
Remote conditional trade	If you were able to / were to + verb, (then) we could / would + verb	If you were to extend the deadline, we could absorb the extra scope.
Conditional connectors	provided (that) / as long as / on condition that + present simple (not <i>will</i>)	We could move on price, provided the timeline shifts.
Hypothetical proposals	What if we were to...? · Supposing we..., would you...? · How would you feel about...?	Supposing we added a Saturday, would you consider a longer term?
Face-saving framing	situation as subject · agentless · shared <i>we</i>	The timing has been against us. · Things didn't quite go to plan. · I don't think either of us saw this coming.
Closing	Shall we say...? · So, to recap... · I'll put it in writing.	Shall we say three percent, twelve months, rate frozen?

Pronunciation. In negotiation, **pace and pitch** carry authority. Model a slower pace, lower pitch and **falling** tones on the substance ("the budget is locked ↘"), with rising or fall-rise tones only where you invite response ("What matters most to you here? ↗"). In conditional trades, put **contrastive stress** on the two sides of the exchange: "If **YOU** could move on the **TIMELINE**, then **WE** could look again at the **PRICE**." In *agree to DIFFer* the stress is on *differ*; in *reSERvations* on the third syllable. For holding phrases, a deliberate pause *before* speaking ("Let me take a moment... before I respond to that") signals calm, not weakness.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Diplomatic swap** (calm, even pace): T: "You're wrong." → S: "I appreciate where you're coming from, but I see it differently." T: "No." → "I'm afraid we won't be able to do that." T: "That's a bad idea." → "I have one or two reservations about that approach." T: "You failed." → "Things didn't quite go to plan on this occasion." T: "We'll never agree." → "With respect, we may have to agree to differ on this one."
- 2 Make it a trade:** T gives two halves; S joins them with the cue. T: "you pay a deposit / we deliver early (provided)" → S: "We could deliver early, provided you pay a deposit." T: "you commit to twelve months / we hold the price (If you were able to)" → "If you were able to commit to twelve months, then we could hold the price." T: "we add Saturdays / you sign for a year (What if)" → "What if we were to add Saturdays, and you signed for a year?"

- 3 **Explore, don't argue:** T states a position; S asks for the interest. T: "We need it by Friday." → S: "Help me understand what's driving Friday." T: "We won't pay more than \$50." → "What matters most to you in the budget?" T: "Thursday or nothing." → "What would Thursday give you that another day wouldn't?"
- 4 **Hold the line** (T pushes; S stays calm): T (sharply): "This is unacceptable!" → S (slowly): "Let me make sure I understand your concern." T: "Just give me a yes or no!" → "I'd like to take a moment before I respond, so I give that a fair answer."

◆ NEGOTIATION SIMULATION – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Set-up.** Groups of 5 (A-pair, B-pair, observer) or 3 (A, B, observer). Neighboring groups get different scenarios. Hand each side its **confidential brief** in an envelope. Say it twice: "Your points table is secret. Don't show it. Don't compare your points with the other side's: the tables measure different things."
- ◆ **The design.** Both scenarios have five issues. Some matter a lot to one side and little to the other (in The Hall: storage matters hugely to the Robotics Club and costs the Center little; cleaning matters to the Center and costs the Club little). Groups that **haggle issue by issue** and split every difference land around the middle; groups that **explore interests and trade across issues** find a package in which both sides score well above their BATNA. Don't tell them this in advance; it's the debrief.
- ◆ **Prep (8 min):** same-side pairs fill in the prep sheet (Workbook 7.2): position, interests ranked, BATNA, walk-away point, the other side's likely interests, three conditional offers, one face-saving line, one holding phrase. Circulate and ask each pair: "What's your BATNA worth? So what's the worst deal you'll accept?"
- ◆ **Negotiate (12 min):** open with a position, not an ultimatum. The observer ticks the checklist and writes down **one quote** for each move. At minute 10, call "two minutes": they must close on the deal sheet (all five issues filled in) or agree to differ honestly.
- ◆ **Debrief (8 min):** (1) The **"Can they sell it upstairs?" test:** each side says in one sentence how it will present the deal to its board or members ("We've secured a year of steady income and the club will handle cleaning"). If a side can't say it with a straight face, face wasn't saved. (2) Sides reveal their points and compare them with their BATNA. (3) Observer: one strength, one suggestion, quoting. (4) Whole class, 2 minutes: board the scores; ask the highest-scoring groups what they traded.
- ◆ **If a group deadlocks:** that's a legitimate outcome if both sides' BATNAs really are better. Ask them to close well: "We may have to agree to differ; let's keep the door open for the spring."

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SIMULATION

SAY: *Are you playing yourself? (No, the brief.) Can you show your points table? (No.) Should you compare points with the other side? (No: they measure different things.) What's your BATNA? (What we do if there's no deal.) Do you accept a deal worse than your BATNA? (No.) Do you announce your BATNA as a threat? (No.) What grammar do you use for offers? (If you were able to..., then we could... / provided*

that.) What must be on the deal sheet at the end? (All five issues, or "agree to differ.") What's the test? (Can each side sell it upstairs?) Can you say "Pass"? (Yes.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Pair the learner with a stronger reader on the same side, so the brief is read aloud and discussed. Give a **six-line move card**: "Ideally, we'd be looking at... / What matters most to you here? / If you were able to..., then we could... / We could move on..., provided... / I take your point; my only concern is... / Shall we say...?" and let them be the **voice** of the pair while the partner keeps the notes. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 4 items 1–3. Target: one complete conditional trade and one acknowledge-then-counter, said aloud in the simulation.

STRETCH (TOWARD PROFESSIONAL MASTERY)

Packages and anchors. Teach **multiple equivalent simultaneous offers**: put two or three packages on the table at once ("We could do \$55 with the storeroom, or \$45 with the cabinet: which works better for you?"), then read the other side's choice as information about their interests. Discuss **anchoring** (the first number shapes the range) and how to re-anchor gracefully ("That's a long way from where we'd need to be; let me explain our costs"). After the simulation, they write a 120-word **deal memo** to their board: clear decision first, then the reasons, framed so the board's face is saved too.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Conditional connectors + will**: "provided you will sign," "as long as you will pay," "on condition that you will..." (common transfer from future-marked languages, including French, Spanish, Portuguese and Italian, where the subjunctive or future appears after similar connectors). English uses the present simple: *provided you sign*.
- ◆ **"If you would be able to..."**: learners over-use *would* in both clauses. Teach the remote pattern: *If you were able to..., we could...* (though *If you would* as a polite request, "If you'd sign here," is fine).
- ◆ **"Agree to disagree" as a door slam**: learners from exam-trained systems deploy it to end a discussion. The idiom is courteous only when it keeps the door open; at C2, prefer *We may have to agree to differ on this one, for now*.
- ◆ **Modal strength**: German *müssen*, Russian *нужно*, French *devoir* → "You must lower the price," which sounds like an order in English negotiation. Offer *We'd need..., It would help us if...*
- ◆ **False friends in the deal**: Spanish/Portuguese *discutir* and Italian *discutere* (often "argue" as well as "discuss"): "We discussed" may be heard as calmer than the speaker meant, or vice versa; French *compromis* and Spanish *compromiso* (= commitment as well as compromise); German *Konsequenz* (= consistency, also consequence). A *compromise* in English can sound like both sides losing; a *package* or *solution* doesn't.

- ◆ **Numbers under pressure:** *thirteen/thirty, fifteen/fifty* stress (*thirTEEN / THIRty*); percentages ("three percent," not "three per cents"). Always confirm figures in writing: *Just to confirm, that's fifty, five-zero?*

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_20.html. Shadow the Rosa and Daniel dialogue with the Listen buttons, matching its calm, even pace; say the five model sentences back; do Exercises 1–2, the Quick Quiz and the "High-Stakes Conversation" project (script both sides of an **invented** negotiation or difficult message: a price, a schedule, a shared resource; the new identity cards each have one). Workbook 7.2: Exercise 5 (the cushioned message), "My new words" and the journal (a high-stakes conversation, real, invented or from a card, rewritten from "you vs me" to "us vs the problem").

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** "If you were able to move the deadline, then we could look again at scope." · Q2 **C** The listener may not realize they were turned down and feel misled later · Q3 (new) **B** your best alternative if no agreement is reached. Listening (Ex 1): 1 material costs have risen across the whole sector · 2 the budget is more or less locked · 3 commit · could · 4 10% · 3% · 5 predictability / something he can defend to his own bosses (not having the same conversation in six months) · 6 put it in writing (today).

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain why word-for-word translation fails (idiom, collocation, grammar) and treat **the idea, not the word**, as the unit of translation
- ◆ spot and warn against **false friends**, and keep a personal false-friend list
- ◆ convey an untranslatable or culture-bound word with the **paraphrase pattern** (signal → literal image → plain meaning → feeling) and the mediating frames (*The closest equivalent would be...* · *It literally means...*, *but we'd actually say...* · *The nearest we get in English is...*, *though that loses...*)
- ◆ distinguish translation, consecutive and simultaneous interpreting, and **sight translation**, and carry **register and tone** across the switch
- ◆ reason through an **interpreting-ethics** dilemma with the core principles: accuracy and completeness, impartiality, confidentiality, transparency, role boundaries and the first-person convention, and know when a professional interpreter is needed

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 7.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Lab record, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · Picture "everyday mediation" cards (menu, phone, book, passport) · false-friend and mediating-frame flashcards · **Translation & Interpreting Lab**: 8 ethics dilemma cards, 2 register rescue cards, 3 plain-English sight texts, the untranslatables gallery · learners' own short texts (optional) · New identity cards · Bridge It! boards (early finishers)
- ◆ Listening scripts 7.3-A (Ana and Tom: *sobremesa*) and 7.3-B (the helpful volunteer: spot the ethics breaches)

BOARD PLAN

Left: why word-for-word fails. IDIOM: Je te tiens au courant ≠ "I hold you in the current" → I'll keep you posted. COLLOCATION: *make* a decision / *take* a photo. GRAMMAR: I have 30 years → I'm 30. False friends: embarazada = pregnant · actuellement = currently · Gift = poison · libreria = bookstore · eventuell = possibly. **Unit = the idea.**

Center: the paraphrase pattern. signal (There isn't a single English word for it, but...) → literal image (It literally means "over the table"...) → plain meaning (the talk after a meal) → feeling (not being in a hurry). Frames: The closest equivalent would be... · Think of it as a kind of... · The nearest we get is..., though that loses...

Right: between speakers. Translation (written, time) · Interpreting: consecutive (chunks) / simultaneous (booth) / sight translation (text → speech). Register survives the crossing. Ethics:

accurate & complete · impartial · confidential · transparent ("Interpreter speaking: may I check a word?") · first person ("I have two children") · know your limits.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: trade it!	7	S-S	Review C21. Board four blunt demands ("Pay by Friday." · "Lower the fee." · "Give us Saturdays." · "Sign for a year."). Pairs turn each into a conditional trade with a different connector (<i>If you were able to...</i> · <i>provided</i> · <i>as long as</i> · <i>What if we were to...?</i>), then add one face-saving line to the hardest. One pair reads its best trade; the class checks the tense after <i>provided</i> . Ask one or two groups: "Could you sell your deal upstairs?"
Lead-in: I hold you in the current	4	T-S	Slide 14 (menu, phone, book, passport): "When did you last mediate between languages: glossing a menu, checking a phone translation, explaining a word to a friend?" (Answers voluntary; "never" is fine.) Board: "I hold you in the current." "Grammatical? (Yes.) Meaningful? (No.) It's French <i>Je te tiens au courant</i> . What would an English speaker say?" (I'll keep you posted.) "Today: meaning, not words."
Meaning: why word-for-word fails · false friends	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 15. The three mismatches (idiom, collocation, grammar) with one example each; "machine translation makes exactly this mistake, often." Then false friends: the six from the online lesson on the slide; pairs have 2 minutes to add any they know between <i>any</i> two languages (voluntary; English-only examples like <i>eventually</i> / <i>possibly</i> count). Board them in a "danger map" corner. CCQs.
Meaning: the untranslatable and the paraphrase pattern	10	T-S	Slide 16. <i>hygge</i> , <i>saudade</i> , <i>Schadenfreude</i> , <i>sobremesa</i> : the words aren't untranslatable, they're un-one-word-able. Model the pattern with <i>sobremesa</i> , then elicit it for <i>tsundoku</i> from a gallery card. Point out the reverse direction too: English words other languages borrow or struggle with (<i>cozy</i> , <i>awkward</i> , <i>binge-watch</i> , <i>brunch</i>). Mediating frames on the board. CCQs.
Translation vs interpreting · ethics	8	T-S	Slide 17. Translation (written, time to craft) vs interpreting (live, real time): consecutive, simultaneous, and sight translation (reading a written text aloud in another language on the spot). Register and tone must survive. Then the core ethics principles found in professional interpreter codes: accuracy and completeness, impartiality, confidentiality,

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			transparency, role boundaries, the first-person convention. Say plainly: in many public services in the U.S. (hospitals, courts, schools) people have a right to a professional interpreter, and children should not be asked to interpret in high-stakes settings. Discuss in the abstract only.
Drill	5	T-S → S	Two rounds (see Drill script): mediating frames, and first person. Choral for the frames with an easy, explanatory rhythm, then individual.
Listening: <i>sobremesa</i>	5	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 7.3-A (Ana and Tom) once; learners map Ana's explanation onto the four steps of the pattern and note what Tom's "closest equivalent" loses. Pairs compare.
Controlled practice	7	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (false friends) and Ex 3 (why word-for-word fails: label and fix) alone, then compare. Board-check disagreements. Ex 4 (paraphrase idioms) and Ex 5 (register and ethics) are homework unless a pair finishes early.
Freer: Translation & Interpreting Lab	24	S-S → T-S	Slide 18. Part 1, Ethics and register (8 min) : groups of 3 take two ethics dilemma cards (a volunteer interpreting at a parent-teacher conference, a rude remark at a community meeting, a joke that won't cross, a number you didn't catch...) and one register rescue card ; for each dilemma they name the principle at stake and script what the interpreter should say. Then listen to Script 7.3-B as a class (2 min of the 8) and count the volunteer's breaches. Part 2, Mediate (13 min) : same triads, roles mediator · listener · checker , three rounds of about 4 minutes. The mediator chooses: (a) sight-translate a short, simple text they brought, in any language they read, into natural spoken English; or (b) render one of the dense English sight texts into plain spoken English; or (c) convey an untranslatable word, their own or from the gallery. The listener then runs the " Explain it back " test; the checker notes one register-and-tone point and one frame used. Part 3, Share (3 min) : two mediators repeat their best rendering for the class. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Four columns. Accuracy: false friends that slipped out ("actually" for "currently," "eventually" for "possibly," "sensible" for "sensitive"), "It literally means..., but we'd actually say..." with the wrong tense. Range: "The nearest we

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			get in English is..., though that loses..." Appropriacy: a rendering that flattened a friendly text into officialese (register loss), or an interpreter who "helpfully" added advice. Effect: which rendering made the listener smile or say "Oh, I get it"? Close the module with slide 19 (see Closing).
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 7.3 and a Listen button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick all three "I can..." lists.
Total	90		7 + 4 + 10 + 10 + 8 + 5 + 5 + 7 + 24 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the unit of translation is the idea. A mediator first asks "What does this mean, and what is it *doing* here?" and only then looks for the natural target-language way to do the same job, which may share no words with the original.

SAY: "I hold you in the current." Is the grammar wrong? (No.) Is the meaning there? (No: it's a literal rendering of an idiom.) What job is the French doing? (Promising updates.) So in English? ("I'll keep you posted.") Same words? (None.) Same job? (Yes.) • "She did a mistake." Is it an idiom problem? (No: collocation. English makes mistakes.)

Meaning: false friends. Words that look or sound alike across languages but mean different things. They're dangerous because the sentence stays grammatical and the word *feels* right.

SAY: "Actuellement, je travaille à Lyon" → "Actually, I work in Lyon." What's wrong? (Actuellement means "currently.") Does the English sentence look wrong? (No, and that's the danger.) • Which false friends are most dangerous for you? (Only the ones between your languages: that's why the list must be personal.) • Are all similar words false friends? (No: most cognates are true friends. Suspect the too-convenient match; don't distrust them all.)

Meaning: the untranslatable. Culture-bound concepts can't be carried by one word, but they can be conveyed: give the category, then paint the situation and the feeling.

SAY: "Saudade is a kind of longing." Enough? (No: it's just the category.) What's missing? (The situation and the feeling: longing for someone loved and absent, nostalgia with an ache in it.) • "The closest we'd get is 'chatting over coffee after dinner,' but that loses the sense that it's a whole custom." What is Tom doing? (Offering an equivalent and flagging what it loses.) Is that a failure? (No: it's honest mediation.)

Meaning: translation, interpreting, ethics. Translation = written, with time to research and revise. Interpreting = spoken, in real time: **consecutive** (the speaker pauses; the interpreter renders each chunk), **simultaneous** (almost at the same time, usually from a booth) and **sight translation** (a written text read aloud in another language on the spot). Professional interpreters speak in the **first person** ("I have two

children," not "She says she has two children") and step out of it transparently only to manage the conversation ("Interpreter speaking: may I ask the speaker to repeat the number?").

SAY: *A speaker makes a rude remark. Should the interpreter soften it? (No: accuracy and completeness. The listener has a right to hear what was said, and in the same register.) · The parent asks the volunteer, "What would you do?" Should the volunteer answer? (No: impartiality and role boundaries. "I'm only here to interpret. You could ask the teacher.") · After the meeting, a neighbor asks what was said. (Confidential: say nothing.) · You didn't catch a number. Guess? (Never: ask, and tell both sides you're asking.) · A child interpreting at a hospital appointment: good idea? (No: that's what professional interpreters are for.)*

Form.

Signal the gap	There isn't a single English word for it, but... · We don't really have a word for that in English.	There isn't a single English word for <i>hygge</i> , but...
Literal vs real	It literally means..., but what we'd actually say is... · Word for word it's..., but...	It literally means "over the table," but really it's the talk after a meal.
Approximate	The closest equivalent would be... · The nearest we get in English is..., though that loses... · Roughly, it's the feeling of...	The nearest we get is "cozy," though that loses the social side.
Describe use	It's the word we use when... · Think of it as a kind of... · You'd say it when...	It's the word we use when you wear something for the first time.
Warn	Careful with that word: it looks like..., but it really means...	Careful: <i>eventuell</i> looks like "eventually," but it means "possibly."
Interpreter's voice	first person for the speaker · third person only to manage: <i>The interpreter would like to...</i>	"I have two children." · "Interpreter speaking: may I check one word?"

Pronunciation. Borrowed words: model them once and accept approximations; nobody is marked on Danish vowels. *hygge* /'hju:gə/ (often anglicized "HOO-guh"), *Schadenfreude* /'ʃa:dənfrɔɪdə/, *saudade* /sau'da:də/ (Portuguese varieties differ), *sobremesa* /soβre'mesa/. More important is the **explanatory rhythm**: a slight pause after the signal ("There isn't a single English word for it... | but"), stress on the contrast in *it LITerally means..., but what we'd ACTually say...*, and chunked, unhurried delivery in sight translation. Give learners time-buyers for live mediation: *Let me put that another way... · What she's saying, roughly, is...* (the second only in informal mediation, never in professional first-person interpreting).

- 1 **Frame it** (easy, explanatory rhythm): T: "hygge, no single word" → S: "There isn't a single English word for it, but the closest equivalent would be a kind of cozy contentment." T: "I hold you in the current" → "It literally means 'I hold you in the current,' but what we'd actually say is 'I'll keep you posted.'" T: "actuellement, trap" → "Careful with that word: it looks like 'actually,' but it really means 'currently.'" T: "saudade, feeling" → "Roughly, it's the feeling of longing for someone you love who isn't there anymore." T: "sobremesa, use" → "It's the word we use for the lingering talk at the table after a meal."
- 2 **First person, please:** T reads a reported line; S renders it as an interpreter would. T: "She says she has two children." → S: "I have two children." T: "He's asking if the fee can be waived." → "Can the fee be waived?" T: "She says she's sorry she's late and the bus didn't come." → "I'm sorry I'm late. The bus didn't come." T: "He wants to know what time practice ends." → "What time does practice end?" Then T: "You missed a number." → S: "Interpreter speaking: could you repeat the number, please?"

◆ TRANSLATION & INTERPRETING LAB – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Own languages are voluntary, always.** Every part has an English-only route of equal value, and nobody is asked to translate for the class, teach a word or "represent" a language. Learners who share a language may choose to work together; nobody should be paired *because* of a shared language without asking.
- ◆ **Part 1, Ethics and register (8 min):** each group takes two **ethics dilemma cards** and one **register rescue card**. For each dilemma: ☐ name the principle(s) at stake (accuracy/completeness · impartiality · confidentiality · transparency · role boundaries · competence) ☐ script the interpreter's exact words ☐ decide whether a professional interpreter should be there instead. For the register card: restore the original tone to a flattened rendering. Then, all together, **Script 7.3-B:** the teacher reads what was said and what the volunteer "interpreted"; groups count the breaches (there are six).
- ◆ **Part 2, Mediate (13 min):** triads, three rounds, rotate roles. **Mediator** (about 2 minutes): option (a) **sight translation** of a short, simple, public text they brought (recipe, sign, label, children's news story), read aloud directly in natural English, not word by word; option (b) render a **plain-English sight text** (a dense English notice) into friendly spoken English for a neighbor; option (c) **convey** an untranslatable word (their own or from the gallery) with the paraphrase pattern. **Listener:** runs the **"Explain it back" test:** "So what you're telling me is..." (meaning) "...and it feels..." (feeling/tone). **Checker:** notes on the lab record ☐ idea not words ☐ register kept (friendly stays friendly, formal stays formal) ☐ one mediating frame used (quote it) ☐ any false-friend trap.
- ◆ **Sight-translation tips to give first:** read the whole text silently first (30 seconds); chunk it into ideas; start with the main point; if a word won't cross, paraphrase and keep going; keep the tone of the original.
- ◆ **Part 3, Share (3 min):** two mediators repeat their best rendering for the class; the class says what the original text was *for* and what tone it had.
- ◆ **Early finishers:** the **Bridge It!** board game.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE LAB

SAY: *Do you have to use your own language? (No: there's an English route.) Can you bring a letter from the bank or the doctor? (No: public, simple, non-personal texts only.) In sight translation, word by word or idea by idea? (Idea by idea.) If a word won't cross? (Paraphrase and keep going.) What does the listener do? (Explain it back: the meaning and the feeling.) In the ethics cards, can an interpreter leave out a rude remark? (No.) Give advice? (No.) Guess a number? (No: ask, transparently.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Learners with limited literacy in their first language (or in any script) can do the lab entirely **orally**: option (c), conveying a word or idiom they know from speech, is just as demanding and needs no reading. Give a **frame strip** with the four steps of the paraphrase pattern and four frames. For the ethics cards, a partner reads the card aloud; the learner decides the principle from a picture-free list of six single words. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–6, Ex 3 items 1–4. Target: one complete signal → image → meaning → feeling explanation that a partner can explain back.

STRETCH (TOWARD PROFESSIONAL MASTERY)

Back-translation and the translator's note.

Learners who work in two languages sight-translate a short text into English, then a partner who shares the language (if any) back-translates it; they compare what drifted. Others write a 60-word **translator's note** justifying one choice (why they kept an image, dropped a pun or changed the register). Try 60 seconds of **whispered simultaneous interpreting** (*chuchotage*) of the teacher reading a plain-English sight text into simpler English, and discuss why professionals rotate every 20–30 minutes. For ethics: when is **cultural brokering** (explaining a cultural point) part of the job, and how do you do it transparently so both sides know?

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS (FALSE FRIENDS BY FIRST LANGUAGE)

- ◆ **Spanish:** *actualmente* (= currently), *asistir* (= attend), *carpeta* (= folder), *éxito* (= success), *librería* (= bookstore), *constipado* (= has a cold), *embarazada* (= pregnant), *sensible* (= sensitive). **Portuguese:** *pretender* (= intend), *puxar* (= pull), *assistir* (= watch/attend).
- ◆ **French:** *actuellement* (= currently), *éventuellement* (= possibly), *assister à* (= attend), *librairie* (= bookstore), *sensible* (= sensitive). **Italian:** *libreria* (= bookstore), *camera* (= room), *morbido* (= soft), *fattoria* (= farm).
- ◆ **German:** *Gift* (= poison), *eventuell* (= possibly), *bekommen* (= get/receive), *Chef* (= boss), *sensibel* (= sensitive). **Polish:** *ewentualnie* (= possibly), *aktualny* (= current). **Russian:** *магазин* (= shop), *аккуратный* (= neat, careful), *фамилия* (= surname).
- ◆ **Japanese and Korean loanwords** that look English but aren't used that way: Japanese *manshon* (= apartment building), *kurēmu* "claim" (= complaint), *sumāto* "smart" (= slim), *konsento* "consent" (=

power outlet); Korean *haendeu-pon* "hand phone" (= cell phone), *aisyoping* "eye shopping" (= window shopping), *paiting* "fighting!" (= good luck, go for it!).

- ◆ **Varieties, not errors:** some forms that look like transfer are standard in a variety of English, such as Philippine English *comfort room* (= restroom) or Indian English *prepone* (= bring forward). Treat these as **audience** questions ("Will this reader know it?"), which connects to C2 5.1 (Global Englishes).
- ◆ **Collocation and grammar transfer:** "do a mistake," "make a photo," "open/close the light," "I have 30 years," "arrive to," "strong in math." These are the "grammar" and "collocation" rows of the mismatch table: fix them as chunks.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_21.html. Listen to the Ana and Tom dialogue and the five model sentences with the Listen buttons and say them back in an easy, explanatory rhythm; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Convey the Uncrossable Word" project (a word from any language you know, **or** one from the gallery or a new identity card: using your first language is welcome but never required). Workbook 7.3: Exercises 4 and 5, "My new words" and the journal (start a personal false-friend list with three entries, from your languages or from this lesson).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** An idiom's meaning isn't the sum of its words, so the literal version is opaque · Q2 **A** Translation is written with time to craft; interpreting is live speech in real time · Q3 (new) **B** Tell both people you need to check the word, then ask the teacher to explain it. Listening (Ex 1): 1 *sobremesa* · 2 "over-the-table" · 3 the time you spend still sitting and talking after a meal · 4 not being in a hurry (the meal isn't over just because the food is) · 5 "chatting over coffee after dinner" · 6 the sense that it's a whole custom.

END OF C22: MODULE 7 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 19, "read the rules, negotiate across them, carry meaning between them": **That would be quite challenging = probably no** · **When you said..., did you mean...?** · **That's on me** (read and repair) → **If you were able to..., then we could...** · **What matters most to you here?** · **With the new figures in, it'd be completely reasonable to revisit this** (negotiate and save face) → **It literally means..., but we'd actually say...** · **The nearest we get is..., though that loses...** · **Interpreter speaking: may I check a word?** (mediate). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you; review it in the C23 warmer (the **Bridge It!** board game is ready for that).

Watch for in Module 8: the CPE speaking paper (8.1) rewards exactly the collaborative moves practiced here: inviting a partner in, disagreeing diplomatically, negotiating toward a joint decision; make that link explicit when you run the paired speaking task. Public speaking in 8.2 needs the calm, low-pitched delivery of C21 and the audience awareness of C20 (humor that travels; no jokes at anyone's expense). For the 8.3 masterwork, a cross-cultural or mediation topic is a strong, safe choice: offer it, with an assigned angle.

Final assessment (C26) covers all eight modules. From this module it can test: decoding an indirect refusal and writing a clarifying check; labeling a politeness strategy; placing words on a euphemism ladder; repairing a misfired joke; turning a blunt line diplomatic; positions vs interests and BATNA; conditional trades (*If you were able to..., then we could...* · *provided + present simple*); a cushioned difficult message; false friends; conveying an untranslatable word with the paraphrase pattern; translation vs interpreting and one interpreting-ethics principle.

Module 8 — The Summit: Exams, Performance & Lifelong Command

The last three classes of the whole A1–C2 ladder are about performance, in three different arenas. First, the **exam room**: a C2 exam-skills clinic in which learners treat proficiency-level tasks (key word transformations, gapped text, the essay summary, the speaking long turn and collaborative task) as solvable puzzles with their own logic. Then the **stage**: a public-speaking lab on structure for the ear, rhetoric performed rather than written, the working voice, nerves and Q&A, ending in **three-minute speeches with peer feedback**. Finally, the review project, **Your Masterwork & Lifelong Command**: each learner presents a capstone piece of their own choosing (a speech, an op-ed, a creative piece or a research summary), fields a searching discussion, and shares a personal plan for keeping their English growing when there is no next level.

3 Lessons

Lessons 8.1–8.3

Classes C23–C25

Weeks 12–13

90 min per class

CEFR C2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. The shape is the usual one: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**. At C2, 8.1 and 8.2 are **workshops**: the "language" is a set of task logics, delivery techniques and discussion moves, and most of the time goes to doing them under realistic pressure. C25 is a project class: short input, then the **Masterwork Salon**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from `slides/module-8-masterwork.html`. Print `materials/module-8/classroom-materials.html` before C23. It holds the **phrase cards**, the **collaborative-task picture cards**, new identity cards, the **transformation relay cards**, the cut-up **gapped text**, the **essay summary** task sheet, **long-turn prompt cards** and the **examiner's descriptor sheet**, the **speech cards** and **speech feedback slips**, the **Summit Climb** board game, the **masterwork kit** (format cards, rotation sheet, chair's script, response slips), the **four format rubrics** and the discussion rubric, the **lifelong-command exchange card**, the **teacher observation checklist** and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home and choose a US or UK voice. For this module the online lessons are also where learners **practice alone under time** (8.1), **record a talk** (8.2) and **record their masterwork** (8.3).

- ◆ **The project starts in C23, not C25.** A polished capstone cannot be produced in class. Learners choose a format and a subject at the end of C23, fill in the **masterwork planning frame** (Workbook 8.3) before C24, draft and polish after C24, and send written pieces to their salon group before C25. The timeline is in the box below; board it in C23 and leave it up.
- ◆ **Refinement toward mastery, not re-teaching.** Every skill this module asks for was built earlier: precision and collocation (1.1, 1.3), register (1.2), implicature (2.1), figurative language (2.3), stance and cohesion (3.1–3.2), summary and synthesis (3.3), rhetoric (4.1), style and voice (4.2), writing for readers and at length (6.1–6.2), diplomacy (7.2). Point back whenever a learner reaches for a tool: "That's your 4.1 antithesis, now performed." The new element is **performance under constraint**: a mark scheme, a clock, an audience, a challenger.
- ◆ **Feedback that is genuinely useful at C2.** Your learners are near-native in some areas and **fossilized** in others, and they know it. Generic praise ("very fluent!") is useless to them, and so is a list of ten corrections. Take notes in three columns: **Fix** (errors, especially the persistent ones: an article with an abstract noun, *discuss about*, a present perfect with a past time phrase), **Refine** (correct but imprecise, unidiomatic, off-register, or lacking effect: "correct, but a native editor would say *cast doubt on*, not *put doubt on*") and **Wow** (a choice worth spreading). Board 2–3 of each without names. Keep a private **fossilization log**: two or three persistent items per learner, which you hand back on a slip at C26. At this level, **one precise, named observation** is worth more than any score.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** C2 classes often contain one or two brilliant, fast talkers who fill every silence. In C23 give them the **examiner** role (they must listen, rate against the descriptors and report in 20 seconds). In the collaborative task, the task itself rewards inviting a partner in: tell them so ("Monologue loses marks here"). In C24 they are **timekeepers** with a strict three-minute limit, and in C25 the **chair**, whose job is to bring others in and keep the challenge fair. Say it early and kindly: "Great point, Daniel. Let's hear Mei's take first."
- ◆ **Quiet or anxious learners.** Speaking in front of peers is the most exposing task in the course, even for a learner who writes beautifully. Allow a **seated** speech in C24, notes on the table, and a shorter slot (two minutes) if needed. In C25 the four formats exist partly for them: a writer may choose the **op-ed** or **research summary**, present a short spoken frame and read a passage. Nobody presents to the whole class: all groups run in parallel.
- ◆ **Stretching the strongest.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The direction for this module is **invisibility of craft**: the exam answer that looks effortless, the rhetorical device that sounds like thought rather than technique, the response to a challenge that reframes the question rather than defending against it. Ask strong learners to explain *why* a choice works, and give them the hardest cards.
- ◆ **Peer review, the C2 way.** All three classes use the same protocol, which learners know from earlier modules: (1) **quote before you judge** (name the exact phrase or moment); (2) **describe the effect** it had on you; (3) **ask a genuine question before you suggest a change**; (4) **offer one change, framed as "If this were mine, I might..."**; (5) **the writer or speaker decides**. Post it on the wall. Comments are about the work, never the person, and never about accent.
- ◆ **Exam material: original only.** Everything in this module is written for teaching and imitates the *style* of proficiency-level task types. Nothing reproduces a real or past exam paper. Cambridge English C2 Proficiency (often called CPE) and IELTS are the trademarks of their owners; the kit is independent and unofficial. Formats,

timings and word limits change: **tell learners to check the current official specification** for any exam they plan to take, and describe tasks in class as "typical" rather than "exact."

- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and words (*recognise, organised, practise* as a verb, *analyse, judgement, defence, humour, programme, full stop, public transport, towards*). Teach *recognize, organized, practice, analyze, judgment, defense, humor, program, period, public transportation, toward*. Accept British forms when learners use them, but ask for **one** system per piece. Both exams accept either spelling system used consistently.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Perform for a mark scheme → perform for a room → perform as yourself. In C23 the audience is an examiner with descriptors, and the skill is converting existing mastery into points: *read the task, bank the sure marks, prove every answer*. In C24 the audience is a room of people, and the skill is making meaning easy to receive: *a hook, a spine, a close; the pause; the stressed word; poise under a hard question*. In C25 there is no mark scheme and no set topic: learners choose what to make and whom to make it for, and then say how they will keep growing. The module ends the whole ladder on the learner's own terms: **command is not something the course gives them; it is something they now keep.**

TRAUMA-INFORMED: TOPICS, EXAMS, AUDIENCES AND "PASS"

Exams carry real weight for many adults at this level: a visa, a university place, professional registration, a job that depends on a band score. Some learners have failed a high-stakes test before, sometimes more than once.

Never ask anyone to share a past score or a reason for taking an exam. Frame 8.1 as "technique for anyone who performs English under pressure," not "exam prep for exam candidates." All topics stay in **workplace, education, science, arts/culture, technology, language and community** territory: the kit's cards contain no party politics, religion, immigration or border policy, policing, war or national identity; **don't add any**, and steer a masterwork away from them privately if a learner proposes one ("Let's find an angle on this that the group can discuss as ideas"). Long-turn prompts that invite a personal story can always be answered as a **new identity** or invented, and the lifelong-learning plan may be written for a persona. Any learner may say "Pass, next card." In C25 the discussion challenges the *work*; the chair stops any question that becomes personal, and nobody is asked where they are from, what they believe, or to speak "for" a culture.

THE PROJECT TIMELINE (BOARD IT IN C23)

End of C23	Choose a format (speech · op-ed · creative piece · research summary: see the format cards) and a subject you genuinely have a view on . Read Workbook 8.3: the four formats and the planning frame.
Before C24	Fill in the masterwork planning frame : controlling idea in one sentence, audience, shape, the "range plan" (which tools the piece needs), the hardest question you expect. Notes only. Also prepare the three-minute speech skeleton for C24 (speech-format learners may use the opening of their masterwork).
C24 (last stage)	Salon groups announced. Each learner tells their group, in one sentence, what their piece will argue, show or explain.
After C24	Draft, then polish until the seams disappear. Written pieces: 500–700 words . Speeches: 4–5 minutes . Send written pieces to your salon group by the evening before C25 (or bring 4 printed copies); speakers send a five-line abstract . Complete the lifelong-command plan (Workbook 8.3).
C25	Read your group's pieces closely, prepare a response, then the Masterwork Salon : present (4–5 min), take the discussion (about 4 min), receive written response slips. Then the lifelong-command exchange in pairs.
After C25	Hand in the piece (or its script/notes), the plan and the rubric self-check. You return them with written feedback, and the fossilization slip, at C26.

Why these four formats, when the online lesson names a talk, an essay-into-speech or an article you then present? They are the same idea, widened so that every kind of C2 user can show their best: the **speech** is the online "talk"; the **op-ed** is the "article you then present" (the C2 6.1 genre); the **research summary** is the "essay-into-speech" for learners whose English lives in academic or professional reports (3.3 and 6.2); the **creative piece** (a short story, a personal essay, a sequence of prose poems, a monologue) serves learners whose voice is literary (2.3, 4.2, 5.2). All four are presented aloud and discussed, so all four test the same integration. If a learner's week is too full, 400 well-polished words or a three-minute speech is fine: tell them privately.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **phrase cards** (exam self-talk, collaborative moves, delivery, Q&A, response protocol) and the six **collaborative-task picture cards**. Card stock helps.
- For C23: the **transformation relay cards** (1 set per group of 3), the **gapped-text strips** (1 set per pair), the **essay summary task sheet** (1 per learner), the **long-turn prompt cards** (1 set per group of 3), the **examiner's descriptor sheet** (1 per group) and the picture cards for the collaborative task (1 set per group). Phone timers.

- For the end of C23: the **masterwork format cards** and **subject starters**, and the **speech cards** (for learners who want a topic for the C24 speech).
- For C24: **speech feedback slips** (3 per learner), the **Summit Climb** board (1 per group of 3–4, a die or coin, counters), a timer on the screen.
- For C25: the **rotation sheet** and **chair's script** (1 per group), **response slips** (3 per learner), the **four format rubrics** and the **discussion rubric** (each learner needs the one for their format, plus copies for their respondents), the **lifelong-command exchange cards** (1 per learner) and your **observation checklist** on a clipboard.
- Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- Set up a way for salon groups to share written pieces before C25 (a group email, a shared folder, or printed copies). Decide the groups at the end of C24.
- Read the kit's **C2 final assessment** before C25. Your C25 observation notes feed straight into how you run C26.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
8.1	C23 · wk 12	C2 exam skills (CPE / IELTS 8+), described generically. The strategist's mindset; Use of English: key word transformations (the four checks), word formation, collocation choice; Reading: gapped text (cohesion breadcrumbs) and the "true but not there" trap; Writing: the essay summary (summarize and evaluate two texts) and writing to the descriptors; Listening past the distractor; Speaking: the long turn and the collaborative task	solve original task items in the style of proficiency exams with a deliberate strategy, prove every reading answer with textual evidence, plan an essay summary that covers every part of the task, and sustain a structured two-minute long turn and a genuinely interactive collaborative task
8.2	C24 · wk 12	Public speaking lab. Structure for the ear (open · spine · close); rhetoric recap , now performed (tricolon, rhetorical question, antithesis, anaphora, from 4.1); vocal delivery (pace, the pause, contrastive stress, breath groups, vocal variety); rapport and nerves ; Q&A with poise (acknowledge, answer, concede, narrow, bridge)	plan and deliver a three-minute speech with a hook, a signposted spine and a resonant close, use pause and stress deliberately, handle one unscripted question with composure, and give a peer precise feedback with the speech rubric
8.3	C25 · wk 13	Review project: Your Masterwork & Lifelong Command. The integration map (every C2 thread in one piece); the four formats; "deploy	present a substantial piece of their own choosing that integrates the full C2 range, field

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		the range, then hide the seams"; the peer-response protocol (reflect · probe · challenge · offer); concede → narrow under challenge; the four habits of lifelong command (read · use · teach · live in it)	a searching discussion on it, respond to a peer's work precisely and generously, and commit to a specific, self-diagnosed plan for lifelong growth

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain why marks are lost at C2 to **technique** rather than language, and name the four classic leaks: the under-answered prompt, the "true but not there" answer, the miscounted transformation, the monologued collaborative task
- ◆ complete **key word transformations** in the proficiency style by applying the four checks: key word unchanged · word limit respected · meaning preserved exactly · the gap grammatical with what surrounds it
- ◆ decide the part of speech and the prefix in **word formation**, and choose the word that **collocates** rather than the one that merely means the right thing
- ◆ place sentences in a **gapped text** by tracking reference words and connectors, and reject any reading answer they cannot underline evidence for
- ◆ plan an **essay summary** that identifies, paraphrases and evaluates the key points of two short texts and adds their own view, covering every part of the task
- ◆ sustain a structured two-minute **long turn** and take part in a **collaborative task** that rewards inviting, building and negotiating toward a decision

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 8.1 (New words, two Grammar boxes, Exercises 1–5, the collaborative-task dialogue, the Speaking circuit + descriptor self-rating)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Phrase cards (exam self-talk, collaborative moves) · **Transformation relay cards** · **Gapped-text strips** · **Essay summary task sheet** · **Long-turn prompt cards** · **Collaborative-task picture cards** (park, market, bus, garden, restaurant, school) · **Examiner's descriptor sheet** · phone timers · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts **8.1-A** (Two pairs, one task), **8.1-B** (Listen past the distractor) and, optionally, **8.1-C** (a model long turn)
- ◆ Masterwork **format cards**, **subject starters** and **speech cards** (for the project launch at the end)

BOARD PLAN

Left: where C2 marks leak. (1) the under-answered prompt · (2) "true but not there" · (3) the miscounted transformation / changed key word · (4) the monologued collaborative task. **The strategist:** read the task before the text · spend time in proportion to marks · bank the sure points · prove every answer.

Center: key word transformation, the four checks. ① key word unchanged ② word limit (a contraction = 2 words) ③ same meaning, nothing added or lost ④ fits the grammar on both sides of the gap. "I couldn't understand the lecture at all." (NO) → I could make **no sense of** the lecture. · "As soon as she arrived, the argument started." (SOONER) → **No sooner had she arrived** than... **Word formation:** part of speech first → prefix? → plural / comparative?

Right: speaking. Long turn: frame → 2–3 signposted points → deliberate close. Collaborative: invite (*What's your take on...?*) · build (*I'd add that...*) · differ softly (*I see it slightly differently, in that...*) · decide (*So, are we agreed that...?*). **Corner:** the project timeline.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: the untranslatable	6	S–S	Review C22 (7.3). Pairs: each learner explains one word that "doesn't translate" (from any language they know, or an English word that is hard to translate out), using the 7.3 frames: <i>There isn't a single English word for it, but...</i> · <i>The closest equivalent would be...</i> · <i>It literally means..., but we'd actually say...</i> Partner offers the best English paraphrase they can. Two pairs share their best paraphrase. Note one Fix, one Refine, one Wow.
Lead-in: where the marks leak	5	T–S	Slide 3. "You already have the English a top exam measures. So why do strong candidates lose marks?" Elicit ideas, then reveal the four leaks . Give the online lesson's four situations orally (one gap has stumped you for two minutes · an option "feels right" but you can't find the words · a great idea for part one of a two-part prompt · your partner has paused in the collaborative task); pairs decide the strategist's move in 20 seconds each. Stress the frame: technique is fixable in an afternoon .
Key word transformations	12	T–S → S–S	Slides 4–5. Show the two worked examples (NO, SOONER). Elicit the four checks from the examples before you name them. CCQs (below). Then the families the task keeps testing: negative inversion (<i>No sooner... than</i> · <i>On no account</i> · <i>Not until... did</i> · <i>Never before have...</i>), fixed phrases with dependent prepositions (<i>make sense of</i> · <i>on the brink of</i> · <i>in the wake of</i> · <i>make light of</i>),

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			passives and causatives, reporting structures. Pairs do Workbook Ex 1 items 1–2 together.
Drill: the transformation race	6	T-S → S	Oral, fast (see Drill script): you say a sentence and a key word; learners say the transformed sentence aloud (choral for the first two, then individuals, then teams with the transformation relay cards). Every answer is checked aloud against the four checks: "Key word? Count? Meaning? Fit?"
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1 (items 3–8) and Ex 2 (word formation + collocation) alone, under a light time limit : 6 minutes, "bank the sure ones, mark the hard ones, come back." Pairs compare, count words aloud, and board-check only disagreements.
Reading & listening clinic	12	S-S → T-S	Slide 6. Gapped text (Workbook Ex 3; the cut-up strips for pairs who like to move paper): place three sentences, one is extra. Rule: underline the breadcrumb (the reference word or connector) that proves each placement. Then the two "true but not there" items. (7 min.) Then Script 8.1-B : four short extracts, read once each; learners write what each speaker settles on , not what they mention first, and one word for the attitude (Workbook Ex 5B). (5 min.)
Writing clinic: the essay summary	10	S → S-S	Slide 7. The task type: summarize and evaluate the key points of two short texts and give your own view, in a set number of words (typically 240–280 in this style of task; tell learners to check the current specification). Workbook Ex 4 with the task sheet: (1) underline two key points per text; (2) paraphrase each in your own words (3.3 skills: no lifted phrases); (3) plan four paragraphs. Pairs swap plans and check one thing: does the plan cover every part of the task? The opening paragraph is written at home.
Freer: the Speaking Circuit	20	T-S → groups of 3	Slide 8. Read Script 8.1-A (Pair 1 monologues, Pair 2 interacts; 2 min): "Which pair would score

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			higher? Why?" Then groups of 3: candidate, interlocutor (gives the card, times, asks one follow-up), examiner (rates on the descriptor sheet and reports in 20 seconds). Round 1, the long turn (about 11 min): 1 minute to prepare (notes allowed, three words), 2 minutes of speech, one follow-up (30 s), report. Rotate three times. Round 2, the collaborative task (about 5 min): two learners discuss the picture cards ("A town wants to make its center more welcoming...") for 3 minutes and must reach a decision; the third examines interaction only. ICQs first. See "How to run it."
Feedback	6	T-S	Delayed correction. Board 2 Fixes (e.g. a transformation that changed the key word: <i>no sooner she had arrived</i> · a collocation near-miss: <i>make a big mistake</i> is fine, <i>do a mistake</i> is not), 2 Refines (e.g. a long turn with no close: add "So, to pull that together..."; a collaborative turn that answers but doesn't invite) and 1–2 Wows. Ask: "Which leak do you personally need to plug first?"
Homework & project launch	5	T-S	Show online lesson 8.1 and a Listen button; set the homework (below). Launch the project: board the timeline, show the four formats (slide 15, briefly), pass round the format cards and subject starters. Everyone leaves with a format and a first idea for a subject, and a speech card or their own topic for the C24 three-minute speech. Learners tick the 8.1 "I can..." list.
Total	90		6 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 8 + 12 + 10 + 20 + 6 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the Speaking Circuit: speaking under exam conditions is the thing learners cannot practice alone. Cut in this order: (1) Script 8.1-B shrinks to extracts 1 and 2; (2) the collaborative round runs as a single demonstration pair while the others examine; (3) the essay-summary plan stops after step 2 (key points and paraphrase), with the plan at home. Never cut the project launch: learners who leave C23 without a format lose two days of planning.

Meaning: the strategist's mindset. A proficiency exam is not a fair sample of a learner's English; it is a stylized, time-pressured performance. At C2, lost marks are almost always **leaks in technique**, not gaps in knowledge.

SAY: "My English is excellent but my score was lower than I expected." Is the problem probably vocabulary? (No, usually technique.) · A reading option is true in real life, but you can't find it in the passage. Right or wrong? (Wrong: "true but not there.") · You wrote a brilliant answer to half of a two-part writing task. Can it reach the top band? (No: the prompt is under-answered.) · In the collaborative task, is a fluent two-minute monologue a good answer? (No: the task rewards interaction.)

Meaning and form: key word transformations.

SAY: "I couldn't understand the lecture at all." → "I could make no sense of the lecture." Did the meaning change? (No.) Is NO exactly as given? (Yes.) How many words in the gap? (Three: no sense of; "the lecture" is already printed.) What fixed phrase is being tested? (make sense of.) · "No sooner had she arrived than the argument started." Which word order after No sooner? (Auxiliary before subject: inversion.) Could you write "No sooner she had arrived"? (No: that loses the mark.) · If the limit is 3–6 words and "I'll" is in your answer, how many words is it? (Two.) · You write a perfect sentence but change SOONER to SOON. Mark? (Zero.)

Meaning: word formation and collocation.

SAY: "The evidence was, regrettably, ____ (CONCLUDE)." Which part of speech? (Adjective.) Does "regrettably" suggest the evidence settled the question? (No.) So? (inconclusive: the prefix carries the meaning.) · "a strong / heavy / thick / hard possibility." Do all four mean something like "big"? (Roughly.) Which one keeps company with possibility? (strong.) So what are you testing: meaning or partnership? (Partnership: collocation.)

Meaning: gapped text and the essay summary.

SAY: The sentence after the gap begins "This compression...". What must the missing sentence mention? (Something being compressed.) · A distractor sentence is about the right topic but has no link to either neighbor. Keep or reject? (Reject: it must fit what comes before and after.) · The essay summary asks you to "summarize and evaluate." If you only summarize, what's missing? (The evaluation and your own view: part of the task.) · Can you copy a key sentence from the text? (No: paraphrase. Lifted phrases don't show your range.)

Form: the patterns the transformation task loves.

Negative inversion	No sooner had + subject + past participle... than · Hardly / Scarcely had... when · On no account + aux + subject ·	C2 1.2 register, C2 4.1 rhetoric; C1 2.2
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	Not until... + aux + subject · Never (before) + aux + subject · Only when / Only after... + aux + subject	
Fixed phrase + preposition	make sense of · make light of · on the brink of · in the wake of · take into account · come in for (criticism) · cast doubt on · have no intention of	C2 1.3 collocation
Passive / causative	It is thought that... → X is thought to have... · have / get something done · There is said to be...	C1 review
Word formation	part of speech → negative prefix (in-, un-, dis-, mis-, ir-, il-) → suffix (-ive, -ous, -ance, -ity, -able) → plural / comparative	persuade → persuasive · conclude → inconclusive · foresee → unforeseen

Pronunciation: the speaking criteria. Proficiency speaking assesses pronunciation as **intelligibility and prosody**, never as closeness to a native accent. Say this explicitly, because many C2 learners believe their accent costs them marks. What earns credit is **chunking** (pausing at the boundaries of ideas, not mid-phrase), **sentence stress** on the new or contrasted information, and **intonation that signals structure**: a fall at the end of a completed point, a rise or level tone on a list that continues. In the long turn, a signpost followed by a short pause ("My second point | is cost.") sounds controlled. In the collaborative task, questions that invite should rise at the end ("What's your **take** on it? ↗"); a proposal to close should fall ("So, are we agreed that **these two** are strongest? ↘").

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 The four checks** (choral, as a chant, twice): "Key word · word count · same meaning · fits the gap."
- 2 Transformation race** (T gives the sentence and key word; S says the full new sentence): T: "I couldn't understand the report at all. NO." → S: "I could make no sense of the report." T: "As soon as he sat down, the phone rang. SOONER." → S: "No sooner had he sat down than the phone rang." T: "You should never underestimate her. ACCOUNT." → S: "On no account should you underestimate her." T: "The company very nearly collapsed. BRINK." → S: "The company was on the brink of collapse."
- 3 Spot the lost mark** (T says a wrong answer; S names which check failed): T: "No sooner he had sat down than the phone rang." → S: "Fits the gap: no inversion." T: "On no account you should underestimate her." → S: "Same problem: inversion." T: "The company was on the edge of collapse (BRINK)." → S: "Key word changed." T: "I could make hardly any sense of the report (NO)." → S: "Key word missing, meaning changed."
- 4 Word-formation flash**: T: "PERSUADE, adjective." → S: "persuasive." T: "RELUCTANT, noun." → "reluctance." T: "CONCLUDE, adjective, negative." → "inconclusive." T: "FORESEE, adjective, negative." → "unforeseen."
- 5 Collaborative moves** (with intonation): "Shall we **start** with...? ↘" · "What's your **take** on...? ↗" · "I see it slightly **differently**, in that... ↘" · "So, are we **agreed** that...? ↘". Then open pairs: S1 proposes an

option from the picture cards; S2 builds on it and invites S3.

◆ THE SPEAKING CIRCUIT – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3** (candidate · interlocutor · examiner). Each group has the long-turn prompt cards face down, the six picture cards, one **examiner's descriptor sheet** and a phone timer.
- ◆ **Round 1: the long turn** (three rotations of about 3½ minutes). The interlocutor offers **two cards**; the candidate chooses one, has **1 minute** to prepare (three key words only), then speaks for **2 minutes**. The interlocutor calls "30 seconds" and "Thank you," then asks one follow-up question from the card (30 seconds). The examiner reports in 20 seconds, using the sheet's four criteria: "Strong frame and close; two signposted points; one great collocation, *a double-edged sword*; pace rushed in the middle."
- ◆ **Round 2: the collaborative task** (about 5 minutes). Two candidates discuss the six picture cards for **3 minutes**: first how effective each idea might be, then **which two to recommend**. The third learner examines **interaction only** (tallies invites, builds, soft disagreements and the move to a decision). If time is short, one pair demonstrates and everyone else examines.
- ◆ **Descriptor sheet** (materials set F): four criteria (fluency & coherence · lexical range · grammatical range & accuracy · pronunciation) plus **interaction** for the collaborative task, each at three levels written in plain language. The descriptors are original and simplified; they are a practice tool, not an official band scale. Say so.
- ◆ **Personal prompts** ("Describe a skill you learned later than most people...") can be answered as a **new identity** or invented. Any candidate may say "Pass, next card."
- ◆ **You circulate** with Fix / Refine / Wow columns. Sit through one full long turn per group. Listen especially for the ending: most strong candidates run out of time rather than closing.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SPEAKING CIRCUIT

SAY: *Long turn: how long do you prepare? (One minute.) How long do you speak? (Two minutes.) Can you write sentences? (No, three key words.) · Who asks the follow-up? (The interlocutor.) · What does the examiner report? (The four criteria, briefly, with one example.) · Collaborative task: is the goal to give the best speech? (No, to discuss and reach a decision together.) How many ideas do you recommend? (Two.) · What does the third person listen for? (Interaction: inviting, building, disagreeing politely, deciding.) · Can you say "Pass"? (Yes.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some C2 learners speak brilliantly but read slowly under time, or learned to read English late. Give them the **four checks** as a card to hold, and let them do Ex 1 items 1–4 and Ex 2 part A only. For the gapped text, give the cut-up strips and ask them to find the breadcrumb for **one** gap first, then the others. In the long turn, allow a **90-second** turn and let them choose from the more concrete cards. In the essay summary, a partner may read the two texts aloud once. Target: one transformation checked aloud against all four checks, and one long turn with a clear frame and close.

STRETCH

Write **two original transformation items** for the class (sentence, key word, limit, answer) that test different structures, and justify why each has only one correct answer. In the gapped text, explain why the distractor fails in *both* positions it seems to fit. In the long turn, take the hardest card and add a **concession** ("Admittedly...") before the close. As examiner, give feedback that names a **specific** phrase for each criterion. Homework: the full essay summary under 40 minutes, self-marked against the descriptors.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Articles inside fixed phrases.** Learners whose languages have no articles (Russian, Polish, Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese, Thai, and others) may write *on brink of* or *in wake of*. In a transformation, a missing article loses the whole mark. Train the eye: **the** brink, **the** wake.
- ◆ **Negative prefixes by analogy.** Romance-language speakers transfer *in-* where English takes *un-* (*inforeseen*, Spanish *imprevisto*) or the reverse (*unconclusive*). Keep a class list of the tricky ones: *inconclusive*, *unforeseen*, *irrelevant*, *illegible*, *dissatisfied*, *misleading*.
- ◆ **Light-verb collocations** transfer from L1: Spanish/Portuguese/Italian *make a question* (*hacer una pregunta*), German/Dutch *make a photo*, Arabic and Persian *do a mistake*, French *take a decision* (British, but check the context). These are exactly what the collocation task targets.
- ◆ **Memorized essay formulas.** Learners from exam systems that reward set phrases (common in Chinese, Arabic, Persian, Turkish and South Asian test-preparation cultures) may open with *Nowadays*, *with the development of society...* or *Every coin has two sides*. Examiners at this level read these as **formulaic**: they lower the range score. Offer an alternative that engages the actual texts.
- ◆ **"True but not there."** Learners from academic traditions that value bringing in outside knowledge (a strength in a seminar) are especially prone to choosing the option that is true in the world. Frame the exam as a different game with different rules.
- ◆ **Monologue as politeness.** Some learners avoid interrupting or inviting a partner because it feels rude or presumptuous (often Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Thai and Vietnamese speakers); others hold the floor because turn-taking in their L1 conversation is more competitive (sometimes Spanish, Italian, Arabic, Hebrew or Greek speakers). The task rewards the middle; teach the invitation phrases as the polite move.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_22.html. Listen to the five model sentences and say them back until they feel automatic; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the project **Two Tasks, Self-Assessed** (one should be the essay summary from Workbook Ex 4: write it in full, about 240–280 words, in 40 minutes). Workbook 8.1: Ex 5A (if not done in class), "My new words" and the journal. **Project:** fill in the masterwork planning frame (Workbook 8.3, notes only) and prepare the skeleton of your **three-minute speech** for C24: write your first and last sentences in full.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** genuine interaction: inviting, building, negotiating toward a decision. · Q2 **C** reject it: if you can't underline the evidence, it isn't supported. · Q3 (new) **A** "was on the brink of" (5 words, within the limit, key word unchanged, article present). Ex 1: 1 no sense of · 2 sooner had he sat down · 3 no account should you underestimate · 4 the first time I have (I've) · 5 was on the brink of · 6 in the wake of · 7 made light of · 8 until the report came. Ex 3 gapped text: 1 **B** · 2 **C** · 3 **A** (D is extra). Full answers in the answer key.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ shape a talk **for the ear**: an open that earns attention in fifteen seconds, a **signposted spine** of two or three points, and a **resonant close** that ends on a full stop, not a fade
- ◆ **perform** the rhetorical figures of 4.1 rather than merely write them: the tricolon whose third beat falls, the rhetorical question followed by a pause, antithesis and anaphora with parallel stress
- ◆ use the voice deliberately: **the pause** before and after a key line, **contrastive stress** on the one word that carries the meaning, **breath groups**, and variety of pace, pitch and volume
- ◆ build **rapport** (eye contact, inclusive *we*, reading the room) and channel **nerves** (automatic bookends, the "excited" reframe, slow exhales)
- ◆ handle **Q&A with poise**: listen to the whole question, acknowledge, answer what was asked, concede the valid part and narrow to the real claim, bridge back
- ◆ deliver a **three-minute speech** and give a peer precise, useful feedback with the speech rubric

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 8.2 (New words, two Grammar boxes, Exercises 1–5, the speech-and-Q&A dialogue, the Speech Lab plan and feedback record)
- ◆ Slides 9–14 · Phrase cards (delivery, Q&A) · **Speech cards** (spares for anyone without a topic) · **Speech feedback slips** (3 per learner) · **Summit Climb** board game (warmer) · a big timer on the screen · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts **8.2-A** (Same words, two deliveries), **8.2-B** (the speech on talent and its Q&A) and **8.2-C** (I never said she stole the money)
- ◆ Learners' **speech skeletons** (homework from C23)

BOARD PLAN

Left: build for the ear. A listener can't rewind. OPEN (15 s): a question · a striking fact · a short story · a bold claim; never an apology. SPINE: "There are three things I want to leave you with. First..." (number them, say the numbers). CLOSE: echo the open · a call to action · one line to carry home; end on a full stop. **Performed rhetoric (4.1)**: tricolon (let the third beat fall) · rhetorical question + beat · antithesis (stress both halves) · anaphora (same stress, rising energy).

Center: the voice. | = short pause · || = long pause. Pause **before** a key line to prime it, **after** to let it land. Stress **one** word per idea: "I never said **SHE** stole the money." One idea, one breath. Slow down for what matters; speed up for asides.

Right: Q&A with poise. listen to the end → acknowledge (*I'm glad you raised that.*) → answer what was asked → concede + narrow (*You're right about that; where I'd differ is...*) → bridge back (*Which brings me back to...*). Don't know? *I don't have that to hand, but here's how I'd find out.* **Nerves:** bookends by heart · "I'm excited" · slow exhale · friendly faces first.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Summit Climb	6	S-S	Review C23. Groups of 3–4 play Summit Climb (materials set H) for 5 minutes: each square is a quick exam item (a transformation, a word-formation stem, a collocation choice, a "strategist's move") or a 30-second speaking challenge. Then ask: "Which of the four leaks have you plugged since Thursday?" Note one Fix and one Wow.
Lead-in: same words, two deliveries	5	T-S	Slide 9. Read Script 8.2-A twice: first flat and rushed, then performed (pauses, stress, a slower close). Ask: "Were the words different?" (No.) "Which version do you remember? Why?" Elicit the lesson's premise: an audience remembers how you made them feel ; delivery is part of the meaning. Frame delivery as generosity to listeners, not vanity.
Structure & rhetoric for the ear	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 10. Open · spine · close, with the online model open and close ("Every one of you made a decision this morning..."). CCQs (below). Then the rhetoric recap : learners name the 4.1 figures from four example lines, and you show how each is <i>performed</i> (tricolon: rising-rising-falling; antithesis: stress both poles; rhetorical question: a real beat before the answer). Workbook Ex 3 (open, close, Q&A choices) in pairs, 2 minutes.
The voice: pause, stress, pace	10	T-S → S-S	Slides 11–12. Script 8.2-C : read "I never said she stole the money" five times in random order, stressing a different word each time; learners match each reading to its meaning (Workbook Ex 1B). Then "one idea, one breath": you mark the first lines of the talent speech on the slide with and , learners mark the rest (Workbook Ex 4) and read it to a partner. CCQs.
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: contrastive stress, the pause before the key line, the falling third beat, the Q&A acknowledgements. Choral first, then individuals; insist on real silence in the pauses (count "one-and" in your head).

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Nerves & Q&A with poise	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 13. Read Script 8.2-B (the talk on talent and the audience question; two voices, or a confident learner reads the questioner). Ask: "How does the speaker handle the challenge?" (Concedes the valid part, narrows the claim, checks the answer landed.) Elicit the five-step method. Then nerves: ask for what learners already do; add the four online techniques. Pairs: Workbook Ex 2 and Ex 5 (turn a defensive answer into a poised one).
Speech prep: mark up and rehearse	10	S → S-S	Learners take their homework skeleton (or a speech card) and complete the Speech plan in Workbook 8.2: write the first and last sentences in full, mark three pauses and three stressed words, place one rhetorical device. Then pairs rehearse only the open and the close , twice each, with the partner giving one note: "Slower on the last line." You circulate and help anyone without a topic.
Freer: the Speech Lab	25	groups of 4	Slide 14. Groups of 4: speaker , timekeeper (3 minutes; shows "1 min" and "30 s"; stops at 3:15), questioner (asks one genuine or gently challenging question), feedback lead (fills in a speech feedback slip, and all three listeners add one line). One turn is about 6 minutes: speech (3) → one question and answer (1) → feedback (1½). Rotate roles. ICQs first. See "How to run it."
Feedback	6	T-S	Board 2 Fixes (e.g. an apologetic open: "Sorry, I'm not a good speaker, but..." · a fizzled close: "So... yeah, that's it"), 2 Refines (stress on the wrong word in a key line; a rhetorical question with no pause after it) and 1-2 Wows (a close that echoed the open; a concession in the Q&A). Ask each learner to read aloud the one line from someone else's speech that they remember: that is the real score.
Homework & salon groups	5	T-S	Show online lesson 8.2 and a Listen button; set the homework (below). Announce the salon groups for C25 (3-4 learners, mixed formats) and how pieces will be shared. Each learner says one sentence to their group: "My masterwork will argue / show / explain that...". Learners tick the 8.2 "I can..." list.
Total	90		6 + 5 + 10 + 10 + 5 + 8 + 10 + 25 + 6 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the Speech Lab: a learner who prepared a speech and doesn't get to give it will be hurt. Cut in this order: (1) the warmer becomes 3 minutes of transformation relay in pairs; (2) Script 8.2-B becomes homework (it is the online excerpt), and you give the five-step Q&A method from the slide only; (3) speech prep shrinks to 6 minutes (bookends only). If a group runs out of time, the last speaker gives their speech first in C25's warmer slot, not never.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: content vs delivery; structure for the ear.

SAY: *Two speakers read the same script; one bores the room, one holds it. Is the difference the argument? (No, the delivery.) • A reader can re-read. Can a listener rewind? (No.) So must a talk be more or less signposted than an essay? (More.) • "Sorry, I'm a bit nervous and not very prepared." When is the audience's attention highest? (In the first fifteen seconds.) What did this open do with them? (Wasted them, and lowered expectations.) • "So... yeah, that's about it." Is the end a good place to relax? (No: attention peaks again. Write the last line in advance.)*

Meaning: rhetoric performed.

SAY: *"It was quick, it was clean, and it was completely wrong." How many parts? (Three.) Which part carries the surprise? (The third.) So where does the voice fall? (On wrong.) • "And what did all that planning achieve?" [pause] "Nothing at all." Why the pause? (The audience answers in their heads; the speaker's answer lands on their thought.) • "We have never known more and understood less." What's the figure? (Antithesis.) Which two words carry the stress? (more and less.) • On the page a device is a pattern. In a speech? (An event: it depends on timing.)*

Meaning: the pause and stress.

SAY: *A pause before a key sentence says what? ("Listen: this matters.") After it? ("Let that sink in.") • Does a two-second silence feel long to the speaker? (Very.) To the audience? (No: it feels weighty.) • "I never said SHE stole the money." Who stole it, then? (Someone else.) "I never SAID she stole the money." (I implied it.) So is stress decoration? (No: it's part of what you say.)*

Meaning: Q&A with poise.

SAY: *"Isn't it a bit easy to say? Some people start with more advantages." Is the questioner partly right? (Yes.) The speaker says: "You're absolutely right: the starting lines are not equal." Has she lost the argument? (No.) What does she do next? (Narrows her claim: persistence is the part you control.) • Is "That's just wrong, actually" persuasive? (No: defensive.) "I'd rather not get into that"? (Evasive.) • You don't know the answer. Do you invent one? (No: "I don't have that to hand, but here's how I'd find out.")*

Form.

Open	Every one of you... · Here's a number that surprised me: ... · Picture this: ... · I want to begin with a question. · I'm going to argue something that sounds wrong.	a curiosity gap
Signpost	I want to leave you with three thoughts, and here's the first. · Which brings me to my second point. · Now, and this is the part that matters, ... · Let me put that another way.	say the numbers
Emphasis grammar	<i>wh</i> -cleft: What I want you to remember is... · <i>it</i> -cleft: It's not talent that separates us; it's time. · fronting: This, I think, is the heart of it. · <i>the thing is</i> : The thing is, we already know how.	C2 3.1 stance; C1 2.3
Close	If you remember one thing today, let it be this. · So where does that leave us? · And that brings me back to where we began. · Don't wait to be good before you begin. Begin.	end on a full stop
Q&A	That's a good question; let me take it in two parts. · I'm glad you raised that. · If I've understood your question correctly... · You're right about that; where I'd differ is... · That's outside what I've studied, but my honest guess is... · Can I check I've answered what you were really asking?	acknowledge · answer · concede · narrow · bridge

Pronunciation: the working voice. English is **stress-timed**: stressed syllables fall at roughly regular intervals and unstressed ones are squeezed between them. That is why **one** strongly stressed word in a thought group carries so much meaning, and why stressing every word ("I-NE-VER-SAID-SHE...") sounds robotic. Teach the notation: | short pause, || long pause, CAPITALS for the stressed word, ↘ for a final fall. A tricolon rises on items one and two and **falls** on three ("quick ↗ | clean ↗ | completely **WRONG** ↘"). Antithesis stresses both poles ("known **MORE** | and understood **LESS**"). A rhetorical question falls (it is not a real question) and is followed by a **real** silence. For intimacy, drop the volume, not the clarity; for a call to action, lift pitch and slow down. **Accent is never the target.** A learner's accent is part of their voice; the goal is intelligible chunking, deliberate stress and controlled pace.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Shift the stress** (Script 8.2-C, then learners): T says a meaning, S says the sentence with the right stress.
T: "Someone else stole it." → S: "I never said **SHE** stole the money." T: "She stole something else." → "...
stole the **MO**ney." T: "I only implied it." → "I never **SAID**..." T: "It wasn't me who said it." → "I never
said..."
- The primed line**: T: "Pause before the key phrase." → S: "The gap between you and the person you
admire || is not talent. | It is **TIME**." Choral, then three individuals; the class claps once if the silence was
real.
- The falling third beat**: T: "quick, clean, wrong." → S: "It was quick ↗ | it was clean ↗ | and it was

completely **WRONG** ↘." Then learners invent their own triads: "It was cheap, it was fast, and it was..."

- 4 **Acknowledge, then answer** (T asks a challenging question; S gives only the first move): T: "Isn't that a bit idealistic?" → S: "That's a fair challenge, and you're right that..." T: "What's your evidence?" → S: "I'm glad you asked; let me take it in two parts." T: "Do you know the figures for other countries?" → S: "I don't have that to hand, but here's how I'd find out."
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs**: S1 says their first sentence; S2 repeats it back with one change of pause or stress and asks "Better or worse?" Swap.

◆ THE SPEECH LAB – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 4**, chairs in a small arc so the speaker can stand (or sit) facing three listeners. All groups run at once: nobody speaks to the whole class. Put a big timer on the screen and call "Change" every 6 minutes so groups stay together.
- ◆ **One turn ≈ 6 minutes**: speech (**3 minutes**; the timekeeper shows "1 min" and "30 s" cards and says "Thank you" at 3:15) → the questioner's **one question** and the speaker's answer (1 minute) → feedback (1½ minutes): the feedback lead reads the slip, and each other listener adds **one line they remember** and **one change**.
- ◆ **Topics**: learners' own (prepared at home), a **speech card** (materials set G), or, for speech-format masterwork learners, the **first three minutes of their masterwork** (a real rehearsal). Speeches on a personal topic may use a new identity.
- ◆ **The feedback slip** has five criteria (open · spine · close · voice · presence & Q&A) at three levels (Mastery · Secure · Developing), plus two lines: "The line I'll remember:" and "If this were mine, I might...". The speaker keeps all three slips.
- ◆ **Rules on the slide**: no apology to open; no "that's about it" to close; a question is answered, not argued with; feedback quotes before it judges, and never mentions accent.
- ◆ **You circulate** with Fix / Refine / Wow. Hear at least one full speech per group. The most common C2 problem is not language but **time**: rich speakers overrun. The timekeeper's "Thank you" at 3:15 is final.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SPEECH LAB

SAY: *How long is each speech? (Three minutes.) What happens at 3:15? (The timekeeper says "Thank you" and the speech ends.) · How many questions? (One.) · Can you open with "Sorry, I'm nervous"? (No: a hook.) · What does the feedback lead write? (The slip: five criteria, one line to remember, one change.) · Does feedback mention accent? (Never.) · Can you sit down to speak? (Yes.) · When do you change roles? (When the teacher says "Change.")*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Allow a **two-minute** speech from a skeleton of five key words, with the first and last sentences written in full on a card. Give the learner three phrase cards to hold: *I want to leave you with two thoughts · Which brings me to my second point · If you remember one thing today, let it be this*. Let them be **timekeeper** first so they hear two speeches before giving theirs. In the workbook: Ex 1, Ex 3 and Ex 4 (first two lines). Target: a real hook, one deliberate pause, and a close that ends on a full stop.

STRETCH

Build the speech on a **curiosity gap** that the close shuts, and use two rhetorical devices so that neither is audible as a device. In the Q&A, don't just concede and narrow: **reframe** ("I'd put the question slightly differently..."). Give the speech twice in the week (once in class, once recorded) with one deliberate change, and compare. As feedback lead, name the exact moment a pause or stress changed the meaning. Early finishers write a 60-second version of the same speech: what survives?

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Syllable-timed rhythm.** Speakers of syllable-timed languages (Spanish, French, Italian, Portuguese in part, Turkish, Tagalog, and many others) and mora-timed Japanese give syllables more equal weight, so contrastive stress and the squeezed unstressed syllable feel unnatural. The stress drill helps more than explanation. Praise audible contrast, not accent change.
- ◆ **Tone languages and pitch.** For Mandarin, Cantonese, Vietnamese and Thai speakers, pitch carries word meaning in L1, so using pitch for emphasis or attitude can feel risky, and some speakers flatten it. Show that English uses **length and loudness** as well as pitch for emphasis.
- ◆ **The opening apology.** In several speech cultures (Japanese is the best-known example, and it occurs in Korean, Chinese and many others) a modest opening ("I am not a skilled speaker, but...") is a courtesy. In an English speech it reads as a lack of confidence. Present it as a **genre convention**, not a moral one, and offer a warm alternative: "Thank you for having me. I want to begin with a question."
- ◆ **Eye contact norms.** Sustained eye contact with individuals can feel intrusive or disrespectful to some learners (in parts of East Asia, among some West African and Indigenous communities, and for many neurodivergent people regardless of background). Offer "scan the room and rest on friendly faces" or "look at the space between two people" as full alternatives; never mark eye contact down on its own.
- ◆ **Bold claims and modesty.** Learners from traditions that prize understatement (Japanese, Korean, Scandinavian, Dutch and others, for different reasons) may resist a "bold claim" open. Offer the question or story open instead. Learners from more oratorical traditions (Arabic, Persian, Greek, Italian, many West African) may over-ornament: remind them that at C2 the device should be invisible.
- ◆ **"Discuss about," "explain me," "return back."** These fossilized items come back under pressure, especially in the Q&A. Note them for the private fossilization log, not the board.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_23.html. Listen to the speech and its Q&A with the Listen buttons and shadow the speaker's lines, matching the pauses and the stress; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Do the project **Deliver a 2–3 Minute Talk** as a **recording** of today's speech with one change suggested on your feedback slips; watch it once with the sound off and once with the picture off. Workbook 8.2: "My new words" and the journal. **Project:** draft and polish your masterwork; send written pieces (or a five-line abstract for a speech) to your salon group by the evening before C25; complete the lifelong-command plan in Workbook 8.3.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** it primes the audience's attention and lets the line land. · Q2 **A** concede the valid part, then narrow to your actual point. · Q3 (new) **B** memorize the open and close; speak the middle from a skeleton of key points. Ex 1A: 1 pause · 2 rhetorical question · 3 stress · 4 rule of three · 5 eye contact · 6 vocal variety. Ex 2: thing · question · differ · began · parts · hand. Ex 3: 1 b · 2 c · 3 b.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ present a **substantial capstone piece** of their own choosing (a speech, an op-ed, a creative piece or a research summary) that integrates the full C2 range: the exact word, controlled register, cohesion across the whole, rhetoric and figurative language with purpose, and a recognizable personal voice
- ◆ make the craft **invisible**: deploy the range deliberately in the draft, then polish until nothing sounds placed rather than arisen
- ◆ **field a searching discussion** on their piece: understand the question behind the question, concede the valid part, narrow to the claim that survives, stay composed
- ◆ respond to a peer's work with the **peer-response protocol**: quote, describe the effect, probe, challenge fairly, offer one change
- ◆ judge their own performance against the **C2 standard** (spontaneous, very fluent, precise, differentiating finer shades of meaning) and name one triumph and one growth edge
- ◆ commit to a specific, self-diagnosed **lifelong-command plan** built on four habits: read widely, use the language where it matters, teach it, live in it

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 8.3 (the four formats, the integration map, discussion language, Exercises 1–5, the **masterwork planning frame**, the pre-presentation checklist, the **lifelong-command plan**, the rubric self-check, the final journal)
- ◆ Slides 15–18 · Phrase cards (response protocol, concede → narrow) · The **masterwork kit** (materials set I): **rotation sheet**, **chair's script**, **response slips** (3 per learner) · The **four format rubrics + discussion rubric** (set J) · **Lifelong-command exchange cards** (set K) · **Teacher observation checklist** (set L) on a clipboard · a timer on the screen
- ◆ Listening scripts **8.3-A** (a masterwork and its discussion) and **8.3-B** (a model response round)
- ◆ Learners' pieces (shared the evening before, or 4 printed copies each) · spare copies of the model excerpt for anyone who arrives without a piece

BOARD PLAN

Left: THE SALON (per learner, about 10 min). Chair introduces (15 s) · Presentation (4–5 min) ·

Reflect: Respondent 1 quotes what landed (1 min) · **Probe:** Respondent 1 asks a genuine question (1

min) · **Challenge:** Respondent 2 raises one challenge; presenter concedes → narrows (1½ min) · **Offer:**

"If this were mine, I might..." (30 s) · Response slips (1 min) · rotate

Center: CONCEDE → NARROW. That's a genuinely important challenge, and you're right to press it. · Let me draw the distinction I actually mean. · I'm not saying...; I'm saying... · Granted, ...; what I'm claiming is narrower: ... · I'd resist the word "..."; I'd say "...". instead. · If I've understood you, the worry is that...

Right: RESPONDING. What landed for me was the phrase "...": it made me... · I wonder whether... · What made you choose... rather than...? · Someone might push back on... · If this were mine, I might...

Lifelong command: read · use · teach · live in it.

Corner: Challenge the work, never the person. · The chair stops personal questions. · Not a grade: C25 is practice. · C26 = the final assessment + celebration.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: one line to carry home	4	S-S	Review C23-C24. Pairs (not from the same salon group): each learner says the last sentence of their masterwork, performed, and says in one breath what the piece is about. Partner repeats the line back and names its device, if any. Then everyone sits with their salon group and checks that all pieces arrived.
Pre-task: a masterwork and its discussion	9	S → S-S	Slides 15-16. Show the four formats and the integration map in 1 minute (no re-teaching). Read Script 8.3-A (the door and the room; two voices). Listen 1: "What's the central image? Does the speaker change her position?" Listen 2: Workbook Ex 1 (name the thread) and the comprehension questions. Pairs check. Point out the move under challenge: she concedes the risk of elitism, draws the distinction she actually means , and narrows the claim to one that survives.
The response protocol	6	T-S → S-S	Slide 17. Read Script 8.3-B (a model response round on a short op-ed opening). Learners identify the four moves: reflect · probe · challenge · offer. CCQs (below). Drill the frames quickly. Workbook Ex 5 items 1-2 in pairs (vague feedback → precise feedback).
Salon set-up	3	T-S	Hand out the rotation sheet, chair's script, response slips and the rubric for each presenter's format. Each learner checks whom they respond to

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			first (Respondent 1) and whom they challenge (Respondent 2). ICQs.
Reading & response prep	8	S	Silent reading. Each learner rereads the two pieces they respond to (they should have read them the night before), marks one phrase that landed and drafts one genuine question (as Respondent 1) or one fair challenge (as Respondent 2) on a sticky note. Speakers' pieces: read the five-line abstract. Meanwhile each presenter rehearses their opening line silently. You circulate and help respondents sharpen one challenge each: "Is it about the work? Is it answerable?"
TASK: the Masterwork Salon	40	groups of 4 (or 3)	Four salons of about 10 minutes each, run by the chair from the script: introduction (15 s) → presentation (4–5 min; see "The four formats in the salon") → reflect and probe (Respondent 1, 2 min) → challenge (Respondent 2, 1½ min) → offer (both respondents, 30 s) → everyone writes a response slip and circles the format rubric (1 min). Big timer on the screen; call "Rotate" every 10 minutes. You sit in on every group in turn with the observation checklist . Groups of 3: three salons of 13 minutes (longer discussion).
Lifelong-command exchange	7	S–S	Slide 18. New pairs (across groups). Each learner shares their lifelong-command plan using the exchange card: "My growth edge is... · My four habits are... · My first step, this week, is...". The partner asks one question to make a commitment more specific ("How many pages? Which day?") and writes their name as accountability partner on the card, with a date to message each other. Plans may be for a new identity.
Feedback & language focus	8	T–S	First the content : name two outstanding moments (a line that landed; a concession that narrowed the claim beautifully) and one precise response you overheard (no names, or with permission). Then board 2 Fixes, 2 Refines and 1–2 Wows. Learners complete the rubric self-check in Workbook 8.3.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Looking ahead & homework	5	T-S	Preview C26 (see "Looking Ahead"). Collect pieces, plans and self-checks (or ask learners to email them tonight). Homework: record the masterwork (online capstone), the final journal. Learners tick the 8.3 "I can..." list.
Total	90		4 + 9 + 6 + 3 + 8 + 40 + 7 + 8 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the Salon: a learner who made a masterwork and doesn't get to present it will be hurt. Cut in this order: (1) Script 8.3-B shrinks to the challenge and offer only; (2) reading time drops to 5 minutes if pieces were shared the night before (they should be); (3) the discussion in each salon drops from 4 to 3 minutes (the offer round is written on the slip only); (4) the lifelong-command exchange shrinks to 4 minutes, with the accountability message sent after class. **Never cut Looking Ahead:** learners must leave knowing exactly what C26 looks like.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION (REVIEW)

No new grammar. The work today is **integration** (every C2 thread in one piece), **composure** (answering the challenge actually made) and **generosity** (responding to a peer precisely). Keep CCQs fast.

SAY: "You are asked to deploy the full range deliberately, then make that deliberateness invisible." Is a piece where you can hear "there's the metaphor, there's the inversion" a success? (No: the seams show.) · Five metaphors, three inversions and a chiasmus in one paragraph? (A showreel, not a piece: deploy only what the thought needs.) · Is the masterwork about learning a new technique? (No: orchestrating the ones you have.)

SAY: A discussant asks: "Isn't there something a little elitist in that?" Response A: "No. That's not what I said." (Stonewall.) Response B: "You're right. Forget it." (Collapse.) Response C: "That's a genuinely important challenge, and you're right to press it. Let me draw the distinction I actually mean: I'm not saying mastery makes a person richer; I'm saying it opens particular rooms." Which is poised? (C.) What are its moves? (Acknowledge → concede the risk → narrow the claim.) · Is narrowing the same as giving up? (No: the claim that survives is often stronger.)

SAY: A respondent says "It was really good, well done." Useful to a C2 writer? (Not very: nothing specific.) Better? ("What landed for me was 'information's impersonation': it made the familiar phrase suddenly suspicious.") · A respondent gives ten corrections. Useful? (No: one or two, framed as offers.) · Who decides whether to take a suggestion? (The writer.)

Presenting	My piece asks whether... · I want to argue the opposite, and I'll try to earn your agreement as I go. · This is a short story about... told from the point of view of... · The research points, cautiously, toward...	frame, don't apologize
Check the question	If I've understood you, the worry is that... · Do you mean... or...? · Is the question really about...?	find the question behind the question
Concede → narrow	That's a genuinely important challenge, and you're right to press it. · Granted, ... · Let me draw the distinction I actually mean. · I'm not saying...; I'm saying... · What I'm claiming is narrower: ... · I'd resist the word "..."; I'd say "..." instead.	C2 7.2 diplomacy
Reflect	What landed for me was... · The phrase "..." did a lot of work: ... · The moment I leaned in was when...	quote first
Probe	What made you choose... rather than...? · I wonder whether... · Could you say more about...?	genuine, answerable
Challenge	Someone might push back on... · How would you answer a reader who...? · Does the evidence really support "...", or something narrower?	the work, never the person
Offer	If this were mine, I might... · One thing I'd be tempted to try is... · You might consider...	one, not ten; writer decides

Pronunciation for presenting and discussing. Bring 8.2 into the salon. The opening line is said slowly with a pause after it. A read-aloud passage (op-ed, creative piece) is **performed**, not read: look up at the end of each sentence, pause at paragraph breaks, and slow the last line. In the discussion, the concession falls and is sincere ("You're **right** to press it ↘"); the narrowing restarts with a slightly higher pitch and stresses the contrast ("I'm not saying **RICHer**; I'm saying it opens **ROOMS**"). A respondent's quotation is said in a slightly different voice, so the group hears it as quoted.

◆ **DRILL SCRIPT (QUICK, CHORAL → INDIVIDUAL)**

- 1 Concede → narrow chain:** T gives a challenge: "Isn't this just nostalgia?" S1: "That's a fair challenge, and you're right to press it." S2: "Let me draw the distinction I actually mean." S3: "I'm not saying the past was better; I'm saying we lost one thing worth keeping." New challenge, new chain.
- 2 Vague → precise:** T: "It was really interesting." → S: "What landed for me was the image of..., because..." T: "Maybe change the ending?" → S: "If this were mine, I might end on the image of the door, and cut the last sentence."
- 3 Resist the word:** T: "So you think experts are useless?" → S: "I'd resist the word 'useless'; I'd say

'overtrusted.'" T: "So technology is bad for learning?" → S: "I'd resist 'bad'; I'd say 'badly used.'"

- 4 **Check the question:** T asks a long, slightly unclear question. S: "If I've understood you, the worry is that... Is that right?" Then S answers in one sentence.

◆ THE FOUR FORMATS IN THE SALON

Format	Length (prepared)	In the salon (4–5 min)	Rubric focus
Speech	4–5 minutes spoken	Delivered in full, from notes; bookends by heart.	structure for the ear · rhetoric performed · voice · audience
Op-ed	500–700 words, for a named publication or readership	A 1-minute spoken frame (the argument and why now), then the presenter performs the two strongest paragraphs. The group has read the whole piece.	thesis & angle · argument & concession · voice for a general reader · concision
Creative piece	500–700 words: a short story, a personal essay, a sequence of prose poems, a dramatic monologue	Read aloud (up to 4 minutes; an excerpt if longer), then a 30-second craft note : one choice the writer made and why.	controlling image · style & voice · figurative language · diction · reading aloud
Research summary	500–700 words synthesizing at least three sources on one question	A 4-minute spoken briefing from notes for an intelligent non-specialist: the question, what the evidence says, how strong it is, what remains open.	question & scope · synthesis · attribution & calibrated hedging · clarity

Subjects are the learner's choice, within the module's territory (workplace, education, science, arts and culture, technology, language, community). The subject starters on the format cards help anyone who is stuck. Research summaries must use real, checkable sources: ask for a short source list at the end, and remind learners not to invent statistics. Creative pieces may be fiction; a personal essay may draw on invented or composite experience, and nobody is asked whether it is "true."

◆ SETTING UP THE SALON (END OF C24) – GROUPS, ROLES, ROTATION

Groups: 4 is ideal (3 works). **Mix formats** inside a group so respondents meet something new, and mix confident and anxious presenters. Avoid putting close friends together: they respond gently. Announce groups at the end of C24 so pieces can be shared. Each group gets a **rotation sheet** (materials set I):

Salon	Presenter	Respondent 1 (reflect & probe)	Respondent 2 (challenge)	Chair & timekeeper
1	A	B	C	D

2	B	C	D	A
3	C	D	A	B
4	D	A	B	C

Every learner presents once, reflects-and-probes once, challenges once and chairs once. They read closely only **two** pieces. **Groups of 3:** A–B–C, with Respondent 2 also acting as chair. **Absences:** you become Respondent 2 in one group, or run a group of 5 with two Respondents 2. A learner who arrives **without a piece** still responds and chairs, and presents the **planning frame** as a 2-minute pitch ("Here is what my masterwork will be"), then takes the discussion: the discussion is the C2 skill you most want to see.

Who chairs well: the chair keeps time, reads the introduction, runs the offer round and **stops any question that becomes personal** ("Let's keep to the piece. Next question, please."). A dominant speaker makes a good chair, because the job is to bring others in; so does an anxious learner who likes structure, because the chair's script tells them exactly what to say.

***SAY:** ICQs: How long do you present? (Four to five minutes.) · Respondent 1: what two things do you do? (Quote what landed, then ask a genuine question.) · Respondent 2? (One fair challenge.) · Is a challenge about the person OK? (No: the chair stops it.) · When a challenge is fair, what does the presenter do? (Concede it, then narrow.) · What does everyone write at the end? (A response slip, and circle the rubric.) · How many changes do you offer? (One.) · Is this a grade? (No, it's practice for C26.)*

◆ RUNNING A SALON – THE CHAIR'S ORDER (ABOUT 10 MINUTES)

- 1 Chair introduces** (15 s): "Welcome. Our presenter is Lina. Her masterwork is an op-ed for a city magazine, arguing that every library should keep one room free of screens. Lina, you have five minutes."
- 2 Presentation** (4–5 min): the chair shows "1 MINUTE" and "TIME."
- 3 Reflect** (Respondent 1, 1 min): "What landed for me was..." (a quoted phrase or moment, and its effect).
- 4 Probe** (Respondent 1, 1 min): one genuine question about meaning or a choice; one short follow-up allowed.
- 5 Challenge** (Respondent 2, 1½ min): one fair challenge to the thesis, the evidence or a craft choice. The presenter concedes what is valid and narrows. One follow-up allowed.
- 6 Offer** (both respondents, 30 s): "If this were mine, I might...". The presenter says only "Thank you": no defending during offers.
- 7 Response slips** (1 min): everyone except the presenter writes a slip and circles the format rubric; the presenter notes the question they found hardest. Rotate.

◆ THE RUBRICS AND THE OBSERVATION CHECKLIST → C26

The format rubrics (set J; the self-check version is in Workbook 8.3) each have five criteria, three shared by all formats (**integration of the C2 range** · **precision & register** · **coherence across the whole**) and two specific to the format (for example **rhetoric performed** and **voice & delivery** for a speech; **synthesis** and **calibrated attribution** for a research summary). **The discussion rubric** has three: understanding the question · concede & narrow · composure. Three levels: **Mastery** (the C2 standard: precise, nuanced, effortless) · **Secure** (strong, with occasional visible effort or near-misses) · **Developing** (the range is there but not yet controlled). Respondents circle the rubric for the presenter; learners self-assess; you use both for written feedback returned at C26. **Don't grade C25**: it's practice. Say so clearly.

The observation checklist (set L) has one row per learner and 10 can-do items. Three marks: ✓ did it clearly · ~ did it with visible effort, or with slips that affect precision · ○ not yet / not observed. You can't sit through every salon: see each learner's whole presentation or at least their discussion, and one of their responses. After class, use it to:

- ◆ **Plan each learner's C26 assessment.** The C2 final assessment is **an individual speaking interview (about 12 minutes) plus listening, reading and writing tasks** — see the kit's C2 final assessment. Before C26, read it and match your checklist notes to its speaking criteria: which subjects suit each learner, and where to begin the interview so that each learner starts with something they did well.
- ◆ **Plan the C26 warm-up:** the two items with the most ~ / ○ across the class become a short review before the assessment begins.
- ◆ **Write one sentence of feedback** for each learner on the returned piece, naming a real strength from the salon specifically ("Your concession to Sam's point about cost narrowed your claim and made it stronger"), and fill in their **fossilization slip** (two or three persistent items, with the correct form).
- ◆ **Spot who needs reassurance:** anyone who froze under challenge gets a quiet word at the end of C25: "Next class is one-to-one and friendly. No audience. You'll be fine."

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Before C25 (in C24 or by message), agree a **lighter piece**: a 3-minute speech, or 350–450 words in any format, built directly from the planning frame's sentence starters. In the salon, allow a **3-minute** presentation and ask the group's Respondent 2 to use a **probe** rather than a hard challenge. Give the learner four phrase cards to hold: *That's a fair point* · *Let me draw the distinction I mean* · *What landed for me was...* · *If this were mine, I might....* As a respondent, they may write their question in advance and read it. Target: one precise quotation as a respondent, and one concede-and-narrow as a presenter.

STRETCH

Answer the question *behind* the challenge: name its assumption ("That question assumes that access is the only barrier; I'd question that"). **Reframe** rather than defend. In the piece, aim for **one** device that carries the whole (like the door and the room) rather than several. As Respondent 2, challenge a **craft** choice, not only the argument ("Does the second metaphor compete with the first?"). At home: write a 150-word **afterword** revising the piece in light of the hardest question, and a second version of the lifelong plan for five years, not one.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Where the main point goes.** Some rhetorical traditions build toward the point (Japanese *ki-shō-ten-ketsu*, Korean *gi-seung-jeon-gyeol*, and some Chinese, Arabic and Persian essay conventions value context before claim). An English op-ed or briefing puts it **early**; a creative piece may delay it on purpose. Frame it as a choice of genre, not a better way of thinking.
- ◆ **Fossilized items at C2.** The ones most likely to surface in a polished piece: articles with abstract or generic nouns (*the society, the nature* meaning "nature in general") · uncountables made plural (*researches, advices, informations, evidences*) · present perfect with a finished time (*I have finished it last year*) · *since / for* confusion · dependent prepositions (*depend of, consist in* for *consist of, interested for*) · *discuss about, emphasize on, explain me*. Put them on the fossilization slip, one learner at a time, never on the board with names.
- ◆ **Challenging a peer in public.** Learners from cultures where questioning a peer publicly risks loss of face (Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Thai, Vietnamese, Filipino, and many others) may only praise; learners from more direct traditions may challenge bluntly. The role card helps both: "The card asks for a challenge; it's your job, not your opinion." Teach the softeners: *Someone might push back on...* · *I wonder whether....*
- ◆ **Reading instead of presenting.** Learners from exam systems that reward memorized recitation may read an op-ed or research summary word for word. The format rules help: op-eds perform two paragraphs, briefings are from notes. Allow a full script at home for confidence.
- ◆ **Spelling system.** Written pieces often mix American and British spelling (*analyze* and *organisation* in one paragraph). Ask for one system; it's the kind of consistency a C2 reader notices.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c2/lesson_24.html. Listen to the masterwork and its discussion with the Listen buttons and shadow the speaker's concession; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Do the **Capstone Project** as a **recording** of your masterwork, with the one change from today's slips you chose to make, and answer the hardest question your group asked, better than you did in class.

Workbook 8.3: the rubric self-check (if not finished) and the **final journal**: the letter to your A1 self and your own curriculum for the years ahead. Send your accountability partner the message you agreed. Bring the workbook to C26.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** integrating the whole range into one seamless, effortless piece. · Q2 **C** keep growing through lifelong reading, real-world use, teaching, and living in it. · Q3 (new) **B** the specific response that quotes, describes an effect, wonders and offers one change. Ex 1: mot juste · register · cohesion · rhetoric · personal voice. Ex 2: reading · teach · garden · door. Ex 3: 1 below the bar · 2 meets it · 3 below the bar · 4 (new) meets it. Full answers in the answer key.

CLOSING THE MODULE AND THE COURSE

END OF C25: MODULE 8, C2 AND THE WHOLE LADDER

Recap on slide 18: "Key word · count · meaning · fit" → "If you remember one thing today, let it be this." → "You're right to press that; let me draw the distinction I actually mean." → read · use · teach · live in it. Perform for a mark scheme, perform for a room, perform as yourself. Learners tick the three "I can..." lists and look back at the "I can..." lists from Module 1. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you, for the C26 warm-up.

The C26 final assessment covers the whole C2 course. From this module the most relevant skills are: sustaining a structured, precise long turn; taking part in a discussion that rewards interaction; answering an unexpected, searching question with composure (concede, narrow, reframe); and writing a controlled, well-organized piece for a specified reader. Check the kit's C2 final assessment for exactly how it tests them.

WHAT TO TELL LEARNERS AT THE END OF C25 (SLIDE 18)

C26 has two parts. First, the **C2 final assessment: an individual speaking interview (about 12 minutes) plus listening, reading and writing tasks — see the kit's C2 final assessment.** Read it before C26 and tell learners how the class will be organized (the order of the tasks and when each learner will be interviewed), so there are no surprises. Then a **celebration:** certificates, a look back at what everyone can do now, and the next steps, which at C2 are the learner's own: a formal exam if a credential opens a door they want, demanding professional or academic use, teaching or mentoring, translation or interpreting pathways, and the lifelong-command plan.

Say it simply: "Next class is our last class. You'll have a one-to-one conversation with me for about twelve minutes, and some listening, reading and writing. It's everything we've practiced. Today you presented a piece you chose and answered questions you didn't expect, from people who had read it closely. That was harder than anything in C26. Then we celebrate."

Reduce anxiety: show C2 lesson 1.1 on screen and ask: "Week 1: could you have chosen between *impersonation* and *copy* for a reason, performed it, and defended the choice?" Then remind them of the longer view: for many learners this is the end of a ladder that started at A1. Let them hear how far they've come. Remind them that the online lessons stay open for review, and that their recorded masterwork is the best preparation for the interview.

Celebration planning: if learners want to bring food to share in C26, great. Ask everyone to label their dish with its main ingredients (allergies, halal, vegetarian). Nobody should feel they have to bring anything. Invite 2–3 volunteers to give a one-minute closing speech: "**one line I'll carry home from this course**", the C24 skill, with the friendliest audience of all. Learners who want to may read their "letter to my A1 self" aloud, or one line of it; nobody is asked to.